

Essays from the British Critic

John Henry Cardinal Newman

Newman's essays and reviews for the British Critic, the review of the Oxford Movement.

Essays of 1836 to

1842.

Contents

ART. VI.—The Theological Library. Vol. XIII.—The Life of Archbishop Laud. By Charles Webb Le Bas, M.A. Professor in the East India College, Herts, and late Fellow of Trinity College, Cambridge. London: Rivingtons. 1836.	2
ART. X.—The History of the Christian church, from the Ascension of Jesus Christ to the Conversion of Constantine. By the Rev. Edward Burton, D.D. 1836.	21
ART. VI.—Lectures on the Principal Doctrines and Practices of the Catholic Church. By Nicholas Wiseman, D.D. London: Booker. 1836.	37
ART. V.—The Life of Augustus Hermann Franké, &c. Translated from the German of H. E. F. Guericke, by Samuel Jackson. With an introductory Preface, by the Rev. E Bickersteth. Seeley and Burnside.	58
ART. II. Geraldine—a Tale of conscience. By E. C. A. In 2 vols. London: Booker and Dolman. 1837.	73
ART. VIII.—Random Recollections of Exeter Hall in 1834-1837. By one of the Protestant Party. London: Nisbet. 1838.	88
ART. II.—Travels in the Three Great Empires of Austria, Russia, and Turkey. By C. B. Elliott, M.A., F.R.S. 2 vols. Bentley. 1838.	102
ART. VI.—1. Ancient Christianity, and the Doctrines of the Oxford Tracts. By the Author of "Spiritual Despotism." Part I. London. Jackson & Walford. 1839. 2. Brief Memoirs of Nicolas Ferrar, M.A., Founder of a Protestant Religious Establishment; chiefly collected from a Narrative by the Right Rev. Dr. Turner, formerly Lord Bishop of Ely, and now edited with Additions. By the Rev. T. A. Macdonogh, Vicar of Bovingdon. Second Edition. London: Nisbet. 1837.	114
ART. II.—The Court of King James the First. By Dr. Godfrey Goodman, Bishop of Gloucester. To which are added Letters illustrative. Now first published from the Original MSS. By John S. Brewer, M.A. Bentley. 1839.	126
ART. IV.—1. The Protestant Exiles of Zillerthal: translated from the German of Dr. Rheinwald. By J. B. Saunders. London: Hatchard. 1840. 2. Persecution of the Lutheran Church in Prussia from 1831 to the present Time, compiled from German Publications: chiefly translated by J. D. Löwenberg. London: Hamilton and Adams. 1840.	137
ART. VI.—1. Catena Aurea, Commentary on the Four Gospels, collected out of use Works of the Fathers. By S. Thomas Aquinas. Vol. I. St. Matthew, Part 1. Oxford: J. H. Parker. 1841. 2. The Gospel Narrative of our Lord's Passion harmonized, with Reflections. By Rev. Isaac Williams, B. D. Fellow of Trinity College, Oxford. Rivingtons. 1841.	150
Notices of Books	162
Notices of Books	168
Notices of Books	175
Notices of Books	181
Notices of Books	185
Notices of Books	194
Notices of Books	199
Notices of Books	204
Notices of Books	210

Notices of Books	213
Notices of Books	218
Notices of Books	225
Notices of Books	230

ART. VI.—The Theological Library. Vol. XIII.—The Life of Archbishop Laud. By Charles Webb Le Bas, M.A. Professor in the East India College, Herts, and late Fellow of Trinity College, Cambridge. London: Rivingtons. 1836.

[*British Critic*, vol. 18, April 1836.]

IN this volume Mr. Le Bas has added to those claims upon the gratitude of Churchmen, which he has successively made of late years, by stimulating at once and supplying the thirst for ecclesiastical history, ignorance of which may safely be accounted one of the most deplorable evils of this time. No one can judge of the exact measure of evil in a deficiency, who is not aware that there is any deficiency at all. Those, then, who know nothing whatever of the history of Christianity in past times, whose insight into the course of Providence for 1800 years is confined to some slight acquaintance with chronology, or with the names of such sects and parties as prevail *de facto* in this day, wilt remain contented with the present platform of things, and will take every event in the ecclesiastical world as it comes, without capacity or anxiety to form any definite judgment about it. To them one opinion about existing matters is as good as another, and none good for much, except it be to afford subject for conversation, or lead to this or that immediate secular result. Ecclesiastical changes or movements are regarded merely as they affect local or personal interests or political parties. But let a man know ever so little of the history of former times, and he will at once discern, if he has any portion of a serious and thoughtful mind, that he is under a course or dispensation of things, as truly though not as visibly divine, as the Jewish; that no event which happens to the Church stands by itself, but arises from the past, influences the future, and bears upon the eternal destinies of thousands upon thousands. Under these circumstances the real condition both of himself and of his generation is brought home to him; he and they are like travellers on a desert without sun or landmark, chart or compass; they do not know how they came there, or whither they are tending, so that every step is fearful lest it should be in the wrong direction. For instance, at present we are evidently working out principles and events of three centuries old, elements of good and evil, which have to be sifted, separated, repressed, fostered, as the case may be, and have employed in this very work our great Divines and Churchmen ever since. Popery and Puritanism are still alive and struggling for the ascendancy, and must be resisted by the same measures, or at least on the same principles, on which Whitgift or Hooker resisted them in their day; and, if we do not know their faces when we fall in with them, and are surprised and over-reached in consequence, it will assuredly not be for want of opportunities of information, if we would employ them.

A curious and almost incredible instance of this exceeding ignorance as regards *facts*, is afforded by certain strange and not unfrequent mistakes in our treatment of standard authors, viz. in citing, as their own, not their own text, but the positions which they have undertaken to refute, and building an argument thence as if on the vantage-ground of their authority. It has been confessed by the representatives of the late respected Mr. Scott, of Aston Sandford, that for years and years his "Force of Truth" contained as Hooker's a passage of Cartwright's which Hooker had undertaken to refute; and another modern writer might be named who is open to the charge of having, in all

innocence, taken a similar liberty with the same great divine. Again, it is said that the popular duodecimo editions of Pascal's *Thoughts* contain passages which he had quoted, we believe from some French author, for the sake of refuting. Now it is no great crime to mistake Bull for Pearson, or Cave for Bingham, or Basil for Chrysostom, but to mistake Augustine for Pelagius, or Hooker for Cartwright, certainly does require an explanation, and total and self-satisfied ignorance is the kindest explanation we can suggest. Writers now-a-days open the volumes of our old divinity, not to know their contents or gain instruction from them, but to see if there be any thing there which will tell in favour of their own views. They turn over the pages, and, if any passage strike them as apposite, down it goes in their note-book, and is forthwith published without any solicitude about its why or whereabouts, its history, its parentage, its occasion, or its context.

Mistakes about the Middle Ages afford another pregnant evidence both of our ignorance of history and of our resignation under it. A Turkish Minister, on the news of a battle between Russians and Persians, is said to have asked his informant, "what it was to the Sublime Porte whether the dog beat the hog or the hog the dog?" And like his is the indolent superciliousness with which a pseudo-protestantism regards the dealings of God with his Church through a whole decade of centuries. Were it not that we cannot help dating our letters 1836, it might be suspected that we thought Christianity a few hundred years old, or that, like the Persian monarch, by dipping our head into water and lifting it out again, we had annihilated long periods which once had an existence. Or, as the other alternative, we seem to deny, that the Gospel had ever really a beginning, or Christianity founders; as if it had existed as an opinion, or rather as a hundred discordant opinions, from time immemorial, derived from a volume written in English, and set up in types, and sold in Earl Street, Blackfriars, from time immemorial. The fact that it has existed and been dispensed in divers times and places is above the reach of our present religionists. Certainly they would feel indignant at being confused with their ancestors of four centuries since, nay with the witch-finders and astrologists of a more recent date; yet they feel no conscience at throwing together in one the eras, persons, and exploits of more extended and not less eventful periods. The respective characteristics of this or that series of Popes, the varying relations of Church and State in this or that country, the differences of ecclesiastical policy between an Henry and an Edward, are subjects quite beyond the range of their sensibilities; and they are satisfied that Popery being one and the same in all times, what happened in one century may be fairly fastened in condemnation upon the character of the next.

Another serious indication and result of the same ignorance is the flippancy with which even religious writers speak of the established forms of orthodoxy, and the labours of the early Fathers to whom we owe their public adoption. Every word in the Creeds is the issue of a long history of controversy and trouble; and till we know that history, we cannot possibly know the value of such expressions, nor the expediency or lawfulness of altering or dispensing with them. Every error, now produced, is the same or all but the same as former errors; and though the fact that an opinion has been anticipated long since, is no argument to its present upholders that it is an error, yet it is a reason why they should not be so very well pleased with themselves, and so very confident that they have wherewith to demolish received doctrines. Every rite and ceremony is expressive, with more or less accuracy, of one certain character of mind, in distinction to others. The times of which Mr. Le Bas treats in the present volume furnish abundant illustrations of this last remark. What could apparently be so futile as a contest about a vestment or a posture, on which continually the controversy turned with the Puritans? But in fact, as that contest when viewed in the history shows, such differences were but the external indications of ecclesiastical views radically distinct

from one another.

But it is time to turn to the consideration of Mr. Le Bas' present volume. The author seems to feel the delicacy and difficulty of portraying a character which at this day labours under the odium and unpopularity attaching to Archbishop Laud; but we feel no apprehension, whatever anxiety the work has cost him, that it will be not repaid with a more than counterbalancing success. Not a step, indeed, can be taken in the account of this great Prelate's life, but some or other charge has to be refuted, or mistake rectified; and the difficulty of course is very considerable, to do what mere justice requires, and yet to avoid the appearance of being a mere partizan or panegyrist, instead of an historian. Yet we feel confident that Mr. Le Bas has so conducted his narrative as to secure its extensive popularity even in this anti-Laudian age, and that many will be the family and the solitary student whom he will disabuse of those prejudices which education has engendered.

However, the chief and truly characteristic point of view in which he represents the Archbishop is one of which perhaps he is hardly himself aware, viz. that of a Reformer. In good truth, Laud in all respects merited that now popular title, and seems to have had the virtues and defects which are commonly supposed to attach to it. We do not for an instant intend to *limit* his character to such a view of it; but we speak of its external development, and with reference to the active functions which he was specially allotted. Nor, again, must it be supposed that he was a Reformer on any principles or no principles, according to the fashion of this day, but upon definite and fixed principles, those ancient and Catholic lines of truth and sanctity which Apostles laid down once for all, and on which the Scriptures are based. Still, whatever his real inward qualities of mind, which were great, generous and bold, philosophical and devotional, and whatever the strength and truth of the principles on which he governed the Church whose interests were committed to him, after all he was, all through his life, and is conspicuous in history as being, a *Reformer*, amid as unchristian abuses, and with as tough a struggle, and with as hard an issue, and as true claim to the praise of Martyrdom, as the worthies of the preceding century.

His early years at Oxford were devoted to a noble and almost chivalrous effort (as it appeared) to reclaim the University from Calvinism to the pure and primitive faith which was unjustly stigmatized at the time as Popery. And in thus resisting the "traditions of men," and appealing to "the Law and the Testimony," he incurred in full measure the enmity of those who, without having the grosser vices, had all the conceit and affectation, the formality, narrowness, and obstinacy of the Pharisees. Yet he threw himself into the contest with a high-minded spirit, and showed no signs of wincing, in spite of the false and cruel suspicions to which he was in consequence exposed. Mr. Le Bas' interesting and picturesque narrative will afford us some specimens of this contest.

"When Laud commenced his academic residence, Oxford bore a greater resemblance, in many respects, to a colony from Geneva, than to a seminary of Anglo-Catholic Divinity. The genius of Calvin presided in the schools. The dark theory of predestination was maintained as an essential ingredient in the faith of a Christian man. The Apostolic succession of Bishops was treated as little better than a fable. The authority of the Church was scornfully disregarded. The very existence of a visible Church during the long period of Papal predominance, was gravely questioned by some distinguished divines, while others maintained that it was to be sought for only in the scattered Conventicles of Berengarians, or among the Albigenses, or the mountaineers of Piedmont, or perhaps, among the Wiclifites of England, or the Hussites of Bohemia. In short, the whole life and virtue of religion appeared to be well-nigh concentrated into one thing,—an abrupt and impetuous departure from the Church of Rome.

"Now the theological studies of Laud had taught him a very different lesson. They had been

prosecuted in the spirit of the Canon of 1571; which enjoined that the interpretation of Scripture should be regulated, not by a licentious exercise of private judgment, but by a strict regard to the doctrines which had been collected from Scripture, by the primitive fathers of the Church. It was remarked by Dr. Young, by whom Laud had been ordained, that his studies had not been confined to the narrow and partial systems of Geneva; but that his scheme of divinity had been raised 'upon the noble foundations of the Fathers, the Councils, and the Ecclesiastical Historians.' And, hence, he pronounced that, if the young man's life should be spared, he would become a fit instrument for the Church's deliverance from the trammels of every modern school, and for her restoration to the more free and comprehensive principles of the first and purest ages. The whole plan and elevation of doctrine which this course of inquiry had set before him, he found to be in strict conformity with the original scheme of the Anglican Reformation; but, in many essential respects, at mortal variance with the theory and the practice which then had got possession of the schools. And he was seized with a vehement desire to bring the Church of England from this state of defection, back to her native principles.

"It was not long before an opportunity was afforded for the manifestation of his *zeal*, his *forwardness*, and his *confidence*, in the cause of pure and primitive Christianity. Such was the estimation in which he was held, as a scholar and a divine, that, in 1602, he was admitted to read the Lecture of Mrs. May's foundation, with the full consent and approbation of his College. And it was either in this, or some other academical exercise performed about the same time, that he resolved to stand forward in vindication of the Articles and Constitution of the Church. The adventure was one which, in times like those, demanded an intrepid resolution. But Laud had, doubtless, counted the cost of his warfare: and he, accordingly, maintained, in opposition to the predominant theology of the day, 'the constant and perpetual visibility of the Church of Christ, derived from the Apostles to the Church of Rome, and continued in that Church, as in others of the East and South, until the Reformation.' By this exploit he marked himself out as an object of hatred to the Puritans, and, more especially to their patron and champion Dr. George Abbot, Master of University College, Dean of Winchester; and, in 1603, Vice Chancellor of the University. This divine (who was afterwards elevated to the Primacy of all England) was the foremost man among those who affirmed that it was impossible to discern the visibility of the Church, otherwise than by tracing it, through a straggling series of sects, from the days of Berengarius to those of Luther and of Calvin. These opinions he did not embody in writing till the year 1624; but they were notoriously entertained, and urgently contended for by him, at the time when the contrary position was taken up by Laud. There is too much reason to believe that Abbot never forgave this act of open resistance to the authority of his name. And it is most certain that, from that moment to the end of his days, Laud was detested and pursued by the party of Abbot, as a confederate of Popery, and a sworn enemy to the Gospel of Christ."—pp. 5-8.

At the time of this first protest against the errors of his day, he was about 30 years old, an age which seems marked out by nature as that when the principles are at length finally settled, and the silent meditation and study of former years begin to display themselves for the good of the destined objects of their influence. Shortly after we find him engaged in a similar controversy.

"In July, 1604, he became Bachelor of Divinity. From the propositions which he undertook to defend, in his exercises for that degree, it is evident that his spirit was wholly undaunted by the resentment which his first theological essay had so recently called forth. He maintained, first, the necessity of Baptism; and, secondly, that there could be no true Church without Diocesan Bishops. Two subjects more distasteful to the Puritans could not easily have been selected. They did not

suffer the occasion to pass without reminding Laud that their eye was constantly upon him. His arguments for the necessity of Baptism were treated with contempt, on the ground that they were borrowed from the writings of Bellarmine; as if all reasoning *must* inevitably be vicious, which had been resorted to by a Papist. For his vindication of Episcopacy, he was severely assailed by Dr. Holland, Rector of Exeter College, who had succeeded Laurence Humphrey in the divinity chair. The mantle of his predecessor, as well as his office, appears to have fallen upon Holland; for he now complained loudly that the disputant was casting the torch of discord between the Church of England and the Reformed Churches beyond the seas. The result was a general conviction that Laud was becoming, every day, more thoroughly steeped in Romish superstition.”—pp. 9, 10.

In consequence a violent effort was made by the ascendant party to preclude him from the headship of his College, (St. John’s,) to which, on a vacancy in 1610, his merits justified his aspiring. Abbot, his inveterate enemy, being at this time Archbishop of Canterbury elect, addressed himself through Lord Ellesmere, the Chancellor, to the King, alleging the so-called Popery of Laud; and, when this attempt failed, recourse was had to a most unusual measure,—unusual, that is, in our own quiet times,—to hinder the election.

“It appears that among the competitors was one Rawlinson, formerly a fellow of St. John’s, and at that time Principal of St. Edmund’s Hall. When the scrutiny was completed, and the election on the point to be declared, one of Rawlinson’s supporters, perceiving that the result would certainly be favourable to Laud, suddenly snatched the scrutiny-paper, and, in a moment, tore it to pieces. By this outrage, some doubt was thrown upon the regularity of his election, and the matter was referred, by appeal, to the decision of the King.”—p. 19.

The King confirmed the election, and the dispute ended, though time of course was required to cool the heats which such dissensions involved. Mr. Le Bas here furnishes us with two remarkable facts. The first is, that, bigot and firebrand as Laud is represented, he succeeded, in the course of a few months, in restoring peace to his society, which was never afterwards interrupted. He was able to boast that, during the eleven years of his Presidentship, nothing happened to disturb it; and for the truth of this he publicly appealed in his adversity to the knowledge of individuals of consideration in the Church, who were in a condition to give evidence on the subject. The other instance shall be set before the reader in Mr. Le Bas’ own words.

“There was one part of his conduct, more especially, which could scarcely fail to disarm the hatred even of those who had been most forward to injure him. For the sake of example, it was necessary that some punishment should be inflicted on Bayley, the individual who had torn the scrutiny-paper. Laud, however, perceiving him to be a young man of promising talent, steady application, and intrepid temper, thought it wiser, as well as more charitable, to win him by kindness, than to confirm him in his alienation by severity. He accordingly released him from the censure inflicted upon him, as soon as was consistent with propriety; and, not content with this, he bestowed upon the man his favour and his confidence; and, at length, made him his Chaplain, advanced him in the Church, married him to his brother’s daughter, and, eventually, obtained his promotion to that very Presidentship which he had endeavoured to snatch from Laud, and with it, to one of the best Deaneries in the kingdom.”—pp. 20, 21.

His next dispute, and under more painful circumstances than any of the former, was with Robert Abbot, the Archbishop’s brother.

“It chanced that, in the course of a sermon preached by him (Laud) before the University on Shrove Tuesday, 1614, he had ventured on some expressions bitterly offensive to the Presbyterians. On the Easter day which followed, he (Abbott) preached at St. Peter’s in the afternoon, and his

Sermon was so obviously directed against the Preacher of Shrove Tuesday, that it was impossible for any one of the congregation to mistake the individual at whom he aimed. At this exhibition, Laud himself was not present. His friends, however, thought it due to his reputation that he should boldly make his appearance at St. Mary's, on the following Sunday; on which day, conformably to the ancient custom of the University, the same Sermon would be repeated. Laud, though not without some reluctance, consented; and the consequence was that, according to his own account of the matter to Bishop Neile, 'he was fain to sit patiently, and hear himself abused, almost an hour together; being pointed at as he sat.'

This circumstance is well worthy of attention, not only because it illustrates the spirit which never ceased to persecute him, till it brought him to the scaffold, but, also, because it shows what were some of the opinions, then stigmatized as treasonable to the Protestant faith. The following is a specimen of the language of the assailant: —

'Some,' said the preacher, 'are partly Romish and partly English, as occasion serves them; that a man may say unto them, *Noster es, an adversariorum?* who, under pretence of truth, and preaching against the *Puritan*, strike at the heart and root of the Faith and Religion now established among us. They cannot plead that they are accounted Papists, because they speak against the Puritan; but, because, being indeed Papists, they speak nothing against them. If they do, at any time, speak any thing against the Papists, they do but beat a little about the bush, and that but softly, too, for fear of waking and disquieting the birds that are in it. They speak nothing but that, wherein one Papist will speak against another; as against Equivocation, and the Pope's temporal authority, and the like; and perhaps some of their blasphemous speeches. But, in the points of *Free Will, Justification, concupiscence being a sin after Baptism, Inherent Righteousness, and certainty of Salvation*, the Papists beyond the sea can say they are wholly theirs, and the Recusants at home make their brags of them. And, in all things, they keep so near the brink, that, upon any occasion, they may step over to them. Now, for this speech, that the Presbyterians are as bad as the Papists, there is a sting in the speech which I wish had been left out; for there are many Churches beyond the seas which contend for the Religion established among us, and yet have approved and admitted the Presbytery.' Then, after some sentences in vindication of the Presbyterian Discipline, the preacher proceeded thus: 'Might not Christ say, what art thou? *Romish or English? Papist or Protestant?* Or what art thou? A mongrel, or compound of both? A *Protestant* by ordination? a *Papist* in point of *Free Will, Inherent Righteousness*, and the like? A *Protestant* in receiving the Sacrament? a *Papist* in the doctrine of the Sacrament? What, do you think there are two heavens? if there be, get you to the other, and place yourselves there. For into this, where I am, ye shall never come!'

This passage is extremely important and memorable. The invective of Abbott very plainly discloses to us certain of those ingredients which entered into the composition of what has been sometimes complained of by the vindicators of Puritanism, as the *Semi-Protestant* Divinity of those days. And this disclosure must be kept steadily in mind, if we would duly estimate the justice of the charge, that, among the theologians of James and Charles, several were guilty of a perfidious approximation to the Romish scheme of doctrine. To exalt the Eucharist above a mere act of commemoration, to maintain the freedom of the human will, to doubt whether or not the elect are favoured with a full and perfect assurance of salvation, all these were infallible symptoms of a relapse into superstition and corruption! Every step *from* Calvinism was held to be *towards* Popery. All who were not fixed and stationary at Geneva, were denounced as meditating a desertion to Rome. By artifices like these, it was that the character of *Papist* was made to adhere to Laud so closely, that he could no more shake it off, than he could escape from his own shadow. Let him say

or do what he would, he was still, manifestly, no other than a servant of Anti-Christ!"—pp. 23-26.

These extracts afford a specimen of his "good warfare" at the University, and justify our giving him the title of Reformer. His promotions, which followed successively, introduced him into fresh spheres of usefulness, and of trouble thence resulting. His first dignity was the deanery of Gloucester, and here, while it was Laud's fate to impinge at once upon abuses, which required a remedy, it was not his character tamely to acquiesce in them.

"There was not a Church in the kingdom which exhibited in more ample measure the *peculiarities* of the Calvinistic discipline. Every thing was in a state of scandalous disorder. The cathedral was falling to decay: the worship was assimilated, as nearly as might be, to the service of a Conventicle. So notorious, in short, were the irregularities which had long prevailed, that they had excited the attention and the displeasure of the King: and Laud departed for Gloucester, armed, not only with his own zeal and resolution, but with the strongest injunctions of his Majesty to effect a searching reformation. The first measure of Laud was to assemble the Chapter, to lay before them his Majesty's instructions, and to procure their consent to two acts,—the one, for a speedy reparation of the fabric; the other for removing the communion table to the east of the choir, and placing it against the wall, conformably to the usage of other Cathedral Churches. He further recommended to the Clergy, and to the subordinate officers of the Church, the practice of a reverent obeisance on entering the choir; a custom which, at that period, was generally observed, in the chapels of the King, and of many among the first nobility in the land."—pp. 27, 28.

However, he had to encounter the opposition, first of the Bishop, then of the populace, who at the cry of Popery created a tumult, and rendered it necessary for the Magistracy to interfere. Yet here, as in the case of his College, success attended his exertions. In the course of less than a twelvemonth the mob was quieted, and the disorders were reformed, at no price but that which the author of reformations must ever expect from the community, a loss of name and credit to himself, in proportion to his good deeds. Laud set right the Cathedral of Gloucester; and he gained once for all the indelible title of Papist.

This achievement was a specimen of one of the more prominent labours of Laud's life, the restoring sanctity and a permanent form to the externals of religion. He had directed his exertions this way from the first.

"Of the life and habits of Laud, as a parochial clergyman," says Mr. Le Bas, "scarcely any notice has been preserved, except, that as one of his first acts, after taking possession of a living, was to assign an annual pension to twelve poor persons, that he laid aside one fifth part of his income for charitable and pious uses; and *that it was his invariable practice to put the Glebe-house into a state of substantial repair, and to see the Church supplied with becoming furniture.*"

The zeal which animated himself in private, and in matters of personal expense, in the first years of his ministry, showed itself on a noble scale and with most beneficial and enduring results, when he was Archbishop. Let us hear Mr. Le Bas' account of his proceedings in a later period of his life.

First as to the state of Parish Churches.

"The Archbishop resolved upon a Metropolitan Visitation of the whole province of Canterbury; in other words, upon a course of warfare against the manifold indecencies and abominations which, for a long period, had disfigured the Church. One of his first cares was, for the due position of the Sacramental Table, and for its protection from irreverence and desecration. It has already appeared, that, from the moment of his first promotion, this had always held a foremost place in his thoughts: and it has been conceived by many that it occupied a disproportionate share of his attention. In

order to estimate his conduct rightly, it will be proper to take into consideration the consequences which had resulted from a neglect of this department of ecclesiastical discipline. In the Cathedral Churches, then, and in the Chapels of the Nobility, that which we now scruple not to call the *Altar*, was usually placed, *where we now uniformly see it*, close to the Eastern wall of the Church; guarded by a decent railing from defilement and profanation. In many of the Parochial Churches the case was widely different. It was dragged, by Puritanical scruple or caprice, into the body of the Church, and treated as if no peculiar sanctity belonged to it. It often served the Churchwardens for a parish-table, the school-boys for a desk, and the carpenters for a working-board. In one place, we are told, a dog had run away with the bread set apart for the Holy Communion; and in many instances the wine had been brought to the *table* in pint-pots, and bottles, and so was distributed to the people. Such were the effects of an indiscriminate aversion for the practices of Rome! It can hardly be thought surprising that any man, whose mind was rich in the knowledge of Christian antiquity, and whose heart was warm with zeal for the glory of God, should look upon these base and slovenly usages with loathing and indignation; more especially when it was found that, by such practices, the Reformed profession was identified with positive impiety, in the estimation of the most sincere and sober-minded Romanists.

The Archbishop felt it to be his duty to attempt a reform of these unseemly abuses. And when he was finally called upon to answer for his proceedings, he solemnly averred that his motive was not a stupid attachment to Popish mummeries, but solely a desire for the restoration of external and visible Religion.”—pp. 183-185.

In the above extract Mr. Le Bas exempts Cathedral Churches and private Chapels from the indignities which had been allowed in country places; however, from a subsequent passage of his work, it would appear that this is but a comparative approbation of them, and that the best that could be said of any class of sacred buildings is that they might have been worse.

“Another most important care which fell upon the Archbishop, was the restoration of the Cathedrals to a fit condition for the due and becoming celebration of Divine Worship. They were, most of them, in a state which indicated a long period of irreverent neglect. The Archbishop resolved to begin the work of reformation in his own glorious Cathedral. His first injunction was, that appropriate furniture should be provided for the solemnity of the Eucharist. And in order that this might be no transient regulation, he compiled a complete body of statutes for the government of the Church, with his own hand signed to every separate leaf, and despatched it to the Chapter under the authority of the Great Seal; and one of the enactments was, that every Prebendary, at his entrance into the Choir, and departure from it, should bow towards the Altar, and so make due reverence to Almighty God. A similar code was prepared by him for the Cathedrals of Winchester and Hereford. In various other Cathedrals, he found that the Chapters had been more careful of their own emoluments than of the repair and decoration of the fabric. And, with the aid of Bishops Davenant and Morton, such effectual measures were taken for the correction of these abuses, that the Cathedral Churches began to recover something of their ancient dignity and splendour, and to serve for an example to the Churches connected with them. That many of the parochial edifices had long been in need of some such influence to preserve them from ruin, is undeniable. Of this, one instance may be mentioned, as illustrating the feelings with which such profanation was contemplated by Laud. At a visitation held by him, when he was Bishop of London, the preacher at St. Peter’s, Cornhill, derived the word *Diaconus* from [*konis*] (*dust*); as if the title were significant of the dust and heat of a laborious life. ‘I am sorry,’ said the Bishop, afterwards, in his charge, ‘to find here so true an etymology. Here is *dust*, and dirt too, enough for a Deacon, or a Priest,

to work in; dust of the worst kind, from the ruins of this ancient House of God!’ But of all the monuments of neglect which Abbott had left behind him, the Chapel of his own palace at Lambeth was, perhaps, the most disgraceful. When first Laud came to reside there, he could never enter it without disgust. It was a scene of filth, disorder, and decay. Among other deformities, the painted windows were in some places broken to pieces; and, in many, they were miserably patched with the most ordinary glass; so that, as Laud avers, they had the appearance of a beggar’s coat. This state of things was not suffered by him to continue long. The whole Chapel was properly repaired. The windows were restored and beautified, as nearly as might be, according to the original design. The Communion-table was removed from the middle of the Chapel, fenced with a costly railing, and decorated with a suitable canopy. Plate and other furniture were provided for the Sacramental Service. Copes (which at that time were not wholly disused) were supplied for the use of the officiating Chaplains. The broken and tuneless organ was fitted up: till at length the whole place wore an aspect no longer dishonourable to the worship of God. The example of the Archbishop was not lost upon his own University; and the College chapels at Oxford gradually shook themselves from the dust.

In the principles which dictated these improvements there is surely nothing for intelligent and sober-minded men to reprove. In these days, it is difficult for us to imagine the perverseness which then revolted against the spectacle of decent solemnity—nay, of common cleanliness,—in the public services of Christian devotion. If Laud’s proceedings, relative to such matters, were Popish, then are we, of the Reformed establishment of England, now living in the midst of an almost complete apparatus of Popery; for our Cathedrals and our Churches are, for the most part, in a condition which Laud himself might have looked upon with complacency. In those times, however, a reverence towards the Altar was often thought to indicate a firm belief that Christ was corporeally present in the Sacrament of the Altar: and, in every painted window, was read no less than a design to subvert the true religion, and to set up Romish, or even semi-pagan, idolatry in its stead.”—pp. 205-207.

This frenzy of the day will account for the charge of superstition brought against Laud, in the well-known instance of his consecration of St. Catherine’s church. We should not have noticed here what we believe to be a mere exaggeration, as far as it is open to remark, except that silence might have looked as if we were ashamed of it. Mr. Hume’s account of it is as follows:—

“On the bishop’s approach to the west door of the church, a loud voice cried, ‘Open, open, ye everlasting doors, that the King of Glory may enter in!’ Immediately the doors of the church flew open, and the bishop entered. Falling upon his knees, with eyes elevated and arms expanded, he uttered these words: ‘This place is holy; the ground is holy; in the name, &c. I pronounce it holy. Going towards the chancel, he several times took up from the floor some of the dust and threw it into the air. When he approached, along with his attendants, near to the communion table, he bowed frequently towards it; and, on their return, they went round the church, repeating as they marched along, some of the Psalms; and then said a form of prayer, which concluded with these words—‘We consecrate this church, and separate it unto Thee as holy ground, not to be profaned any more to common uses.’ After this the bishop, standing near the communion table, solemnly pronounced many imprecations upon such as should afterwards pollute that holy place by musters of soldiers, &c. &c. ... On the conclusion of each curse he bowed towards the east, &c. ... The imprecations being all so piously finished, there were poured out a number of blessings on such as had any hand in forming and building that sacred and beautiful edifice, &c. ... At every, benediction he in like manner bowed towards the east, &c. ... The sermon succeeded; after

which the bishop consecrated and administered the Sacrament in the following manner. As he approached the communion table he made many lowly reverences, and coming up to that part of the table where the bread and wine lay, he bowed seven times. After the reading of many prayers, he approached the Sacramental elements, and gently lifted up the corner of the napkin in which the bread was laid. When he beheld the bread, he suddenly let fall the napkin, flew back a step or two, bowed three several times toward the bread; then he drew near again, and opened the napkin, and bowed as before. Next he laid his hand on the cup, which had a cover upon it, and was full of wine. He let go the cup, fell back, and bowed thrice towards it. He approached again, and lifting up the cover, peeped into the cup. Seeing the wine, he let fall the cover, started back, and bowed as before. Then he received the sacrament, and gave it to others; and many prayers being said, the solemnity of the consecration ended. The walls, and floor, and roof of the fabric were then supposed to be sufficiently holy."

Here Mr. Hume leaves the matter, but we will add our present author's remarks.

"His answer to this despicable charge may be seen in his own history of his trial; and the statements of his enemies, when compared with his, are almost enough to make one ashamed of human nature. It turned out that the *pompous retinue* consisted only of the officials, who always attend at consecrations; that the throwing up of dust, and the uttering of curses, were pure fictions; and that the Pontifical supplied no more to the consecration service, than the Missal is known to have done to our Liturgy. He confesses that he approached the church door with the words, *Lift up your heads, O ye gates, and be ye lift up, ye everlasting doors, and the King of Glory shall come in*—a passage which had been used at consecrations from time immemorial. He further allows that he pronounced the ground to be holy, in the name of the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Ghost. And he contends that there is a *derivative* and *relative* holiness in places, as well as vessels, and other things, dedicated to the service and honour of God. He avers that he used no bowings (or *cringings*, as they were called,) but such as were demanded by the solemnity of the place and the occasion. And he added, 'are we, who have separated the chaff, to cast away the corn too? If it come to that, let us take heed that we fall not upon the *devil's winnowing*, who labours to beat down the corn. It is not the chaff that troubles him!'"—pp. 144, 145.

"But, even admitting for a moment, the representation of his enemies, respecting this fact, to be correct, the very worst which, in that case, could justly be urged against him, amounts to no more than this,—that he was betrayed into some transgression of the rigid letter of the ritual, partly by the fervour of his own devotional feelings, and partly by his disgust at that sordid slovenliness, which, of late years, had rendered the Protestant worship contemptible, and which, be it always remembered, was driving multitudes back within the attraction of Romanism. The fanatics swaggered into the church with their hats on, and frequently so remained during the whole of the divine service. Laud, in his anxiety to correct their almost brutal irreverence, was desirous that they who entered a church, should testify, by an obeisance directed towards its most hallowed spot, that they were conscious of treading within a precinct dedicated to the majesty of Heaven. The same feeling prompted him to give peculiar solemnity to the rite of consecration, the Puritans having maintained that the sanctity of the place walked in, and walked out again, together with the congregation! In short, like many other wise and holy men, he apprehended that 'religion would grow strangely wild, if it were left to the boisterous clowneries and unmannerly liberties' of those who, in the pride of their humility, trampled on the decorous appointments and ordinances of the Church."—pp. 146, 147.

In addition to these apposite observations, we would ask, is there any opportunity for exagger-

ation more ready than when testimony is to be given concerning manner, gesture, tone of voice, and the like; any circumstances which admit of so much unconscious colouring from the prejudices and feelings of the witnesses? The evidence given every day in police courts, of quarrels or riots, is sufficient to verify this remark. Whether this man or that spoke civilly or insolently,—what were the very words used by each,—who struck first,—whether the party struck, or shoved, or passively repelled, or submitted,—all such questions have two solutions, equally true and equally false, depending on the side in the dispute taken by the deponents under examination. And in like manner, to a rude and scornful mind, to bow is to cringe; and to feel, and involuntarily show we feel, the presence of God, is either hypocrisy or superstition, as the case may be. Much more might this so appear on the occasion in question, were Laud flurried, or conscious he was making a protest, or that he was being looked at, or were he wanting in ease and dignity; nay, even his disadvantage of person might disparage what in another might have been accounted a seemly and reverential bearing. It should be added, too, that Mr. Hume's account is evidently from one who was unacquainted with the English ritual, and that the ordinary course of our Communion Service, as all clergymen perform it, might be made by the dexterous and profane, very much the same *in kind* as the ceremonial above attributed to Laud.

Laud is generally considered to have failed in his projects for the Church's welfare. His violent death, the immediate downfall of religion, and the unpopularity of his name and principles since, have created this impression. Yet, on a more accurate consideration, we may be led to a different conclusion. Two specimens have already been given of his exertions and his consequent successes. He made our churches decent, and restored their altars, and they remain so restored, so embellished, to this day. He encountered the Genevese spirit when ascendant both in Oxford and in the Church; and never since has it recovered its place, whether in the hierarchy or in the university. He has gained a number of hard names as an inheritance; but to him we owe the suppression of puritanical rationalism and profaneness for two hundred years. A third ever-enduring benefit has been his patronage of sacred learning. By far the greater number of our celebrated divines may be referred, directly or indirectly, to his influence or favour. Usher, Pococke, Hall, Bramhall, Sanderson and Taylor, owed their advancement to him. His principles in their main respects were adopted and propagated, in addition to some of the above, by Hammond, Pearson, Bull, Stillingfleet, and Beveridge. It is true there are two divines of his promoting from whom the Church has reaped no great benefit, able and accomplished as they were—Hales and Chillingworth; but when the circumstances are carefully considered, the censure which has thence attached to him will be found undeserved. These celebrated men were Arminians and Latitudinarians, and hence it is common to consider the archbishop as the follower of Arminius; and sometimes, too, his theological system as of ultra-Protestant tendency. Really, however, he had no more, rather much less, to do with the principles of the Arminians than the Puritans themselves. Arminianism, or, as it soon became, Latitudinarianism, was the *reaction* from Calvinism in Holland. The public mind could not long remain contentedly in the trammels of a human system, and, not having the refuge of true Catholicism open to it, it recoiled into an apathetic liberaliism. The English Church, though tinctured with Calvinism, under Elizabeth, was saved from this melancholy reverse by the interposition of the more enlarged yet reverent principles of Christian antiquity,—by the rise of Laud's school, among whom there is but slight truce of Latitudinarian indifference. But our reunion with foreign Protestantism introduced that plague. Hales, who accompanied Sir Dudley Carleton to the Synod of Dordt, made acquaintance there with Episcopius, the disciple of Arminius, brought back his doctrines to England, and communicated them to Chillingworth. We have evidence in history of

the great disquiet which this importation gave to Laud, who prevailed on one of these two divines to abandon or conceal his opinions. However, the contagion ran its course; in the next reign it gave rise to a school in Cambridge, under Tillotson and others, diffused itself through the nation in the writings of the celebrated Mr. Locke, which drew upon him the condemnation of Laud's own university, and evinced its inbred hatred to the Church, by co-operating in the separation of the Nonjurors, in the erection of the Presbyterian kirk, and in the ascendancy of Hoadly and his party.

But to return to Laud. Mr. Le Bas notices some specimens of his encouragement of letters in the following passages:—

"The distracting responsibilities which came upon him daily, could never, for a moment, divert him from his course of enlightened munificence. He continued to enrich the University which bred him with a profusion of literary treasure, chiefly manuscripts in various languages, ancient and modern, European and Oriental, which he spared no pains in seeking or cost in procuring. Equally admirable was his care for the cultivation of those Eastern tongues which were most eminently subservient to the study of Theology. It has already been noticed that, by his intercession, a Canonry of Christ Church was permanently annexed to the royal professorship of Hebrew. His good offices were now extended to the Arabic language; a lectureship in which, was established, and afterwards endowed by him, in perpetuity, with a revenue of £40 per annum, and of which the first occupant was the illustrious Pocock. He further obtained the annexation of another Canonry to the office of public orator; a benefit which, however, was subsequently lost to literature, during the period of successful rebellion and usurpation. By these and various other instances of noble and generous patronage, his ascendancy at Oxford became almost supreme."—pp. 213, 214.

Again, three years later:—

"In the midst of all this care and toil, while his energies were tasked to the uttermost for the honour and stability of the Church, and his name was torn to pieces by ingratitude and calumny, the Archbishop was unwearied in devising liberal and glorious things for the cause of literature and charity. He erected, at his own cost, a stately pile at the west end of the Divinity School, at Oxford; the lower part for the assembling of Convocations, the upper as a repository for learned writings. 'And,' as Heylyn quaintly remarks, 'that he might not be said to have given them nothing but an empty box,' he furnished it with no less than 576 manuscripts, in addition to 700 which he had sent before; of which 100 were Hebrew, Arabic, and Persian. His munificence was, likewise, extended to his native town of Reading; upon which he bestowed a revenue of £200 per annum, to be employed in apprenticing young men, in assisting meritorious beginners in trade, in furnishing marriage-portions to deserving female servants, and, lastly, in augmenting the stipend of the minister of the parish church of St. Laurence. He also purchased the perpetual advowson of the same church, and annexed it to the patronage of St. John's College. Certain other noble designs, of a more public nature, were entertained by him; some of which were executed, and others interrupted by the calamitous vicissitudes which fell upon him. Among those which he was not spared to accomplish, may be mentioned, his projects for increasing the poorer vicarages, for the settlement of the London tithes, for the establishment of a Greek press at Oxford, and for obtaining a grant from his Majesty, for the purchase of impropriations. He, further, intended to procure, at his own charge, a copy, on vellum, of all the Records in the Tower, relating to the Clergy, from the 20th of Edward I. to the end of Henry VIII.: but the troubles of the time prevented the completion of this work to a later period than the 14th of Edward IV. In order that the learned men of Europe might be enabled to judge between that Church and the faction which assailed it, he caused the Liturgy which had been rejected by the Scots to be translated into Latin: but the publication of it

was prevented by the same unhappy cause which stifled several of his other undertakings.”—pp. 249-251.

At an earlier date he had prevailed on the Earl of Pembroke to purchase no less than 240 Greek manuscripts as a present to the University, and gained twenty-eight more for the same destination from Sir Thomas Roe, King James’s ambassador to the Mogul. A benefit of a different and more important nature was his undertaking the task of forming the University Statutes, which had fallen into a state of almost inextricable confusion, into one intelligible digest, accommodated to existing circumstances. To this service was added the further benefaction of obtaining from the Crown the celebrated *Caroline Charter*, which contained not only a confirmation of all the ancient privileges of the University, but a grant of new ones, as ample and honourable as those enjoyed by the University of Cambridge. Here again Laud, occupies the position which we have already ascribed to him, the author of great and permanent deeds. Under his constitution the University is still conducted.

Another strenuous act, of which posterity has reaped the fruits, was his resistance of the Puritan scheme of purchasing impropriations for the establishment of lectureships in towns. This took place in the year 1631, under the following circumstances. Some years before, one Dr. Preston, a person of great influence among the Puritans, had recommended to the Duke of Buckingham the destruction of the Cathedrals and Collegiate Churches. The reasons produced by him for this confiscation were, as Mr. Le Bas informs us, first, “the promotion of God’s glory,” next, as subsidiary, the payment of James’s debts, and the creation of patronage for the favourite himself. The plan failed; but the projector, untired, exerted himself in the discovery of some other means of effecting his end, the weakening of the Church established, and this was the plan above-mentioned. A sort of corporation was formed for the purchase of impropriations, though without authority either from King or Parliament, and very considerable sums were subscribed. The impropriations therewith purchased, instead of being employed in benefiting the livings to which they originally belonged, were used in the hiring of stipendiary lecturers, altogether dependent on their employers, and notoriously disaffected to the discipline, if not the doctrine, of the Church. The support of schoolmasters, of students at the University, of silenced ministers, and of their widows and children, were additional objects to which the fund was applied. Such a project, introducing into the heart of the Church a body of ministers dependent solely on a self-constituted board, was plainly intolerable, and Laud succeeded in overthrowing it by means of the law.

After surveying for a while the above and similar instances of Laud’s services to the Church, the question suddenly comes across the mind, “What it is after all that has made such a man so unpopular?” and no wonder, if for a moment it remains in doubt. But the question is of no difficult solution: he was a Reformer and Restorer; and the labours of such men, when most beneficial, really are least pleasant to the objects benefited. It is easy indeed to gain these popular titles by popular acts, by flattering the forwardness of the populace or the cupidity of kings; but when most is done, fewest understand it, though their praise is a sufficient return. Besides, as was above noticed, Laud had the faults which commonly belong to reformers, though they have been most indulgently regarded in the case of others. He was rough and hasty in manner, violent in temper, and inconsiderate, nay it may be said even cruel, in occasional words or deeds. We have evidence of his own consciousness and distress at these failings; and of his deep and habitual humility. The more we inspect his character, the more we shall acquit him of spiritual pride and self-esteem; an enemy might indeed accuse him of a superstitious and slavish temper, (to speak the language of this day,) but scarcely of the haughty, self-exalting spirit of a Wolsey. Yet, lowly as might be his own thoughts about himself, he was undeniably intemperate in his words and manner. On the

examination of Felton before the Council, he threatened him with the rack;—an excess which not even the atrocity of the assassin's crime and his own strong attachment to Buckingham can excuse. When Richardson, the Chief Justice, was brought before the Council for giving orders to the Clergy in disobedience to the Royal injunction, Laud took upon himself to administer the censure upon him. It is sad work noticing the failings of men to whom we are indebted, and it does good to no one. Who is surprised at reading of Knox's violence and extravagances, his exulting approval of Cardinal Beautoun's assassination, and his violence towards Mary? He was not simply betrayed into excesses, but committed them on principle; yet we are accustomed to take them as part of his whole character, we take him for what he is, as a fact in history, and we bear to mention his name without reviling it. We call him magnanimous, and so in charity veil his pride and insolence. In like manner we endure in Luther great liberties of language, because he was a great man; liberties which we should be shocked even in imagination to impute to Laud. Calvin, again, in burning Servetus, went very far beyond Laud; as did the mild and cautious Cranmer himself, when, not from warmth of temper, but actuated by the spirit of the age, he kindled the flames of Smithfield in behalf of the Anabaptists. Charges, then, of ill-temper, peevishness and the like, are unfair and invidious when urged against so considerable a man as Laud; they were failings certainly, and are not to be explained away; but we may fairly ask for such persons as are not, in some respect or other, as faulty as he was, to cast the stone at him, and may allow his infirmities to pass *sub silentio* till we find a ruler or reformer of these last degenerate times less open to serious charges in life or manners. The real difference between him and the Reformers who preceded him seems to be this, that he was intemperate *against* his age, and they *with* their age; and, as treason never prospers, so strong measures, when unsuccessful, pass for rashness and tyranny. It is not a question between them of truth, but of good policy.

The other chief ground of exception against him is his supposed inclinations towards Popery; but these will always be attributed to the most moderate of men who unhappily live in the midst of Puritanism or Latitudinarianism. Bishop Butler has not escaped a whit more successfully than Laud; as if to show us that not the greatest sobriety of mind or philosophical abstraction from the excitements and struggles of life will suffice for the exculpation of those who scruple to run the full race of vulgarities and profanities miscalled Protestantism. Laud bowed to the altar, Butler put up a cross; this was *enough* in the eyes of the multitude to asperse the fame of the former as well as of the latter; and it cannot be *more* than aspersed in consequence of those opportunities which he had and used above Butler for diffusing his principles. Till, then, something more in point is brought than that he offended the Puritans of his day or of this day, we may be content to let him bear so far an ill fame, which, as it never can be removed, while Puritanism lasts, so it need inspire his admirers with little uneasiness, as if it led to the suspicion of some lurking defect in him who endured it.

The imperfections of true Christians are but as light clouds, and a warm charity will easily dissipate them; their excellences and works, their trials, sufferings and teaching, remain as substantial comforts for those who inherit their principles. For such readers, and we hope and believe that our readers are in the number of them, whatever judgment they may form about particular actions of the illustrious man under review, we will select from Mr. Le Bas's interesting narrative some account of the sufferings of his last years, and the final combat he underwent, as a good soldier of Christ, on the scaffold.

When he was in the Tower he received a message from Grotius, urgently beseeching him to seek safety in flight until the troubles should have abated, as the Lord-Keeper (Finch) and Secretary Windebank had already done.

"But Laud inflexibly refused this counsel. 'An escape,' he said, 'is feasible enough. Yea, it is, I believe, the very thing my enemies desire. For, every day, an opportunity for it is presented; a passage being left free, in all likelihood for this purpose, that I should endeavour to take advantage of it. But they shall not be gratified by me. I am almost seventy years old. Shall I now go about to prolong a miserable life, by the trouble and the shame of flying? Should I go to France, or any other Popish country, it would give some seeming grounds for that charge of Popery, which they have endeavoured, with so much industry, and so little reason, to fasten upon me. But if I should get into Holland, I should expose myself to the insults of those sectaries there, to whom my character is odious, and have every Anabaptist come and pluck me by the beard. No: I am resolved not to think of flight, but patiently to expect and bear what a good and wise Providence hath provided for me, of what kind soever it shall be."—p. 290.

After a time he was consigned to the keeping of Prynne, who had suffered from the severities of the Star-Chamber, and, as he himself asserted, especially through the influence of the archbishop.

"That worthy minister of revolutionary vengeance repaired to the Tower on the 31st of May, armed with full powers to search and seize. That he should carry with him to the execution of this office, some feelings of bitterness against the man whom he regarded as the principal author of his mutilation, might, reasonably enough, have been expected. But, on this occasion, he demeaned himself, not only like an enemy, but like a shameless villain. He found the archbishop in his bed, and immediately began to ransack his pockets. He then laid hands on a mass of papers, which Laud had prepared for his defence; on two letters from the king, relative to Chartham and his other benefices; on his Scottish Service Book, with such directions as were attached to it; on his Diary, in which he had briefly noted all the occurrences of his life; and he did not even spare the archbishop's Book of Private Devotions. All the money that he discovered was about £40, and this he was graciously pleased to leave untouched; for revenge, and not gold, was his object: and speedily afterwards it was proclaimed from the pulpit, that great and fearful things had been discovered in this search, which would soon be brought to light."—p. 301.

Omitting the history of the vexations and indignities which Laud suffered, we come to Mr. Le Bas' account of his trial.

"The trial, which commenced on the 12th of March, continued, with some intervals of cessation, until the end of July. The archbishop vindicated himself against every charge with such consummate ability, such intrepid bearing, and such evident consciousness of innocence and high desert, as won for him the admiration of all; and extorted expressions of splenetic wonder, and bitter praise, even from William Prynne himself. 'To give him his due,' says that worthy, 'he made as full, as gallant, and as pithy a defence of so bad a cause, and spake so much for himself, as it was possible for the wit of man to invent, and that, with so much art, sophistry, vivacity, oratory, audacity and confidence, without the least blush or acknowledgment of guilt in anything, as argued him rather obstinate than innocent, impudent than penitent, a far better orator and sophister, than Protestant or Christian; yea, a truer son of the Church of Rome than of the Church of England.' We may fully rely on the truth of the reluctant commendation here pronounced. The value of the censure will be duly estimated, when we remember that it came from one who proclaimed Archbishop Laud to be the most execrable traitor and apostate that our English soil, or the whole Christian world, had ever bred! Once, and only once, in the course of this persecution, did the spirit of Laud break forth into open and vehement indignation. One of the managers, a foul-mouthed ruffian, by the name of Nicolas, among other disgusting abuse, repeatedly reviled him as a *pander to the whore of Babylon*. 'I was much moved,' says Laud, 'and humbly desired the Lords, that if my crimes were such that I

might not be used like an archbishop, yet I might be used like a Christian; and that, were it not for the duty I owed to God and my own innocence, I would desert my defence, before I would endure such language in such an honourable presence.' Their lordships were sufficiently touched by this appeal, to desire that the speaker would lay aside his slanderous rhetoric, and proceed with the evidence.

"The trial being finished, all appeared ripe for a sentence. But still there was more impediment than was anticipated. To use his own expression, 'he had been sifted to the bran.' Nevertheless, after all this sifting, whatever else was discovered, no *residuum* of treason could be found. On the 2d of September he was allowed to deliver a recapitulation of his impeachment and defence, before the Lords. The instant he came to the bar, he perceived that every peer in the House was provided with a thin folio, in a blue cover. This turned out to be the handywork of William Prynne, who had printed an infamously garbled *Breviate* of his Diary, embellished with his own commentaries, and had placed it in the hands of his judges, in order that the sight of that secret record might strike a damp upon his spirit, and chain up his tongue. His wickedness, however, was herein signally defeated. The archbishop 'gathered up himself, and looked to God,' and pronounced his recapitulation. His address produced such aggravated confusion among his enemies, that, two days afterwards, the Commons began to talk of having him sentenced by an *ordinance*. An impeachment of high treason, they found, would hardly reach him. But an attainder, by the 'barefaced power' of the two Houses, would be irresistible.

"After some further proceedings, and much clamour on the part of Nicolas, (who loudly demanded that the archbishop should be hanged,) on the 11th of October, his counsel were heard at the bar of the Lords, on two points; *first*, whether his imputed offences amounted to treason; *secondly*, whether there were sufficient legal certainty and particularity in the articles of impeachment. With regard to the former of these points, the archbishop had already appealed, unanswerably, to the Lords, in his recapitulation. 'If no particular,' he said, 'which is charged upon me, be treason, the result from them cannot. For the result must be of the same nature and species, as the particulars from which it rises; and this holds in nature, in morality, and in law. So, this imaginary result is a monster in nature, in morality, and in law; and if it be nourished, will devour all the safety of the subject, in England, which now stands so well fenced by the known law of the land.' Yet was it now contended, with shameless effrontery, by Sergeant Wilde, in answer to the archbishop's counsel, that, although no single crime of his amounted to treason, or to felony, yet did all his misdemeanors, when put together, form many grand treasons, by way of accumulation. But 'nature, morality and law,' were, by this time, set at nought by them that were assembled to administer *justice*. The appeal was now to a very different authority. The passions of a delirious populace were called in to quicken the tardy proceedings of the judges. Towards the end of October, petitions were got up by the most disgraceful and inhuman artifices, for the speedy punishment of all *delinquents*. And, on the 1st of November, the archbishop was summoned to appear at the bar of the House of Commons, who, in utter contempt of law or right, were pleased to treat their prisoner as if he were already degraded from the dignity of a Lord of Parliament. Well knowing that resistance would be useless, he obeyed the order. He was then apprised by the Speaker, that the ordinance for his attainder was actually drawn up, but was suspended till he should hear, and answer, a summary of the charge. On the 11th of November he pronounced his last defence. He began by acknowledging the comparatively moderate and civil manner in which the proceedings against him had been recapitulated by Mr. Browne, the Clerk of the House. 'For this,' he said, 'I render him my humble thanks, having, from other hands, pledged my Saviour in gall and vinegar, and drunk the cup of

the scornings of the people, to the very bottom. I shall follow everything in the same order he proceeded in; so far forth, at least, as an old slow hand could take them, a heavy heart observe them, and an old decayed memory retain them.' Having accomplished this, he reminded the House that they had before them, not the evidence itself, but merely a report of it, furnished by the individual who attended the House of Lords for that purpose; and, further, that this person was not always present, and was, consequently, able to supply them, as to some particulars, only with a statement of what had been reported to him by others. And he conjured them to pause before they delivered a verdict upon such grounds as these. He next desired them to consider his calling, his age, his former life, his long and rigorous imprisonment. And, lastly, he made a solemn protestation, that, whatever might have been his infirmities or errors, 'he never intended, much less endeavoured, the subversion of the laws of the kingdom, nor the bringing in of Popish superstition upon the true Protestant religion, established by law in this kingdom.' These words, however, might as well have been addressed to the bare walls as to the men who sat within them. The mystery of iniquity was now drawing towards its consummation. On the 16th, the ordinance for his attainder was passed, and instantly transmitted to the House of Lords; and there it found an impatient and most flagitious advocate, in the Chancellor of Oxford, the Earl of Pembroke. He disgraced himself and his order by the coarsest scurrility. He denounced the archbishop as a rascal and a villain. And he had even the insolence and the turpitude to warn the Lords against the rashness of delaying their consent, till the rabble should be collected at their doors to force it from them. He demanded of the Lords what they stuck at? and asked them whether they imagined that the Commons had no conscience when they framed and passed the ordinance? So outrageous was his demeanor, that it was remarked, that, if ever there should be a parliament in Bedlam, his lordship ought by all means to be chosen Speaker of it. In spite of this, the business lingered till the 17th of December. It was then voted that the archbishop was, *in fact*, guilty of three things; *first*, endeavouring to subvert the laws; *secondly*, of an attempt to overthrow the Protestant religion; and, *thirdly*, of being an enemy to parliaments. The question was then put to the Judges, whether, or not, all this amounted to treason. Their unanimous answer was, that nothing with which he was charged by the impeachment, even if fully proved, would amount to treason, by any known and established Law of the land.

"The Lords had sufficiently degraded themselves by consenting to the attainder of Strafford. Nevertheless, the above response of the sages of the law arrested them, only for a moment, in their descent to still lower depths of infamy. At a conference, held on the 24th of December, they ventured to represent to their masters, the Commons, that, after the most diligent search, they were able to find no treason in the acts of which the archbishop was accused. Another conference, however, took place on the 2d of January, 1645, by which their consciences were so effectually enlightened, that, on the 4th of the same month, the ordinance of attainder was passed by the voice of six peers, the rest of that assembly having absented themselves, through fear or shame. On the 7th, a third conference was solemnized, at which the Lords informed the Commons, that the archbishop had pleaded a pardon from the king, in arrest of judgment. This pardon had been granted by his majesty at the suggestion of Hyde, then Chancellor of the Exchequer; and had been secretly conveyed to Laud before he was brought to trial. It was received by him with great joy, as a testimony of his sovereign's affection and esteem. But he never imagined, for a moment, that it would protect him against the fury of men, who were levying war against the king himself. In fact, he might almost as well have pleaded a pardon from the Pope! The royal act of grace was, of course, pronounced to be of none effect against a judgment of the *Parliament*. The only favour vouchsafed to the prisoner, was, that the gibbet should be exchanged for the axe; and even this boon

was extorted with extreme difficulty. His first application for it was brutally rejected. A second petition to the Lords was more successful. It was felt, at last, that an Archbishop of Canterbury, a Privy Counsellor, and a member of their own House, could not be hanged up like a common felon, without indelible disgrace to all concerned in his destruction. And the Commons, after some debate, reluctantly consented to the commutation.”—pp. 311-317.

Ample as have been our extracts from Mr. Le Bas’ work, we should be wanting to the memorable narrative before us, if we omitted the concluding scene.

“We must hasten to the close of the tragedy. The intelligence of his doom was received by Laud, in the temper which became a Christian Bishop. It had long been manifest that he was neither ashamed to live, nor afraid to die. And, when death was once before him, he instantly broke off the history of his sufferings, and calmly prepared himself for his departure. On the evening of January the 9th, the day before his execution, he refreshed himself with a moderate meal, retired to rest, and slept so soundly, that his attendants had to wake him when the hour was come. He then continued in prayer, until the officers arrived to conduct him to the scaffold. He had requested that three of his own chaplains might be with him in the Tower, and at the place of execution. But even this comfort was inhumanly denied him. One chaplain, indeed, his persecutors allowed to attend him, at his death; but, with him, they sent two of their own incendiaries and fanatics. On his way, he was occasionally assailed by the revilings of the lowest of the populace, who were unwilling that he should pass even to the grave in peace. But his composure was unruffled by these insults; and when he reached the spot, he ascended the platform ‘with so brave a courage, and a countenance so cheerful, as if he mounted rather to behold a triumph, than to be made a sacrifice.’ It was remarked, that four years of imprisonment and affliction had left the natural floridness of his complexion wholly unimpaired. Being permitted to speak to the people, he read to them a paper of considerable length, which he had drawn up for that purpose. In this address he acknowledged that, although he felt the infirmities of flesh and blood, and might have been glad that the cup which was given him should pass from him, yet he was now ready to drink it ... He then proceeded to speak of himself: ‘I was born and baptized’—he says—‘in the Church of England: in that profession I have ever since lived; and, in that, I come now to die. This is no time to dissemble with God; least of all in matters of religion. What clamours and slanders I have endured, for labouring to keep an uniformity in the external service of God, according to the doctrine and discipline of that Church, all men know, and I have abundantly felt. And now,’ he added, ‘I am accused of high treason; a crime which my soul abhors. I am charged with an endeavour to subvert the laws, and to overthrow the Protestant religion. In vain I protested my innocence of these crimes. The protestations of prisoners, it was said, could never be received at the bar of justice. I can bring no witness of my heart! I now, therefore, make my protest, in the presence of God, and his holy angels, that I never did attempt the subversion either of religion or of law. I, further, have been maligned, as an enemy to Parliaments. I know their uses too well to be their enemy. But I, likewise, know that parliaments have been sometimes guilty of misgovernment and abuse; and that no corruption is so bad, as the corruption of that which, in itself, is excellent. From the power of parliaments there is no appeal. If, therefore, they should be guilty of oppression, the subject is left, without all remedy. But I have done;’ he said in conclusion, ‘I forgive all the world; all and every of those bitter enemies which have persecuted me. And I humbly desire to be forgiven—of God first; and then, of every man, whether I have offended him or not; if he do but conceive that I have, Lord do thou forgive me, and I do beg forgiveness of him. And so, I heartily bid you join in prayer with me.’ He then fell on his knees, and uttered the following memorable

supplication, no word of which should be suffered to perish from the annals of martyrdom:

“O eternal God and merciful Father! look down upon me in mercy, in the riches and fulness of all thy mercies, look down upon me; but not till Thou hast nailed my sins to the cross of Christ, not till Thou hast bathed me in the blood of Christ; not till I have hid myself in the wounds of Christ, that so the punishment due unto my sins may pass over me. And since Thou art pleased to try me to the utmost, I humbly beseech Thee, give me now in this great instant, full patience, proportionable comfort, and a heart ready to die for thine honour, the King’s happiness, and the Church’s preservation. And my zeal to this, (far from arrogancy be it spoken!) is all the sin, (human frailty excepted, and all the incidents thereunto,) which is yet known to me in this particular, for which I now come to suffer; I say, in this particular of treason. But otherwise my sins are many and great; Lord, pardon them all; and those especially (whatever they are) which have drawn down this present judgment upon me! And when Thou hast given me strength to bear it, do with me as seems best in thine own eyes; and carry me through death, that I may look upon it, in what visage soever it shall appear to me. Amen! And that there may be a stop of this issue of blood in this more than miserable kingdom, (I shall desire that I may pray for the people too, as well as for myself;) O Lord, I beseech Thee, give grace of repentance to all blood-thirsty people. But if they will not repent, O Lord, confound all their devices, defeat and frustrate all their designs and endeavours, upon them, which are or shall be contrary to the glory of thy great name, the truth and sincerity of Religion, the establishment of the King and his posterity after him in their just rights and privileges, the honour and conservation of Parliaments in their just power, the preservation of this poor Church in her truth, peace, and patrimony, and the settlement of this distracted and distressed people under their ancient laws, and in their native liberty. And when Thou hast done all this in mere mercy to them, O Lord, fill their hearts with thankfulness, and with religious, dutiful obedience to Thee and thy commandments all their days. Amen, Lord Jesus, Amen. And receive my soul into thy bosom! Amen. Our Father which art in heaven, &c.”

After narrating a number of painfully interesting details, which our space will not admit, Mr. Le Bas proceeds—

“Having put some money into the man’s [the executioner’s] hand, he said to him, with unruffled countenance, ‘Honest friend, God forgive thee as I do. Do thine office upon me with mercy.’ He then sunk, again, upon his knees, and prayed shortly in these words: ‘I am coming, O Lord, as quickly as I can. I know I must pass through death, before I can come to see thee. But, it is only the mere shadow of death; a little darkness upon nature. Thou, by thy merits, hast broken through the jaws of death. The Lord receive my soul, and have mercy upon me; and bless this kingdom with peace arid plenty, and with brotherly love and charity, that there may not be this effusion of Christian blood among them; for Jesus Christ’s sake, if it be thy will.’ Having laid his head upon the block, after a few moments of silent supplication, he said aloud, *Lord receive my soul*. This was the death-signal agreed upon. The axe fell: and a single blow of it delivered the Archbishop, for ever; from his persecutors.”

Here then we must close our account of Mr. Le Bas’ volume. Were we reviewing the writing of any one else, it might be necessary to have employed ourselves more directly in a critique upon the work itself. But our author’s name is too well known to need any officious panegyric from us. Praise is fitly bestowed on rising merit only, and we should be seriously pained at the necessity, were there one, of bestowing it on Mr. Le Bas. We believe that for honest and manly pursuit of truth, no living writer has a greater claim on our reverence; and a writer thus endowed will not fail to draw readers after him on to the truth, and not merely to himself,—to the attainment of

truth, not to the contemplation of his own talents;—and will gain a far higher reward than the mere popularity could be, in successfully forming their views and principles, and in giving them objects for their nobler feelings to rest on, and take comfort in, during evil times.

ART. X.—The History of the Christian church, from the Ascension of Jesus Christ to the Conversion of Constantine. By the Rev. Edward Burton, D.D. 1836.

[*British Critic*, vol. 19, July 1836.]

THE unexpected and immature death of the highly accomplished writer of this volume, is one of those events which have tended of late years to change the tone of opinion prevailing in the University to which he belonged, and to introduce into it for good and for evil the characteristics of a new generation. Dr. Burton is the third in succession of Divinity Professors, who have been cut off in the beginning, or in the fulness of their labours and usefulness; men of great consideration in the place, who, doubtless, were they now alive, would take a principal part in the direction of the University in the stormy times seemingly before it. Few men of late years have had the extended influence of Dr. Hodson, or the popularity with junior men of Dr. Lloyd, Bishop of Oxford, both of whom were removed at a time when the Church itself, if not the scene of their previous reputation, seemed likely to feel the impression of their minds. In like manner, the death of Dr. Elmsley took place when he had just entered upon duties to which the careful and silent studies of years had recommended him, and was about to devote to the service of the University the habits of precise thought, the composure of mind, gentleness of bearing, and gifts and attainments of a more striking character, which were discernible by all who knew him ever so little. Professors Mills and Nicoll, are additional instances, in late years, of rising abilities and erudition, cut short in their career by an (humanly speaking) untimely stroke. Such successive losses may, for what we know, be common at all times; but, whether common or not, they cannot happen without changing the character of a place, if there be room for change. And such seems to have been the effect of them in the University in which they have occurred; almost all the distinguished men enumerated were more or less specimens of a school which seems for many years to have had prevalence, or rather supreme sway in the place, so as even to constitute the existing academical body itself. Since quiet days have succeeded in Oxford, to political feuds and parties, from the latter part of the last century almost down to the recent passing of the Emancipation Bills, elegant scholarship and literature have been the main road to distinction, and an abstinence from subjects purely ecclesiastical, or even an indisposition towards them, the characteristic, or at least the accidental property of the gentleman and divine. Some of the most eminent members of the Episcopal Bench at this moment are instances of the truth of this remark, at the time they were promoted; and what they were in younger days, such were the individuals above-mentioned. They were learned in the languages, they were men of classical attainments, of various accomplishments; they were loved and revered in private; but they either were in no sense theologians, or they added theology to their other attainments, with little concern to ground themselves in it as a science. There was in their day little of political or religious commotion to draw away their minds from criticism and literature, or to make theology much more than a theoretical or amateur pursuit. The Socinian and Predestinarian controversies, and the external evidences, almost exhausted the range of divinity; and though the sagacity of Bishop Lloyd discerned the renewal of hostilities with the Romanists in prospect, and began, in this very Review ¹, to prepare for defence, he was not allowed time to do much more

¹1. *Vide British Critic* for 1825.

than direct attention to a conflict of which he himself was to be spared the toil.

If there was any one who might be deemed an exception to these remarks, it was the lamented divine who has led to them. He was unquestionably, not only variously read in classical and modern literature, but deeply versed in the writings of the fathers. Always excepting one venerated individual, whose name will at once suggest itself to Oxford men, he had above all men reputation for patristical learning, a reputation which belonged rather to the seventeenth century than to our own. Yet it may be doubted whether even he was not better acquainted with the writings of Christian antiquity, as historical records, or depositaries of facts, or again in their bearing upon one or two important modern questions, than in themselves, in their great fundamental principles, and their peculiar character and spirit, or what is sometimes called their [*ēthos*]. There was nothing in the circumstances of the day to send him to their works as a revelation of times, feelings and principles gone by; and his study in consequence was far from embracing even an abstract knowledge of their views. While, then, his reading spoke forcibly for the loyalty and devotion of his heart towards those prophets of the ancient truth, and tended much to encourage younger men in the study of them, yet it scarcely separated him in mental characteristics from that classical school to which we have above referred him.

But Dr. Burton's death is remarkable in another point of view. He was not only an University man; he was an active parish priest, and emphatically a religious man. We mean a man who had the heart and the opportunity to evidence sincere and practical religious views; and consequently, abstract and inoperative as might be his theological reading, he was necessarily forced by his very seriousness and earnestness into the adoption of a definite line of action, at least during the recent critical position of the University. He might not perhaps make his ecclesiastical learning bear upon his conduct; but a determinate line and a decided conduct he could not forbear adopting; he was too religious to forbear it, and the form of religious opinion which he chose was that which according to all appearances is likely to prevail in the high places of the Church, unless, which is not improbable, some violent convulsion throw all its interests into disorder. As the school of Waterland succeeded to that of Bull, in consequence of the exigencies of the times, which brought into notice men of a more *Protestant* complexion, (if we may be allowed a catechesis in the use of the word); so, according to all appearance, if things go smooth, we shall find a still more modern divinity necessary to harmonize with those secondary systems in religion and education to which the policy of the day is tending. The probability is that the influential places in the Church will be held by men of a widely different stamp from those who have hitherto gone by the designation of high Churchmen. That clear and inflexible adherence to rule and precedent, which is called by its enemies stiffness and narrowness of mind, but which saved the Church during the last century from the gulf of Ultra-Protestantism, is melting away under the influence of feelings which might rightly be called charitable, did they answer in the long run. We are likely to have men in station and authority, not openly latitudinarian, but accessible to all sorts of impressions from without, and deficiently acquainted with the peculiarities and excellences of the system they administer. Unexceptionable in doctrine themselves, except as being tinged with the popular religion of the day, they will give their confidence and their preferment to men inferior to themselves, and as these parties in turn will bestow their own patronage on persons who come short proportionably of themselves, there is danger of the Church being overrun with objectionable principles, while the first authors of it are amiable, and on the whole orthodox men. When we class the late Professor among these, it is not as forgetting the noble stand he made for Christian truth in 1834, when, at the head of the tutorial body, he drew up that distinct and impressive avowal of the dependance of

education on religion, which was ultimately subscribed by two thousand members of convocation. Such a man, if indulgent, would certainly be so within limits, beyond which he would be inflexible; still his humility and unaffected simplicity of mind were such, he was so unsuspecting of others, so liberal and expansive in his feelings, so much better endowed with candour and generosity than with a clear apprehension of our ecclesiastical position, that it is easy to see where on the whole he would have taken his stand, had he been raised to those higher preferments which were all but his when he died. His loss is the greatest, perhaps, which his principles could have sustained in Oxford. We think it no disparagement to the talents and virtues of those who remain as upholders of them, to say that it is irreparable. His equal or his second cannot be found in the combined qualifications of extensive reading, unwearied diligence, promptness and despatch, parochial activity, kindness of heart, and general popularity. No man so considerable ever bore his faculties more meekly. No man descended more entirely to the level of those with whom he conversed, submitted to their waywardness, or sympathized with their peculiarities. No man thought less of self, laboured less for the appearance of consistency, or feared less the confession of doubt or error. No man less excited in others those feelings which tend to jealousy, distance, and disunion. In his death, what may be called the moderate section of the University, have lost perhaps the only man who was qualified to head and lead them, or to serve as a restraint on persons of keener or more eccentric minds. The consequences of it have been seen sooner than might have been anticipated; his party have in effect vanished with him, and those who maintained more and maintained less have come into collision.

If it were not for the hazard of intruding upon subjects beyond human sagacity, something might be said in connexion with the above remarks, on the indications which the existing events furnish of an approaching conflict, sooner or later, between what are commonly considered extreme opinions. As decks are cleared before a fight, so in the field of ecclesiastical politics, those who were hitherto middle men, are either taken out of the way, or retreat to this or that side in the struggle. The crisis may be delayed an indefinite time by external events; a foreign war might call off all our thoughts in another direction; or the return of the Conservatives to power might partially suspend the natural operation of the principles at work, and compose the surface of the Church into an apparent calm. Still, whether by a secret underground influence, or by outward manifestation, what are called extreme opinions will spread on either side, and sooner or later will join issue, and find a solution. The highly to be revered school of divinity, commonly called high Church, has lately been bereaved of its brightest ornament, in the admirable Prelate who filled the See of Durham; while it is fast losing ground in the Christian Knowledge Society. As to the party who seem to be succeeding to their power, and are full of hope and triumph in consequence, they have no internal consistency, clearness of principle, strength of mind, or weight of ability sufficient to keep the place they may perhaps win. They have the seeds of dissolution in them, and are already breaking into pieces. As Whigs and Tories have disappeared from the stage of politics, so the high Church section of the Establishment, to which we owe so great a debt in years past, is almost broken up, and the Low party has a mortal disease upon it.

It has been thought best to make the above remarks on the present condition and prospects of the Church, in frank, perhaps in blunt language—but it must not be thence supposed that we view the state of things lightly, or range ourselves on neither side of the contest; but we wish to draw our readers' attention simply to our ecclesiastical condition itself, as the first step in their setting about to form a judgment upon it.

The work before us, published under the direction of the Literature Committee attached to the

Christian Knowledge Society, is such as might have been anticipated from its lamented author. It presents a luminous and distinct account of the fortunes of the Church during its three first centuries, condensed into a small volume without effort, and abounding in learning without display. It is the composition of one who has full mastery over his materials, and (as it were) got his subject by heart; and it will doubtless be of the greatest value to those who are already interested in church history, and either desire further information, or a synoptical view of what is familiar to them. These we consider to be its chief merits; its deficiency on the other hand, if it must be noticed, lies in a want of unity in the history, in the absence of plan or scope, the neglect to interpret the events and facts which occur. This indeed is a very tolerable fault, especially in this age, when scarcely a man can prevail on himself to write without some preconceived theory in his mind, or some striking but peculiar view, which he takes care to herald forth at every pause in the narrative, and to use for the perversion rather than elucidation of its details. As times go, it is a relief and a refreshment to read a work, which is not straining after novelties, and torturing men and things on the Procrustean bed of what the author perhaps calls a "simple principle." As it is pleasant to sit by a smooth river, and gaze upon its stream equably flowing by, so is Dr. Burton's work a balm and solace to those who have busied themselves in many thoughts, and are weary of controversy and speculation. But this very quality which recommends it to the harassed student, is somewhat a disadvantage to it, considered as intended for popular use. It is better indeed to be sound and accurate, than merely amusing; we do not wish history to be made either a romance or a diatribe, to be poeticized or philosophized: still to interest and to instruct are main objects in its composition, and here we consider Dr. Burton's work, with all its excellence, to be somewhat defective. There is too little of moral and of lesson, we do not mean deduced, but deducible from the course of affairs as he presents them. Yet even in this respect his work is a very considerable advance upon Mosheim's history; which is as dry and sapless as if the Church were some fossil remains of an antediluvian era, lifeless itself and without any practical bearing on ourselves. Nay it is in this respect an advance even on the writings of the present very learned Bishop of Lincoln, who has apparently been led by an accurate taste, critical exactness, and dislike of theory or paradox, into an over-estimation of facts, as such, separated from their meaning and consequences. Dr. Burton had much of this critical accuracy also; yet we should rather attribute this same peculiarity, as far as it is found in this and other of his works, to the cause above indicated, viz. to his having apparently taken up theology without such an accurate grounding in its principles as would enable him to speak confidently as a moralist or divine.

Dr. Burton commences his history from the day of Pentecost, which he conceives to be a truer date for the foundation of the Christian Church, than that of our Lord's public ministry. The transactions of the first century occupy not very far from half the volume, and consist principally of the details of the apostles' own labours. The usual subjects follow; the martyrdom of Ignatius, the spread of Gnosticism, the Paschal controversy, the Persecutions, Montanus, Theodotus and Praxeas, in the second century; and in the third, Tertullian and Origen, the Platonists, Cyprian and the Rebaptizers, Novatus and Novatian, Dionysius of Alexandria, Manicheism, and the gradual victories of the Gospel over the powers of the world. The history ends with the conversion of Constantine. It will be the most respectful course to our author now to put before the reader some passages from his work, with such brief observations of our own as they may suggest. Dr. Burton thus manfully states his view of the tone to be adopted by the ecclesiastical historian.

"I wish, however, distinctly to state, that there are some points upon which the ecclesiastical historian may be allowed to have made up his mind, without being charged with partiality. Thus,

he is not required to speak of Christianity as if it was merely one of the numerous forms of religion which had appeared in the world. He is to write as a Christian, addressing himself to Christians; and as he is not called upon to prove

Christianity to be true, so he may assume that his readers are acquainted with its doctrines. In speaking, therefore, of the first propagation of the Gospel, I have said little concerning the nature of those new opinions which were then, for the first time, delivered to the world. A contemporary heathen historian would have thought it necessary to describe them; they would have formed an important feature in the history of the times; but a Christian historian does not feel called upon to explain *the principles of the doctrine of Christ*. He supposes his readers not only to know these principles, but to believe them; and though the differences among Christians form a necessary part of the History of the Church, it is sufficient to say of Christianity itself, as first preached by the apostles, that it is the religion contained in the Bible.”—pp. 15, 16.

And he thus forcibly describes that peculiarity in Christianity, which brought upon it persecution from the heathen.

“The Greeks and the Romans had long been acquainted with the Jews; but they looked upon their religion as a foolish superstition, and treated their peculiar customs with contempt. This treatment might be provoking to individual Jews, but it generally ensured for them toleration as a people; and hence they were seldom prevented from establishing a residence in any town within the Roman empire. The Jews repaid this indulgence by taking little pains to make proselytes. In their hearts they felt as much contempt for the superstitions of the heathen, as the latter professed openly for the Jews; but they were content to be allowed to follow their own occupations, and to worship the God of their fathers without molestation. The Christians might have enjoyed the same liberty, if their principles had allowed it; and for some time the heathen could not, or would not, consider them as anything else than a sect of the Jews. But a Christian could not be sincere without wishing to make proselytes. He could not see religious worship paid to a false God, without trying to convince the worshipper that he was following a delusion. *The Divine Founder of Christianity did not intend it to be tolerated, but to triumph*. It was to be the universal, the only religion; and though the apostles, like the rest of their countrymen, could have borne with personal insults and contempt, they had but one object in view, and that was to plant the cross of Christ upon the ruins of every other religion.

“This could not fail, sooner or later, to expose the preachers of the Gospel to persecution; for every person who was interested in keeping up the old religions, would look upon the Christians as his personal enemies.”—pp. 83, 84.

In this extract we see the same high religious principle avowed by the author, which led to his strenuous effort in favour of dogmatic religion in 1834. In the document then, drawn up by him, he carried out the protest, borne in the above passage in favour of Christianity in the general, to maintenance of the creed of orthodoxy in particular. The words to which we allude are as follows:—

“They [the Declarationists] wish to state in the first place, that the University of Oxford has always considered religion to be the foundation of all education; and they cannot themselves be parties to any system of instruction, which does not rest upon this foundation. They also protest against the notion, that religion can be taught on the vague and comprehensive principle of admitting persons of every creed. When they speak of religion, they mean the doctrines of the Gospel, as revealed in the Bible, and as maintained by the Church of Christ in its best and purest times,” &c.

It has been much the fashion at various times, to speak as if Christianity was becoming better

and better understood as time went on, and its professors more enlightened and more virtuous. In saying this, we do not allude to the creed of Montanus, Manichee or Mahomet, or of the Gnostics, each of whom professed to be bringing to perfection that system which the apostles began indeed, but only rudely understood; nor again of the St. Simonians; nor of those religionists of the sixteenth century and their descendants now, who teach that the visible Church was lost in error for an indefinite period, and then emerged into purity and light such as Irenæus himself did not enjoy ²; but of men of the present day, who are considered especially men of the world, well-judging and practical men, and who assume it as an axiom in all their reasonings, or rather as what Aristotle calls an enthymematic [*gnōmē*], that the nineteenth century (i.e. *because* the nineteenth) is superior to the first and second. We have been told much of late years about the early receptacles of religious truth having corrupted it by the pagan feelings or heathen learning with which they had been previously filled; or the testimony of the fathers has been considered as the mere *declarations* of individual *opinion*, not as assertions of the *fact* of certain widely spread and generally received doctrines. Their comments on Scripture, however unanimous in various times and countries, have been considered but glosses and fancies; as if it were the easiest thing in the world to get Jew and Gentile, bond and free, learned and unlearned, Roman and Alexandrian, to speak the same thing and to be joined together in one judgment,—as if Scripture itself did not give us an instance of the difficulty of making even “two false witnesses” “agree together,” in traducing Him whose doctrine it is considered so easy to deface. The following admirable remarks are a reply to this gratuitous hypothesis, which, instead of having proved to us, we are unceremoniously called upon to *disprove*.

“There is, perhaps, a difficulty in steering between the opposite extremes of attributing too much or too little value to ecclesiastical antiquity. It is easy to say, on the one hand, that a stream is purest at no great distance from its source; and, on the other, that the world is much more enlightened now than it was eighteen centuries ago. The latter statement, however, may be fully acknowledged to be true, and yet may prove nothing as to the weight which ought to be given to the authority of the earlier ages.

“We do not appeal to the primitive Christians for their knowledge or their opinions of matters upon which the world is now more enlightened; but a question arises, whether the world is really more enlightened upon those points with which the primitive Christians were specially concerned. These points are the doctrines which are essential to be believed as contained in the Gospel, and the method which is most likely to be successful for spreading them through the world. Whether these two points were imperfectly understood by the early Christians, and whether they have received more light from the discoveries of succeeding ages, are questions which it is not difficult to answer, if we rightly understand the nature of the Christian revelation.

“The one word *Revelation* seems not suited to lead us to expect, that the matters which have been revealed would require, or could even admit, successive illustrations and improvements, from the powers of the human mind becoming more developed. If Christianity had been merely a system of moral precepts, which human reason had imagined and arranged, the system might undoubtedly be rendered more and more perfect as the world continued to advance. But, if the scheme of Christian redemption was not only revealed by God, but every part of it was effected by the agency of God, without man knowing anything concerning it until it was thus effected

²2. Like him [Justin] he [Irenæus] is silent, or nearly so, on the election of grace, which from the instructors of his early age he must often have heard, and like him, he defends the Arminian notion of free will and by similar arguments. His philosophy seems to have had its usual influence on the mind, in darkening some truths of Scripture, and in mixing the doctrine of Christ with human inventions.”—*Milner*, vol. i.

and revealed, it seems impossible that such a system could be modified or improved by later and successive discoveries.

“Now it will not be denied, that the apostles themselves had the fullest and clearest understanding of the doctrines which they preached. It might, perhaps, be said, when their inspiration is taken into the account, that no Christians have had their minds equally enlightened by a knowledge of the Gospel; so that the revelation was, in its very commencement, full and complete; and to say, that we are more enlightened now as to the truths of the Gospel, would be the same as to say, that a ray of light is purer and brighter when it has reached the surface of the earth, than when it was first emitted from the sun. We must also recollect that the doctrine which the apostles preached, namely Justification by Faith in the death of Christ, could not be more or less complete at one period than another. It was complete, when Christ died, or rather when he rose again, and when God consented that faith in his death and resurrection should justify a sinner. The first person

who embraced this offer of reconciliation, at the preaching of the apostles, was as fully justified, and as fully admitted into the Christian covenant, as any person from that time to the present, or from now to the end of the world. The terms of salvation are precisely the same now as they were in the infancy of the Gospel. The only written record which we have of this last Revelation was composed by the persons to whom it was made; human reason has added nothing to the letter or the spirit of it: and whoever believes the doctrines which it contains, possesses all the knowledge which can be possessed concerning the salvation of his soul.

“This being the case, it would seem to follow, that we have nothing else to do but to ascertain exactly what the doctrine is which was revealed, and, having ascertained it, to embrace it. This is, in fact, allowed by a vast majority of those persons who call themselves Christians. The notion, that Christianity admits of being improved as the world becomes more enlightened, can hardly be said to be entertained by any persons who really understand the Gospel; and though Christians are unhappily divided upon many fundamental points, they all agree in referring to the Scriptures, as containing the original Revelation; and each sect or party professes to believe its own interpretation of the Scriptures to be the best. It becomes, therefore, of great importance to know which of these conflicting interpretations was adopted by the early Church; and if it can be proved that any doctrine was universally believed in the age immediately following that of the apostles, the persons who hold such a doctrine now would naturally lay great weight upon this confirmation of their opinions.

“It cannot fairly be said, that, in making this appeal to antiquity, we are attaching too much importance to human authority, or that we are lessening that reverence which ought to be paid exclusively to the revealed Word of God. It is because we wish to pay exclusive reverence to the Scriptures, that we endeavour so anxiously to ascertain their meaning; and it is only where our own interpretation differs from that of others, that we make an appeal to some third and impartial witness. We think that we find this witness in the early Christians, in those who lived not long after the time of the apostles; and though we fully allow that they were fallible, like ourselves, and though in sound critical judgment, their age may have been inferior to our own, yet there are many reasons why their testimony should be highly valued.

“In the first place, they lived very near to the first promulgation of the Gospel. Even to a late period in the second century, there must have been many persons living who had conversed with the apostles, or with companions of the apostles. This would make it less likely that any doubts would arise upon points of doctrine, and, at the same time, more difficult for any corruption to be introduced. The simplicity of the Gospel was not in so much danger from the pride of learning and

the love of disputation, when Christians were daily exposed to persecution and death, and when the fiery trial purified the Church from insincere or ambitious members. The language in which the New Testament was written made the early Christians better judges of the

meaning of any passages than ourselves; for Greek continued for many centuries to be the language of the learned throughout the greater part of the Roman empire, and the Fathers of the three first centuries wrote much more in Greek than in Latin. These are some of the reasons why an appeal is made to the primitive Christians in matters of faith; not that we receive any doctrine, merely because this or that Father has delivered it in his writings, but because the persons who lived in those days had the best means of knowing whether any article of faith had been really delivered by the apostles or not. And this testimony of the early Church becomes so much the stronger, if we find, as the following pages will show, that, for at least three centuries, there was a perfect unanimity among all the different churches upon essential points of doctrine.”—p. 8-12.

We offer no apology to our readers for this long extract, as they will doubtless be desirous to know the sentiments of a writer of Dr. Burton’s views upon the subject. The principle on which we consult antiquity is most satisfactorily stated in it; not less satisfactory is the application of it on the whole, except indeed a one slight respect, which shall be noticed in the sequel, but which does not interfere with the decisiveness of the testimony afforded in it against the Socinianizing spirit of the day, a spirit which in one instance ³ has proceeded so far as to condemn St. Ignatius for his celebrated Epistles; and next to ascribe to the Apostle Barnabas what the writer calls “a tissue of obscenity and absurdity which would disgrace the Hindoo mythology.”

In the following passages we find the like clear and decisive statements on an article of faith, which has of late been much canvassed, that of the Holy Catholic Church.

“The unity of the Church had not as yet (A.D. 200) been broken by any open secession from the whole body of Christians. This body, though consisting of many members, and dispersed throughout the world, was yet one and undivided, if we view it with, reference to doctrines, or to the form of ecclesiastical government. Every church had its own spiritual head or bishop, and was independent of every other church, with respect to its own internal regulations and laws. There was, however, a connexion, more or less intimate, between neighbouring churches, which was a consequence, in some degree, of the geographical or civil divisions of the empire. Thus the churches of one province, such as Achaia, Egypt, Cappadocia, &c., formed a kind of union, and the bishop of the capital, particularly if his see happened to be of Apostolic foundation, acquired a precedence in rank and dignity over the rest. This superiority was often increased by the bishop of the capital (who was called in later times, the metropolitan,) having actually planted the church in smaller and more distant places; so that the Mother Church, as it might literally be termed, continued to feel a natural and parental regard for the churches founded by itself. These churches, however,

were wholly independent in matters of internal jurisdiction; though it was likely that there would be a resemblance, in points even of slight importance, between churches of the same province

...

“But early in the second century we find proofs of churches, not only in neighbouring provinces, but in distant parts of the world, taking pains to preserve the bond of unity, and to show themselves members of one common head.—The term *Catholic*, or *Universal*, as applied to the Church of Christ, may be traced almost to the time of the apostles; and every person who believed in Christ was a member of the Catholic Church, because he was a member of some particular or national

³3. *Vide* Mr. Osburn’s *Primitive Errors*, pp. 25, 191, 256-290.

Church, which was in communion with the whole body. We have already seen instances of this communion being preserved or interrupted between the members of different churches: and the anxiety of the early Christians upon this point is shown by the custom of bishops, as soon as they were elected, sending a notification of their appointment to distant churches. When this official announcement had been made, any person who was the bearer of a letter from his bishop, was admitted to communion with the church in any country which he visited: but these *communicatory letters*, as they were called, were certain to be denied him if any suspicion was entertained as to the unsoundness of his faith.—It may be supposed that these precautions were very effectual in preserving the unity of the Church, and in preventing diversity of doctrine. The result was, as has been already observed, that up to the end of the second century no schism had taken place among the great body of believers. There was no church in any country which was not in communion with the Catholic or Universal Church; and there was no church in any particular town or province which was divided into sects and parties.”—pp. 288-291.

The following passage is too important to be omitted, though it retraces in some measure the ground gone over in the last.

“The term *Catholic* was applied to the church, as comprising the whole body of believers throughout the world, as early as the middle of the second century, and perhaps much earlier: and the preceding history has shown us how anxious the heads of the churches felt, in every country, that their members should hold communion with each other, and that this communion should not be extended to any who held sentiments at variance with those of the whole body. During the three first centuries, if a Christian went from any one part of the world to another, from Persia to Spain, or from Pontus to Carthage, he was certain to find his brethren holding exactly the same opinions with himself upon all points which they both considered essential to salvation; and wherever he travelled he was sure of being admitted to communion: but on the other hand, if the Christians of his own country had put him out of communion for any errors of belief or conduct, he found himself exposed to the same exclusion wherever he went; and so careful were the churches upon this point, that they gave letters or certificates to any of their members, which ensured them an admission to communion with their brethren in other countries.—The first dispute of any moment was that concerning the Paschal festival: but churches which differed upon this

point, continued to hold communion with each other; and the bishop of Rome was thought decidedly wrong when he made this difference a cause of refusing communion. So strong a measure was only considered necessary, when the difference involved an essential point of doctrine,” ... “Thus Theodotus, who did not believe the divinity of Christ, was excluded from communion when he went to Rome. The same church excluded Praxeas for denying the personality of the Son and Holy Ghost: and when a doctrine somewhat similar began to spread in the Alexandrian diocese, the bishop who opposed it was so desirous to know that he was acting in agreement with other churches, that he sent copies of his own letters to Rome.” ... “It is in this way that we are able to ascertain, at different periods of history, the sentiments entertained by the church, on various points of doctrine. We have also the works of the early Christian writers, which show that the Church maintained the same doctrines during the whole of the period which we have been considering. If we take any particular opinion, Sabellianism for instance, we know for certain that it was not the doctrine of the Catholic Church. Whenever it was brought forward by Praxeas, Noetus, Beryllus, or Sabellius himself, it was uniformly condemned, and that not merely by one writer, or by one church, but by the consentient voice of all the Eastern and Western churches. If we wish to know whether the divinity of Christ was an article of belief at the period which we have been considering,

we find no instance of its being denied till the end of the second century, when Theodotus was put out of communion by the Roman Church for denying his belief in it. A few years later, Dionysius of Alexandria was obliged to defend himself from the charge of not believing it: and all the Eastern churches put forth their declaration from Antioch, that not only did they all maintain this article of belief themselves, but that it had been maintained by the Catholic Church from the beginning.—Creeds and confessions of faith were, during this period, and especially the former part of it, short and simple. While there were no heretics, there was no need to guard against heresy. Antidotes are only given to persons who have taken poison, or who are likely to take it: neither do we use precautions against contagion, when no disease is to be caught. The case, however, is altered, when the air has become infected, and thousands are dying all around us. It is then necessary to call in the physician, and guard against danger. The case was the same with the church, when she saw her children in peril from new and erroneous doctrines. When a member wished to be admitted, it was her duty to examine whether he was infected or not. The former tests were no longer sufficient. Words and phrases, which had hitherto borne but one meaning, were now found to admit of several; and the bishops and clergy were too honest to allow a man to say one thing with his tongue, while in his heart he meant another. It was thus that creeds became lengthened, and clauses were added to meet the presumptuous speculations of human reason. But the fault (if fault it can be called) was with the heretics, not with the church. Her great object from the beginning had been unity.”—pp. 424-428.

We have devoted more space to extracts illustrative of Dr. Burton’s ecclesiastical principles than we should have thought advisable, were the author any other than Dr. Burton; but his authority is such that we are not unwilling to produce it in behalf of doctrines which are at the present looked on in some quarters with not a little suspicion. The above passages will serve also to instance, to those who are unacquainted with his writings, the late Professor’s perspicuous and easy, or, we might even call it, pleasant way of laying out a view before his readers, without any of that elaborateness or diffuseness of language which is frequently the failing of learned men.

The extract we shall presently give contains Dr. Burton’s account of the income of the primitive clergy, and the mode of raising and apportioning it. Nothing is so common with Dissenters at this time as to defend their own Voluntary System by the custom, as they suppose it, of the Primitive Church; yet nothing surely is so unfair. The first ages have nothing in them either of the name or nature of *voluntariness*. No Christian system can be voluntary; except we mean to say, that it ever depends on our free will to receive it or not, and to be judged accordingly. The payments in the early Church were voluntary in that, and that sense only, in which our service to God is such. The word then, as not legitimately bearing this meaning, is an odious one, and becomes those and those only who think they may pass from Church to meeting, as they feel inclined. Nor was there any thing of the nature or the mischief of the Voluntary System of this day in the primitive economy. The mischief of it lies materially in this; that, when it is in operation, a preacher is paid in proportion to his popularity, so that a *bonus* is held out to him for flattering or indulging his audience. But the early Church considered the special gift of a Christian minister to lie, not in preaching, but in ministration of the sacraments, which was one and the same in all who were intrusted with it, and depended for its effect on the *faith* of the recipient, not on the talents of him who exercised it. Here is the true doctrine of salvation by faith, which the very men who make such a clamour about nowadays, show by their mode of reasoning and teaching they understand least of all mankind. It is said, “Thy *faith* hath made thee whole,” not a running after preachers, not the eloquence, the fervour, or the knowledge of Scripture, or of the human heart, possessed by this

or that individual. Nothing is required in the Christian system but God's act and our act; there is no medium interposed such that one man is better than another in his exercise of it. This minister and that minister are but *instruments*, or rather but the *same* instrument, where faith asks, and God answers. This is what the early Church held, and in consequence, did a congregation demand it ever so much, they could not, as they themselves knew, in any way, or by whatever potent bribes, make their minister modify according to their wayward taste, the nature or the quality of that gift which God alone gave and they but passively conveyed, or act in rivalry with his brethren to please them. But not only so; the contributions of the faithful were thrown, as the following passage will show, into a common fund, from which the clergy were paid at the bishop's discretion. Where the bishop had the apportioning of the clergy's incomes, the people could make no discrimination between one of them and another. This is not our usage at this day, nor are we recommending it; but surely it was very different from the Voluntary System. So far, however, we would even go in the way of suggestion; in the noble design under agitation of building additional Churches in the metropolis, might it not be as well that some such rule were observed, to hinder those most mischievous inducements to popular preaching which the existing system of chapel building has fostered? Might not, for instance, the pew-rents be thrown into a common fund, to be dispensed by trustees or others, upon equitable and religious principles? Speaking of Natalis, or Natalius, a confessor who had lapsed to heresy, and taken the episcopate in it, at a monthly salary of 120 denarii, Dr. Burton says,—

“The fact of Natalius receiving a monthly payment for his services, may throw some light upon the method which was then established for the maintenance of the clergy; for though Natalius, in consequence of his heresy, was not at this time in communion with the Church, we may suppose that his followers adopted the custom which was then prevalent with the orthodox clergy. The principle had been expressly asserted by St. Paul, as well as supported by the analogy of the Jewish priesthood, and by the reason of the case itself, that the ministers of Christ should be maintained by their flocks. The apostles availed themselves of this privilege; and all those who were ordained to the ministry by the apostles, received their maintenance from the congregation in which they ministered. The common fund, which was collected by subscriptions from the believers, supplied this maintenance; and the poorer members, such as widows, and those who were destitute or afflicted, received relief from the same charitable sources. We have no means of ascertaining the proportions in which this common fund was divided between the ministers of the word and the poor: and it appears certain that the distribution must have varied in different churches, according to the amount of sums contributed, and the number of applications for relief.—One fact has been preserved, that the management of the common fund was at the discretion of the bishop, who appointed the presbyters and deacons to their offices, as well as paid to them their stipends. The primitive and apostolic custom was preserved of the money being actually distributed to the poor by the hands of the deacons: but the sums allotted to

the respective claimants were settled by the bishop, who was probably assisted in this work by the presbyters of his church. The bishop himself received his maintenance from this common fund: and we know that in later times a fourth part of the whole was considered to belong to him. But when this fourfold division existed, one of the parts was appropriated to the repairs of the church; an expense which was not required, or in a very small degree, for at least the two first centuries, when the Christians had not been permitted to erect churches, but were in the habit of meeting at private houses. A small sum must always have been necessary for the purposes of congregational worship, even when thus simply and privately conducted: but we may conclude

that the remainder of the common stock, after this moderate deduction, was divided between the bishop, his clergy, and the poor: although it does not follow that the proportions were equal, or always invariable. Natalius, as we have seen, a sectarian bishop, residing in Rome, received 120 denarii for a month's salary; and though we cannot suppose that the fund which was raised by a single sect, and that apparently not a large one, was equal to that which belonged to the Church; yet it is not improbable that the supporters of Natalius would be anxious to secure to him as good an income as that which was enjoyed by the bishops of the Church. If this was the case, it follows that the bishops, at the end of the second century, received a payment which equalled 70*l.* a year: or if it be thought that this cannot be taken as an average of the incomes of all bishops, which were certain to vary in different churches, we may at least assume that the income of the bishop of Rome was not less than the amount which has now been mentioned."—pp. 276-279.

As we have above alluded to the project for building additional Churches in London, it may be instructive to contrast with our present liberty of worship the distress and peril in which the early saints met for prayer and praise. We have no obstacle at this moment from without; they had none from within.

"He" [Alexander Severus] "may be said to have expressly tolerated their public worship: for when the keepers of a tavern claimed a piece of ground that had been occupied by the Christians, the emperor adjudged it to the latter, adding the remark, that it was better for God to be worshipped there in any manner, than for the ground to be used for a pothouse.

"The last anecdote might lead to an interesting inquiry into the period when the Christians first began to meet in churches, or at least to have buildings set apart for public worship. They probably acquired this liberty earlier in some countries than in others: but we can hardly doubt that some such buildings were possessed by them in Rome, during the reign of the present emperor. We know that, for many years, they met in each others' houses. Concealment, on such occasions, was absolutely necessary; and we may judge of the perils with which they were beset, as well as of the firmness of their faith, when we know that the excavations in the neighbourhood of Rome, which were formed by the digging of stone, were used for a long time by the Christians, as places

of religious meetings. In these dark and dismal catacombs, which may still be seen, and which still bear traces of their former occupants, the early martyrs and confessors poured forth their prayers to God, and thanked their Redeemer, that they were counted worthy to suffer shame for his name. Here also the remains of their dead were interred: and it was long before the intolerance of their enemies allowed the Christians to breathe a healthy air, or enjoy the light of heaven, while they were engaged in their sacred duties. This indulgence appears to have been gained at Rome during the period of comparative peace, which began on the death of Septimius Severus: but since Elagabalus prohibited every kind of public worship, except that of the Sun, we may perhaps conclude, that few, if any, religious buildings had been possessed by the Christians, till the time when Alexander decided the case in their favour.

"At that time, they had a piece of ground belonging to them; and it appears to have been the property, not of some one individual who was a Christian, but of the whole community. It was probably bought out of the common fund, which has already been mentioned as belonging to the Christians: and the emperor's decision makes it plain, that it had been used for the purposes of public worship. It is not probable that the Christians met in the open air. The spot must, therefore, have been occupied by some building; which was either a private dwelling converted to this sacred purpose after its purchase by the Christians, or one which had been specially erected for the occasion. The latter conclusion would be the most interesting, as containing the earliest evidence

of the building of churches: though it might be thought that the present edifice was rather of an inferior kind, since the opposite party intended to turn it into a tavern.”—pp. 316-318.

This transaction took place about A.D. 222—forty years later the See of Antioch had a house attached to it, which was recognized as being so by the Emperor Aurelian. On this account we the more wonder at the following sentence in the author’s narrative of the times of Constantine, which seems to sink the primitive Church to the level of the Popish agitators in Ireland in this day.

“It is plain from the terms of this edict, (one of Constantine’s) that the Christians had for some time been in possession of property. It speaks of houses and lands which did not belong to individuals, but to the whole body. Their possession of such property could hardly have escaped the notice of the government; but it seems to have been held in direct violation of a law of Diocletian, which prohibited corporate bodies, or associations which were not legally recognised, from, acquiring property. The Christians were certainly not a body recognized by law at the beginning of the reign of Diocletian; and it might almost be thought that this enactment was specially directed against them. But, like other laws which are founded upon tyranny, and are at variance with the first principles of justice, it is probable that this law about corporate property was evaded. We must suppose that the Christians had purchased

lands and houses before the law was passed: and their disregard of the prohibition may be taken as another proof that their religion had now gained so firm a footing, that the executors of the laws were obliged to connive at their being broken by so numerous a body”—pp. 418, 419.

As the volume before us is of a popular character, and upon controversial points of the history states but the conclusion to which its author had arrived, and which he has argued at length in his former works, it will not be necessary to notice any of them or examine what may be said for or against them. Every writer has a right to his own opinion in such matters, and a learned man like Dr. Burton, pre-eminently. One of these, however, we are tempted to say a few words upon, because it bears immediately upon the sacred text, and all men, not theologians only, have an interest in it. Dr. Burton considers James the Less, Bishop of Jerusalem, and brother or cousin of our Lord, as a different person from James the son of Alphæus, the Apostle. Without wishing to dogmatize on a point of this nature, we are somewhat surprised that he has been able to acquiesce in that view. In his lectures on the first century, he rests the proof of it on the testimony of antiquity, which he says is certainly in favour of the Bishop of Jerusalem not being one of the Twelve. But in the first place we are by no means sure that the authority of the Fathers in matters of fact connected with Scripture history, is greater than that of any one at this day. The personal history of the first propagators of the Gospel seems from the first to have been almost consigned to oblivion; and it is but in accordance with the height and grandeur of the system they administered, that it should be so. Doctrinal truth was carefully guarded, and transmitted; individuals, however illustrious, were passed by. How little is known about the labours and sufferings of the Apostles! while the result of them is clear, the establishment of the Church far and wide. In consequence, the early Christian writers, in attempting to trace the history of Christ and his Apostles, had no other resource than our own, viz. the attempt to glean from the sacred text what slight hints might therein be conveyed about it; and, having no means of information distinct from ours, they may as fairly be criticised or differed with as if they lived at this day. For instance, Theodoret speaks of St. James and St. Matthew as living together, and Chrysostom of St. James being a publican; can we doubt, under the circumstances, that this belief arose from St. Matthew being called the son of Alphæus as well as St. James? We have a parallel case in Dionysius’s inquiry whether the author of the Apocalypse was the Apostle or another John. He plainly knew no more of the matter than ourselves, and his opinion

has no kind of authority over our belief. He argues the point critically, and ingeniously, from the structure of the book, and he comes to the conclusion that it is not the writing of St. John. As we do not feel bound in this case to adopt Dionysius's opinion, neither are we under any necessity to follow other Fathers, though they even did distinguish between James, Bishop of Jerusalem and James the Apostle. But in the next place the evidence from the Fathers seems not at all so clear, as at first sight might be thought. Dr. Burton refers to Eusebius, Epiphanius, Nyssen, Chrysostom, Theodoret, Jerome, and the author of the Constitutions; but the true reading in Eusebius seems to speak just the reverse. Chrysostom elsewhere strongly implies there were but two, not three, disciples of the name of James; and Jerome thought sometimes one way, sometimes the other. On the other hand various Fathers called James the Less an Apostle, absolutely and without restriction. Thus after all we are cast upon the text of Scripture for our information; and, though it is certain that we read of James the Less in one place, of James the son of Alphæus in another, without any hint in those very places that the names did not belong to separate individuals; yet there is strong reason to conclude from other passages that they were but different designations of the same person. The text in the Galatians would seem decisive in the matter; "*Other of the Apostles I saw none, save James the Lord's brother.*" If it be said that the word *Apostle* extended beyond the twelve, being applied to St. Paul himself and St. Barnabas, this cannot be the case in this place, for in that sense St. Paul's declaration does not hold, as he *had* seen St. Barnabas at the season he speaks of. Indeed it seems almost incredible that James the Less should be spoken of as he is, if he were not one of the Twelve. For instance, when St. Paul first came to Jerusalem, St. Barnabas "took him and brought him to the Apostles;" that is, as the passage above referred to informs us, to Peter and *James*. It is James who presides at the Council of Jerusalem; it is James before whom St. Paul lays his proceedings on his coming up to Jerusalem after his Apostolic journey; it is as brother of James that the Apostle Jude designates himself, which hardly could be, were James short of an Apostle. Further, if the author of the Catholic Epistle be not an Apostle, it will be the only exception to the rule among the books of the New Testament; the Gospel according to St. Mark and St. Luke, not only being ultimately referable to Apostles, but being a narrative of our Saviour's teaching, not the teaching of the Evangelists themselves.

So much stress has been laid of late, in popular divinity, on one or two doctrines of the Gospel, apart from the rest, that it is not wonderful that Dr. Burton, a man of frank, accessible, and unsuspecting mind, and from his parochial habits especially likely to be brought under the influence of the current religion, should have sometimes worded himself in a way which he would be the first to lament, had he discovered whither it was tending. We hear frequent complaints about the evil of seclusion from pastoral labour, of learned leisure, and the like: this counterbalancing good, however, may be expected from it, that the old forms of thought and language will probably be retained in theological teaching, whatever happens in the world. The following passage will explain what we mean.

"The doctrine itself (the 'new and strange doctrine, which was opposed to the prejudices and passions of mankind,' which the Apostles had to preach,) may be explained in a few words. They were to preach faith in Christ crucified. Men were to be taught to repent of their sins and to believe in Christ, trusting to his merits alone for pardon and salvation; and those who embraced this doctrine were admitted into the Christian covenant by baptism, as a token that they were cleansed from their sins, by faith in the death of Christ: upon which admission they received the gift of the Holy Ghost, enabling them to perform works well-pleasing to God, which they could not have done by their own strength."—pp. 23, 24.

Now, if by this statement it is only meant that the doctrines specified were those elementary portions of the Gospel which in matter-of-fact the Apostles preached to the unconverted as first steps in the Christian faith, it is quite borne out by the book of Acts. Yet we cannot help fearing that most readers, instead of considering it to speak of the first truths put before the minds of those whom the Apostles addressed, will conceive it to specify those which are highest and most sacred, and in such sense the *essence* of the Gospel, that, they being secured, every thing really important is secured with them. They will consider that all other doctrines, however true in themselves, however high in their subject, are but secondary, and only useful as ministering to the former and easily to be dispensed with in individuals, if the former are ascertained. Not that this single passage by itself need convey this, but that it seems to do so, interpreted, as it will be, by the mode of thinking and the language of the day. At this moment especially, when the orthodox doctrines of the Trinity, Incarnation, or Atonement, are so lightly treated in quarters where one might have hoped for better things, we regret the *accident*, for it is merely an accident, which makes Dr. Burton appear to put those divine truths in the second place in the Christian scheme, in defence of which no late writer has been more zealous, more energetic, more unwearied than himself in former publications.

It is the same cause, a latent desire, as we conceive, to accommodate the ancient theology to the habits of this day, and to *explain* to his readers, in a manner level to their comprehensions, the abhorrence in which the then existing heresies were held by the early Church, which has led this most amiable and excellent man to *prove* the impiety of the Gnostics, not from their doctrine itself, but from the *consequences* of it. That doctrine *directly* contravenes the Catholic doctrine of the Incarnation; but, as if feeling that the age would respond languidly to any charge of heresy on that score, Dr. Burton observes, what is quite true, but, as we should say, superfluous, that it *indirectly* denied the Atonement. He observes,—

“The name of Christ held a conspicuous place in the system of the Gnostics, but there were parts of their creed which destroyed the *very foundations* of the doctrine of the Gospel. Thus, *while* they believed the body of Jesus to be a phantom, and denied the reality of His crucifixion, they, *in fact*, denied their belief, in the death of Christ, *and with it they gave up altogether the doctrine of Atonement.*”—p. 102.

He is not content with observing it once, but repeats it in a subsequent chapter:—

“He (Simon Magus) would not believe that Jesus had a real substantial body; he thought that a divine and heavenly being would never unite himself with what was earthly and material; and having heard of Christ soon after his ascension, before any written accounts of his birth and death were circulated, he formed the absurd and fanciful notion, that the body of Jesus was a mere spirit, or phantom, which only appeared to perform the functions of a man, and that it was not really nailed to the cross. *It has been already observed, that this impiety entirely destroyed the doctrine of the Atonement.*”—p. 154.

Nay, his anxiety on this point leads him to a third mention of it, as if he thought that theology must be recognized as practical, before it had any claims on the deference of the age.

“He (Basilides) therefore had recourse to the extraordinary notion that Simon of Cyrene was substituted for Jesus; which may remind the reader of what has been already observed, that Gnosticism entirely destroyed the doctrine of the Atonement: that Jesus Christ suffered death for the sins of the world, did not, and could not, form any part of the religious tenets of Basilides. *We are not, therefore, to be surprised that the heads of the Church took such pains to expose the errors of a system which, though it appears at first unworthy of a serious notice, was fatally subversive of the very foundations*

of our faith."—p. 201, 202.

Were it not that this volume is intended for general circulation under the joint authority of Dr. Burton's respected name and of the Literature Committee, we should not dwell on a point like this. But, considering this very serious circumstance, we think it right to call attention to one or two other passages of a similar complexion, that is, containing expressions, meaning nothing in the work itself, but which the divinity of the day will at once single out, appropriate, and triumph in.

In the first of the passages above quoted, the author speaks of admittance "into the Christian covenant by baptism," "as a *token* that they were cleansed from their sins by faith in the death of Christ." Now if we wished to be critical, we should object first of all to the phrase, "admittance into the Christian *covenant*," not for its own sake, (for it is in itself quite unobjectionable,) but as being a substitute for one which is much more comprehensive, "admittance into the Christian *Church*." This also is an accommodation in the writer to the temper of the day, which is much more willing to suppose that in baptism we enter into certain *relations* with Almighty God, than that we join a certain *society*. Of course baptism introduces us into a new state, but it does more than this, and we may be quite sure that where there is unwillingness to admit the received *language* of divinity, this is not an accident, a matter of taste, feeling, or habit, but rises from some lurking indisposition towards the *thing* which that language expresses. We have then some light cast upon the declension of this day's divinity from the standard of the Reformation, from the following observable fact, that in the baptismal service, while the expression of "admittance into the covenant" is not once found,—there occur on the other hand those diversified phrases of "received into Christ's holy Church;" "received into the ark of Christ's Church;" "remain in the number of thy faithful and elect children;" "we receive this child into the congregation of Christ's flock;" "grafted into the body of Christ's Church;" "incorporate him into Thy holy Church." It is as clear as words can make it, that our Service contemplates the Church, whatever is meant thereby, (for that is quite a distinct question,) as a definite instrument in God's hands, *through* which baptized persons receive the promised blessings. It compares it to the ark of Noah, by which we escape "the waves of this troublesome world," and *in which* we are to be found at the last day, if we are to be "inheritors of God's everlasting kingdom." Substitute *covenant* for Church, as the privilege into which baptism admits us, and an entire doctrine is dropped out of the Christian scheme.

But, after all, it is the word "*token*," in the extract referred to, which makes it necessary to dwell upon it. The author says that admittance by baptism is a *token* that they were cleansed from their sins by faith in the death of Christ. Why not a means? Yet this defective expression is used of the sacraments more than once. For instance,—

"They immediately established the custom of meeting in each others' houses, to join in prayer to God, and to receive the bread and wine, in *token* of their belief in the death and resurrection of Christ ... Scarcely a day passed in which the converts did not give *this solemn and public attestation* of their resting all their hopes in the death of their Redeemer."—p. 31.

"Whether the dying penitent would have his pardon sealed in heaven or no, was not for man to decide; but it was not for man to prohibit him from testifying his faith by receiving the symbols of Christ's body and blood."—p. 351.

In a sentence which soon follows, there is indeed an advance towards the higher truth; but not a decisive one. The author speaks of "this solemn rite being considered the privilege, as it was the *blessing and comfort*, of sincere believers only." Once more,—

"If a man did not hold the articles of faith which were taught by the Church, he could not receive the bread and wine *which were taken as a proof of his holding this faith*."—p. 425.

Surely they were taken as a “blessing and comfort,” in the author’s own words, or rather as a special channel of heavenly grace, on condition of his faith. Considering what is going on at present in the Christian Knowledge Society on the subject of baptism, we think its Literature Committee should reflect that these passages on the sacraments may be taken in an exclusive sense which the author did not contemplate, and would be the first to disown.

And now having given our readers some insight into Dr. Burton’s work, we leave it for the study of those, an increasing number we trust, who think that an acquaintance with the early Church may tend to the edification of their own.

**ART. VI.—Lectures on the Principal Doctrines and Practices of the Catholic Church.
By Nicholas Wiseman, D.D. London: Booker. 1836.**

[*British Critic*, vol. 19, Oct. 1836.]

WE are no friends to Popery, as our readers will bear us witness; yet, we confess, we were not displeased at the publication of Dr. Wiseman’s Lectures. In truth, the foundation of the English Church lies very deep, while the views and principles of a number of her children are very shallow; so there is no inconsistency in welcoming a controversy which will be an advantage to them, yet no harm to her. Much as we sympathize, as we ought, with those of our own body, and strong as our party feelings necessarily are when they enter into the lists, yet we have brought ourselves to believe, that in the present case defeat and perplexity are for their good. Reverses in argument may humble and sober them, may make them see they have something to add to their present stock of theological knowledge, and teach them somewhat more clearly what it is they are defending, and on what principles the English Church stands; and on this account we can bear to contemplate what in itself will be a pain to all who are connected with them, and a triumph to the enemy. We conceive the controversy with Rome will have the effect of recalling them to those good and true views of divinity which numbers of them have nearly abandoned. Moreover (if it may be said) our very devotion to the Church herself inspires us with somewhat of a serious feeling against such of her champions as are not able to defend without degrading her;—who maintain her, as if she were a mere establishment, and as they would support the new system for administering the poor laws or the London police. Let us be candid; there is still another reason which somewhat increases our satisfaction at Dr. Wiseman’s and similar publications. The line of argument against Romanism adopted by our great divines has not been deemed good enough by many of us moderns; it has been judged severe and uncharitable to Dissenters of various denominations to walk in the steps of Hammond and Beveridge; and if some isolated individuals have ventured to do so, they have been promptly and unscrupulously ranked as confederates with the corrupt system which they professed to oppose. Well, then, let us see whether these more clear-sighted religionists (as they think themselves), these pure Protestants and rigid Scripturists, will make a better and more satisfactory fight when they come into close contact with their foe, that crafty foe which shelters its errors under the truths which such adversaries wantonly, unreluctantly surrender to it as its own. Hitherto they have either skirmished with the enemy, or have engaged at an advantage which they can never expect again. It is a very different thing to attack Romanism on ultra-Protestant principles in an open field, or to have the law and the multitude on our side. The latter has been the condition of things during the last 150 years; Protestantism was the sovereign religion of the state, and the great object of policy was to repress and keep under Romanism. The English Church has been upheld, not on its own merits, but as a useful antagonist to the church of Rome, and a substitute for it. Irreligious statesmen thought it a stopgap, and they confronted it to the Romanists, as much as

to say, "we have our Church as well as you; we can make a church for the occasion." They used it (we speak in sober sadness, and with shame) as if it were an abbot of Unreason in mock controversy with the abbot of Kennaquhair. We could enlarge upon this fact were it decorous to do so. Another principal use of the English Church in the eyes of politicians has been its suppression of enthusiasm and extravagance in religion. And to these must be added the more obvious national blessings which it dispenses, and which are so fully understood and so eloquently stated at conservative meetings and dinners. All these circumstances have invested the cause of the English Church hitherto with a popularity external for the most part to its own principles; and Romanism has had to contend since the Revolution rather with the power of the civil sword than the arguments of divines. Arguments indeed have been used, but they have been drawn from any quarter without weighing whether they had too much or too little in them for the purpose of the English Church, rather as if to comply with a rule of the game, than as if the words used were intended to have any particular meaning. But now that the English Church has been bereft of its civil defences, it has but an alternative of defending itself, or retreating backward into the lines of that mixed multitude of denominations, which alone the state seems to recognize and cherish. Its defenders must either reform their arguments, or modify their conclusions; must either reason as true Catholics, or profess themselves mere Latitudinarians.

And there is danger certainly, and (as some persons think) a very considerable one, of the English Church, at this era of her history, acquiescing in the latter alternative. There is certainly a strong party in the Church, who would be pleased to obliterate her distinctive marks, in order to increase her political security. We are not accusing such men of what is commonly called *worldly-mindedness*. They think the religious advantages of an establishment such, that it is *tanti* to make, what seems to them, but a little alteration in its doctrines, for the sake of preserving it. The government says to them, "*you must reform, (to use the fashionable word), or others will reform for you;*" so to prevent evil men from altering the *political relations* of the Church, they consent to alter its *principles*. And certainly our Church has before now been betrayed in this manner by those who are her consecrated defenders; which throws an additional shade over the prospect of the future. Yet, whatever be her present weakness, whatever treachery there be within the camp, we conceive that her controversy with Rome will advantage her rather than otherwise. Many men, doubtless, will run from fear of Popery into the opposite extreme, and thus fulfil Horace's remark. Such of the laity, especially, as lightly employ themselves in the controversy, being bound by no obligations to the principles of our Church, will, it is to be feared, take refuge in ultra-Protestantism. With the Clergy we should hope it would be otherwise; they are tutored in the words and services of the Church, even when they do not understand her spirit; and the collision with Rome must in consequence rather bring them nearer to Rome (in those points in which Rome has preserved neglected truths) than drive them further off. An untaught layman, for instance, who never read the Ordination Service, may scoff at the doctrine of the ministerial commission when brought forward by the Romanist; but one who has had the awful words pronounced over him, in which it is conveyed in our ritual, cannot deny the doctrine, and at the very utmost will but keep silence—cannot go further than doubt—when it is urged upon him. He may have forgotten, he cannot oppose it. The clergy, in fact, are bound to true Catholicism by firm, though (of late) neglected ties; and the controversy with Rome will but remind them of them, and lead them to use them. At the same time that this will lead to a still wider separation between the views of Churchmen and those of our civil governors it is impossible to deny.

Nor do we think that the controversy will tend, on the other hand, to any dangerous spread of

Romanism. That it will spread is likely enough, though we have no proof of its success among us hitherto; but, if it spreads, it will spread among Dissenters and irregulars. Men who are one day of one religion and another of another, will at length become victims of Rome,—they are its fit prey. Far from lamenting them, we shall consider them better off than when they were carried about by every wind of doctrine. The tyranny will be profitable, though it be a “house of bondage” and an iron yoke; and for corruption of faith, they have not so much purity to boast of at present, that we should think their case very pitiable. It is better to be fixed and quiet than ever to be restless and changing; better to be superstitious than profane; better to have the ordinances of grace than to be without them; and Romanism will benefit in these three ways the mere Protestants whom it converts.

For all these reasons we hear with great equanimity the rumours of the impression which Dr. Wiseman’s lectures have made upon the mixed multitude of London. Romanism has great truths in it, which we of this day have almost forgotten; and its preachers will recall numbers of Churchmen and Dissenters to an acknowledgment of them: Dissenters who never had them will embrace them in their Roman form; Churchmen who have received, but forgotten them, will discern them, and use them in the Church. We cannot hope for unity and peace in our time. We have but a choice of evils, and perhaps pure Anglicanism and pure Romanism would not be worse than the present unmeaning conglomeration of sects and parties, which tends to the ruin of all that is devotional, generous and humble-minded.

How far we have degenerated from the characteristic principle of our Reformation in the sixteenth century, appears in nothing more than in this; that, while to say a word in favour of any part of the Roman system is reckoned a symptom of Popery, yet the very persons who so consider it will have no scruple whatever, not only in recommending, and giving away the works of Dissenters, but in co-operating with them. Multitudes who consider themselves sound members of our Church, and are so, as far as good feeling and religious sentiment go, would feel no remorse at giving away Doddridge’s *Rise and Progress*, or Bunyan’s *Pilgrim’s Progress*, while they would be surprised to hear any thing good said of Dr. Wiseman’s lectures, as tending, not indeed to the end which he anticipates, but to the revival of certain truths which have been for some years forgotten. They would consider this as all one with recommending Popery; but if so, how is our Church’s doctrine a *via media*? quite as fairly, to say the least, might *they* be called Dissenters for circulating the peculiar works above mentioned.

With this explanation of the feelings with which we view Dr. Wiseman’s appearance in the metropolis, we turn to his published lectures. The doctrines he discusses are far too ample for the limits of a review; it may be best therefore to confine ourselves to the subject most elaborately treated in them, and indeed the most important, viz. what is commonly called the Rule of Faith. He undertakes, of course, to justify his own Church’s doctrine concerning it, and his arguments are of the following kind:—Romanists, or, as he calls them, Catholics, consider there is a living infallible authority in matters of faith. Protestants, among whom he includes the English Church, consider the Bible the sole authority; the latter principle is, in every way of viewing it, ill suited, or rather inadequate for the purposes of a rule, the former is simple, intelligible and applicable on all occasions; there is, then, a very great antecedent probability in favour of the Roman and against the English rule. Next he professes to prove the Roman rule from Scripture; and then to confirm its divine original from its fruits. Now this statement affords abundant matter for exception.

Dr. Wiseman would make it appear as if there were no medium between the two alternatives above stated; between an infallible living guide, and no guide besides Scripture itself. Now this is

far from being the case; for at least English theology does admit a guide, though not an infallible one, but subordinate to Scripture. It considers that Scripture is not an easy book, and, as so considering, believes also that Almighty God has been pleased to provide a guide. The 20th Article expressly declares, that the Church “hath authority in controversies of faith.” There is, then, at least there is professed, whether or not it can be maintained, a middle view between the two extremes with which he opens his lectures.

In his second lecture Dr. Wiseman acknowledges this; but then he attempts to show that the article above quoted is unmeaning, and leaves matters as it finds them. He frankly acknowledges in the most candid way, that, as far as the wording of the Articles go, there is no countenance therein given in matters of faith to the exercise of private judgment on the text of Scripture. He says, quoting the 6th Article, “in this passage there is not one word about the individual right of any one to judge for himself; it is only that no one is to be *charged* with the belief of any doctrine, no one can be *required* to give his adhesion to any article which is not contained in the word of God.”—p. 28. He goes on to state most clearly and truly what the drift of the article really *is*; “the rule,” he says, “is more to prevent some one, not named, from exacting belief beyond a certain point; it is a limitation of the power to *require* submission to the teaching of some authority. That this authority is the Church there can be no doubt;” and then he quotes the 20th Article; “the Church hath authority in controversies of faith,” provided it ordains nothing “contrary to God’s word written,” or so expounds “any passage of Scripture as to be repugnant to another.”

Nothing can be clearer; the English doctrine does not encourage private judgment in matters of (necessary) faith, but maintains the Church’s authority. But Dr. Wiseman sees so much perplexity in this view, that after this clear exposition of it, he abandons it, from inability to apply or use it. His first objection is, that there is a practical absurdity in saying that the Church has authority and *yet* must go by Scripture; for, he argues, who is to *judge* whether it goes by Scripture or not? Either then, he says, the article is nugatory or it throws us upon some higher tribunal; as for instance, private judgment. No surely; the article need not be nugatory, though we do not have recourse to any further tribunal. *How* shall we know, does Dr. Wiseman say, whether the Church goes by Scripture or not in her decisions? Why, suppose she herself *confesses* she does not, and maintains she *need* not. Dr. Wiseman says the article aims at “some one not named;” perhaps he is aware of “some one not named,” who, claiming to be the Church Catholic, also claims to decide by tradition, without Scripture, in matters of faith. What need of a further tribunal when we have “*confitentem reum*?” Will he reply that the Roman Church does *not* grant that it can decree things *contrary* to Scripture? true, but it claims to decree points of faith *beyond* Scripture. And this is the authority which we deny it. We do not deny that many things may be true which are not in Scripture; but we deny such are points of what is emphatically called the *faith*, i.e. points necessary to be believed in order to salvation; and whether or not it be easy to determine what doctrines *are* in Scripture and what not, at least we may safely take the Roman Church’s own word, when she *confesses* she is determining from tradition, not from Scripture. For instance, the Council of Trent makes it necessary to salvation to believe that it is “good and useful suppliantly to invoke the saints,” and this on the ground of its being “*juxta Catholicæ et Apostolicæ Ecclesiæ usum à primævis Christianæ religionis temporibus receptum, sanctorumque Patrum consentionem, et sacrorum Conciliorum decreta*,” not a word being said of *Scripture* sanction. This is the principle which we altogether disavow; we allow that the Church may pronounce doctrines as *true* which are not in Scripture, so that they are not against it, but we do not think that she may declare points to be necessary to be believed in order to salvation, and may act accordingly, unless she professes to derive them from Scripture. We consider that her

decision in such extra-scriptural matters is not secure from error; is entitled indeed to veneration, but has not, strictly speaking, *authority*, and therefore may not rightly be *enforced*. This distinction is made at the end of the twentieth article. "As it (the Church) ought not to *decree* any thing *against* the same, so *besides* the same ought it not to enforce any thing to be believed for necessity of salvation." The Church must not enforce beyond Scripture; it may decree, i.e. pronounce, beyond it, but not against it.

Here, then, we have a most consistent meaning given to these articles, a plain and obvious drift. They are directed against the Church of Rome, which does professedly violate the principle therein propounded. But Dr. Wiseman will ask, how this helps us in a case where the Church *does* profess to be guided by Scripture. "It so *happens*," he may say, "that the Roman Church affords a case when the rule has a meaning; but this is but a fortunate exception. May the Church always be judge in its own cause; and, as her witness is to be taken when she owns she goes beyond Scripture, is it also decisive when she professes to deduce from it? In short, is this article intended to explain to us a positive theory, or is it merely directed against the Romanists? It restrains the authority of the Church, does it define it?"

Now this very article does not supply the full limitations which Anglicans put upon the Church's authority; we find another limitation mentioned elsewhere. In the Canon of the very Convocation, (1571), which confirmed the Articles, it is declared that nothing should be preached to be religiously held by the people, but what is agreeable to Scripture doctrine, and *gathered thence by the "Catholic Fathers and ancient Bishops."* This then is a second restriction, and, acting under these two, we may safely say that the Church, i.e. the Church Catholic, has absolute authority in matters of necessary or saving faith, and supersedes so far private judgment upon the text of Scripture—that, as ruling herself by Scripture and antiquity, she may securely and implicitly be trusted in all matters of necessary doctrine; nay further, we may even grant (to imitate Dr. Wiseman's mode of varying his proposition, p. 30,) she literally *cannot*, that is, she has a promise that she never will, enforce any thing as a point of necessary faith which is not at once Scriptural and primitive, and that so she is a sure authority. As it is her *duty* ever diligently to study Scripture and antiquity, so it is her *privilege* to be assured she shall be kept ever from departing from these two joint guides. And this is one token that the Church of Rome is not the Church Catholic, but a particular Church; because she has avowed and used a different rule.

The doctrine we have elicited as the Anglican, in the course of these remarks, viz. that the Church Catholic is indefectible in matters of necessary and saving truth, will, perhaps, startle some persons till they are assured that it is taught by our Principal divines; some of whom express it in the very words which we have just used. Let the force of our words be clearly understood. By matters of *faith* are meant, not all doctrines which may be gathered from the Bible, but fundamental and necessary to be believed; nor again, new doctrines, but the old and original articles; for by the hypothesis the Church ever will be guided by antiquity. Again, we speak of the Church Catholic; not of portions of the Church; of these, another of our Articles declares expressly, that "as the Church of Jerusalem, Alexandria, and Antioch, have erred, so also the Church of Rome hath erred ... in matters of faith." (Art. 19.) We mean that the whole Church, all over the world, will never agree together in teaching and enforcing what is not true. With these explanations, is not the doctrine as true in fact, as it is natural and probable in itself? There is surely no harshness, even at first sight, in supposing that so far Divine Providence may watch over his own work; and, in fact, the supposition is, and ever has been, much more than fulfilled. All over Christendom that faith which St. Athanasius, for instance, held, is still held *as* the Christian faith. *All* its branches, one and

all, believe in the Trinity and Incarnation, which have ever been considered the fundamental or essential doctrines of the Gospel.

But the reader shall have the very words of some of our standard Divines. "In this troublesome and quarrelsome age," says Laud, "I am most unwilling to meddle with the erring of the Church in general. The Church of England is content to pass that over; and, though she tells us that the Church of Rome hath erred even in matters of faith, yet of the erring of the Church in general she is modestly silent. But since A.C." Fisher's partisan, "will needs have it, that the whole Church did never generally err in *any one* point of faith," (he uses faith here not for *necessary* doctrine only,) "he should do well to distinguish, before he be so peremptory. For if he mean, no more than that the whole universal Church of Christ cannot universally err in any one point of faith, *simply necessary to all men's salvation*, he fights with no adversary, that I know, but his own fiction, for the most learned Protestants grant it".—*Conference with Fisher*, p. 160; *vide*, also, p. 139, 240. Bramhall says, "We do readily acknowledge that the true Catholic Church is so far infallible, as is necessary to the salvation of Christians; that is the end of the Church."—p. 282. Again, "We believe the Holy Ghost doth lead the Catholic or Universal Church into all truths, which are simply necessary to salvation, and preserves it from all such damnable errors, as are destructive to saving faith; so that the gates of hell never prevail against it. But we believe also that it is the property of the Church triumphant, to be without all spots and wrinkles; particular Churches are of another matter, they have no such privilege, no not Rome itself."—p. 1018, *vide* also p. 30. Stillingfleet says, in his *Grounds of the Protestant Religion*, "The most that we assert is, that there is and shall always be a Church, for that is all that is meant by a Church being infallible in fundamentals; now for this we have the greatest assurance possible, that there shall be, from the promises of Christ, and that there is, from the certainty we have of the faith and baptism of Christians."—*Grounds*, p. 518. Again, "This is all which is meant by saying, that the present Church is infallible in fundamentals; viz. that there shall always be a Church; for that which makes them a Church, is the belief of fundamentals."—p. 233. In like manner Hammond, treating of Œcumenical Councils, makes a still larger admission. "Though I make it no matter of faith," he says, "because delivered neither by Scripture nor Apostolic Tradition, yet I shall number it among the *piè credibilia*, that no general council, *truly such*," (i.e. not the professed and pretended general councils of which our 21st Article speaks *historically*,) "first, duly assembled; second, freely celebrated; and third, universally received, either hath erred, or ever shall err, in matters of faith."—*Of Heresy*, § 9.

Ussher's authority is still more valuable, on account of his being supposed to hold some private uncatholic opinions. "In all places of the world," he says, in his Sermon on Eph. iv. 13, "where the ancient foundations were retained, and these common principles of faith, upon the profession whereof men have ever been wont to be admitted by baptism into the Church of Christ, there we doubt not but our Lord had his subjects, and we our fellow-servants; for we bring in no new faith, nor no new Church. That which in the time of the Ancient Fathers was accounted to be 'truly and properly Catholic,' namely, 'that which was believed *every where, always, and by all*,' that in *the succeeding ages hath evermore been preserved*, and is at this day entirely professed in our Church. And it is well observed by a learned man, (Serranus, *Appar. ad Fid. Cath.*) who hath written a full discourse of this argument, that 'whatsoever the father of lies either hath attempted, or shall attempt, yet neither hath he hitherto effected, nor shall ever bring it to pass hereafter, that this Catholic doctrine, ratified by the common consent of Christians always and every where, should be abolished, but that in the thickest mist rather of the most perplexed troubles, it still obtained victory, both in the minds and in the open confessions of all Christians, no way overturned in the

foundation thereof; and that in this verity, that one Church of Christ was preserved in the midst of the tempests of the most cruel winter, or in the thickest darkness of her wanings.’ Thus if at this day, we should take a survey of the several professions of Christianity that have any large spread in any part of the world, as of the religion of the Roman and the Reformed Churches in our quarters, of the Egyptians and Ethiopians in the South, of the Grecians and other Christians in the Eastern parts, and should put by the points wherein they did differ one from another, and gather into one body the rest of the articles wherein they all did generally agree; we should find, that *in those propositions which without all controversy are universally received in the whole Christian world, so much truth is contained*, as, being joined with holy obedience, may be sufficient to bring a man unto everlasting salvation. Neither have we cause to doubt, but that, ‘as many as do walk according to this rule,’ neither overthrowing that which they have builded, by superinducing any ‘damnable heresies’ thereupon, nor otherwise vitiating their ‘holy faith’ with a lewd and wicked conversation, ‘peace shall be upon them, and mercy, and upon the Israel of God.’ Now these common principles of the Christian faith, which we call [*choinopista*], or things ‘generally believed’ of all, as they have *universality*, and *antiquity*, and *consent* concurring with them, which, by Vincentius’s rule, are the special character of that which is truly and properly Catholic, so for their duration we are sure *that they have still held out*, and been kept as the *seminary* of the Catholic Church in the darkest and difficultest times that ever have been; when, if the Lord of Hosts had not in his mercy reserved the seed unto us, we should long since have been as Sodom, &c.”

Considering the importance of the point in question, the little acquaintance of most persons with our standard divines, and the consequent confusion in the popular mind between true Catholicism and Popery, we have not scrupled to make extracts instead of setting down references at the foot of the page. The above passages, to which many more might be added, are *facts* against Dr. Wiseman,—facts in evidence that it is possible to protest against Romanism without holding in consequence that Christian doctrine is of a variable or private nature, left for individuals to deduce from Scripture, by their own ability, apart from the testimony of the general Church. They speak of the Church as always holding indefectibly, or knowing infallibly, those doctrines which are the fundamentals of faith; from which position its absolute authority in respect to them necessarily follows. What the Church Catholic now is, whether the Church in communion with Rome, or the mere multitude of professing Christians poured over all countries, or the Church Episcopal throughout the world, or the established Churches in various countries, this is a question most incumbent on us to answer, but not entering into the present discussion; which is merely on this one point—do our Articles mean what they say, and what Dr. Wiseman allows they say, when they give the Church “authority in controversies of faith,” whatever “the Church” is? On the other hand, what fundamentals are, may, as Ussher intimates, be exactly ascertained by referring to those times when there is no doubt either what and where the Church was, or what her faith was. What were considered the necessary articles of faith in the early Church is a matter of history; *these* are they which we Anglicans consider the Church indefectibly to preserve even to the end; these accordingly are the points in which she has authority,” not as a judge or arbiter, so much as a witness. The characteristic difference then, between the English and Roman doctrine in the point under consideration is this—that Romanists conceive that the Church may create articles of *necessary* belief; that what was not necessary to be believed in order to salvation before her decision, becomes so afterwards; whereas we consider that the one saving faith has, from the first, been ever promulgated; that the Church does not, by her decision, make any part of it saving, but merely declares it: in other words, they consider the Church an infallible arbiter *pro re natâ*; we, a faithful

and indefectible guardian of what was, in the first instance, *given* as saving. Both parties consider “the faith” to be *necessary to salvation*; but we say the faith is prior to the Church; they, the Church is prior to the faith.

Now, before continuing our examination of Dr. Wiseman’s argument in order, let us pass on for an instant to his fourth lecture, in which he adduces some of the texts on which his Church builds her claim to absolute infallibility. He quotes the 54th and 59th chapters of the prophet Isaiah, which address the Church as follows:

“Enlarge the place of thy tent, and let them stretch forth the curtains of thine habitations; spare not, lengthen thy cords and strengthen thy stakes ... with everlasting kindness will I have mercy on thee. My kindness shall not depart from thee, neither shall the covenant of my peace be removed, saith the Lord that hath mercy on thee ... All thy children shall be taught of the Lord, and great shall be the peace of thy children ... No weapon that is formed against thee shall prosper; and every tongue that shall rise against thee in judgment thou shall condemn ... This is my covenant with them, saith the Lord; My Spirit that is upon thee, and my words which I have put in thy mouth, shall not depart out of thy mouth, nor out of the mouth of thy seed, nor out of the mouth of thy seed’s seed, saith the Lord, from henceforth and for ever.”

These are certainly most remarkable and impressive promises, and grow upon the mind the more we meditate upon them. The first question is, “Of whom speaketh the Prophet this?” And we may, doubtless, as confidently answer, “Of the Church which the apostles founded,” as St. Philip answered the Ethiopian’s question, by “preaching unto him Jesus.” But is not the prophecy fulfilled abundantly, if it so happen, as we maintain, that the Church then founded, whatever have been its errors and sins, has, up to this day, kept that deposit of necessary faith which was pronounced to be necessary at the time it was set up? That it is not fulfilled in its highest conceivable sense, even Dr. Wiseman must confess. He must confess that heresy and schism have been infringements of the letter of the prophecy; being spots and wrinkles in the Church during the time of their growth, and an enfeebling of her when they were cast out. As, then, he considers it as fulfilled by there being one place (Rome) where perfect purity of *all* doctrine ever has been, so we surely may account its fulfilment to lie in there having been ever in *all* places, perfect maintenance of *fundamental* doctrine. And, while we do dispute his fulfilment, he cannot dispute ours; for he cannot deny, that in matters of faith the whole Church descended from the Apostles now holds fundamental what the early ages held to be so; he will only claim to his Church, which he identifies with the true one, the power of *adding* to the fundamentals. The same remarks apply to the other passages quoted by Dr. Wiseman, such as Matt. xxviii. 19, 20.

But to return. If we have correctly drawn out the Anglican doctrine, it is as distinct from Romanism as from common Protestantism. The Romanist gives to the existing *Church* the ultimate infallible decision in matters of saving faith; the Ultra-Protestant to the *individual*; and the Anglican to *antiquity*, giving authority to the Church, as being the witness and voice, or rather the very presence of Antiquity among us. And here we arrive at another misunderstanding of our doctrine, into which it has already been implied Dr. Wiseman has fallen. We are indeed surprised that so well-read a man should not have recollected more of the divinity of our standard authors, than to assert that the fundamental principle of Protestantism, as *recognized in the English Church* (for he speaks of us Anglicans all along) is, that “the Word of God alone is the true standard and rule of faith.” Now let us be understood here; we know full well that this is a popular mode of speaking at this day; we know well it is an opinion in our Church; but it is by no means an opinion universally received, much less a principle. And Dr. Wiseman as a *well read* divine ought to recollect this. Let

it be observed, that he interprets the above principle to mean that “each one must have studied the Word of God, and *must have drawn from it* the faith which he holds.”—pp. 8, 9. Now can this be truly, nay fairly said, we will not say, by a well read divine, but by an intelligent observer of the English Church for the last twenty years? Is Dr. Wiseman a stranger to the continual and violent charges brought against far the larger portion of the Church, of its making the Prayer Book “a safeguard” to the Bible? Has not the body of the Church opposed the Bible Society on this ground? Nay, to go higher, do we not read in our service, the Athanasian Creed, which, whether it allows private judgment or not, clearly propounds that unless private judgment terminate in the reception of certain most definite statements of doctrine, it incurs the Church’s direct and absolute anathema? Considering the assaults conducted by individuals on this Creed; considering the continued struggle against what is sometimes called the High Church party, for a series of years past, on the ground of its enforcing one certain interpretation of the Word of God, under what impression, or in what state of mind, does Dr. Wiseman take for granted that the English Church consigns the Bible to each individual, and bids him draw his faith thence; confessing, as he does, at the same time, there is nothing in the Articles to countenance such a proceeding? That many individuals in the Church do so, is true; but with what show of reason does he fasten it on us as the “essential ground?”

But he will appeal, perhaps, in his defence, to a phrase in use among us, viz. that the Bible is “the rule of faith;” a phrase most correct in one sense, most untrue in another. By “Rule” may be meant either *Standard*, as Dr. Wiseman correctly explains it in one place, or *Guide*. Now the Bible is not our only guide or teacher; it *is* our only standard, test, or depository of faith. Now the Romanists deny that the Bible is a rule *in either sense*; when the Anglicans say that the Bible *is* the rule of faith, they say it in opposition to the Romanists; and since the Romanists deny it in any sense, they do not think it worth while to stop and define, and make irrelevant distinctions. But when the Ultra-Protestant comes upon them, and catches up and perverts their words, and says, “You admit the Bible is a rule of faith; therefore it is our sole *guide*,” we answer, as our Church has ever answered, “No; it is our sole document, basis of proof, record, standard of appeal, touchstone of the faith, not the sole guide, for the Church is a guide, having ‘authority in matters of faith.’” Dr. Wiseman has looked at the English Church not even superficially.

For ourselves, we confess, we are willing to dispense with the phrase “Rule of Faith,” as applied to Scripture, on the ground of its being ambiguous; and, again, because it is then used in a novel sense, for the ancient Church made the Apostolic Tradition, as summed up in the Creed, and not the Bible, the “Regula Fidei” or Rule. Moreover, its use as a technical phrase seems to be of late introduction in the Church, that is, since the days of King William the Third. Our great divines use it without any fixed sense, sometimes for Scripture, sometimes for the whole and perfectly adjusted Christian doctrine, sometimes for the Creed; and, at the risk of being tedious, we will prove this by quotations, that the point may be put beyond dispute.

Ussher, after St. Austin, identifies it with the Creed;—when speaking of the Article of our Lord’s descent to Hell, he says,

“It having here likewise been further manifested, what different opinions have been entertained by the ancient Doctors of the Church, concerning the determinate place wherein our Saviour’s soul did remain during the time of the separation of It from the body, I leave it to be considered by the learned, whether any such controverted matter may fitly be brought in to *expound the Rule of Faith*, which, being common both to the great and the small ones of the Church, must contain such varieties only as are generally agreed upon by the common consent of all true Christians.”—*Answer*

to a Jesuit, p. 362.

Taylor speaks to the same purpose: "Let us see a little further, with what constancy, that and the following ages of the Church did adhere to the Apostles' Creed, as the sufficient and perfect *Rule of Faith*."—*Dissuasive*, part 2, i, 4, p. 470. Elsewhere, he calls Scripture the Rule: "That the Scripture is a full and sufficient *Rule* to Christians in faith and manners, a full and perfect declaration of the will of God, is therefore certain, because we have no other."—*Ibid.* part 2, i, 2, p. 384. Elsewhere, Scripture and the Creed: "He hath by His wise providence preserved, the plain places of Scripture and the Apostles' Creed, in all Churches to be the *Rule* and Measure of Faith, by which all Churches are saved."—*Ibid.* part 2, i, 1, p. 346. Elsewhere he identifies it with Scripture, the Creeds, and the first four Councils: "We also" [after Scripture] "do believe the Apostles' Creed, the Nicene, with the additions of Constantinople, and that which is commonly called the symbol of St. Athanasius; and the four first General Councils are so entirely admitted by us, that they, together with the plain words of Scripture, are made the *Rule* and measure of judging heresies among us."—*Ibid.* part 1, i, 1, p. 131.

Laud calls the Creed, or rather the Creed with Scripture, the Rule. "Since the Fathers make the Creed the *Rule of Faith*, since the agreeing sense of Scripture with those Articles are the *Two Regular Precepts*, by which a Divine is governed about his faith," &c.—*Conference with Fisher*, p. 42.

Bramhall also: "The Scriptures and the Creed are not two different Rules of Faith, but *one and the same Rule, dilated in Scripture, contracted in the Creed*."—*Works*, p. 402. Stillingfleet says the same—(*Grounds*, i, 4, .3.) As does Thorndike.—(*De Rat. fin. Controv.* p. 144, &c.) Elsewhere, Stillingfleet calls Scripture the Rule, (*ibid.* i, 6, 2,) as does Jackson (vol. i, p. 226.) But the most complete and decisive statement on the subject, is contained in Field's work on the Church; from which we are tempted to make a long extract.

"It remained to show," he says, "what is the Rule of that judgment, whereby the Church discerneth between truth and falsehood, the faith and heresy, and to whom it properly pertaineth to interpret those things which touching this Rule are doubtful . . . The Rule of our Faith in general, whereby we know it to be true, is the Infinite excellency of God . . . It being pre-supposed in the generality that the doctrine of the Christian faith is of God, and containeth nothing but heavenly truth, in the next place, we are to inquire by what Rule we are to judge of particular things contained within the compass of it.

"This Rule is, 1. The summary comprehension of such principal Articles of this divine knowledge, as are the principles whence all other things are concluded and inferred. These are, contained in the *Creed of the Apostles*.

"2. All such things as every Christian is bound expressly to believe, by the light and direction whereof he judgeth of other things, which are not absolutely necessary so particularly to be known. These are rightly said to be the Rule of our Faith, because the principles of every science are the Rule whereby we judge of the truth of all things, as being better and more generally known, than any other thing, and the cause of knowing them.

"3. The Analogy, due proportion, and correspondence, that one thing in this divine knowledge hath with another, so that men cannot err in one of them without erring in another; nor rightly understand one, but they must likewise rightly conceive the rest.

"4. Whatsoever *Books* were delivered unto us, as written by them, to whom the first and immediate revelation of the divine truth was made.

"5. Whatsoever hath been delivered by all the saints with one consent, which have left their judgment and opinion in writing.

"6. Whatsoever the most famous have constantly and uniformly delivered, as a matter of faith, no more contradicting, though many other ecclesiastical writers be silent, and say nothing of it.

"7. That which the most, and most famous in every age, constantly delivered as matter of faith, and as received of them that went before them, in such sort that the contradictors and gainsayers were in their beginnings noted for singularity, novelty, and division, and afterwards in process of time, if they persisted in such contradiction, charged with heresy.

"These three latter Rules of our faith we admit, not because they are equal with the former, and originally in themselves contain the direction of our faith, but because nothing can be delivered, with such and so full consent of the people of God, as in them is expressed, but it must need be from those first authors and founders of our Christian professions. The Romanists add unto these, the decrees of Councils and determinations of Popes, making these also to be the Rules of Faith; but because we have no proof of *their* infallibility, we number them not with the rest.

"Thus we see, how many things in several degrees and sorts are said to be Rules of our Faith. The infinite excellency of God, as that whereby the truth of the heavenly doctrine is proved. The Articles of Faith, and other verities ever expressly known in the Church, as the first principles, are the Canon by which we judge of conclusions from thence inferred. The Scripture, as containing in it all that doctrine of faith, which Christ the Son of God delivered. The uniform practice and consenting judgment of them that went before us, as a certain and undoubted explication of the things contained in the Scripture . . . So then *we do not make Scripture the Rule of our faith, but that other things in their kind are rules likewise; in such sort that it is not safe, without respect had unto them, to judge things by the Scripture alone.*" &c.—iv. 14, pp. 364, 365.

These extracts show not only what the Anglican doctrine is, but, in particular, that the phrase "Rule of Faith" is no symbol with us, appropriated to some one sense; certainly not, as a definition or attribute of Holy Scripture. And it is important to insist upon this, from the very great misconceptions to which the phrase gives rise. Perhaps its use had better be avoided altogether. In the sense in which it is commonly understood at this day, Scripture, it is plain, is not, on Anglican principles, the Rule of Faith.

Returning to Dr. Wiseman, we must express our regret, that he should, in a popular lecture delivered to numbers who would have no means of being set right, display so very little knowledge of our real principles. It is no vindication of such neglect, that some Protestant preachers do the same; because he himself complains of them; and implies he is going to set them an example, and because his reputation for learning loads him with an additional responsibility. When our use of the Athanasian Creed implies that we do not think a man may choose his own doctrine from Scripture at his pleasure,—when our Articles expressly declare that the Church has authority in faith, when our great Doctors, in the clearest and strongest terms refer to the Ancient Church as an unerring guide in necessary matters, and when our existing government has for the last 20 or 30 years incurred an especial weight of odium for resisting the alleged right of private interpretation, it is really a little hard that we should be gravely accused of teaching that "each one must have drawn from the word of God the faith which he holds." And what makes Dr. Wiseman's conduct still less comprehensible, is that he does refer to the Articles, does acknowledge the plain sense of them as investing the Church with authority, and then, from a notion of the "complexity and confusion" (p. 29) of the view resulting, takes the Rule "on the terms *on which it is commonly understood*, namely, that it is the prerogative, the unalienable privilege of every Christian, to establish for himself the truth of his doctrines from that Book which God has revealed to man." p. 31. Now really, unless it were a serious subject, one could not help smiling at so very simple a sleight of hand, as this

sentence exhibits. Dr. Wiseman states the Ultra-Protestant doctrine about the "Rule of Faith." He says, "let us look into the 39 Articles for it." He finds there neither the *name* nor the *thing*. Then he says, "this is so obscure, I despair making anything of it; *therefore* let us take the popular Ultra-Protestant sense of the doctrine." Well add good; let him do so, if he will, *provided* he no longer includes the English Church, as a Church, in his subsequent discussions. The Article is not a dead letter to us, though it be to him; we see in it, what he himself allows, a something discriminating us off from the mass of Protestants. Yet he no-where says this; he no-where gives his reader any caution that he is forthwith not speaking of the English Church; no one would suppose, from any thing he goes on to say, that the Church existing in this country, the State Religion, the religion of the mass of the population, was really clear of a tenet which he is imputing to this whole country. Let him but except the English Church, and he may, for us, declaim against Protestantism as he will.

But Dr. Wiseman will say in his defence, that he has appealed to standard writers of our Church, particularly to Bishop Beveridge, in proof of our holding the Ultra-Protestant view. Now this circumstance, it is much to be feared, increases our reasons for dissatisfaction with him. He says our Articles are perplexed; under such circumstances, the plain way certainly would be to go to our principal writers for their explanation. Does he do so? No. He has indeed "carefully perused" Mr. Hartwell's Horne's chapter on the subject of the Rule of Faith; but we hear not a word of the mighty dead. But surely Beveridge is a standard writer? he is so, but we ask a little patient attention. In the first place, Dr. Wiseman acknowledges that Bishop Beveridge speaks a language *contrary* to the Article; how then is it fair to take him as a guide to explain its consistency and applicability? But in truth he does not in any sense refer to him as a commentator on the Article, but as a substitute for the Article, as the patron of an opposite view; he does not in any degree attempt to ascertain the drift and scope of the Article; but he puts it aside. Now there is much complaint, on the part of Roman writers, of our injustice in interpreting the Tridentine Decrees by the sentiments of Roman divines. When we have done so, it has been promptly replied, that the doctrines adduced were but the opinions of individuals, opinions of the schools, and the like. Yet Protestants who have so acted (and most justifiably, as we would maintain, but that is another matter) have at least not referred to Roman divines who opposed the Decrees of Trent; but Dr. Wiseman, not content with going to private doctors, and in so doing, taking the very course which his friends do to this day condemn in us, selects a passage from one of our divines which actually runs counter to the authorized decision of our church. Such is his conduct towards the Church itself; towards the learned and pious Beveridge, who is truly in every sense of the word, one of the Lights of our Church, his conduct is not less inconsiderate. Suffice it to say, that the passage he quotes from Beveridge, in illustration of the Ultra-Protestant theory, does not even tend to prove that the writer thought he was bound to gather his *creed* from Scripture for himself, and even if it did, it is found in a volume, most interesting indeed and deservedly popular, but which, being written for the private purpose of settling his own principles and conduct when he was but 23 years old, and published not till after his death, can in no sense be taken as an authority in a controversial subject.

That Bishop Beveridge in his riper years, and his own publications, gave no countenance to private judgment when directed against the testimony of the Church Catholic, is abundantly manifest to those who are ever so little acquainted with him. But since persons often will not believe, unless they see, we refer Dr. Wiseman, as one out of many places which are in point, to his 6th sermon, which runs as follows:—

"The Eternal Son of God, having with His own blood purchased to himself an Universal Church,

we cannot doubt but that he takes due care of it, that, according to his promise, 'the gates of hell shall never prevail against it.' For which end, He, the head of this mystical body, doth not only defend and protect it by His Almighty power, but He so acts, guides, directs, and governs it by His Holy spirit, that though errors and heresies may sometimes disease and trouble some parts of it, yet they can never infect the whole; but that is still kept sound and entire, notwithstanding all the power and malice of men or devils against it. So that, if we consider the Universal Church or congregation of faithful men," [vide Article 19,] "as in all ages dispersed over the whole world, we may easily conclude, that the greatest part, from which the whole must be denominated, was always in the right; which the Ancient Fathers were so fully persuaded of, that, although the word [*katholikos*] properly signifies universal, yet they commonly used It in the same sense as we do the word *orthodox*, as opposed to an heretic, calling an orthodox man a Catholic, that, is, a son of the Catholic Church; as taking it for granted, that they, and only they, which constantly adhere to the doctrine of the Catholic or Universal Church, are truly orthodox; which they could not do, unless they had believed the Catholic Church to be so. And, besides that, it is part of our very Creed, that the Catholic Church is holy; which she could not be, except free from heresy, as directly opposed to true holiness. *He therefore that would be sure not to fall into damnable errors, must be sure also to continue firm and stedfast to the doctrine of the Universal Church, as being grounded upon the Scriptures rightly understood*; for so every thing is, that she hath taught us. For the Catholic Church never undertook, as the Romish hath done, to coin any new doctrines of her own head: no, she always took the Scriptures for the only *standard* of truth, and hath accordingly delivered *her sense* of them in such worth as she judged to agree exactly with those which are there used."

And presently, he continues,

"Be sure, no sober man but must acknowledge, it is more possible for himself, yea, and for any particular Church to err, than it is for the Universal Church to do so; and, therefore, it must be the safest way to use Scripture words in such a sense as the Universal Church hath always put upon them, &c."

Certainly Beveridge does give the Church "authority in controversies of faith," as fully as Laud or Hammond.

Even this is not the limit of Dr. Wiseman's misconception. He is acquainted with Leslie's works, and speaks of him as "an eminent divine of the Protestant [*i.e.* English] Church, and one who has written the most strongly, perhaps, in favour of its grounds of faith," p. 298. He says this in the recapitulation of his argument, showing that in his discussions upon the Rule of Faith, he has all along had the English Church in view, as his principal antagonist. Indeed in this passage he speaks of the "respective opinions of the two Churches," and quotes Leslie in confirmation of his own description of the nature of the controversy existing between them. He quotes Leslie, as observing that "the whole of modern religion may be said to differ essentially on *this one point*, what is the ground-work whereon faith is to be built." It is evident then, that Dr. Wiseman believes that Leslie, not being a Romanist, took that Ultra-Protestant alternative which he himself has been employed in combating. But after all such is not Leslie's view; on the contrary, the following passage is enough to show that he agrees with Bramhall, Field, Hammond, and the rest above quoted.

"There is a Tradition," he says in his *Case between the Churches of Rome and England*, "which (for the evidence of it) we are willing to admit; that is, according to the Rule of Vincentius Lirinensis 'Quod semper, quod ubique, et ab omnibus.' ... And we are willing to join issue with you upon this Tradition as to Purgatory. This is *universal* Tradition; and you would not desire we should be concluded by any particular Tradition of this or that Church or place; for you know there are many

deceits in such.”—Vol. iii. P. 156.

We have not pursued Dr. Wiseman’s misconception about the English Church to its end. As if he felt it a strong measure to reject our authorized Article, and to adopt instead of the *consensus doctorum*, the unpublished opinion of a young man of twenty-three, just entering into orders, he brings, *ex abundanti cautelâ*, two additional testimonies, to wit, a couple of Dissenters, “the Rev. Jeremiah Jones, a celebrated nonconformist divine, at the end of the last century,” (p. 33); and “another and still more celebrated divine of nearly the same period, the celebrated Richard Baxter.” (p. 35.) In explanation, as it would seem, of this extraordinary selection, he adds, that the works of the former were “published at Oxford in 1827;” and that “the last of these divines was”—what we did not know before—“one of the most zealous upholders of the Established Church.” *Valeant quantum*. It is a second, perhaps a heavier injustice, to Bishop Beveridge to put him in such company.

One more observation must be made on Dr. Wiseman’s argument. Besides the above-mentioned authors, he does quote one other writer, of the English Church—“a very modern one, and which in the Church of England should be considered essentially orthodox.” Then follow some quotations from Mr. Newman’s work on the Arians, which he represents as spoken well of “by many who are considered very accurate in their acquaintance with the doctrines of that Church.”⁴ He quotes from this work some passages which speak of the authority existing, and acknowledged as existing, in the Primitive Church Catholic, considered as the teacher of Gospel truth. Now let the *purpose* with which he quotes them be carefully observed. Here is an Anglican writer who *both* avows his own belief in Church authority, and witnesses to its actual existence in the early Church. But Dr. Wiseman quotes him only in evidence of the latter fact, not in any sense as an indication (as far as an individual can be) of the *doctrine* of his Church. It seems, then, Jeremiah Jones’s conclusions are to be substituted for our real ones; and then our own premises made to tell against ourselves. We differ from Dr. Wiseman in logic as much as in divinity.

However, in consideration of the uses which he may supply in our warfare with Separatism, and similar evils of the day, we are almost willing to forgive Dr. Wiseman the above combined offences. He cannot lastingly obscure the character and genius of the English Church, though his mistakes about it may mislead others for a time. He cannot long be ignorant himself; he will shortly grow impatient of such authorities as “the celebrated Richard Baxter,” or Mr. Hartwell Horne, or Mr. Tottenham, or the Jubilators of 1835, and crave after the more solid food supplied by Bramhall and Laud, Field and Hammond, Bull and Beveridge: or, at least, if such folios are not to be found in Rome, he can take with him thither Bishop Jebb’s pocket volume of “Pastoral Instructions,” which will give him in a few pages abundant authorities for the views which have been above maintained; and when he arrives at a truer view of the English Church, he will cease to apply to it what does not really apply, and will direct his arms against our Dissenters, who are his legitimate victims, and whom we surrender to him to plague and persecute in Moorfields, Lincoln’s-Inn-Fields, and any other field but Smithfield.

As a specimen of his powers that way, we will present our readers with several passages from his Lectures. He argues, from the structure of the Bible, and the circumstances under which it comes to us, that it was not intended to be the instrument of teaching individuals the Christian doctrine. It is common for Ultra-Protestants to argue, on the other hand, that a written record must be the sole instrument of revealed teaching, *because* oral tradition is in its nature vague and uncertain. We,

⁴Dr. Wiseman is mistaken in saying that it came out under Dr. Burton’s sanction.

however, follow Bishop Butler, in considering that none of us antecedently knows any thing, or can determine any thing, about what is likely or unlikely as to God's way and degree of communicating to mankind supernatural truths; that Providence often gives us a little knowledge and obscure notices; and that the very least is more than man has a right to ask. The following argument of Dr. Wiseman also, in part, offends against Butler's principle, and so far can only be looked upon as a good *argumentum ad hominem*; but with a slight alteration it may be made to escape this defect, and rise to a higher level:—

“We are to suppose that God gave his Holy Word to be the only rule of faith to all men. It must be a rule, therefore, easy to be procured, and to be held. God himself must have made the necessary provision, that all men should have it, and be able to apply it. What, then, does he do? He gives us a large volume written in two languages, the chief portion in one known to a small and limited country of the world. He allows that speech to become a dead language, so that countless difficulties and obscurities should spring up regarding the meaning of innumerable passages. The other portion he gives in a language spoken by a large body of mankind, but still by a very small proportion, considering the extent of those to whom the blessings of Christianity were intended to be communicated; and he gives this book as a satisfactory and sufficient rule.

“1. In the first place, then, he expects it to be translated into every language, that all men may have access to it. In the second place, it must be so distributed, that all men may have possession of it; and, in the third place, it must be so easy that all men may use it. Are these the characteristics of this rule? Suppose it to be the only rule of all who believe in Christ, are you aware of the difficulty of undertaking a translation of it? Whenever the attempt has been made, in modern times, in the first instance it has generally failed; and even after many repeated attempts, it has proved unsatisfactory. Had I time, or were it necessary, I could show you, from various Reports of the Bible Society, and from the acknowledgment of its members, that many versions, after having been diffused among the natives of countries to be converted, have been necessarily withdrawn, on account of the absurdities, impieties, and innumerable errors which they contained. And this is the rule that has been put into the hands of men! But look to the history of even more celebrated translations, such as are put forth by authority. I speak not of those early versions which were made when the knowledge of the facts and circumstances was fresh, and when those who wrote better understood the language. But look at any modern version, such as that authorized in these realms. Read the account of how often it was corrected, what combinations of able and learned men it required to bring it to a tolerable degree of perfection. Then its worth, as a rule, must depend upon the skill and fitness of individuals for the task of translating; and we cannot suppose that the providence of God would stake the whole usefulness and value of his rule upon the private or particular abilities of man. And this is the first difficulty to its being considered the ordinary rule appointed of God.

“2. Secondly, what are the difficulties attending its diffusion. Oh, my brethren! could we look at this consideration in another age front the present, you might better understand them. You fancy, possibly, that because Bibles are now multiplied by thousands, and by millions, their application as a rule is obvious and easy; that because there is one nation on the globe possessed of immense wealth and mighty empire, and have ships that frequent the farthest bounds of earth; that because there are men willing to devote their time, and wealth, and zeal, to the publication and diffusion of these books; that because, in this country, and at the present time, a combination of political, commercial, and literary circumstances facilitate this distribution, therefore the rule is sufficiently accessible to all mankind. But God does not plan the rule of his faith in accordance with the possible

literary or commercial prosperity of any country; nor so construct the groundwork of his truth as to depend upon the mechanical inventions of man. The Gospel's being the rule of faith can have no connexion with the circumstance, that the press, by the aid of the strongest mechanical power applied to it, has now produced the Bible in measureless abundance. God could not mean that, for 1,400 years, man was to be without a guide, and that mankind should have to wait until human genius had given efficacy to it by its discoveries and inventions. Such cannot be the qualities or conditions of the rule. We must look for it as one for all times, and for all places; as something coming into operation as soon as delivered, and destined to last until the end of time. We cannot, therefore, admit, as the only necessary rule of faith, that which depends for its adoption on the accidental instrumentality of man, and requires essentially his unprescribed co-operation.

"For I think, that, on reflection, any unprejudiced mind will rather wonder how, in the Word of God, there should have been no provision made for this important condition. Why do we never find any precept given to the Apostles to disseminate the Scriptures, after having them translated into all languages? How comes it that no intimation is ever given therein of the duty of ministers to provide copies of the sacred volume for those whom they are bound to instruct? If this dissemination of the written word was and is an essential part of Christianity, and if in Scripture alone is to be found the rule and criterion of all that is essential, how comes this important provision to be there omitted? Nay, as our acquaintance with history proves to us the utter impossibility of the Bible's being extensively circulated without the aid of the press, why was not its invention provided for, as the necessary instrument for arriving at the rule and groundwork of faith? Surely the Bible Society is no part of the economy and machinery of Christianity, and yet, without it, the Scriptures could not have been diffused to the extent which we have witnessed in modern times."—vol. i. p. 44-46.

The following remarks on the words in the Apostolic Commission, (Matth. xxviii. 20,) "Lo, I am with you always," &c., seem to us truly important and valuable. It will be observed they are used by Dr. Wiseman to prove the absolute *infallibility* of the Church, i.e. in communion with Rome; they seem, however, quite as clearly and fully satisfied by what we see at this day—the indefectibility of the *whole* Church, whether united to Rome or not, in fundamentals. The passage, however, is very striking, and much to the purpose when directed against Ultra-Protestants.

"On examining the practice of Scripture we find, that whenever God gives a commission of peculiar difficulty, and one which to those that receive it appears almost, or indeed entirely, beyond the power of man, the way in which he assures them that it can and will be fulfilled, is by adding to the end of the commission, '*I will be with you.*' As if he should thereby say, 'the success of your commission is quite secure, because I will give my special assistance for its perfect fulfilment.' A few passages will make this position quite clear.

"In the 40th chapter of Genesis, 3d and 4th verses, God says to Jacob, 'I am God, the God of thy father; fear not to go down into Egypt, for I will make thee a great people. *I will go down with thee* into Egypt.' That is, I will accompany thee, I will be with thee, and therefore fear not. This assurance is added as a special guarantee for the truth of the promise, that the descendants of Jacob should be a great people. They were to become, by fulfilling the command given them; subjects of another state: their chances of becoming a mighty nation seemed greatly lessened; yet God pledged his word that he would so protect them that the promise should be fulfilled, and this he does by adding the assurance, 'I will go down with thee.' But this is still clearer in the book of Exodus, where the Almighty commands Moses to go unto Pharaoh and liberate his people. He execute this commission! who had been obliged to flee from Egypt under a capital imputation—who was now

not only devoid of interest at court, but, was identified with that very proscribed and persecuted race, whose extermination Pharaoh had vowed—who, should he come forward, could only ensure his own destruction, and the more certain frustration of the hopes which God had given to his captive people! How then does God assure him, that in spite of all these apparent impossibilities he shall be successful? 'And Moses said unto God, Who am I that I should go to Pharaoh, and that I should bring forth the children of Israel out of Egypt? And he said unto him, *I will be with thee.*' The fulfilment is secure, no other assurance is given; Moses has the strongest guarantee that God can propose to him that he will be successful. Again, when Jeremiah is sent to preach to his people, and considers himself unfit for the commission, God promises him success in the same terms, and with the very introductory phrase used in the commission given to the Apostles, 'and behold!' and with no other less extraordinary coincidences. In the first chapter of that Prophet (verses 17-19) we thus read, 'gird up thy loins, and arise and *speak unto them all that I command thee; and behold!* I have made thee this day a walled city ... And they shall fight against thee, but they shall not prevail, *for I am with thee*, saith the Lord. Here is a command given precisely such as we have seen delivered to the Apostles, to tell the people *all that God had commanded*; and to it is appended the very same form of assurance as is addressed to them.

"Thus, therefore, we have a clear axiom deduced from the simple examination of similar forms in other parts of Scripture, that whenever a commission is given by God to accomplish what appears impossible by human means, he guarantees its complete success and perfect execution by adding the words 'I am with thee.' And thus we have a right to conclude, that in the text under examination Christ, by the same words, promised to his Apostles and to those who should succeed them till the end of the world, such a similar scheme of especial providence as shall be necessary and sufficient to secure the full accomplishment of the commission therewith to them given. We have consequently only to see what the commission is, and the case is closed. 'Go teach all nations;' that is one part of the commission to teach all the nations of the world. And what are the things to be taught? '*To observe all things whatsoever I have commanded you!*' Therefore we have the guarantee of Christ that he will aid his church with a special and efficacious providence, *to teach all things* that he has commanded to all nations, and till the end of time.

"I ask you, is not this a commission exactly comprising all that I said we might expect to find? Does it not institute a body of men to whom Christ has given security that they shall be faithful depositories of his truths? Does it not constitute the kingdom whereunto all nations should come? Does it not establish therein his own permanent teaching in lieu of prophecy, so as to prevent all error from entering into the church? and is not this church to last till the end of time? Now this is precisely all that the Catholic Church teaches, all that she claims and holds as the basis and foundation whereupon to build her rule of faith. The successors of the Apostles in the church of Christ have received the security of his own words and his promise of 'a perpetual teaching,' so that they shall not be allowed to fall into error. It is this promise which assures her she is the depository of all truth, and is gifted with an exemption from all liability to err, and has authority to claim from all men, and from all nations, submission to her guidance and instruction."—pp. 107-109.

We do not see cause for disagreeing with Dr. Wiseman, till we come to the *application* of the above statement. He considers all the tenets of the Church of Rome as part of the "all things whatsoever;" we think that those in which it differs from the Church Apostolic and Catholic are not so. He would say the doctrine of Purgatory was part; we say it is a human addition. He says it is divine, because the Roman Church holds it; we say it is not, because the Church Catholic does

not. But this is altogether a subsequent question. The doctrine which the above extract illustrates is very solemn, and Dr. Wiseman writes with a good deal of feeling and eloquence.

We shall but direct attention to Dr. Wiseman's remarks on the different success which has attended the preaching of Catholics and Ultra-Protestants, and then bring this review to an end. *Audi alteram partem* is a necessary rule; so we must wait to hear what the party assailed will say against him, before we form a judgment, especially since the above examination of Dr. Wiseman's treatment of the Anglican doctrine does not inspire us with any great confidence in the completeness or evenness of any inquiry of his in which the interests of his own Church are concerned. All that can be said is, that he professes to cite Protestant witnesses in his review of the Protestant Missions; whereas his judgment of the English Church is formed from doctrines held by enemies or strangers to her.

He observes that the practical success of the Protestant (Ultra-Protestant) or Catholic (Roman) Rule of Faith (i.e. mode of teaching) in converting heathen nations, must necessarily be a test of the divinity of the one or the other, since success was promised to the true preaching of the Gospel, when it was said, "Lo, I am with you always." And he then proceeds to argue that Romanism has had most remarkable success in its missions in heathen countries, and that Ultra-Protestants, though attempting much more, have done little or nothing. Of recent missions from the latter party, he mentions the Baptist Missionary Society, instituted in 1792; the London, in 1795; the Scotch, in 1796; the Church, in 1800; and the Wesleyans and others since. Others also have been lately founded in America, Germany and France, and have exerted themselves with extraordinary zeal and diligence in their momentous object. The expenditure on the whole in the work of conversion was said, in 1824, to amount to £1000 a day, or £365,000 *per annum*. In addition to this charitable outlay, the Bible Society, in 1835, expended above £125,000; and in the course of the last thirty-one years above two millions sterling, in great measure for the same purposes; and has circulated, with other similar societies in Europe and America, above fifteen million copies of the Scriptures. "If the true way of working conversion," says Dr. Wiseman, "be the dispersion of the Written Word, surely an abundant harvest might by this time have been expected."—p. 168. By a subsequent statement he shows that the present yearly income of Missionary Societies is even £300,000 more than the foregoing calculations give, though probably in this account are included some Societies, as that for the Promotion of Christian Knowledge, which have really no place there. He then notices the government grants, though here again he includes the English Church in his survey; whereas its fortunes, whether prosperous or otherwise, do not come under a review of the proceedings of Societies which consider the Bible as the appointed means of conversion. Next he calculates the number of missionaries employed, and considers it to amount to 3000, exclusive of Americans and other foreigners, which he supposes to be three or four times the number employed by the Church of Rome. The allowance of these missionaries has sometimes been as high as £100 a year; in others, particularly in Asia, as high as £240, with £40 additional for every wife, and £20 more for every fresh child. Dr. Wiseman also speaks of the political advantages which Englishmen enjoy in India.

He then professes to go through the returns of conversion and reports of the progress of the Gospel in different countries, and sums up after the following manner: that in India, for instance, the utmost number of converts in a course of years is twelve in one place, four in another, and four in another, and so on; that among the Calmucks, the Moravians had been employed fifty-six years without making one convert; and that Mr. Bickersteth declared, in 1823, that in the course of the first ten years the Church Missionary Society never heard of a single individual who passed from Idolatry to Christianity. He then describes at length the manner and effect with which the Bible

Society acts in heathen Countries.

"You must not allow yourselves to be led away by those Reports which speak of the immense number of copies of the Bible and the New Testament distributed among the natives of heathen countries,—you must not suppose that this gives any evidence of conversion,—or that, because missionaries ask for innumerable quantities of Bibles, any thing like a proportionable number of conversions are made. For these Bibles are sent out in cargos, and accumulated in warehouses abroad, or distributed to persons who make no use of them at all, or make them serve any purpose, as you, will see by a few examples, which I will give you just now. General Hislop, for instance, in his 'History of the Campaign against the Mahrattas and Pindarris,' says, that 'these missionaries think that this distribution of the Gospels in Chinese, Sanscrit, &c., is sufficient to obtain their purpose; and as they send out these books to English agents and magistrates, in different places, so they reckon the number of their converts, and the success of their labours, in proportion to the copies distributed.' He says, that he knew several residences where no vessel ever arrived without a case or bale of Bibles for distribution. The residents send them in every direction, by hundreds at a time. The Chinese took at them, and say that they have more beautiful histories in their own literature, and have not the least idea whether they are intended for amusement or instruction, and, after having read them, throw them aside; so that the resident could not possibly distribute any more: but the ardent zeal of the Malacca missionary continued to supply them, by ship after ship, in such quantities that they were obliged to be placed in a warehouse! He adds, that 'this is the missionary who had written to the Bible Society that they might send him out a million of Bibles; and in this way it would have been easy to dispose of them.'

"I have also seen a letter, and will quote it, although it is from a Catholic authority, written a few years ago by the Vicar Apostolic of Siam, who relates precisely the same circumstance,—'That two English emissaries had arrived, and were distributing Bibles in every direction; the people used them to wrap up their merchandize in the shops; some of them, however, brought them to the Catholic clergy as of no use.' He then remarks, 'in this way reports are sent over, and the number of converts are reckoned by the number of Bibles distributed. I know that not a single conversion has been made by them.'

"In the French 'Asiatic Journal,' we are assured, on the authority of a letter from Macao, that copies of Dr. Morrison's Bible, which had been introduced into China, were afterwards sold by auction; and that the greater part of them were bought by manufacturers for different purposes, but principally by the makers of slippers, which they used to line with them! It is painful, and humiliating, and unbecoming the solemnity of this place, to mention such circumstances; but they are important towards undeceiving those who think that all these Bibles are put to a useful purpose, instead of this degrading and disrespectful use being made of the Word of God."—vol. p. 198-200.

Such are some of the exceptions which Dr. Wiseman takes to the Protestant missions. When he turns to the Roman Catholic, he is, perhaps, less to be trusted, it being easier to be candid towards an opponent whom we do not fear, than impartial in our own case. If we are to take his account as it stands, Romanism has a success among the heathen, inferior indeed, but similar to that which attended the preaching of the first propagators of the Gospel. Nor are we unwilling to allow, that it has so much of the blessing of the true Church with it, as to have a measure of success, which Ultra-Protestant efforts, however zealous and praiseworthy in themselves, will not experience. We will but cite the contrast he draws between the conduct of the Dutch Calvinists and Romanists in the Island of Ceylon, which, if it may be trusted, is a remarkable instance of this.

"I will enter into some details respecting a portion of the Indian Church, that in the island of

Ceylon, to show you how far this reasoning is correct; and I think it presents a case which will put the two ground-works of faith on a fair comparison. This island was first converted to Christianity in the following way:—The natives having heard of what was doing by St. Francis Xavier on the continent, sent a messenger, or rather an embassy, to him, requesting him to come among them. He replied that he could not go in person at that moment, as he could not abandon the mission at Travancore, but sent another missionary, who baptized many natives; after two years St. Francis landed there in person, and finished the work of conversion. Persecution soon arose; the king of Jaffnapatam put six hundred Christians to death in one year, and among them his own eldest son; so that this church may be said to have been watered by the blood of martyrs.

“In 1650 the Dutch became masters of the island, and instantly took two very important steps. The first was, as Dr. Davies tells us in his travels, to allow Wimaladarme, son of Raja Singhe, to send messengers to Siam for twelve Buddhist idolatrous priests of the highest order. These came to Candy, and ordained twelve natives to the same order, and many to the lower order; and thus they restored the religion of Buddha for the purpose of extirpating Catholicity from the island. In the second place they excluded the Catholic bishops and priests from the country, and forbade the natives to meet for religious purposes; they built Protestant churches in every parish throughout the island, and compelled every one to attend that worship; and they allowed no one to hold any post or office unless he subscribed the Protestant profession of faith.

“Here, then, we have a church established for less than a century, which yet had obtained a strong footing in the island. After this we have another religion introduced, and every thing done to counteract and destroy what had been effected in favour of the other by a double method; first, by giving those who were so inclined permission to return to their old superstitions, and affording these protection and means of propagation; and secondly, by proscription, and by endeavouring to substitute in its stead the Protestant religion. For 150 years, till it came into the possession of the English, the island of Ceylon remained in this state. During all this time the native Catholics had no spiritual succour but what they received from the Portuguese priests of the order of St. Philip Neri, who landed there from time to time at the risk of their lives, and administered the sacraments privately, going from house to house. We have an interesting account given by the missionary D. Pedro Cubero Sebastian, how during the time of this persecution he landed, and disguising his character applied to the governor Pavellon for leave to remain some time in the town of Colombo. Leave was given him, on condition that a guard of soldiers should constantly accompany him, as he was suspected. He contrived however to elude their vigilance, and having lulled the attention of his guards in the middle of the night, assembled the whole Christian community of the place, and administered to them the comforts of religion. The transaction was discovered, he was immediately sent for by the governor, and ordered instantly to quit the island. He did so, and landed on the other side, but found that in the meantime a courier had arrived over land to put the governor of that district, Hoblaut, on his guard. A still more severe guardianship was the result; but in the middle of the night he again assembled the Christians, and administered the sacraments.

“These attempts, however, were not always so successful; for we learn that while Father Joseph Vaz, a zealous Portuguese missionary of the order of Oratorians, was celebrating mass on Christmas night for a congregation of 200 persons, they were suddenly surprised by guards, who broke in the door and carried the entire congregation, men, women and children to prison. They were very cruelly treated, and next morning brought before the Dutch judge, Van Rheede, who dismissed the women and imposed fines on the men. Eight of these, however, were reserved to a severer doom, of whom one, a recent convert from Protestantism, was put to death with studied cruelty; the other

seven were condemned, after a severe scourging, to irons and hard labour for life.

“Such were the means resorted to to put down the church which had been established by St. Francis in that island; and this course was continued for 150 years, until the British took possession of it in 1795. Indeed the laws which proscribed the Catholic religion were not repealed till 1806, when Sir Alexander Johnston, to whom the Catholics of that part of the world owe more than they can repay, obtained equality for all religions, and consequently the free exercise of ours.

“And what do you think has been the consequence of this step? Hear how Dr. Buchanan speaks on the subject:—‘In the island of Ceylon, in which, by a calculation made in 1801, there were 342,000 Protestants—it is a well known fact that more than 50,000 have gone over to the Catholic religion from want of teachers in their own religion.’ So that within a few years after liberty was restored, more than 50,000 have returned to the faith originally planted there, and afterwards crushed by persecution. ‘The ancient Protestant churches,’ he farther observes, ‘some of which are spacious buildings, and which, in the province of Jaffnapatam alone, amount to thirty-two, are now occupied at will by the Catholic priests of the order of St. Philip Neri, who have taken quiet possession of the island. If a remedy be not speedily applied, we may calculate that, in a few years, the island of Ceylon will be in the same situation as Ireland, as to the proportion between Catholics and Protestants. I must further add, however painful the reflection may be, that the defection to idolatry, in many districts, is very rapid.’

“Here, then, are the results of an attempt to establish the Protestant religion, by building and endowing churches, and by doing precisely all that the Catholics did in the peninsula of India; and see what has been the event; that there were 340,000 Protestants in this neighbouring island, and the moment the pressure of the law is taken off, 50,000 returned to the Catholic faith, and a great many of the rest went back to their old idolatry!”—vol. i. p. 231-234.

If it be inquired why the English Church has done so little here and elsewhere in the way of missions to the heathen, an obvious reason may be assigned without reflecting either upon its principles or its members. There is zeal and charity in abundance within it, but political influences have prevented its using them. It is commonly understood that Archbishop Secker wished to impart the Succession to the American colonies, but was forbidden by the government of the day, although he asked for no civil privileges for the bishops he should send them, but merely such countenance as other forms of Christianity might enjoy. Ever since the State took on itself the care and disposal of the Church, it has been very jealous of its forming foreign relations, or advancing one step towards the realization of that Catholicity which is an essential element of the Christian spirit. It has shown a special unwillingness that the Church should learn (as it were) to walk alone, as if it would enforce as the very tenure of its establishment, that it should have no substantive existence except in the framework of the constitution. Zeal, therefore, was for a period a superfluous virtue in the Church; and having no legitimate outlet for its exercise, it turned to the injury of those sacred interests which it was intended to subserve. What was by nature missionary became schismatical. Wesley, instead of being the founder of a Church in America or China, as he might, perhaps, have been, dwindled into a separatist and heresiarch, and drew from the mother he loved some of her best and most generous blood. The civil power saw without concern events which weakened an ally, which was most useful to itself, except when it became too powerful. This answer ought to satisfy such as think fit to object to our Church, what has in fact been its misfortune; and if Romanists consider they see cause for triumph in it, as if we had thrown ourselves into the arms of the State, and were but suffering as all should suffer who take rash steps, we would refer them to the condition of their own Church from A.D. 1000 to 1080, and

remind them that one or two centuries are but a span in the history of an institution which has lasted almost two millenaries, and will outlive all other dynasties and polities, however powerful and however tyrannical in their day.

ART. V.—The Life of Augustus Hermann Franké, &c. Translated from the German of H. E. F. Guerike, by Samuel Jackson. With an introductory Preface, by the Rev. E Bickersteth. Seeley and Burnside.

[?] "Copy at B.O. has note: 'The last 2½ pages are Pusey's in substance. J.H.N.'"—Blehl.
[*British Critic*, vol. 21, July 1837.]

THE Pietists of Germany, to whom Mr. Bickersteth has directed our attention in this Memoir of Franké, one of their principal ornaments, rose out of the orthodox Lutheran School, and terminated in the Rationalists. Every history has its own moral, and every reader draws it in his own way. Mr. Bickersteth would view the Pietists in contrast with the orthodox Lutherans who preceded them; we perhaps are rather disposed to regard them in connection with the Rationalists who followed. He probably discerns in Franké and his associates, that English school of which he is a distinguished member; and here we may on the whole agree with him. But he would proceed to liken the Lutherans, over whom they triumphed, to what is commonly called the High-Church party in England; whereas we should discover in the present state of what are called Evangelical opinions, the more than incipient development of a double tendency, which was realized in the history of Pietism, at once towards that formalism out of which it started, and to the free-thinking system in which it ended. As time went on, Pietism either relapsed or went further; and its English parallel, following its career, is rapidly becoming in one of its portions technical, in another latitudinarian. Now, considering Mr. Bickersteth's publication says not a word about High Church or Low Church, we may be thought unfair and party-spirited thus to interpret it. It may be said that he is simply desirous of doing good, not of making a controversy. Doubtless he is; but then, if we may judge from his usual turn and tone of thought, his notion of religious excellence is such as not to admit of being explained and communicated except through the medium of such contrasts. His main notion of a religious man is of one who relies not on what is outward, but on what is inward; his notion of the Church's warfare with the world, is of a contest between self-righteous and barren orthodoxy, and spiritual faith. Under these circumstances he can but mean Franké's life to be a type of the history of every religious man in his contest with the world; and, inclusively, of every religious man in the English Church.

We have above shown our willingness to agree with Mr. Bickersteth in considering the Pietists of the same religious family with his own friends; yet though this may be granted in general terms, it is by no means true on an accurate comparison between the two schools. Spener and Franké were much more of Romanists than is Mr. Bickersteth. Spener re-published the work of Tauler, an eminent Roman Catholic Mystic; Franké, following his example, translated two of the works of Molinos, "a celebrated pious Spanish Mystic," as the work before us calls him, "who finished his days at Rome in the eighteenth century." As the circumstances of Franké's publication are instructive, we shall present them to the reader in the translator's words.

"In 1687, Franké was induced, by a disputation held in Leipzig, 'De Quietismo contra Molinosum,' in which the antagonist confessed that he had never read Molinos' writings, to translate two of the latter's works—'Guida Spirituale,' 'Manuductio Spiritualis,' and 'Della Comunione Cotidiana,' or 'De Communionem Quotidiana,' from the Italian into Latin. This step was taken amiss

of him, as if he thereby acknowledged himself an adherent of Molinos, and a friend to Catholicism. To this he replied, 'I have never sought to justify or maintain every thing contained in Molinos. But I have been much displeased that others should fall upon an author, and condemn him, without understanding him, or ever having read him, and attribute sentiments to him, which probably never occurred to him. On the contrary, I assert that there is much of what is edifying and useful in his writings, which I can never bring myself to reject or condemn. Truth must be esteemed everywhere, whether found amongst friends or foes. We ought to prove all things, and hold fast that which is good. Am I necessarily a heathen, when I say that many good things are to be found in Cicero's *De Officiis*? And why must I be vilified and made out to be a Catholic, because I find many useful observations in a Roman Catholic book?'"

But to return. It seems from what has been said, we are at issue with Mr. Bickersteth on a sufficient number of points, as regards the history of Pietism, more indeed than it is possible to treat in this article;—on what is life in religion, what is deadness, whether the Lutherans of the seventeenth century were like the so-called orthodox among ourselves, how far the Pietists are like the so-called Evangelical, how far German Pietism, how far English Pietism, how far in short what is called *vital* religion, tends on the one hand to *formal* religion, on the other hand to *freethinking* religion, as being a transition state, vacillating between one or other of two inevitable issues. Out of these ample topics, we shall set apart a very small field for discussion, still, as we hope, not an unprofitable one. We mean to say a few words on the character of the formal Lutheranism which preceded the Pietists, and to inquire whether there be not alarming signs among our English Pietists at the present moment of a tendency to a similar formalism.

The history of the rise of Pietism may be sketched as follows: Luther died A.D. 1545. His contemporaries, who had acted upon his idea of doctrine and preaching, such as Chemnitz, Bugenhagen and Brentius, were removed from this scene of trouble and error before the end of the same century. What Luther's own idea of Christianity was, we shall not attempt to delineate; the opinions of so great a mind are not lightly and cursorily to be handled. But without definitely ascertaining the views of this or that individual, the idea then floating and prevalent among the Lutherans seems to have been this, that it was a *life* in the heart, quickened by the Spirit, manifested in faith; that words were of use merely as instruments of implanting this life, that such especially was the office of the word of God, which was the divinely vouchsafed instrument of conveying this supernatural life to the inward man; moreover, that spiritual life, consisting in faith, the word of God was the means of spiritual life, as being the means of kindling faith and similar religious feelings, dispositions, and habits. From this, two conclusions might follow; first, that words, being the means of imparting religious ideas, were only of use so far as they did convey them, that they were dependent on and subservient to the ideas they communicated to the hearer; that they had their proper scope in their effect upon him, and might be fairly estimated by that effect. Words then were, from the nature of the case, of a variable and multiform nature, springing up, doing their work, dying, reproduced, according to the occasion; in a word, there could be no creed in Christianity, that is, no announcements such as to have their end in themselves, to stand on their own ground, to be contained in and depend upon the words conveying them, not on the intelligence of those who used them, as being from the first beyond the human mind, and being simply the words of God, with prototypes in heaven, and addressed essentially *to* faith, presupposing, not producing it. Next it might follow that sacraments also, not being addressed to the reason or intelligent mind, or calculated to produce faith, but being of the nature of rites, having little or no power to teach, convince or comfort,—were no part of Christianity; or at least belonged to it only

so far as they did teach, convince or comfort, so far as they did tend to produce or reassure faith, as signs, tokens, pledges, seals, not means of grace. These two conclusions however seem not to have been consistently drawn out by the school in question, which occupied an intermediate position; maintaining the supremacy of the Mental Life as the essence and end of all true religion, and the measure by which all other parts of Christianity were to be valued and adjusted, and again the power of the Divine Word, that is, of the intellectual meaning or spirit of Scripture, as the Holy Spirit's main instrument in the production of this Life; but not going on to deny the divine origin of dogmatic statements, for it admitted the Catholic Creeds; nor the true virtue of sacraments, for it maintained the benefit as well as the necessity of infant baptism. As naturally follows from what has been said, its characteristic doctrine was justification by faith only; which, while in the first instance it was the doctrinal symbol of a great truth, viz. the imperative necessity of an awakened mind, a tender conscience and a reasonable service, yet might be readily perverted to the denial of all real virtue in sacraments, all divine mysteries in creeds. Such an incomplete theory, it was plain, could not remain many years. A bold and original mind had insisted upon some great truths, which were at the time depreciated and neglected, in a way which tended to peril other great truths, which he recognized also, yet did not defend, nor secure from the force of his own arguments. He had taken the practical side of the Gospel, and thrown his mind into it, but left the doctrinal and ecclesiastical side standing, but not prominent. What was left to his successors, but either from the love of these latter truths to relinquish the principle by which he enforced the former, or to carry out his principle to their overthrow? to discard altogether or to acknowledge implicitly the supremacy of the letter and the ritual? Under these circumstances they fell into a line of conduct, which might be called ingenious, were it not so natural, as to be almost spontaneous in their case, and in which indeed the Reformers themselves had led the way. They retained the principle of dogmatism, but substituted the Lutheran doctrines for its subject-matter in the place whether of the Roman or the Catholic Creed. Instead of the Pope's supremacy as the centre doctrine of the church, another had been already assumed as its vital principle, justification by faith only. Unless men believed that they were justified on believing, they were not in a saving state. A great number of other points of faith was added; till in a short time a theology arose, as minute, as imperative, not as plausible, not as venerable as the Roman; a theology, appealing not to the unanimous voice of the Fathers, but to Luther, in a manner quite inconsistent with that great Reformer's own resistance to the Church in which he was born. Instead of following out Luther's principle, they left Babylon only to erect the old city on a new site. The formula *concordiæ* 1580, fixed the character of the Lutheran system, and, in fixing, formalized it. After an interval of about two generations the free principle of Luther's original movement awoke, especially about 1650-1660; but its champions were but as single voices in the desert, which found hearers here and there, but excited no general interest or opposition. At length, towards the end of the seventeenth century, it developed itself in the school of the Pietists, of which Spener and Franké, both eminently pious and practical men, are the chief luminaries. Here then matters were brought back pretty much to the same point in which they stood in Luther's time. Words and forms were pronounced to be subject to mind, that is, to the intelligent, reflective principle of the soul. Again the time came when his school must determine whether they would go forward or backward, whether they would carry out his principle of the sovereignty of reason and the heart in religious matters to its furthest limits, or whether they could modify without destroying it. And the event took place on the whole contrariwise to what had happened at the former crisis. Then the Lutheran Church relapsed into scholastic formality; now it dissolved itself in the licence of freethinking and scepticism. The school of Pietists indeed itself

drew back, and underwent the same transformation into rigid and narrow dogmatism, which had befallen the successors of Luther. But it was otherwise with the Church in which they had laboured. The spirit they had kindled in it did its work and proceeded onward to rationalism. What had happened in the preceding age at Geneva was now repeated; Calvin had become in his lifetime the involuntary parent of Socinianism and burned Servetus in disgust. Rationalism was in another country the posthumous offspring of a kindred spirit.

Now, if this outline be tolerably correct, we do not think Mr. Bickersteth would gain much, though the English school which he admires were ever so like the Pietists; and that he holds their resemblance, must be inferred from his editing in his "Christian's Family Library," on the one hand, the life of Franké, on the other, those of Mr. Scott, and Mr. Richmond. If, we repeat, the spirit of Pietism is the inchoate state either of formalism or of rationalism, in whatever degree it is revived in the Low Church School among us, (and that it is in many respects paralleled in them we by no means deny,) the piety of its adherents, whatever it is, is no set-off against its tendencies. That it tends to rationalism is not here to be discussed. It is far too large a field to be traversed within the limits which we propose to ourselves. Besides, persons entitled to all deference have differed in their views on the subject. Mr. Rose imputes the rationalism of Germany to the ill-directed movement of the intellect in that country, to foreign infidelity, and the total want of guiding principles of church government. Dr. Pusey attributes it mainly to a the antecedent stiff orthodoxy, and to the natural tendency to decay inherent in any system of man's device and distinct from the Catholic faith, such as was Lutheran theology in its developed form. Leaving this part of the subject, let us turn to the picture which history presents of that developed Lutheranism, and see whether its lineaments are not discernible in the English school, which thinks its freedom from formalism and its protest against formalism in the High Church divinity one of its especially strong points.

The German author whom Mr. Bickersteth recommends to our notice, speaks as follows in the translation, or rather abridgment, which his editor has sanctioned.

"The light of the Reformation had not long dawned upon Germany, before it became obscured by the pernicious controversies which were carried on in the bosom of the Lutheran Church; so that towards the end of the sixteenth and beginning of the seventeenth centuries, a formal and lifeless orthodoxy, and a mere historical belief, took place of the true and living faith, which the reformation had diffused. People contented themselves with a strict but merely outward adherence to the established articles of belief, instead of regarding with Luther, the practical application of the simple doctrines of the Gospel as the chief and primary object."—pp. 1, 2.

Now, so far, this description may plausibly be made apply to the history of our own Church in the 17th and 18th centuries—plausibly, but not truly. For though no one who knows the writings of our great divines will tolerate even for a moment the attempt to fix on them the charge of formalism here imputed to the Lutherans, yet the many have not looked into them; those who have, sometimes only turn over the pages, and, not understanding them, call them scholastic and technical in self-defence,—look for what they consider eloquence, and find nothing popular or attractive—look to be informed without their own exertion, and find them methodical, deliberate, and accurate. It is plausible then to speak of Laud, Hammond, Bull, and Butler, as formal and lifeless; nor would Hooker escape if he had only written his work on Ecclesiastical Polity. So far, then, they may be conveniently compared to the Lutherans of the seventeenth century; but as our author's description proceeds, general as it necessarily is, some differences begin to show themselves.

“The smallest deviation in doctrinal points from the creed of the church was punished with an ardent zeal, which not unfrequently over-stepped the bounds of propriety; and in short, the substance was neglected and forgotten whilst contending for the form. Every part of divinity received a polemical tinge; whilst biblical exposition, the chief object of theological science, was regarded as completely of secondary consideration. Olearius was unable to introduce an exegetical course of lectures at Leipzig; and the learned Carpzovius was compelled to conclude his lectures on the prophecy of Isaiah with the very first chapter. The consequence of such a mode of study at the universities was, that the preachers they sent forth, instead of expounding the Bible to the people, as the means of communicating instruction, edification, and sanctification, disseminated only scholastic dogmas and controversial sentiments, and being mostly destitute of feeling for things divine, frequently promulgated from the pulpit things of a completely extraneous and ridiculous nature; so that the Holy Scriptures were an unknown and a sealed book to the uninstructed people.”

Now let us illustrate the text thus given us from a work on the subject of Lutheran theology, published in this country some years since, and then the reader shall be judge which of the two schools most resembles those Lutherans whom the Pietists opposed—the High Church or the Low Church of this day. The work we allude to is Dr. Pusey’s *Essay on German Rationalism*.

This author observes, “It was a natural, though injurious consequence of the great superiority of Luther, that every expression of his upon controverted points became a norm for the party, which, at all times the largest, was at last co-extensive with the Church itself. This almost idolatrous veneration was perhaps increased by the selection of declarations of faith, of which the substance, on the whole, was his, for the symbolical books of his Church. Even in the earlier Lutheran controversies, the question is often, not whether the tenet agree with Scripture, but “whether it be a deflection from Luther’s doctrine,”—“whether the individual be fallen away from Luther,”—whether, “if the expression be the same, it be used precisely in the sense of Luther.”⁵ The Lutherans then were remarkable for their strict adherence to the doctrines of the Reformation, justification by faith only, and the rest. On the other hand, the especial offence in their eyes, committed by Spener, the chief writer of the Pietists, was his protesting against this strictness, and appealing to the spirit of the Gospel rather than to the bare letter of formulæ and confessions. The author just quoted speaks of Spener’s venturing to omit “assertions, which were abused by fleshly mindedness and indolence, but to the letter of which an indiscriminating orthodoxy clung,” such as, that “no one can attain to the perfection which the divine law requires,”—in the act of justification on the part of man, faith alone is concerned without good works,”—and of his refusing to “dwell exclusively on favourite doctrines,” instead of the whole of Christianity.

What is thus instanced as regards some of the more characteristic doctrines of Lutheranism, intruded into those also still more sacred, which, for the most part, lay beyond its attention. In one of the dialogues of Andrea, the theologian of the day is introduced as “*devising* formulæ that he may for the future believe as circumspectly as possible,”—and insisting on the necessity of knowing “the *mode* of union of the two natures” in Christ,—of determining whether his passion “had its origin in the preceding or following divine will,”—or whether “the counsel of God” respecting it, “in the order of causes, preceded or followed the Creation.”⁶

As to the study of Scripture at the same period, the chief subject of exposition is said by Schröckh to have been the book of Revelations, and that principally in reference to the Church of Rome. Except in this instance, exposition was almost unknown, Scripture being used rather as a

⁵Theology of Germany, part 1, p. 21, note.

⁶Part 2, p. 173, 4.

storehouse of texts, to be adduced *pro re natâ* in defence of the Lutheran dogmas, than studied and interpreted in its context and in course. "Since Luther and Melanchthon," as Planck observes ⁷, "had compelled doctrinal theology again to have recourse to Scripture alone, or, at least, principally for its truths, it should have been the first object to form a new system of scriptural interpretation." But the actual effect of their struggle had been to subject Scripture to the word of man, revelation to reason,—to shred the inspired message into minute portions, and to apply them to the maintenance of controversial positions. The chief use of the great river of divine truth seemed to lie in its feeding the canals and the broken cisterns of men. "Doctrinal theology," continues the same writer, "permitted polemical theology to dictate to it the meaning of Scripture,—found in each passage, which this deemed useful, a convincing scriptural proof, and thus admitted a number of very ambiguous proofs, which were yet further swelled through the errors to which the ease of bringing *such* proofs together soon led them, namely, of laying an especial value on the number of these proofs." ⁸ Accordingly, as Spener tells us, many, even very diligent students of theology, who readily followed the guidance of their preceptors, had never in their life gone through a single book of the Bible. Franké also avers, that in all his university years he did not hear any lecture upon Scripture ⁹. It is said to be one only out of many instances, that at Leipzig, Carpzov, after completing in the course of one half year the first chapter of Isaiah, did not again lecture on the Bible for twenty years, while Olcarius suspended his for ten. It is illustrative of the character of the biblical exposition then given, that Franké's defence of his reading theological lectures, when it was objected to, lay in this, that his lectures being confined to practical explanations, omitting the theological controversies, were not theological, but philological. It is a more painful fact, that in Leipzig, the great mart of literature as well as of trade, at one time in no bookseller's shop was either Bible or Testament to be found. It will be observed, that in this ignorance of Scripture we are speaking, not of the laity, but their teachers. Catechising of the young was neglected, equally with exposition of Scripture in the case of the more advanced. Spener speaks of its being considered, in his day, ridiculous to maintain its value as co-ordinate with preaching; and he had himself to encounter derision and opposition for attempting it.

These traits of the Lutheran divinity of the seventeenth century certainly do not apply to what has been called the orthodox party among ourselves. Whatever be its characteristics, it cannot be said to have neglected catechism in comparison of sermons, or to have insisted on the peculiar doctrines of the Reformation, as of *first* and almost *exclusive* importance in the circle of Christian truths, or to have chosen one or two favourite doctrines to the exclusion of the rest. Nor has it shown any tendency to limit the knowledge of Scripture to the use of a few texts or passages, nor to absorb all exposition in attempts to interpret and apply to the Roman Church the sacred mysteries of the book of Revelation.

The following points of character still less belong to the High Church. "It was inferred by Edgardi," says Dr. Pusey, "that since Brietkaupt, in two sermons on the Lord's Supper from 1 Cor. x. and xi., *had not refuted* the Reformed Churches, he *must needs* hypocritically *hold with them*. The Pietists were reproached by Löscher for neglecting the office of refutation. In a sermon on a public fast day, we have it hinted that the Pietistic error should not be tolerated, it being neither hot nor cold, but lukewarm—nay, a *mixture of religions*;—heretics they do not refute, but rather

⁷Part 2, p. 170.

⁸P. 145.

⁹P. 148.

excuse then, the *usus elencticus* is banished from their pulpits.”¹⁰ So technical and sapless was the creed of this era, that because Spener urged practical Christianity, he had to defend himself against the charge of preaching mere morality. “It is,” he says¹¹, “an *utterly false imputation* on the parts of opponents, that *we forget faith, and erect only the moral side of good works.*” Elsewhere he retorts the following charge upon the pseudo-orthodox. “I have often observed in many well-disposed persons, and some have even owned to me, that it has been a considerable hindrance to them in their course,—that they constantly heard and thought of this only, *how that we were poor weak men, who could not advance to the highest point*; they consequently became indolent, and did not set decidedly about that which they held it impossible to attain, and began to think *that they might remain children of God, although they did not apply themselves earnestly to good.*” And no wonder; for in the received system the simple position, “good works are present at the time of justification,” was at times thought sufficient *wholly to invalidate the orthodoxy of the holder*; and a professor of theology objected to the Pietists, “that *by making holiness of life, a part of the essence of Christianity, they mingled it up with the covenant of grace, and with the matter of justification and salvation.*”¹² Among the 283 errors which the University of Wittenberg charged upon Spener’s writings, one was “that he considered a holy life as absolutely necessary,” as the test of faith; another, “that the new man was not less nourished by the bread and wine in the Lord’s Supper than the natural man by the natural bread and wine;” and another, “that the Lord’s Supper was the *chief means of becoming partakers of the divine nature.*” Consistently with these notions, it seems to have been considered, that such doctrine as Spener’s was *fatal to the eternal prospects* of those who held it. Arndt, who in the beginning of the seventeenth century had been the precursor of the Pietists, and whose work on “True Christianity” was intended to show that it “consists in the manifestation of a true, living, active faith, in genuine piety and the fruits of righteousness,” was accused “of the *heresy of requiring from Christians angelic perfection, and of practising alchemy,*” and “his extensive benevolence was attributed to the discovery of the philosopher’s stone.” “The clergy of Brunswick issued warnings against his ‘poison.’” L. Osiander pronounced that his writings *could not be read by the ignorant without risk of salvation*; that they were full of heretical poison, and pestilential; that he has blasphemed against the Holy Spirit; that *he used expressions belonging to the mystics or fanatics of an earlier period*. Calixtus, who flourished a few years later, a man, according to Weisman, “of great talent and comprehensive views,” gave great offence to the upholders of the degenerate system under review by “*allowing to the fathers of the five first centuries a secondary authority in fundamental articles of faith.*”¹³ “This,” continues the writer of whom we have availed ourselves all along, “which in no respect differed from the practice of all Protestant writers, who have uniformly referred to the agreement of the early fathers, as witnesses of the primitive faith, *was imputed to him as involving the Romanist error of setting human authority co-ordinate with Scripture*”¹⁴. Though his office as teacher of theology was conferred on him for his success in controversy with a Romanist, and though by one of them he is named as their ablest antagonist, his Lutheran brethren charged him with secretly favouring them.” Even Mr. Bickersteth’s publication speaks favourably of Calixtus, as commencing that movement which issued in Pietism, and seeking “to redirect the attention of the

¹⁰P. 200.

¹¹P. 209.

¹²P. 298.

¹³Part 1, p. 59.

¹⁴Ibid.

students of divinity to its historical department.”¹⁵ Of Arndt also it speaks as one of the “pious and learned divines,” who came forward to “provide for the spiritual necessities of the people;” while in Spener, as might be expected, it declares “the new epoch of evangelical vitality began.” Far different was the reception which these individuals met with from the religionists of their day, loud clamourers as the latter were in praise of the Reformation, and idolators of the dicta of Luther. Professor Fecht, a learned theologian of the age, justified the refusal of the title of “*beatus*” or “*der selige*,”¹⁶ “of blessed memory,” to Spener, (though he asserted it was applicable even to Lutherans, who had led notoriously irreligious lives, and on their death-beds had not given the slightest indication of repentance,) because Spener had not revoked his many grievous errors, or repented of the confusions he had caused in the Church. And Calov, in like manner, denied it might be given to Calixtus, on the ground, that if so, we must in consistency say Beatus Bellarminus, B. Calvinus, and B. Socinus.

We are far from supposing that Mr. Bickersteth would not denounce and condemn formalism wherever it is to be found. He is too candid, too reasonable, too experienced, not to know and allow that it can exist under the strictest profession of Calvinism, Lutheranism, or of any still more spiritual religion. We have drawn out the above account of the Lutheranism of 1600-1700 by no means as a *reductio ad absurdum* against him, as if he were himself advocating a creed which in *other cases* had become formal and technical. He would admit that every creed might so become. Nay, perhaps he would object *in toto* to creeds being made the essence of religion, when they were but the accidental development of it. He would say with the Reformers, that the heart and the spirit were everything; that they *naturally* developed in a certain outward form, but that the existence of that form, however accurate, was no voucher or safeguard of the inward principle. How far we agree with him in this, and where we begin to differ, is not now the question; but this he would certainly say. He would say, that if our orthodoxy in England has been, or is, technical or formal, it matters not of what nature it is, and that, though it be formalism on Laud’s or on Tillotson’s basis, the formalism of bigots or of latitudinarians, it may be viewed as in a type in the formalism of Lutheranism in the seventeenth century. We admit all this; and, as admitting it, have had a different purpose in the above account of Lutheranism,—a purpose which the reader may have discerned. We would maintain, not that what is familiarly (but improperly) called at this day evangelical religion *may* become technical, but that, in a great measure, it *has* so become; that, whether or not, the High Church system has ever fallen into the type of Lutheran formalism, Mr. Bickersteth’s own particular creed is fast running into formalism in Great Britain at the present moment.

This day, indeed, has far too much of kindly and polite feeling to imitate the excesses of the Lutherans in Calixtus’ and Spener’s age, to scatter about curses in open words, to persecute the body, or to exhibit the grosser forms of technicality and superstition. The same causes which hinder the development of Romanism in image worship, restrain the energies of Ultra-Protestantism also; yet, if we make due allowance for the influence of the resisting medium, we shall be able to detect in the Ultra-Protestantism of our own Church many signs of the bigotry and narrow pedantry of that continental theology, which equally prided itself in the name, and thought it understood the principles of Luther.

We cannot help giving these titles to some of Mr. Bickersteth’s own well-meant efforts to purify (as he considers it) the publications of the Society for promoting Christian Knowledge. In his little book against Popery, which, as Mr. Barter truly observes, seems really levelled against those

¹⁵P. 2, 3.

¹⁶P. 164.

publications and the views they embody, he objects (p. 27, note) to it being said that “a life of everlasting happiness after death” is to be “expected” upon the “conditions” of “doing those things which our godfathers and godmothers promise for us in baptism.” He says, “Here everlasting happiness is made to depend on the righteousness of the sinner, and not on the righteousness of Christ; it is no longer the gift of eternal life to us in Christ Jesus:” and this he maintains, though shortly after, as he quotes, the same work from which this is an extract declares that “the performance of these conditions,” the serving and obeying God, and living according to the Gospel of Christ, will not “obtain eternal life” on account of “the doer’s” own deserts, but for the sake and through the merits of Jesus Christ. He argues as if, *because* Christ is the *meritorious* cause of eternal life, there can be no other cause of it at all, or, at least, that the individual receiving it cannot be in any sense a party in the eventual acquisition of it; as if the righteousness—not “of the sinner,” as he words it, but of the *regenerate*, and that not his own, but *wrought in him by the grace of Christ*, cannot be made, not a meritorious price, but a *necessary condition* of eternal life, without excluding the glory of that grace. “Thus the glory of the Gospel,” he says, “free salvation, is shut out, and the true place of good works, as the fruit of faith through the Spirit, and real holiness, as flowing from the belief of God’s love in Christ and our union with him, are wholly unknown and undescribed. It is the law, and not the Gospel; and though ‘for the merits of Christ’ is added, it is still in reality ‘do this and live.’ O miserable exposition of the Protestant faith, teaching all our scholars the very elements of Popery, &c.!” Now, is not this something like the Lutheran divines, who accused the Pietists of “forgetting faith” and “preaching mere morality” because they urged practical Christianity? Has not the Gospel two sides? Is there not both an efficient cause of salvation and a *sine qua non*—a positive and a negative requisite, God’s part and our part? Is it not true that we are saved through Christ, yet true also that we are saved *not without* our own exertions? Must we be excluding the *former* of the two because we mention *both* the former and latter? It is bad enough to be accused, as the Pietists were, of denying faith, because they were not led to mention it; but it is worse fortune still to be considered to deny it merely for mentioning works also. Mr. Bickersteth will not allow works to be directly preached at all. They may just be hinted at, as virtually *existing in faith*, but as cautiously and briefly as possible, as if it were a dangerous secret, scarcely safe to breathe,—as if, though the mother were fruitful, the birth was sure to be fatal, or the offspring unnatural, and destined to be a matricide. According to him, to mention works is to deny faith, even though in the same sentence one enforces it. Surely this is technical, and unlike the largeness of the Apostles. St. James and St. John, not to say St. Paul, do not thus fetter and formalise the free spirit of the Gospel.

Soon after he takes notice of the following sentences, in the same work from which the foregoing are taken. “Think on the account thou must give hereafter, and thou wilt never do amiss.” “O grant that when I depart hence, to appear before thee, in the other world, I may give a good account of myself, and be received into thy favour and the kingdom of heaven, through Jesus Christ our Lord.” On these he observes, “a mind *at all* enlightened by the truth, brought home to his heart by the spirit of God, will be *deeply pained* by such exhibitions of human *self-sufficiency and self-righteousness*,” as if he would say, This is a case in which there is no need of reasoning, in which reasoning will be of no service, where the defect is at once perceived by the spiritual mind without analyzing it logically, and where an analysis, however correct, would not persuade those who are not spiritual. There are such cases doubtless; the perplexity and mistakes of persons who have not in their minds the principle of a certain science, taste, or character, their hopeless struggles to be correct, their failures where they thought to be most correct, their infringing upon words and phrases which those who have the principle in them reject as alien, and which at once detect them as pretenders,

and their complaints, in consequence, against the particular science in question, are technical, unintelligible, and absurd; all this may happen and the science not be to blame. Doubtless; let us grant to the full that spiritual-mindedness, as it is called, *may* be such as to develop itself only in certain peculiar and recondite phrases, and this, moreover, with what appears caprice and fantastic nicety to those who are not spiritual. Let us grant it; but then how comes it that the Apostles are not possessed of this delicate sensibility? How is it that St. John or St. Peter do not shrink from phrases in which Mr. Bickersteth would scent death ever so far off? But it is too serious a matter merely to view in that character of strangeness which really attaches to it. It is most serious and painful to think, that did such a thinker as Mr. Bickersteth meet by chance the following words, not knowing whence they came, "By works a man is justified, and not by faith only;" "Blessed are they who do his commandments, that they may have right to the tree of life;" or "Work out your own salvation, for God worketh in you;"—he would not *argue* about them, nor go to *prove* they were wrong. No—he would quietly put them aside; he would calmly and silently disallow them, without discussion, without effort, without misgiving, confiding in the inward feeling of his mind that they were unspiritual; he would trust in his own heart against those who knocked there, thus rejecting angels unawares. He would *know* and *feel* himself to be superior to them; to have that which they had not; to have a gift within; and he would, in his own words, "be *deeply pained* by such exhibitions of human self-sufficiency and self-righteousness:"—and all this without arrogating any great spirituality or faith to himself,—no, though he thought himself the lowest of the low, the weakest and feeblest saint that walks the earth, (and we have no wish or thought of saying that he considers himself higher than the lowest and weakest;) but provided he did but think he was in God's favour at all, thus must he judge of those Apostles, thus he could not but judge, for as if to allow himself no loop-hole, he speaks expressly of "a mind *at all* enlightened by the truth, brought home to his heart by the spirit of God." Alas! we have no wish at all, we say it sincerely and sorrowfully, to impute any thing wrong or sinful to Mr. Bickersteth personally. No, it is his creed; it is his technical, arrogant, boastful creed—which, equally with that of the degenerate Lutherans of Germany, relies on itself that it is right, and despises others, and is scrupulous about mint, anise and cummin, and tyrannizes over that great gift of God, speech and utterance, loading it by fetters, and subjecting it to rules which God has nowhere imposed, not in Scripture, not by antiquity, not by the Church; nay, rules which, as is undeniable, would convict the whole college of apostles of heresy and spiritual blindness, and that, all upon the secret confidence of the individual's heart that he knows, as if infallibly, the savour of true and untrue statements of Christian doctrine.

One or two instances of formalism, such as the above, are more than enough to convey our meaning to readers of this day, who will see others in abundance before their eyes, without the trouble of looking out for them. Another age, indeed, might not understand or believe what the real state of the case is without a thousand. We have certainly been viewing the ultra-Protestantism now current in the most favourable light, in taking a man like Mr. Bickersteth for our specimen of its religious fruits; a man of kindly and amiable feelings and candid mind, and conciliatory bearing; who, we are persuaded, thinks as charitably of others, and approaches as nearly to them as his creed allows him. We have viewed it to the greatest advantage, in assigning as the explanation of its pedantry and technicality, that it considers words as developments of a certain internal spirit or temper, which is itself one, definite, and discriminating. This is to view it as coinciding in theory with Luther or Spener, in maintaining the practical infallibility of the regenerate mind, in its judgments between truth and falsehood; whereas, in truth, the great mass of ultra-Protestants are fast sinking into that unmeaning and superstitious adherence to words and phrases which

characterized the successors of each of those reformers. Indeed the fantastic and strange distinctions between word and word, phrase and phrase, and the portentous judgments passed on individuals, in consequence of their use of them, in what is improperly called the religious world, rival in their own line, any the most extravagant codes of honour, usages of chivalry, or absurdities of fashion, which the world of arms or the gay world has ever sanctioned. The Norman baron's punctiliousness, when, in consequence of an idle word of promise, he sallied out of his strong-hold to be slaughtered by an overpowering enemy, or the pilgrimage of high-born knight or lady to the Holy Land, whatever may be imputed to it on the score of good sense, is abundantly compensated by the seriousness of purpose, the courage and the suffering therein manifested. But there is nothing great in "strifes of words," arbitrary definitions, and subtle distinctions. There is nothing in nature to ennoble, or in reason to defend, or in Scripture to hallow, or in antiquity to recommend, nor in Church authority to enforce, the miserable squabbles about the miserable subtleties which choke up the thoughts, and hinder the religious advancement of this Christian people; —we say it deliberately, which hinder our advancement in religious truth and obedience. Spenser complained that in his age men heard they were "poor weak men, who could not advance to the highest point," and became in consequence indolent, and "did not set decidedly about that which they held it impossible to attain;" and surely a similar complaint lies against the popular system of our own times. Men have contrived to block up the way to higher excellence, by forbidding it to be preached. So it is, a Christian minister cannot find words to enforce it, which are unexceptionable to ultra-Protestants. All the words of the language, by which he might enforce it, are forbidden, bought up, forfeited, as damaged or unlawful. If he says, "Work out your own salvation," he is self-righteous. If he says, "God will render to you according to your works," he is legal. If he says, "Have respect unto the recompence of the reward," he has fallen from grace. If he enlarges on the beauty of moral excellence, he is heathen. If he enters into those details, which are the very life, the sole conceivable channel of obedience, he is forgetting Christ. He is forbidden to speak of "gaining God's favour," of "receiving a reward," of "securing his, love," of "observing the conditions of salvation," nay; of "acceptance by faith." The vision of the saints of God, as an angelic creation, as great, and noble, and supernatural, is considered a mere earthly dream, is gravely censured as the idle romance, the carnal poetry, of minds who never tasted the truth of the Gospel. Two or three phrases comprehend the whole of religion. If a man has not learned the due use of them, it is as if he "had not charity," he is "nothing;" if he has them well by heart, he may do any thing. One cannot specify them without using sacred words in a like irreverent way with the persons we are censuring; the reader therefore must supply for himself instances, which indeed will readily occur to him. There is no doubt at all that Spenser's and Franké's language would have subjected them to the suspicion of our ultra-Protestants, in spite of those points in which they really resemble them, such as their unsettling things established. They were called Romanists in their day; they would be called Romanists now. If men so candid as Mr. Bickersteth can detect in Mr. Crossman's or in Bishop Wilson's language a latent Popery, surely others less considerate may account Franké or Spenser hopelessly dark or dangerously inconsistent. What indeed could Spenser be in the judgment of such religionists but very ignorant of the truth, when he declined saying, that "in the act of justification, faith alone is concerned on our part without good works?" As to Franké, the work which heads our present article contains sufficient grounds for suspicion and exception, unless the spirit of ultra-Protestantism shows towards him most unusual indulgence. The following passage might be taken for the words of a Romanist, had not Mr. Bickersteth put his *imprimatur* upon it; there is nothing in it of faith, of human corruption, of Christ, or of the warfare of flesh and spirit. It

is upon *love*; and the tone is exactly that of a Roman writer.

“‘Love to God is a thing which a person must himself taste and experience in his heart, in order rightly to know what it is. Hence, although one may describe to a person, what love to God is—yet he cannot duly and salutarily understand it as he ought, unless his heart be really *inflamed with love to God*.’

“‘But perhaps you think, ‘Can you then give us no description whatever of that love, with which we ought to love God?’ I answer, ‘Yes; some description may be given of it; but experience is requisite duly to understand the description. When I tell you that love to God is that *real angelic sweetness*, which entirely fills the heart, you cannot understand me, till God gives you to *taste a drop* of this sweetness; but if you had only tasted a single drop of it, *your eyes would become as bright and clear as those of Jonathan*, (1 Sam. xiv. 2;) so that you would see and know what love to God is.

“‘This love to God is a fruit of the Holy Spirit, by which we regard God as our supreme good, feel a cordial desire after him, seek our joy and sole delight in him, endeavour to please him alone, and long to be *more intimately united with him*, and cleave continually to him, that we may become, as it were, one heart and soul, and as the Scriptures express it, one spirit with him.’

“‘See, my dear children, that you have *now* such a description of it, as is suitable for the present life; for in heaven—if you abide in Christ and thus attain to it—no description will be requisite. Duly consider this description of it, and you will perceive what an extremely excellent thing love to God is; yes, you will then at the same time understand how very different it is from the love of self and the world.”—pp. 189, 190.

After this, he proceeds to speak of our Saviour’s merits; but this is no excuse in ultra-Protestant eyes, for his not having expressly mentioned that most sacred subject before; and after all, he says not a word about faith; but proceeds, instead, in the passage which follows, to speak again of “the Holy Spirit’s peculiar work, to shed abroad the love of God in the heart;” the very text which is the main stay of Romanism.

Or take again the following passage of Franké’s from Mr. Bickersteth’s Appendix:—

“‘What more could be possibly desired, O my soul, which thou mayest not find in this love? That the Son of God should be thy Creator, should be thy life, thy light, which illuminates thee; that commands his word to be revealed to thee by the prophets and apostles, as a testimony of himself, the true light; that the angels themselves should bring thee glad tidings, and rejoice to minister unto thee; that thou shouldst become a true believer, obtain pardon for thy sins, and be again born of God, and from the fulness of his grace and truth, such in all divine riches: that he hath brought forth to thee the knowledge of God from the bosom of his heavenly Father, from the inmost and most secret divinity; that he hath, as the true Immanuel, led thee into communion with God; that thou being baptized in the name of the Holy Trinity, admitted into an eternal covenant with God, shouldst be anointed with the Holy Spirit, and illuminated with his gifts, be sanctified, and by him preserved in the true faith, and be powerfully strengthened in all conflicts against sin, the world, death, the devil, and hell; that nothing should ever be able to withdraw and separate thee from the love of him; nay, ‘That thou art come unto Mount Sion, and unto the city of the living God, the heavenly Jerusalem, and to an innumerable company of angels; to the general assembly, and church of the first-born, which are written in heaven, and to God the judge of all, and to the spirits of just men made perfect, and to Jesus the Mediator of the new covenant, and to the blood of sprinkling, that speaketh better things than that of Abel.’ (Heb. xii 22-24.) That thou mayest obtain all these felicities, here indeed by faith, and a comfortable foretaste; hereafter, by a most perfect intuition, and everlasting glory: and when Christ thy life shall be made manifest, thou also mayest

be manifested with him in glory. I say, all these things, and whatsoever else can be entitled to the name of salvation and blessedness, thou entirely owest to this infinite love, which manifested itself to the world in this, that the Son of God himself became the Saviour of men, in such a manner, that he was made man; and his most exalted Majesty dwelt in flesh, as in his temple, among mortals: of which St. John says, 'He dwelt among us, and we beheld his glory, the glory as of the only begotten of the Father, full of grace and truth.'—pp. 284, 285.

This is not ultra-Protestant, but rich and glowing Catholic language, as far as it goes. Of this our amiable editor seems somewhat sensible, and, accordingly, in his preface says—

"There is much that is very instructive in the account of his conversion, and in the description which he gives of that faith by which he was led to the knowledge and enjoyment of the true and living God; and the editor hopes that the reader may find real help from this statement of Franké's spiritual experience ... *It might have been well to have opened more the struggle between our fallen nature and divine grace*, which, it is very clear from his own confession, Franké deeply felt, lest any should think too highly of a man whom God so greatly honoured with extended usefulness, and either be led to despair or to glory in man."—pp. iv. v.

Still dwelling on the sin and misery of our unrenewed nature! still anxiously turning to the corruption and odiousness of the flesh, and refusing to contemplate the work of *the Spirit*, lest grace should fail of being exalted, lest glory should be given to man, lest Christ's work should be eclipsed! What a strange and capricious taste, to linger in the tomb, to sit down with Job among the ashes, by way of knowing him who has called us to light, to liberty, to perfection! How eccentric and how inconsequent,—how like, (unless sometimes seen in serious and well-judging men,) how like an aberration, to argue that to extol the work of the Spirit, must be to obscure the grace of Christ? Yet this is firmly held,—held as if in the spirit of confessors and martyrs,—held, *mordicus*, as a vital, sovereign, glorious, transporting truth, by the dominant ultra-Protestantism. Regenerate man must, to the day of his death, have in him nothing better than man unregenerate. In spite of the influences of grace, there must be nothing in him to admire, nothing to kindle the beholder, nothing to gaze upon, dwell on, or love, lest we glory in man. Grace must do nothing in him, or it is not duly upheld. The triumph of grace is to act entirely externally to him, not in him. To save and sanctify is not so great a work as to save and leave sinful. There must be nothing saintly, nothing super-human, nothing angelic in man regenerate, because man unregenerate is the child and slave of evil. Sin must be his sole characteristic, his sole theme, his sole experience; or, as Mr. Bickersteth words it, "the struggle between fallen nature and divine grace" must be "*opened*," that is, like "wounds, bruises, and putrifying sores," as the most acceptable sacrifice, the noblest, pleasantest, fittest return to God for the great gift of regeneration. Faith is to be made everything, as being the symbol and expression of this negative or degraded state; and charity, which is the fulfilling of the law, the end of the commandment, and the greatest of Christian graces, must not be directly contemplated or enforced at all, lest it be thereby implied that the Christian can be better with grace than he is without it. Such is supposed to be, [*kat' exochēn*], spiritual religion, the religion in which the Spirit is supposed to do little or nothing for us.

Here we shall part with Mr. Bickersteth, whom we heartily wish we could agree with better than we do. It may be well, however, before parting with the subject he has introduced to our notice, briefly to obviate a misconception which may arise of what has been above said on the subject of dogmas. A dogma, in the objectionable sense of the word, is a doctrinal statement of man's making, imposed by man's authority as necessary to salvation. Such are not those statements of doctrine which we hold by the right of private judgment, *without* enforcing them upon others; as, for instance,

the doctrine of justification by faith only, which, though true, is a human deduction from Scripture, and is not made a condition of church-membership among ourselves. On the other hand, neither are those in any respect dogmas, which, though imposed, have a divine origin, for this is a sufficient reason or call for such imposition. Such, for instance, are the catholic doctrines of the Trinity and the Incarnation, which can be proved to come from God, as stated in the creeds, in the same sense in which the Gospels are proved to come from God. Neither then *human* statements, if *private*, nor *enforced* statements, if *divine*, are dogmas in an objectionable sense; but a dogma is a *human* doctrine *enforced*, such as the doctrine of purgatory as enforced by the Roman, or consubstantiation as enforced by the Lutherans of 1600, or justification by faith only as enforced by the ultra-Protestants, or the millenium as enforced by one party in the present religious world, or personal assurance by another. Nothing then that has been above said about the dogmatism of Germany interferes at all with the due strictness incumbent on us in maintaining the Catholic Faith. It is when men, rejecting their Divine Master, make themselves the servants of men—when they will not have “the Lord for their King,” and fall under the Philistines—when they supersede or encumber the true creed with their self-devised additions—when they *hide* the atonement with purgatory and pardons, or the incarnation with justification by faith only, then they become dogmatical. We, of the English Church, hold justification by faith only; we do not hold purgatory; but we neither anathematize those who do hold purgatory, nor those who do not hold justification by faith. Thus we differ widely from the stiff orthodoxism of Germany, and the present Low Church school among us approaches towards it, inasmuch as we are not dogmatists, and our Low Church brethren are.

We say the same of ordinances. It is a bigoted and schismatical spirit which enforces them for their own sake, on human authority.. Such as are of human origin may be adopted by particular Churches at their discretion, but not imposed upon other Churches; but over those ordinances which come from Christ and His Apostles, we have no power, either to alter or dispense with them. We are obliged to keep and to impose them. Hence we might change our postures in devotion, the ministerial vestments, our saints’ days, our times and forms of prayer; or again, the constitution of our chapters or schools; and ought to bear with differences as to these points in other Churches. We may not dispense with the sacraments, or the ministerial succession, or the sacramentals, or social worship, or the Lord’s day, or the visible Church.

One word, before concluding, as to the author and the translator of the work which has been under review. The author was, when his work appeared (1827), a very young, but able man, (probably about twenty-one,) and he has since given proof of his sincerity by being put out of his office in the university, rather than give up the strict Lutheran doctrine which in Prussia is now proscribed, Lutherans being in Prussia allowed individually to retain their opinions, but not to exist as a body.

In its English dress the character of the work is of necessity much altered by the omission of nearly five-eighths, these omissions being larger or smaller, from passages or pages down to members of sentences. We do not suppose that in so doing the translator has been guilty of wilful garbling; his object was doubtless to produce a popular book, which should inculcate the views which he thought useful for the Church; and so he has omitted what bore especially on the Lutheran body. Yet if history is to be of any use, it must manifestly be as a whole; a fragment of history, however small, is instructive, if complete: even details of single facts are useful in their way, as illustrative of principles; but a view of a period, if incomplete, is worse than useless. Thus the following passages, omitted in page 2, were certainly a desirable addition, when the character of a century is condensed into a single page, at the same time that they tend to destroy any similarity

which might be wished to be established between the rigid Lutherans and any body which ever existed among ourselves ¹⁷.

"The favourite theological study everywhere was controversy." Biblical exposition was made altogether secondary, "because they confined themselves to the doctrinal system once established by church authority; *and this they treated only in the logical manner of the schoolmen.*" "At some of the most celebrated universities, the only lectures given or heard were on doctrinal systems, controversy, and the art of preaching." Calixtus sought to bring back theology to a more historical basis, —(this is translated "to re-direct the attention of the students of divinity to its historical department,")—"whilst most theologians of his time would only admit of one form of doctrine, that established by the Church, by which means an unhistorical tendency might easily be given, which will pay no regard to the historical tradition of that which belonged to true Christianity, in varied forms, through all, and especially the first, centuries, and which threatened to rend the Lutheran Church entirely out of its connection with the development of the whole church from its first apostolic foundation onwards."

These passages, whether as illustrative of the character of the times, of the individuals, or of the author, ought not to have been omitted. Again, at p. 3 is omitted a chronology of Spener's life, which, if history had been any object, of course would have been necessary, and also the following:

"Spener made many propositions for the improvement of theological study in his excellent work, *Pia Desideria*, which first appeared in 1675, as a preface to J. Arndt's *Homilies*. But Spener naturally wished to influence not the theologians only, but, and that principally, the non-theologians, and the members of his own congregation: he wished religion to be the chief concern of every individual Christian. With this view he brought out again, in especial prominence, the primitive notion of a priesthood common to all Christians, which, through the erroneous way of handling theology, had almost wholly sunk into oblivion the notion, namely, that all Christians had, through their common union with the one High-Priest and Atoner, Christ, received equally free access to God, so as to be admitted to consecrate their whole life as an offering of thanksgiving to God."

Again, p.4, on the meetings in Spener's house, there is added in the original, "The evil principle which readily creeps into such assemblages, namely, that those who take part in them account themselves better than other, men, or consider the attendance on them as a work which, by its very performance sanctifies men, he set himself to counteract with great wisdom." Certainly a very necessary caution.

Again, the description of the rigid Lutheranism is generalized, (*ibid.*); and for "a dialectic-scholastic theology and letter of an orthodox system of doctrine, a dead faith," we have only "the letter of a lifeless orthodoxy of scholastic controversy;" as in p. 3 we have "divests the study of divinity," for "bring it back from the scholastic path which it was pursuing."

We said that we did not accuse the translator of wilful garbling, but we think that he is probably a person deficient in practical character, and so has inadvertently given a colour to things. Thus, p. 3, "much which is fanatical," is stronger than the translation, "something of an imaginary and fantastic nature;"—"Christian life," more practical than "evangelical vitality." P. 4,—*"Spener,"* we are told, "wished to enter into closer connection with those *of his hearers* who were most susceptible of divine truth, that they might be a salt to *the Church.*" In the original, certainly with a more Church notion, it is, "those members *of his congregation*, that they might become as salt to *the*

¹⁷We have marked the omissions by inverted commas.

whole congregation." Again,—“those who attended these meetings,” for “those members of his congregation.” “The great truths of religion and the *state of their souls*,” is substituted for “cases of conscience and Christianity.” P. 11,—“hold religious converse,” for “edify himself (build himself up) in Christianity;” “first impressions,” for “first-fruits of grace.” P. 12,—“grant him a real change of heart and make him His child,” for “fully to alter him, and make him *wholly* His child.” P. 13,—“I began to come to myself,” for “to enter into myself;” “to place me in another *state of mind*,” for “*character of life*.” P. 15,—“a zealous *professor of religion*,” for “Christian,” (as “religion” seems to be throughout substituted for “Christianity.”) P. 16,—“I felt that I myself was still devoid of that faith which would be required in my sermon,” for “it came into my mind that I could find in myself no such faith” [i.e. such degree of faith] “as in my sermon I should require of others.” P. 32,—“a mere outwardly *moral* walk,” for “reputable.” In other places the translator is either imperfectly acquainted with German, or has translated very carelessly.

ART. II. Geraldine—a Tale of conscience. By E. C. A. In 2 vols. London: Booker and Dolman. 1837.

[*British Critic*, vol. 24, July 1838.]

THIS is the work of a clever and observant person, though not practised in writing. It is a tale with little incident and no ending; or rather it is an attempt at a tale, which is left unravelled. But in truth its object is very different from that of putting out of hand a well-managed plot, being no other than to recommend the Roman Catholic religion to the favourable notice of the English Protestant; and accordingly it is made up principally of discussions on various points of faith and usage and sketches of character, such as are naturally suggested by the present state and peculiarities of religious parties. In these sketches we conceive the merit of the book lies, for the argumentative portion, as far as it is on the offensive, though not deficient in smartness, is not beyond the ability, and scarcely beyond the opinions, of any one who is not blinded by Ultra-Protestantism; and as far as it is a defence of Romanism, it fails strangely even in matters of fact. Similar failure attends its Roman Catholic sketches, which form an exception, as all readers will feel, to the general spirit and effectiveness of the author's style. It may be, that caricature is much easier than correct drawing, or that true excellence cannot be delineated by a few strokes, or brought out in its substance at the will of a writer; but, however we account for it, De Grey, Angela, Lady Winefride, and Mr. Bernard are but varieties of the “*pious Æneas*,” with the same ambition in the writer, the same failure in the production.

The other characters, however, are for the most part amusingly drawn, and some of them, it must be confessed, good hits. There is a religious indifferentist, with a sufficient insight into the absurdities of the popular ways of thought, a hankering after Catholicity, and a kindness towards the imaginative parts of Romanism; a Whig lord enduring Protestantism and Romanism, yet attached to neither; a High-Church Oxford divine; a Reformation-Society Protestant; a pert young lady inclined to the Presbyterian persuasion; and a parish clergyman of the modern school, amiable, active, uxorious and absurd. Among these personages the heroine moves, being the only child of a widowed father, and heiress of his estates, who, after going through the phases of Protestantism, as it exists among us, seeks for something deeper and truer in Anglicanism, or, as Mr. Palmer more correctly speaks in his recent work, *Anglo-Catholicism*; is disappointed, and at length finds in the Church of Rome the refuge which she is in quest of.

Geraldine, a name which the reader may have already had sagacity enough to give her, is represented as driven from Protestantism by its endless janglings and changes; and from the

Anglican Church by the inconsistency at present existing between its principles and practice. She has been originally brought to serious thoughts about religion by members of what is called the evangelical party; for a time she is in a state of great happiness, till she finds herself involved in the disputes and wanderings which it may be said to consist of, rather than to contain. She falls in with Romanists, and wishes to believe a creed which promises to give the peace and stability which she so much needs. In this state of mind she thus speaks to her intimate friend, the Presbyterian already mentioned.

"Kate! Kate! tell me not that every Bible reader knows the truth: I am weary of this repeated but unsatisfactory answer; I have proved its hollowness. You know well the increased interest I took in religion three years ago,—the confidence I placed in the body of professing Christians, both in this neighbourhood and in London, and the conspicuous part which, from my zeal and my position here, I was induced to take in the various religious associations set on foot. What has become of those Bible readers?—those I most trusted! One has ceased to pray, and now can only praise, being certain of salvation; another has joined the Baptists, being dissatisfied with 'infant baptism;' and my former excellent governess, and still dear friend, has become infatuated by the doctrines of the 'Miraculous Gifts;' and has even been worked upon, by the frenzy of excitement, to utter those sounds which her party denominate the 'Unknown Tongue!' She has ceased to communicate with any of her former acquaintances, as being without the pale of the true Church, which has received baptism by the Holy Ghost; but she still yearns after me with the feelings of a sister. I have received several letters from her, and what think you is her constant entreaty? That I will read the Bible, and nothing but the Bible! pointing out to me the chapter hitherto so neglected during centuries, and reserved for these latter days, to be brought to light by the perfected Church. You know the chapter, Katharine; it is the fourteenth of Corinthians, in which there is certainly most distinct mention made by the Apostle of those very gifts of the Spirit, which, like the power of healing, the Irvingites contend would never have been lost but through want of faith. Now, Katharine, I have looked far too deeply into the cause of all this wild, unstable conduct, longer to suppose it the fault of the individuals who have so wandered astray. It is the *system* which I see is wrong,—the system of private interpretation of Scripture; and hence, however I may pity, I can never blame its victims."—vol. i. pp. 9, 10.

Again; we have another amusing sketch of the source of her perplexities in the following passage.

"I was referring to a clergyman of the Established Church," replied Geraldine, 'whom I met in London during the last season; when having, in addition to Sir Eustace De Grey's defence of his Church, listened repeatedly to that of his aunt, Lady Winefride Blount, and become curious to hear more, I overheard this Rev. Mr. P——, in conversation one evening, at a serious party at Lady Lucy Foster's, make some comments, which I never forgot. 'The present state of the Protestant world,' said he, 'is one of curious contemplation to the philosopher, and one of deep anxiety and pain to the Christian. Infidelity stalks over the land, and will persecute where it dare. The Romish apostacy was superstition and idolatry; the Protestant apostacy is infidelity and anarchy. Each contains in its vital constitution the seeds of these corruptions and abuses. The Romish persecutions have been dreadful, but the infidel persecutions will be far worse; inasmuch as an idolater feels himself responsible to his false god, and the infidel is responsible to nothing. A God obscured is better than a God denied! ... The Roman Catholic Church is right respecting the power of miraculous gifts in the Church of Christ. There is a constant misapprehension respecting the *power* and the *exhibition* of miracles. If miracles were needless, except in the revelation of a new dispensation, why

did they continue in the Jewish Church after it was firmly established? can it be supposed that God would bestow his gifts less on the Christian, than on the Jewish, Church? Miracles *are* granted to a faithful Church.' Much struck by these remarks, I requested to be introduced to this clergyman, to whom every one seemed to listen with as much attention as myself; and from that evening Mr. P—— became a frequent visitor in Berkeley Square. I had hitherto frequented the chapel in —— Street, where I had always been interested and instructed, and where Mr. P—— had himself occasionally officiated; but my new adviser now warned me against the dangerous doctrines that were gradually creeping in at M—— Chapel, without being able, however, to fix for me whither to go instead: 'For,' added he, 'the evangelical body is at present so infected with various heresies that I know not where you would be safe.' 'As a resident in Berkeley Square,' said I, 'my parish Church is St. George's; but all my religious friends assure me, that from the High Church party I should hear nothing that could improve me.' 'Very true,' replied Mr. P——, 'you would never hear the true Gospel from any of the preachers at the great west-end churches. However, do not let this state of things lead you into dissent; for much as I may warn you against the parties in the Church, I doubly warn you against the Dissenters. I have passed much of my life amongst them, and you may trust my experience, that their pride and arrogance are perfectly antichristian.' 'No!' added he, 'the more intercourse I have held with the Dissenters, the less I have liked them: —keep clear of them!'

""Ha!" cried the warden, suddenly roused from a reverie, 'a sensible man that:—who was he?'

""The same man, my dear sir, who assured me, that I could never hear the true Gospel from the preachers of the High Church.'

"The warden was again silent and abstracted, and Geraldine continued. Mr. P—— then inquired whose ministry I attended when in the country? and on my speaking of my dear uncle Edmund,—of his piety, his zeal, his usefulness,—'Yes,' said he, 'Edmund Sinclair is a good man! we were friends at Cambridge—both at that time staunch Simeonites: but take care of his notions on 'Election,' for he has a considerable twist on that point.'

""Positively, sir,' cried I, equally vexed and amused, 'as I am in such imminent danger from those of my own communion, I had better take refuge in the Catholic Church, where no difference of religious opinion is permitted.'

""The Roman Catholic Church, you mean,' replied Mr. P——. 'No! you must not take so wild a step as that would be. You must not leave the pure worship of God for all those awful superstitions. The Romanists, however, have the right on their side in many things. They have indeed. But now,' added he, 'Farewell! for I must leave London within an hour—Farewell! read your Bible, pray fervently, and rest satisfied that the 'assurance of faith in the believer,' is the highest perfection in the Christian course, and a foretaste of the time when Christ will be all in all.'"—vol. i. Pp. 147-151.

Her father being at the time away, her maternal uncle, a Dr. Sinclair, warden of —— College, Oxford, has promised to stay with her at Elverton Hall during the long vacation; and to him she resolves to open her mind, with the hope of its being thereby settled in the faith of the Church in which she has been brought up. Such a procedure is in the particular case not only candid and sensible, but the evidence of a strong mind, for though the warden has many good qualities they are not exactly of the kind calculated to win over a young female. And here it may relieve the general reader to be told that the said warden is purely an imaginary being, a mere abstract head of a house; and we must do the author, or, as we suppose from internal evidence, the authoress the justice to say, that, while he is drawn with a good deal of cleverness, there is nothing ill-natured in the picture. He is represented as a person of learning and ability, High Church even to the

imputation of Popery, a friend to Catholic Emancipation, and with expectancies from the Whigs. He is grave and dignified, really kind in his feelings and address, though somewhat condescending and pompous, and, when displeased, capable of a cold and stern or "college" manner, calm and ready in times of excitement, and gifted with an admirable command of temper.

He has got up his own system well, and knows exactly what answer to give on every occasion; how far to go with the Romanists and when to part with them. He is full of the praises of Hooker, Mede, Barrow, South, Taylor, Tillotson and others; hates Puritanism as the ruin of the Church; and, in spite of his real affection for his niece, has not a very exalted notion of the theological powers of young ladies. His one great defect is what may be called impenetrableness—an absence of all heart, play of mind, and elasticity of feeling;—in short he is not a person one would by choice take as one's confessor, which makes it the more creditable in Geraldine to consult him, and, we will add, the less likely withal beforehand that he would satisfy her. However, that is not her fault, but the author's; the sole alternative given her in the story being in the warden's brother, an amiable excellent clergyman, to whom she is indebted for her first serious impressions, but deficient in the definiteness of principle, clearness of mind, and theological knowledge adapted to exercise a hold over a powerful understanding. She feels that, if she is to belong to the Church of England, it must be to the "old-fashioned Church," as she calls it, not to any modern edition of it; those who go so far as to advocate the doctrinal system of the new school in the Church, being bound in consistency to go on into dissent and liberalism, which are its legitimate results. To her uncle the warden, then, she betakes herself; and various conversations between them ensue, which end in the following most satisfactory and hopeful manner.

"Geraldine here pressed her hand to her forehead, and remained some time silent—at length she exclaimed, 'Then, uncle, I think I understand at last!—As the Church of England is, in essentials, exactly the same with the early Catholic Church of the first five centuries, inasmuch as that Church was infallible, because still pure from its apostolic founders, so also is the Church of England; but she cannot *enforce* any thing that is not proved to have been held by that early Church, and, of course, must not *deny* any thing, clearly flowing from that apostolic source.'

"'You are right, Geraldine.'

"'Well! uncle, I am satisfied; and I believe, shall be now, from this time, a very High Church woman, following strictly all the rules laid down for my practice in the 'Book of Common Prayer,' and endeavouring to recall all the wandering sheep of the flock into the one fold. My next interesting task will be the study of those pure ages in Church history, with which we claim kindred and communion: and in the meantime, I thank you, my dear kind uncle, for all your patience and trouble with me. But for you, I should have confounded our Church with the other Protestant communities; but for you, I should ere this have mistaken, as you have said, 'the reverse of wrong for right,' and have become a Roman Catholic!'"—vol. i. pp. 136, 137.

In consequence of the resolution contained in this extract, Geraldine commences the reading of Milner and Mosheim, and determines meanwhile to act up to the rules of the Church in which she finds herself. She makes a list of the fasts of the Church, and gives orders to the cook to serve up no meat upon them. She also tries to prevail on the neighbouring clergy to open their churches on week days, and to keep sacred the days of the Apostles and other saints, as prescribed. In neither project does she succeed; the fate of the former shall be set before the reader in the author's own words:

"'Blandford,' whispered the warden to his 'own man,' who stood at his post behind his master's chair at the dinner-table, 'inquire what the joint is, and where it is, and when it is to appear; I do

not understand the plan of the dinner today.' A smile passed over the face of the butler, when summoned by the grave valet to reply to the provost's inquiry; but the sense of his own official position in approaching a brother dignitary, repressed in the head of the sideboard all undue sense of the ridiculous, as he informed the astonished doctor of divinity, that Miss Carrington had expressly ordered that no joint of meat of any kind should be served up on the '*Hamper Days*!'

""Ah! what—really—oh! of course—very proper,' said the warden, with admirable presence of mind. 'Everard! a glass of wine.'

""Willingly, warden. On the strength of the '*Hamper Days*? Well!'

""The *Ember Days*,' said Geraldine, much embarrassed by the sudden college look of her uncle, and the struggling mirth which played in the countenance of Mr. Everard and Miss Graham. 'The *Ember Days* begin on this, the twenty-first of September, and used always to be kept as days of abstinence in the Church of England.'

""Why so? what was there either sinful or mournful about the *Ember Days*? cried Katharine Graham, 'was it then St. Anthony preached to the fish, that we have nothing else at table?'

""Come, come,' said Dr. Sinclair, rousing himself, 'there is plenty to eat, and a very good thing would it be, in a medical point of view, for the overfed portion of society to keep what the Anglo-Indians term a '*banyan day*,' once or twice a-week. We all eat too much, according to Cornaro.'

""Oh!' rejoined Miss Graham, 'I am sure that we can all do very well with less food, if necessary. I would often most willingly omit my dinner altogether, when I have taken no exercise. But it is the hope of propitiating God by fish and eggs, as holy food, that strikes me as so absurd. I would live on them entirely to do good to my fellow sinners; for instance, I would eat this insipid whiting every day, to ensure a good meat dinner to some poor exhausted creature; but for the salvation of my own soul! and to be, at the same time, seen of men! why, I can only quote—

'The devil must grin;
For his favourite sin
Is pride that apes humility.'

""The servants all tittered, and the colour rose painfully to Geraldine's cheeks, though, by a great effort, she preserved silence, and endeavoured to forgive—not Katharine, for from her she had never expected support, but her uncle, who had given her false encouragement by his theoretic adherence to what he shrunk from avowing practically. In his study, and amongst the fasting '*Fathers of the English Church*,' Dr. Sinclair fasted retrospectively, and was at peace. Great then was his embarrassment at being called upon to patronize the actual abstinence laid down so unmercifully in the Book of Common Prayer, and begun in all the simplicity of obedience by his niece; especially as he was aware of being too learned and noted a person in the Church not to have aroused enemies, who had already impeded his career of usefulness, by misrepresentations of the Popish twist of the learned warden of —.

'Geraldine,' said he at length, 'you remember, in the twentieth article of the Church, that 'she hath power to decree rites and ceremonies,' and therefore it may happen, that in her wisdom she may see fit to alter or abridge certain of them for the greater edification of its members. Now, although 'fasting' is warranted by the highest example and precept in Scripture, namely, that of Christ, and also of the Apostles, and therefore may be justly reckoned an article of Christian obligation, rather than a rite or ceremony, yet the appointment of certain days for the observance of

this duty is a matter of Church discipline, which may be, and has been, altered at various times, all which I will explain to you at some future period. In the interim,' added he, 'I believe you need not make us keep any more of the 'Ember Days,' although I greatly applaud your zeal for desiring to act strictly according to the supposed commands of your Church.'

"Geraldine, pleased that her uncle had spoken on the subject, and had even praised her, readily gave up the Ember fast, in the full expectation that the alteration of the appointed days would be soon pointed out to her; and she now listened with recovered spirits to the learned conversation which took place throughout the rest of the repast, between the warden and Mr. Everard, on Jewish, Mahommedan, and Pagan fasts. Thence they went off to the Brahmins, till the departure of the servants, who, having at length placed the dessert on the table, finally left the room, completely mystified on the subject of fasting, and with but one clear persuasion, namely, that of the vast learning and power over 'dictionary words' possessed by the reverend warden and his friend,"—vol. i. pp. 175-179.

This incident opened Geraldine's eyes to the fact that the warden's theology was properly speaking but a *literature*, that he knew what ought to be *said* on all occasions, but realized very little of the Anglican system in practice. And in consequence a suspicion not unnatural, however unfounded, arose in her mind concerning the reality of the said system itself, represented to her, as it was, in the person of such an advocate; a suspicion whether the distinctions and modifications and adjustments and balancings with which he handled the Protestant and Roman doctrines, were not after all but verbal, and had nothing solid, substantive, abiding, living beyond them. Certainly such a suspicion under such circumstances, it must be sorrowfully confessed, is pardonable; if, for instance, a Church prescribes days of fasting and abstinence, if it has singled out the Forty Days of lent as such, and if grave persons observe a studied neglect of these, not merely not ostentatiously fasting, but actually giving dinners and holding festivities upon them, the question at first sight will come across a thoughtful person's mind, whether the whole system is not as shadowy as the particular specimens of it before his eyes, whether it is not a mere collection of arguments, serving as a refuge and excuse against either Romanism or Protestantism, rather than the positive theology of earnest and serious minds. So far then we do not blame but rather pity our heroine; we do not blame an enthusiastic and sanguine person experiencing a certain revulsion of feeling on her disappointment, and for the moment despising and shrinking from the system which had apparently deceived her. But we think that after the first feeling was over, good sense and sobriety ought to have resumed their sway, and to have whispered to her that the faults of others had no legitimate claim to determine her duties, or influence her conduct towards sacred things; that she had set out with a determination to act up to the Church's rules; that her Oxford uncle's not doing so did not excuse her; and that in a case far graver than that which was her present trial, it had been said, "*The Scribes and Pharisees sit in Moses' seat; all therefore whatsoever they bid you observe, that observe and do; but do not ye after their works: for they say and do not.*" It will be observed that we are arguing with the author on his or her own ground; we do really admit that Oxford dignitaries neglect fasting in Lent or on Ember days; whether they do or not is nothing to the purpose, nothing to us. Geraldine and others like her should look to themselves before they look at heads of houses; even granting, for argument's sake, they did not fast, but gave dinners on fasting seasons, (which, we repeat, we grant in no other way,) they would not be acting so culpably in enjoying the good things of life, as young ladies in leaving the Church of England on account of it. Now since Geraldine did do so, and mainly because Dr. Sinclair, an individual head of a house, liked dinner in his dining-room, while upholding the duty of fasting in his library, and in spite of

her confessing she ought to act up to such rules of her Church herself, and when there was nothing to hinder her, though others did not, we must say that the author has furnished a refutation to her own book, and an Anglican critic need do nothing besides putting together a few quotations from herself. The utmost she can fairly urge in the case she has imagined, is, that the neglect of duty on the part of authorities is a sort of *excuse* and palliation of a similar neglect on our part; but surely it does not *hinder* our personal performance of it. Indeed she has written very ill-advisedly for a Romanist; for, we suppose, she does not mean to say that in Roman monasteries there has never been neglect of the rules of the Church and of their order. The process of argument which led Geraldine to leave the English Church is the very one which led many an indignant reformer in the sixteenth century to a secession from the Roman; and we presume the author would not justify *that* procedure.

It is then an impatience, and nothing but a sinful impatience, to go out of the English Church for what every believing mind may find in it. The capabilities of our actual state, in the hands of any individual who is moved to use them, are so great, that, putting duty out of the question, it is great inconsiderateness to require more than is given us. Every one may either by faith or in fact develop and realize for himself what is given us in its elements. We have the high doctrines of the Sacraments, Apostolical Succession, Confession, Absolution, Penance, Fasts, Festivals, the daily Service, all recognized as existing ordinances; what do we want but the will to bring into existence what the Prayer Book contains—a will, which, if it exists in the individual himself, will enable him either at once or with a short delay to make all these exist, at least for his own comfort. If he must have an object of ambition, let it be to raise the tone of his own communion. Surely there is as much and as pure gratification in tending piously his afflicted and oppressed mother as in leaving her for another Church, which happens on her surface to have one or two Christian institutions more formally developed, as a set-off against the serious imputations which load her. The captivity in which the English Church lies, if it hinders her from moving, at least allows her children to move more freely. Rome, in some respects more free as a Church, is more free to shackle her children; is it better to have a sick mother or an unnatural one? to be ill-treated by the Church itself, or left defenceless to the state? No; if Anglo-Catholics did but understand their position, it would be no despicable one. For ourselves, we find enough of satisfaction in it, not to be eager for any of those changes in the relation of Church to State which late political events and constitutional reforms make abstractedly fitting. What may be the duty of persons in high station in the Church is another matter; or what might be the Church's duty if her members one and all were of one mind and one judgment in all things, or what may be the duty of individuals as a matter of conscience in the event of certain contingencies; but at this moment, we conceive that Catholic truth will spread and flourish more satisfactorily under the existing state of things, than on any alteration which could be devised. We feel no desire for the meeting of Convocation; we are not even earnest in behalf of a repeal of the Statute of *Præmunire*, though it would certainly be becoming and just. We want changes of no kind, whether in the Prayer Book, or Articles, or Homilies, or Government, except any thing can be shown to us in our present state to be literally and directly sinful. We are content to take things as we have received them, and are quite sure that that system which was sufficient for the expansive minds of Andrews or Laud, has not been so circumscribed by subsequent political events, but it will hold us pigmies, however large we grow. We may like some parts of it less than others; we may conceive that some parts might be more primitive, other parts more finished; but we are thankful to have, and content to use, what has come down to us; and even where any thing has had an unsatisfactory origin, we will make the best of it, and receive it into, and assimilate it to

the glorious deposit which we inherit from the Apostles.

What we have been observing of the ritual of religion applies to matters of doctrine also; and it may be worth while to enlarge upon it, though it will carry us some little way from our immediate object. Geraldine grievously misunderstands her uncle's meaning on this head. He says, that the English Church appeals to the first five centuries; and she supposes this means that *anything* she finds an *instance* of in that period, by dipping into Mosheim or Milner, is our Church's law! But, surely, if he really represents the English Church, he does not mean that any one opinion which any one Father ever whispered or taught, is binding on our faith. If so, certainly our creed would be a worse bondage even than the Roman; for we should have to believe contradictories, and unsay one moment what we said the foregoing. Christianity has in it a great many questions which are but matters of opinion, of doubt, of surmise, in which one person may take one side, another another; which never have been and never can be determined. This is the true field for the religious exercise of private judgment; and for the duty of Christian forbearance and toleration, and this is closed up both by Protestants and Romanists. While Romanists are for settling every thing, Protestants deny there is any thing to settle; they strangely decide, for instance, not that a certain set of questions about the intermediate state *are* settled, which would be strange enough, but positively that they do not exist. They will not allow you even to ask the question about the condition, employments or the powers of departed Christians, ever so religiously, ever so historically, ever so little in the way of speculation, with ever so much deference to the opinions of holy men on the subject. They will not let you do what Augustine and Chrysostom did, and all on the plea that such a liberty has been before now abused; a mode of reasoning most contrary to the genius of the English Church, and if valid, inevitably stripping the Church Catholic of ordinances, ceremonies, usages and prayer-book, nay, used for that very purpose by Puritans and others.

Moreover we may be quite sure that a far worse evil will arise from closing the door to these matters of opinion than permitting them. The human intellect needs some play, as it may be called, and Providence has mercifully consulted this peculiarity, whether we call it a weakness or not. He has given us an innocent outlet for its busy and restless activity. We might have been told peremptorily not to let our minds expatiate at all beyond what is positively revealed; but we are not so told; and the consequence of forbidding what God has not forbidden, will be like stopping a safety-valve. The mind, obstructed in its lawful avenues of thought, will be under the strong temptation to employ itself on subjects, where thought *is* precluded, the sacred and fundamental articles of faith. The irritation of the reason being denied its natural course, will strike inwards, and fall upon vital parts; not without guilt in those who yield to the temptation; but the responsibility of those who yield is one thing, and the responsibility of those who tempt another; and we are now speaking of a procedure which really acts indirectly as a temptation. We hold, then, that these secondary questions of religion are a sort of guarantee for the immunity of the primary points; further we hold that the consideration of them accustoms the mind to the notion of mysteries or secrets in religion, and thus positively protects and disposes towards the reception of the primary points; so that the suppression of the secondary is one of the main causes which tend to lead educated men among us into Sabellianism, Pelagianism, and kindred heresies. If we are determined to admit nothing but what is clear, while we cut off secondary questions, we shall undermine primary doctrines. Such is the mistake of Protestantism: on the other hand, it is easy to see that the contrary conduct of the Roman Church, of determining these doubtful points *in one certain way*, leads to the same evil by a different road. It makes a doubt about lesser points equivalent to a doubt about greater; and thus tempts the educated mind to snap the tie of faith

altogether. Romanism tempts to infidelity, as Protestantism to Socinianism. Equally removed from both extremes, the English Church has set her children's feet, as it has been expressed, "in a large room." She has allowed ample space for diversity of minds, for varying judgments, tastes, feelings, and associations. And this is one reason why we think that Romanism will never spread in England, because whatever is good in it, whatever is adapted to the feelings of particular minds, all this we can enjoy in our Church without leaving her. It were hard indeed, if Puritanism might flourish in her, in spite of her Catholic formularies, yet that those truer elements which are concealed amid the additions of Popery, should not also be able to spring up under her salutary shadow. Mr. Everard's view of the matter is thus expressed in his conversation with Geraldine:—

"Your duty appears to me to be plainly this, remain in that community of Christians where Providence has placed you; and never think of leaving it on account of its short comings, until you shall have acted up to all that it professes to enforce. This will be but justice to your Church, and proper respect to your uncle, who is deeply solicitous on your account. Believe me, that if you really thus act up to all that your Church inculcates, you will be so nearly a Catholic, that, excepting the points of union with Rome and the sacrament of extreme unction, you will be essentially a member of the Universal Church, and need contemplate no change."—vol. i. p. 161.

The last sentence is so strangely worded that it cannot of course be literally accepted by the Anglo-Catholic, but, *mutatis mutandis*, it is true. It is true that we of the English Church have Catholicism in its truest sense in our hands, if we have but the heart and the courage to use it; and the laity have but to ask the clergy for their rights, as laid down in the Prayer Book, and they must give them. In short, to return to Geraldine, that ardent young lady need not have turned Papist in order to keep fasts and feasts, or to reverence churches, or to recognize the mystery of the Eucharist, or to reverence celibacy, or to chant psalms, or to receive absolution, in a word to hold and practise the Creed of Cyprian or Augustine.

However, Geraldine is represented as finding out that the Anglican Creed is incompatible with that of the early Church. We do not intend here to employ ourselves on so great a subject as the comparison of our Prayer Book and Articles with the writings of the Fathers; but a few words will not be out of place to show how very little fitted Geraldine, or the author, is for the comparison, how little fitted to determine what is in antiquity and what is not. Indeed facts of all kinds, ancient or modern, are, we shall presently see, very subordinate matters in this "Tale of Conscience."

Now, first, we must protest against the treatment which the second General Council has received at the author's hands. Merely, as it would seem, because it was held in the same place as the fifth, it is mistaken for it, and set down as held above 170 years after its real date. And then the importance of the matter treated in the second General Council, thus assumed to be the fifth, is urged against the English Church, which it is also assumed stops short at four. What makes the mistake more notable is, that it is administered to the innocent heroine by her venerable instructor in Romanism, Mr. Everard, while she is artlessly inquiring into the history of the Councils, and exposing and lamenting her own ignorance on the subject. She says—

"The next thing to be done is to read the acts of all the Councils, especially that of Trent, together with that previous and important one, which I always concluded to have been the most guilty, and meant to question my uncle about, namely, the Fifth General Council; for if the Church of England receives the four first as inspired by the Holy Ghost, there must have been something very particular in the Fifth, to have made the Church of England reject it ... She claims four General Councils, and, I therefore conclude, she would date the apostasy of the Ancient Church from the guilty acts of the Fifth; but, no! I am now directed on to the last General Council ever held, as the

date when the Holy Spirit no longer overruled the decisions of the Church! What then am I to think of these half-admitted, half-rejected intermediate Councils? And what became of Christ's promise to be with the rulers and pastors of his Church *always*, even unto the end of the world? I must have particulars of the Fifth Council. Where was it convoked?

“‘At Constantinople,’ replied Mr. Everard, ‘and condemned the heresy of Macedonius against the divinity of the Holy Ghost.’

“‘Now, can the Church of England venture to doubt this Council?’ inquired Geraldine; ‘Oh, she cannot, it would be impossible; *I thought the Fifth Council had been that of Constance.*’

“‘No, the Council of Constance was the Sixteenth,’ replied Mr. Everard, ‘one only intervening between it and the Council of Trent.’—vol. i. pp. 219.

Mr. Everard, the philanthropic pseudo-Catholic whom we have above noticed, should not dabble in matters which he has not studied. He finds his fair disciple in the belief that the Fifth Council is the last but two, and he sets her right by telling her it is the second; not much of an approximation to the truth, we make bold to say. But this is not all. The Council of Constance, it seems, is the sixteenth, “one only intervening between it and the Council of Trent.” It is clear from this that Mr. Everard is not an Ultramontane; else he would not so easily admit the authority of this Council of Constance which limited the Pope's power, and so far as it did so, was not confirmed by him. Bellarmine considers it as one of those which are “*partim confirmata, partim reprobata*,” that is, which are open to the objection which our heroine in the innocence and goodness of her heart only intends should apply to our Church, when she asks “*What am I to think of these half-admitted, half-rejected intermediate Councils?*” Surely Dr. Sinclair, Warden of —, may refer his niece to Cardinal Bellarmine for an answer to this interesting question. To complete the series of blunders in this one passage, Mr. Everard not only puts the Council of Constance on a par with those of Trent and Constantinople, but makes it the *last but one before* Trent though it was held 1414; thus cutting out, if not the Council of Florence 1439, at least that of Basil 1431, which, as Constance, “is partly confirmed and partly disowned,” and the fifth Lateran, which is not more than “doubtful.” If Geraldine require another variety of these half-visible, half-invisible Councils, which she thought were only found on Anglican ground, she will find it in the Council of Pisa, held a few years before Constance, which, according to Bellarmine, is “neither clearly approved nor clearly disowned.” This, then, is an interesting specimen of the reasonings by which this polemical young lady, who is determined to exercise the right of private judgment, is converted to Romanism. We would undertake by similar reasonings, if she would as frankly credit them, to make her turn Jewess or fire-worshipper, or to make her fortunes terminate in a Suttee.

Nay, without any such arbitrary power over facts, it would have been no difficult matter, we suspect, to make this young lady believe anything about antiquity she was inclined to; for she is absolutely bewildered in the jungle, as it may be called, of theology into which she has thrown herself, and makes as many mistakes in the proprieties as a country girl would commit if introduced into polished society. Surely there is something most unbecoming in youth and beauty and fashion and the rest of it being represented as mounted aloft on a library stair, and labouring under the weight of books which she was to make subservient to the settlement of her religious sentiments (vol. i. p. 139). And there is something quite ludicrous in fancying that truth could be attained by such child's play. If she had confined herself to arguments (which she also uses), such as that the English system is cold, that its devotions are meagre and heavy, that it has no authority, that it does not clearly say what it believes and what it does not, that bishops' wives dress well, and that a Protestant Sunday is the dullest day in the week, we might differ from her, but still she would have

quite as much right to her opinion as we to ours; but it is another matter when, in her controversy with the warden, instead of confining herself, to use her own illustration, to David's sling and stone, she pretends to have cut off Goliath's head (as she continues it) with his own sword. However, she does attempt this doughty undertaking, and she begins it with a malicious compliment to poor Mr. Everard, which is a suitable introduction to what follows:—

"She found Mr. Everard alone, she laid her hand on his book to gain his attention, and entreated him to hear what she had to say. The old gentleman looked up smiling, but started when he observed the swollen eyes and pale checks of his favourite, and inquired anxiously what had befallen her. Geraldine, without replying to his question, said, with forced composure, 'Mr. Everard, *I know you to be noted for your historical accuracy*; I know also that, although accused of being a dreaming speculatist on impossibilities, you are withheld by no party-feeling from seeing clearly the truth. I come therefore to tell you, and you alone, the result of my researches into Protestant Church History.'"—vol. i. p. 210.

"The result of *my* researches," as this impetuous lady most protestantly calls it, was as follows:—and let it be observed, the italics are not our doing, but hers.

"I find, during the first five centuries, first, that the Apostolical command to anoint the dying with oil, and to pray over them, was constantly observed; secondly, that an intermediate state of purification for the soul after death was an article of faith; thirdly, that the sign of the Cross was universal in the Church; fourthly, that the consecrated elements were held up to the view of the people; fifthly, that miracles attended the preaching of Christianity; and sixthly, that the prayers of the martyrs were invoked, and that supplication was made for the faithful departed. I find also that the first four Councils, which are received by our Church, *confirmed all these things, as articles of faith, against heretics*; and, in short, Mr. Everard, the perusal of these Protestant Histories of the Church has again unsettled my mind, and I am once more as miserable as when the warden arrived, and gave me temporary comfort, by holding out to me the Church of England, as the firm and gentle mother, in whose bosom I was to rest in peace."

Where Geraldine or the authoress could have picked up this piece of information, to which she has attracted attention by the italic type, we cannot even conjecture. While she was about it, she might just as soon have said that the decrees of the Council of Trent were formally confirmed by the first four Councils, or that Cardinal Pole was one of the Pope's delegates at Nicæa. It is worth observing the coincidence in conduct between Protestant and Romanist in the controversy, though after all it is but in accordance with the fundamental principles on which they respectively build their faith. The Protestant thinks it no great mistake, to throw together into one the times of Hildebrand and Leo the Tenth; and the Romanist claims the right of doing the same with the times of Cyprian and Gregory the First. And why, we would ask, should they not do so, on their view of religion? Ecclesiastical history, as they read it, is "all the same" in every age. Each system has a theological key independent of facts, by which it interprets them. Each advocates an hypothesis, contradictory indeed to the other, but at variance also with history, which lies as a *via media* between them. Each accordingly instead of going to history brings up history to its own standard, supplying from itself a complement of the history's defect or excess, reversing, discarding, straightening, or running with the course of events, as the case may require. In neither of the two is Church history supposed to present to us fixed characteristics; according to the one, it is nothing but a gradual development; according to the other, nothing but a gradual corruption; thus while they both admit, as it were the same terms in the series, they but reverse the plus and minus signs, and sum it up into contradictory results. If baptism, for instance, or the sign of the Cross, is spoken of in the

second century with reverence, the Protestant brings his peculiar theory to bear in the complacent inference that “*therefore* the rise of papal corruption showed itself *very* early;” if purgatory and indulgences are unknown doctrines at the same era, the Romanist in like manner moralizes on the “holiness of the Christian body,” which did not call for their inculcation. What matters then whether one speaks of the third or sixth century, of the eleventh or sixteenth?—they have always an answer. In the middle ages the Protestant has conjured up a Church among the Paulicians with Milner, or the Waldenses with Newton, and gives up without remorse all that is visible: one age and another are equally *bad*. With the Romanist, on the other hand, one age and another are equally *good*; he views all ages with charity as entire and as misdirected as is the Protestant’s bitter and arrogant hatred of them.

Such is their concordia discors; and between the two the history of the last and most august dispensation which Providence has given us is sacrificed to human theories, being no longer considered as the deep oracle of His counsels and His ways, but as if it could be poured out and exhausted into the cisterns of scholastic systems. Not that we would impute to the present author so grave a fault as this, but that of falling in with the tone and spirit of those who are guilty of it. She takes for granted her conclusions are right, and therefore is little solicitous about the facts of the case; they *must* come right at last. And if any one here objects to us, that every one, not profoundly learned, must do this in a measure, we answer, of course he or she must, but surely is not bound to *publish* and urge as *arguments* what he has not duly inquired into.

If it were worth while to go into the particulars of the charge which has led to these remarks, we should have still more evident proofs of the looseness and cloudiness of the author’s statements. For instance, she says that during the first five centuries, “an intermediate state of purification for the soul after death was an article of faith.” Now what is here meant by “an article of faith?”—a definite statement necessary to be believed in order to salvation? This is to oppose the current doctrine of the Romanists, who maintain that the Church may convert doctrinal truths *into* articles of faith, and that *this* is one of such, being not determined at earliest till the Council of Florence in the fifteenth century. Again, if it was an article of faith, how could it be true, as it is, that views taken of it in these early centuries *differ* from the present Roman view? Does not all this show it was an open question, a matter of opinion, a point on which the private judgment of the individual had to decide this way or that, as he best might, or that it was not then an article of faith, whether or not the Church had the right of making it one, which is a further question. And then again the author speaks, as if *all* that the Roman Church held about purgatory were, that it is a place of purification, whereas considered not as the Catholic, but as the *Latin* Church, as found among Latins, and teaching in the west, it expressly teaches in the Catechism of Trent that purgatory is a place of fire and pain as hell is¹⁸.

Our author’s under-estimation of facts in argument extends to contemporary history as well as ancient. The dreadful visitation of the cholera is only of yesterday; what happened during it our readers ought to know quite as well as she docs; yet we suppose it will be news to them to be told that the English clergy were remiss in their pastoral duties on that trying occasion. However so we are informed in the work before us, viz. that from one cause or other, principally from regard to their wives and families, they shrunk from the trial; and a romantic picture is presented to us of a Roman priest being first “hooted and pelted” with “yells and execrations” by the “ignorant

¹⁸On the history of the Roman doctrine of Purgatory, one of the latest Tracts of the series called Tracts for the Times may profitably be consulted. It is scarcely necessary to add, that Geraldine’s other alleged primitive points of faith are either founded on misrepresentation or are not denied by our Church.

and capricious mob" of a town, we believe in Staffordshire, with the connivance of "the leading people, including perhaps some even of the clergy;" then the cholera breaking out, a re-action taking place, and a notion spreading that the disease was a judgment for his expulsion and ending in his triumphant return. But this is but a poor specimen of the extent to which the author's creative powers carry her; in order to do her justice, we shall present the reader with an extract of some length.

"At the hour when the bearer of the warden's note started on his commission, the Rev. Edmund Sinclair, his beautiful wife, and four elder children were enjoying, from windows that looked not on the infected town, the calm soft air of a July morning. The fair twin girls were busily employed in some little work of fancy, while their younger brothers were equally engrossed in raising a bridge, with prepared arches and bricks sent them by their uncle, the warden. No lessons were thought on that bright morning; for it was their parent's wedding-day; and besides a promised ride each on the pony, and sundry other pleasures, a magic lantern was to wind up the evening, to which all the establishment were invited. The father of these happy ones, having finished his breakfast, reclined in a reading-chair, which was likewise the gift of the elder Sinclair, partly following the theories of a modern theological author, partly watching the labours of the little architects on the carpet, and partly endeavouring not to hear the whispered secret between his little girls and their governess, respecting the present to be made of their work to papa and mamma, before they went to bed.

"'Mamma,' at length cried one of the boys, who, despairing of the scientific arrangement of the bridge, was playing at a window, 'there is the cholera signal put up at the hall. Come here, and look: there it flies from a high window, just over the Cedars!'

"The whole party flew to the window, and Mr. Sinclair ascertained the fatal truth, that some one, perhaps his brother or niece, had been seized by the unsparing malady. At that instant the footman entered with a note from Dr. Sinclair, informing his brother that their departed sister's old and faithful housekeeper had been attacked by cholera,—that her mind was oppressed by some secret she wished to impart,—and that while she would not permit him, the warden, to attend her dying bed, she called out repeatedly for Mr. Edmund.

"As Mr. Sinclair perused this summons, his wife, eagerly leaning over his shoulder, devoured its contents. 'Thomas,' said she to the servant, while she secured the note, and plunged it into a flower vase filled with water, 'leave the room instantly, and desire the messenger from the hall to go round into the garden; we will throw the answer to him from the window.' The man obeyed. 'Edmund,' continued she, turning to watch the expression of her husband's countenance, 'you are not mad enough to listen to your brother's selfish suggestion? You surely do not believe one word of the old woman's preference for you?'

"'And why not?' replied Mr. Sinclair, 'I am her parish priest; she naturally turns to me. I have held this living, the gift of General Carrington, nine years, during which time his household have constantly attended my ministry,—they have, therefore, a claim on me for the last consolations of religion.'

"'Good heavens!' exclaimed his wife, 'do you actually think of putting yourself in the way of certain death?'

"'I must leave consequences in the hand of God,' replied he, solemnly; 'and now, my dearest Charlotte, let me entreat you not to place these constant obstacles in the way of my obvious duty. Do not forget, as, alas! you have too often done, that, in marrying one of my holy profession, you bind yourself to assist, not to retard, your husband, in his vocation.'

"'I cannot listen to preaching now, Edmund,' interrupted his wife, becoming extremely agitated.

Answer me plainly,—‘Yes,’ or ‘No,’—do you mean to go to the hall?’

“‘I do,’ replied he, and rushed to the door; but his wife had anticipated him, and, turning the lock, placed the key in her bosom, and sank on her knees before him.

“‘Charlotte, my love, I cannot submit to this,—I cannot be detained,’ cried the husband. ‘Is it not enough to have prevented every personal effort I would have made amongst the sick and dying poor, but that you would force me to deny the last request of a faithful though humble friend? Charlotte, recollect yourself,—exert more Christian strength of mind, or you lose yourself in my regard.’

“‘And what is an old servant, what is a friend, compared to your wife, to your children? what claims can equal theirs? and how can you answer to your conscience the bringing back to us this fatal malady?’

“‘God will preserve my family,’ replied Edmund Sinclair, trembling with emotion. ‘My own Charlotte, think of the vows I have taken as a Gospel minister; and remember that, if unfaithful to them, I can never expect Divine assistance.’

“‘I know not what were your vows as a clergyman, Edmund, for I never heard them,—I only know what they were as a husband; and, by those remembered vows, I hold you fast. I will not let you go. Is it thus you would ‘love and cherish me till death do us part?’ Is it thus you would desert the devoted mother of your children, or return to destroy her?’

“Mr. Sinclair here endeavoured to raise her, fondly kissing the hand he held, but at the same time turning his eyes towards the window, whence escape was perfectly feasible. Mrs. Sinclair, however, caught the direction of his looks and thoughts, and throwing her arms around him, burst into tears; while, as the wondering and tearful children gathered round them, the governess ventured to suggest, that, ‘if the warden or Miss Carrington had sent for Mr. Sinclair, it would have been painful to have refused them, but that this old woman was no relation.’

“Mr. Sinclair sighed as he replied,—‘Every soul is of equal value in the sight of God, and with Him all men are brothers. To the inmates of the hall I have bound myself as their pastor before God. My own love, be reasonable, be more than reasonable, be full of faith and trust, and the Master, whom I serve, will protect me and comfort you.’

“‘Oh! Edmund, for God’s sake do not go on talking to me in those set phrases! I know very well what the obvious duties of a clergyman are; and I am certain that carrying about the infection from house to house, is not one of them. It is your duty to obey the Government, and the Board of Health has officially commanded that the contagion should not be thus conveyed. You know all this very well, Edmund, I read you the announcement myself from the newspaper; and you also know the dissatisfaction that was expressed because the Roman Catholic priests would not obey the law of the land.’

“‘Not the law of the land, Charlotte; no punishment could attend its infraction: but now listen. I must go up to the hall, but I will not return here immediately. I will pass the night at the lodge, and then change my dress.

“‘And there die,’ interrupted the wife, ‘and see me die there, and the one yet unborn! Yes! kill us both at once, and then be satisfied that you have well fulfilled your ordination vows! Go! go!’ cried she, with hysterical vehemence; ‘go, you love me not,—you never did, and you shall never see me more!’

“Accustomed as he had long been to similar scenes, whenever bent on the fulfilment of those clerical functions in which danger to himself might be dreaded, Edmund Sinclair had never been so powerfully affected, even during the first months of his marriage. This beautiful and devoted

creature had passionately thrown herself at his feet, and her sobs echoed in his heart: he thought, also, on this their anniversary.

"The children, fully understanding that their mother was in distress, and their father in danger, joined their lamentations to hers, each little hand fastening on his dress, to force him to remain in safety, while the gentle governess again expostulated: 'Surely, Mr. Sinclair, these dear ones have the first claim on you. Excuse me, if I take the liberty to think you have, in this case, mistaken the line of duty. God can never bid you forget that you are a husband and a father.'

Mrs. Sinclair had now ceased to sob and lament; but it was not that she listened to this last appeal in her favour, for her frame, incapable of longer sustaining this highly wrought state of feeling, sank heavily on the floor, and her rebellious grief was lost in forgetfulness.

"Great God!" cried the agonized husband, as, disengaging himself from the children, he raised his apparently lifeless victim, and bore her to a couch. "Thou canst not demand the annihilation of these very affections which Thou Thyself hast blessed. Charlotte, my best treasure, I quit you not. Miss Rigby, tell the messenger from the hall that Mrs. Sinclair is too ill for me to leave her, that I send my best wishes and my blessing to poor old Goodwin, and that I entreat she will have no human preferences at such a crisis, but consent to see my excellent brother the warden. And take the children away, Miss Rigby: I wish to be left with my wife.'

"I cannot, sir," exclaimed that lady, 'the door is, you know, locked; and even, while fainting, Mrs. Sinclair still grasps the key.'

"Tears gushed into Edmund's eyes as he threw forth his Charlotte's now unresisting hand from the folds of her dress: it fell powerless, and dropped the key. The governess and children withdrew; and, no sooner was he freed from witnesses, than sinking on his knees, by the couch of his still insensible wife, and burying his face in the cushions, Edmund Sinclair gave way to the remorseful emotions of his soul,—for he had yielded to the enervating effect of earthly love, and, in the husband, lost the priest of God!"—vol. i. pp. 41-48.

This is much worse than Geraldine's confusing the second and fifth General Councils, and Mr. Everard's annihilation of the Council of Basil; it is a very shameful fabrication; but more comes presently. Not content with accusing clergymen's wives of keeping their husbands from their spiritual duties, this "Tale of Conscience," as it styles itself, proceeds to a further charge, so odious, that we almost retract what we have conjectured, and are tempted to deny that its writer is a woman. It actually accuses a clergyman's wife of teasing her husband out of a secret committed to him in confession on a death-bed, and then without a day's delay spreading it among her gossips. Now considering this must be meant to intimate what is natural and usual in the English Church, and cannot be taken as intended as an extraordinary exception to general rule, and is deliberately put on paper, not by a foreigner at a distance, but by one who has seen much of English society, or at least has taken, in some of its features, a shrewd and discriminating survey of it, we do marvel that he or she has had the heart and still more the head to prefer a charge which is as stupid as it is malicious. Why, it beats the story we have lately heard something about somewhere, of Pope Gregory and his fish-pond of infants' skulls; for what is Pope Gregory to us? and, though he was our great benefactor, still one can understand men, brought up as they are, not feeling any great sensitiveness for the honour of one who died hundreds of years before we were born, and whose existence and graces have never been thrust upon their senses by sight and touch and hearing. It is but ordinary and bearable irreverence to heap accusations upon one who after all was but a pope, considering all popes must be bad men; but with all the advantages of sight and hearing, friendly intercourse, the claims of society, and the influence of personal intimacies, thus deliberately to

sacrifice our clergy and their wives to a mere *theory*, the theory of Romanism, which requires that *facts* should be thus reversed, and the course of things turned inside out, evinces a hardihood which is characteristic of Rome, and which is too extreme and barefaced to excite any angry or impatient feeling. It is their loss who believe it.

Indeed, the authoress seems to feel she has gone too far, and shows signs of compunction; for presently we are favoured, as a set off, with a little sketch of a good parson's wife, or in the words of Mr. Everard, whose luck it has been to discover this rare jewel, "*the one* good clergyman's wife of my acquaintance," "the Protestant sister of charity," the 'reverend mother' of her "little parish."—vol. i. p. 293.

And now perhaps we have said enough to satisfy the reader's curiosity as to this tale, which has made a sensation in some circles. It contains an amusing exposure of Ultra-Protestantism; it may be useful in shaming members of our Church into a more consistent profession of its principles; it is quite harmless as a controversial defence of the Church of Rome.

ART. VIII.—Random Recollections of Exeter Hall in 1834-1837. By one of the Protestant Party. London: Nisbet. 1838.

[*British Critic*, vol. 24, July 1838.]

RELIGION is a social principle; it cannot exist without fellow-feeling, nor can fellow-feeling be maintained without assemblies and celebrations. It is very well to maintain its more private and personal nature in a treatise for the closet or a discussion to serve a purpose; but the notion of strictly independent, secret, isolated religion is unreal and theoretical. He who believes in a Maker and Governor believes that he is Maker and Governor of others besides himself; and (if we may so parallel the sacred text) he who regards Him who made, regards them also who are made by Him. And, moreover, in a world of sin, the current of which runs strongly against the voice of conscience, and the high but delicate instincts of truth and purity, human nature, conscious of its weakness, will ever, in mere self-defence, look out for sympathy and co-operation in its arduous duty of maintaining what is unseen against what is seen.

When then men talk of religion being a secret thing between each man and his Maker, as being too sacred for co-operation, and too peculiar and individual for sympathy, they are either letting their words outrun their ideas or they are mere sceptics and men of the world, catching at any excuse which offers and promises well, in order to get rid of a subject they do not like. Men who are well content with things visible, and wish to frame the materials which this world supplies into a perfect system, who have their *summum bonum* upon earth, and who feel that it is attainable by means which are of earth, consider the religious principle as nothing more or less than a principle of disorder, as the cause of infinite disarrangements and perplexities in that view and method of life which they would fain pursue; and the religious element in our nature as a troublesome and vexatious phenomenon, which they cannot deny to exist, and to require satisfying, though they console themselves by a plain denial of its being a primary or essential part of our nature, or more than the result of education and association, and accordingly do their best to bribe it into quietness as cheaply and as expeditiously as they can.

Such is the case with those who deny that religion is a social principle, because they wish it expelled from society; but others, and the mass of persons, who deny it, deny it in theory only, for party reasons, from bad education, or from other unsatisfactory causes; and they convict themselves of inconsistency, and show that they are using words for ideas, by forthwith proceeding to act against their own doctrine. They resolutely maintain that each individual man must be ultimately

dependent for his religious opinions on himself; and yet in spite of this, by societies, and meetings, and tracts, and united movements, and celebrations, they do bring to bear upon him an extrinsic and external influence, an authority distinct from the sacred volume and from his personal and private inquiry into it, and calculated to overawe and to over-persuade him. They set up a power, the same in kind as the visible Church, to impress and seduce his imagination, in advance or in prejudice of his reason. In theory they maintain the right of private judgment, and the supremacy of Scripture without note or comment; yet by all the enthusiasm of social feeling and all the excitement of a struggle, by those means which the Church uses openly and avowedly, they strive, without avowing them, to oppose them when avowed, to oppose them in the Church.

Even a system (of external *worship* we cannot call it, but) of ceremony and circumstance, is in course of formation, at the shell of testaceous animals, being at once the development and protection of that New Religion, which it has been the fashion among us of late years to substitute for the Ancient Faith. By the ancient religion we mean that which Popery corrupted; by the new religion we mean that which Luther founded in his new definition of faith, and his new dogma, that justification by faith only is the one fundamental truth of the Gospel. The old religion had its pageants, rites, and festivals; and the spirit of destruction which has been unchained in these last centuries declared that such observances were heathenish and idolatrous. The old religion had, or rather it has, its discipline, its monuments, and its ritual, as (by a good Providence) they are still preserved to us; and these were, or rather still are, represented by its enemies as unlawful persuasives, yokes, beggarly elements, instruments of bondage, or rags for the vanity fair of the great Babel. It had its solemn services; and what were these forsooth but mummeries, the fruit of idle legends, of pious frauds, representations *ad captandum*, evil doings that good might come, or exaggerations of what was true, or occasions of unduly exalting individuals, some poor, frail, and fallible being, who after all was but a man of like passions with the rest? It had its religious societies; and what were these but unscriptural, because not prescribed in Scripture? It had its convocations of clergy; and how could a hundred heads be infallible when laid together, when each separately was not so? It had its processions and litanies, and what were these but accurate and deliberate copies of Pagan customs? The most virtuous feelings were displayed, and the most touching delicacy, and the most jealous indignation at religion, which is a thing of the heart, being made so outward, so unspiritual, so unchristian.

It is said that nature will always revenge herself when outraged, and what is true of nature in the general holds good also as regards her religious workings. This pseudo-evangelicism, which is so alarmed at undue influences and yokes of bondage, is now acting over again, only with new dresses, what in many times and places it has already performed since Calvin set up his platform at Geneva. After destroying forms it is introducing others, which bear the same relation to the true ones as the tyranny of a usurper to the legitimate authority of the dethroned monarch. Well, indeed, were it for this king of the barricades if it could assume the venerable character of a father and judge; but, as was to be expected, being set up in rebellion, it has no where been able to preserve reverence, and for no long while to maintain even order. And at the present day, and among ourselves, it presents perhaps the most singular aspect which it has yet shown, and to which the small volume we have prefixed these remarks will enable us to direct attention. While it still retained in its bosom some of its mother's warmth and its mother's fear, there was a sort of solemnity and seriousness in its movements. The Puritans were not triflers, nor the Covenanters cowards; but now, in a time of prosperity, when there is little to season our faith, and of scepticism, when there is much to sap it, while it professes more than ever the pomp of externals, and the impressiveness of combination,

yet (most remarkable it is) it has stripped these instruments of influence, almost altogether of their sacred character, aims at religious objects by means which do not even pretend to religion, offers to God "the sacrifice of fools," and pleads for Him in the garb of the world.

The old religion thinks it scorn to appear before men except as God's minister. Its outward forms are but the type of what it is within. Within it is calm and serene, as the sea spread before the throne of God, reflecting in its bosom the stars of heaven and giving to view "the jewels of the great deep" which lie beneath. And such as this is the garb which, at its Master's command, it has put on from the beginning. Though its coat was of many colours, yet it was woven from the top throughout; though made with much cunning work and many a curious device, yet it was "fine linen, clean and white," like the inward "righteousness of saints." Such was the sanctity, the comeliness, the gravity of those ancient forms, which as being imbued with what they represented resembled it, and while they resembled it promised it. The order of the ministry, the descent and relationship of the churches, the ritual of worship, the precepts for governing, evangelizing, protesting, suffering, all spoke of that inward heaven which exists in its degree in the soul of every true Christian, and has its perfect unapproachable prototype in that of his Divine Master. What Christians were in private in the beauty of holiness, such were they when they met together in one, each member knowing his own place, as each faculty of his soul its own function. In the religious man, reason, will, conscience, affections, and passions do not struggle together, or settle in some compromise or "social compact" one with another; but each recognizes and takes what is its own by nature. And, in like manner, if we would see what true social religion is, we must betake ourselves to the various forms in which it is presented to us in antiquity, and not the least to that form which was the most formal and august of all, and the type of all in their several degrees, its synodal meetings. We shall betake ourselves, for instance, to Eusebius, and there read the account of the great Nicene Council: how the Emperor of the World provided for the Bishops a great hall in his palace, in the capital of Bithynia, where above 300, from all parts of the world, assembled at his charge; how they seated themselves each in his place in silence, waiting his arrival, and how, when he entered robed in his imperial purple, he gravely stood in the middle of the fathers till they called on him to take his seat. Or we may consult the following formulary for the opening of a Spanish council, which Mr. Keble has lately printed from Hardouin.

"At the first hour of the day, before sunrise," says this document, "let all be cast out of the Church, and the entrances being barred, let all the door-keepers stand at the one door, through which the prelates are to enter. And let all the bishops assembling go in together, and take their seats according to the time of their consecration. When all the bishops have come in and taken their places, next let those presbyters be summoned whose admission the nature of the case in hand seems to warrant; and let no deacon intrude himself among them. After these may be admitted the more eminent among the deacons, whose presence is required by the regular form of proceeding. And a circle being made of the bishops' seats, let the presbyters sit down behind them; those, namely, whom the metropolitan has selected to be his successors, such of course as may act with him both in judging and pronouncing sentence. Let the deacons stand in sight of the bishops; then let the laity also enter, who, by choice of the council, have obtained the privilege of being there. Moreover, the notaries must also come in, as is directed by the regular form, for reading documents and taking notes. Then, the doors being fastened, and the prelates sitting in long silence, and lifting up their whole heart to the Lord, the archdeacon shall say,—'Pray ye!' and presently they shall all fall on their faces to the earth, as well the bishops as the presbyters: and they, continuing long in silent prayer, *with weepings and moanings*, one of the *elder* bishops shall arise, and pronounce a

supplication aloud unto the Lord, they all lying still on the ground ... The supplication being ended, and all having answered 'Amen,' the archdeacon says, 'Stand ye up.' Immediately let all arise, and *with all fear of God and orderly discipline*, let bishops and presbyters both take their seats. And thus, all in their places, sitting silently, a deacon, *wearing the albe*, bringing forward in the midst the Book of the Canons, reads aloud the chapter on the manner of holding councils ... And the extract from the Canons being ended, the metropolitan bishop shall address the council with an exhortation."—*Keble. Postscript to Sermon on Tradition*. p. 86.

Or if we would see how matters were conducted in the very rudiments of the Church, we may read in the book of Acts how "the *apostles and elders*," the bishops and priests, "came together to consider of" a matter in dispute, and "the *multitude*" or laity "*kept silence*," "*giving audience*" to their superiors in the Church; till after discussion ended, the presiding apostle summed up and gave judgment, and then all together, bishops, clergy, and laity drew up a declaration founded upon it. These are different forms of one and the same orderly discipline, types of one and the same inward harmony; of what St. Paul calls the Church's "order and steadfastness of faith." On the other hand, if we would know what kind of proceeding was *not* Christian, we shall find it in Tertullian's well known description of the heretical assemblies, which will stand as a specimen of many besides it, which the early writers contain. "They are destitute," he says, "of gravity, of reverence, of rule, so as to correspond with their creed. First, who is catechumen, who believes, does not appear; one and all are admitted, one and all hear, one and all pray; nay, though the heathen were to come in, they would cast their holy things to dogs, and their pearls, their false pearls, to swine. This break up of discipline they call simplicity; our care of it they call corruption. Moreover, they are friends with all persons promiscuously; no matter what their private differences, so that they can combine together against the One Faith. They all are pompous, all consider themselves enlightened. Their catechumens are perfect first, and taught afterwards."—*De Præsc. fin.*

Such is the difference between the outward forms of truth and falsehood in the high and public functions of teaching and propagating the faith; and what it is on the largest scale, such is it in all, however reduced, wherever there is combination for religious ends. If, on the other hand, we would know what it is in private and individual duties, we shall detect truth by the same marks of simplicity, sobriety, staidness, and sanctity. What the ceremonial of a Synod is to a body of Christians, such is the ceremonial of prayer, fasting, and almsgiving, as the most Sacred Authority enjoins them, to the private Christian; such is the vision of charity and humility as developed and typified in the Apostle's instances of "attending on strangers," "washing the saints' feet," and relieving the afflicted;"—duties all of them of a severe and grave character, bearing upon them the impress of the inward principle from which they spring. And of a like solemn nature have hitherto been the outward forms of every popular religion, true and false; they have been *religious* forms. Far different is the religion which has become popular in this day. It is its peculiarity, that, though professing to be very high and warm and influential, it acts by instruments which do not even affect seriousness or reverence. For washing the saints' feet it has substituted charity bazaars, and for synods it has its May meetings; so that it is scarcely too much to say, that as former ages of the Church have been called, one the gnostic age, another the scholastic, another the synodal, this, in like manner, has earned the title of the *sæculum jocularis*.

One phenomenon, indeed, is found amid the Ultra-Protestantism of this day, which certainly has a deep and earnest character; but has not yet made way in the body of the English community—and may it never!—We allude to the observance, habit, occurrence, or by whatever more suitable name it is to be called, of Revivals, as they exist on the other side the Atlantic. Something, indeed, of

the kind seems to flourish among the Wesleyans in some parts of this country; but their proper field has hitherto been North America,—in those vast regions where the Church is not, or sits in feebleness as a stranger or outcast, where a Christian people are like sheep without a shepherd, and where Christian life is a fever, an ague, or a spasm, barely sustaining itself by such intermittent and convulsive throes, which, in a state, of healthy action, are but a disarrangement, not an exercise of its functions. Long, indeed, may such dreary and miserable exhibitions be confined to the “dry places” in which they originated, the solitudes of heresy and sectarianism; and speedy, so be it! may the deliverance of the poor captives be from the iron yoke which their forefathers have forged for them, instead of the “light burden” of the Church Catholic. But still, after all, such manifestations are of a religious nature; they correspond to the object from which they profess to arise; they speak about serious things in a serious tone; they carry upon them marks of enthusiasm, moral power, nay, and sometimes issue in permanent fruits. They cannot raise a smile; they excite respect, fear, sorrow, compassion. Far removed, as they are, from the sweet and equable calmness of the Church, yet they are an approximation to her temper, so far as this, that they indicate earnestness. Such then is the most favourable specimen at this day, under which, what may be called the ceremonial of the New Religion presents itself, as seen in America; but here, while it cannot dispense with forms and festivals, any more than across the water, one need not look very far to be convinced that its principle, as it exists, is not deep enough to be dark, nor vehement enough to be troubled, nor real enough to be violent. It has not life enough in it to give birth to deeds of the same nature as its professions. While in America it has developed itself in the hideous reality of revivals, it supports an artificial existence here on such expedients as have been mentioned, upon the mirthful, brilliant, and varied paraphernalia of charity bazaars and May meetings.

Now here we must make ourselves clearly understood, lest we convey an impression which we do not mean. When we condemn these instruments of religious undertakings, we have no intention whatever of implying any thing disrespectful towards this or that individual who engages in them, whether as provider or purchaser, speaker or listener. If, indeed, such things are evil, as we verily believe them to be, evil of course there must exist some where or other, in those who take part in them, whithersoever we shift or however we divide the blame; but there are very many at all times, perhaps the majority, who take those forms of religious operations which they find at hand, as the menus of their own exertions, and have no time, no opportunity, no taste for inquiring whether these are the best possible, or intrinsically defensible. The most venerated names have before now appeared on the platform of religious societies; the kindest hearts have worked for bazaars; the most innocent curiosity, and the most guileless zeal have listened to the speeches which Scotch or Irish talent circulates through the country. We feel all this most fully; and should be sorry to seem to feel otherwise; and yet we maintain that, although there be some who, as they did not cause, so are not hurt by the evil they take part in, still in the majority this hearing, speaking, buying, and vending, either originates or results, more or less, in that lower and less religious state of mind which is the soul of the system itself.

Dropping then individuals, and looking simply at the system, which they support, we see in this day this remarkable fact, that the New Religion, while it has recourse to externals, shrinks from religious externals. Much might be said in illustration from the case of charity bazaars, did our present subject lead us to consider it. Certainly it infuses sad suspicion that such methods of raising money are an evidence of the decay of genuine piety. What have the elegant nothings displayed on such an occasion to do with contributions for the serious matters of Church building or supporting hospitals? What do they intimate, when rightly interpreted, but this,—that bare charity or piety

is too austere and imperative for men of this generation; and that Christians will not submit now to be beguiled of their alms or offerings, except by sweetening an unpalatable duty? Were they, indeed, but *additional* to large sacrifices freely made on the altar of Christian love, they might be taken as specimens how to convert *all* we do and are, even the elegancies of life, to the service of religion; but, being what they are, and working as they do, assuredly they are not a raising of the world to the Church, but a degradation of the Church to the world. And, moreover, were the subject before us, much might be said of the potent influence exerted on such occasions by the young ladies who oftentimes take their station at the booths and vend their charity. Aged bishops are said, of old time, to have exerted an arm of force, and to have compelled others to enjoy the privileges, and undertake the duties of the Christian Church;—but now-a-days, bright eyes and tasteful bonnets are found more effective, and, though we do not pretend to be connoisseurs in the matter ourselves, we certainly have read in the public prints that, whatever their advantage in the ball-room our charming countrywomen never look so well as in a morning dress.

And, while the bazaar is the realm of feminine beauty, the platform is the region of manly eloquence, and still with the same object of propagating religion by means not religious. The societies which are there advocated are engaged always in benevolent, often in the most sacred and serious religious objects; this should be attentively considered. The Bible Society is formed for giving to individuals the sacred volume, which moreover it considers to be the one means of spiritual life. The Church Missionary Society is for the conversion of the heathen; the Jews, as its name denotes, for that of the once chosen people; the Reformation Society for withstanding errors which their agents in their printed papers declare to be worse than paganism. Objects higher and more momentous cannot be conceived; and individual speakers confess that they are such, and treat them accordingly; and yet, on the whole, strange to say, the anniversary and other meetings, which are the most formal image of these societies, are essentially not religious. They cannot be made religious, for the attempt to make them so would be the signal for private judgment to insist through a thousand separate voices upon a thousand separate varieties of creed or form; and they *will* not be made religious, because their supporters hold that what inspires respect is a degradation of religion, a superstition and a mummary, and that forms are only safe when variable and secular. The temple of this new system is Exeter Hall; its holytide is “the London season;” its chancel is a platform; its cathedral throne is the chairman’s seat; its ministers are the speakers; for holy salutations it uses “Ladies and Gentlemen;” for benedictions it has “cheers;” for a creed it maintains the utility of combination; and for holy services and godly discipline it proclaims civil and religious liberty throughout the world.

If we seem to have said more than the case warrants, we beg objectors to suspend their judgment till they have read the little book which has given occasion to our remarks, or at least such extracts as we are proceeding to lay before them. It consists of a series of lively and graphic descriptions of the leading speakers in Exeter Hall, for the sake of those who, not being resident in London, “have no opportunity,” as it says, “of becoming acquainted with their manner, style, and appearance;” in the number of which occur names, which are little worthy of the notoriety it has given to them, and towards which men of the most opposite views must feel a reverence not to be destroyed even by Exeter Hall. At the same time we are bound to say that, except in one or two instances, there is nothing ill-natured in the author’s pleasantry; he seems to have had no intention of doing more than drawing an entertaining sketch of what takes place in the great meetings of the religious world, and to have been most benevolently inclined to the actors in them whom he describes. If he is satirical, he cannot help it; it is the fault of his subject. Indeed, the tone of his volume, if we

are right in estimating it, is a curious illustration of the point which we bring its contents to prove. He seems, that is, to have set about his task with a high notion of what he undertook to relate; but having not a grain of reverence for a system which is not calculated to impart any, and writing as people write, when they think they may make themselves at home with their subject, he has, without intending or fully knowing it, drifted off from seriousness to satire, and from praise to blame, leaving the reader quite at a loss how to draw the line between these opposites, or how far he means the one, how far the other. Ridicule certainly is not the test of truth; the most serious things may be made ridiculous. Exeter Hall and its religion would not be a joke merely because a lively pen had made them so. But when a professed admirer cannot help unawares passing from panegyric to mockery, then the suspicion does fairly cross one, whether such a result is not the legitimate termination of the system, and the person instancing it is not merely following out the *reductio ad absurdum* which fairly attaches to it.

The author's own state of mind is most singularly illustrated by his Title-page, Dedication and Introduction. He calls his book "*Random Recollections of Exeter Hall, by one of the Protestant Party.*" Is this joke or earnest? Again, his Dedication is to "Mrs. ———, one of the *best of women* and tenderest of mothers, these pages are inscribed as a token of filial love." This of course is most serious earnest; yet surely not of the most respectful kind. And again, he says he has "thrown together some recollections of several among the principal characters *who appear before the audiences* of Exeter and Freemasons' Hall, or the Hanover-square Rooms;" or in other words, we suppose, who "appear" on the London (religious) boards "before" over-flowing houses. And he has been led to do so by a publication called "*Random Recollections of the House of Lords.*" The House of Lords is a most august assembly; but we never heard it claimed as a religious one; nor do we see that, if its members may be treated in a "random" way, that therefore the same treatment may be applied to those who take part in high religious matters, such as the propagation of Christianity and controversy with the Romanists.

With this introduction of the author let us first avail ourselves of his description of the large room of Exeter Hall itself.

"The large room of Exeter Hall was built to contain 4000 persons, with a splendid range of raised seats, to the left of the main entrance, a spacious area in front of it, and a platform, which of itself will accommodate 500 persons, to the right. At the back of the platform were formerly two sunk galleries, like the side-boxes of a theatre, which were opened or closed at pleasure, by means of moveable planks, which may be put aside during the progress of a meeting. They are now thrown completely open. The platform itself is elevated about six feet above the floor of the area, or central seats, and is finished in front by a handsome iron rail; the large and ornamental bars of which, placed about one foot from each other, are connected at top by a thick mahogany spar. In the centre of its front row stands the chair, which in form much resembles that of King Edward the Confessor, in Westminster Abbey. It is of handsomely carved mahogany, with massy open elbows, and is cushioned, in the seat and back, with purple leather. Its dimensions are very large, and any gentleman of small, or even of moderate size, who may preside, can never be said to *fill* it. Very few chairmen appear to advantage there; some seem lost in it, others, at a loss how to occupy it, and where to sit in it, whether backwards or forwards, upright or lounging, to the right or to the left. Those who have seen it tenanted by Lord Winchelsea, will agree that few sit there with greater dignity, or appear more advantageously to themselves.

"To the right and left are common mahogany chairs for the speakers, and behind these are rows of high-backed benches, rising gradually above each other, and intersected by two flights

of steps, which extend from the front row up to the entrances at the back. At upper corners are covered staircases, communicating with these entrances, the tops of which formerly joined the sunk galleries, and were often occupied by rows of ladies, more adventurous or less punctual than the rest. The platform is nominally appropriated to gentlemen, but the more curious sex seldom fail to get admittance there, in limited (or sometimes in large) numbers.”—pp. 7-9.

“When the room is quite filled, the finest view of it is from the deep recesses behind the platform. The scene visible from thence is truly magnificent. Below you lies the platform, slanting downwards, and, extending into a crescent shape, with its crowds, sitting or standing; beyond them is the large flat surface of the area, its close benches all filled, and the avenues among them occupied by chairs, or by persons who are fain to stand, for want of sitting-room. Behind this are the raised seats, gradually appearing one behind another, and equal to half the size of the whole room; all again fully crowded, and the descending steps among the benches filled by the standing multitude. Over their heads, the whole scene is crowned by the back gallery, at a height of many feet, behind the crimson draperies which extend among the pillars, and this is completely full also. Those who wish to realize the saying of “a sea of heads,” should take this view of Exeter Hall, on some popular occasion. When such an assembly rises, for prayer or praise, at the beginning or end of a meeting, the sight is still more stupendous; and the degree of sound they are able to produce, in the way of cheering or singing, is almost incredible. There have been occasions when that vast room has rung with the voices of those assembled within its walls; and a second peal of cheers succeeding, before the echoes of the first have died away, the noise altogether has been of a nature that few persons could bear unmoved.”—pp. 10, 11.

Under this, it seems, there is a second room for meetings, and the inconvenience resulting is thus described:—

“The plaudits of the upper and larger audience frequently drown the voices of those who are addressing the smaller one below; as they are situated immediately under the right side of the large Hall. Should the applause over-head not be very loud, it seems to arise from the lower room, and many an inexperienced speaker has paused for his hearers to cease their cheers, when in reality the noise came from above, and had no reference to him whatever, but was addressed to some orator upstairs, perhaps expressing opinions diametrically opposed to his own.”—p. 13.

A sketch of the Hanover-square Rooms, which follows, adds the effect of light and shade to the above descriptions.

“There is much of the private drawing-room style about it, which might keep a less polished auditory in good order; but the sex and station of those who fill the chief part of the place are so unfavourable to loud acclamations, or any noise whatever, that stranger-speakers are sometimes quite daunted at the silence in which they are heard; and mistaking the well-bred attention bestowed upon their addresses for indifference, they seem to long for the tumultuous approbation of Exeter Hall. A few friendly cheers on his rising and his concluding, a gently swelling murmur of applause, or a subdued laugh during his speech, are all that an orator at the Hanover Rooms must expect to call forth. I think I have never heard a hearty, noisy round of cheers bestowed there upon even the most popular favourites of the day, those who would elsewhere have been received with a deafening uproar of delight.”—p. 14.

But, to return to Exeter Hall.

“The conformation of the Hall is not favourable to the larger class of human voices, and there are but few speakers who make themselves well heard throughout the room: the generality speak too low, or have too little power of lungs to be heard far beyond the centre of the area; while others,

who almost deafen the sitters near them, are equally unintelligible to those at a distance, from the echo of the place itself. Thus the gentle speeches of Lords Cholmondely and Chichester, and the thundering oratory of Dr. Duff are nearly all alike pantomime to the occupants of the raised seats; though from diametrically opposite causes, for the Doctor speaks just as much too loud as their Lordships' voices are too low. Perhaps Lords Winchelsea and Roden, Captain W. Wellesley and Mr. J. E. Gordon, are four of the most universally audible speakers we have. Their voices, though widely differing from each other, are all loud, clear, and equal-toned, and may be well heard from an upper raised seat, or even from the gallery; while, in order to hear agreeably an address from Mr. John Hockin, I should prefer to be in one of the outer passages, or perhaps even in the Strand itself."—pp. 16-17.

The various feelings under which the audience are brought together are next described; and we insert the passage to show how much in earnest the author is on the whole, a fact which needs impressing again and again on the reader's mind, while he turns over the pages which follow.

"Perhaps the truth may be more accurately stated by saying, that although many among the hearers, especially the younger part of them, may be drawn together by the love of a holiday, a crowd, and some fine speaking, with a peep at public proceedings, yet numbers who attend the anniversaries of our societies are attracted thither chiefly, if not solely, by a desire of information as to the progress of religious and moral truth, and the wish to improve their own zeal by kindling their torches from those of the most devoted servants or Missionaries of the Cross.

"Of these latter exemplary persons, it will not be too much to say, that though some of them, unknown to their hearers, and it may be, unknown to themselves, may cherish within them feelings of self-complacency, or a desire to shine in the public eye; yet the major part, whether noblemen, clergymen, or others, are simple-hearted, straight-forward benevolent men, whose chief desire, in addressing public assemblies, as well as in the other actions of their lives, is to spread civilization and Christianity among their fellow-creatures, and to promote the worship and the glory of their God."—pp. 19, 20.

The volume is divided into six chapters, in which are successively discussed "Noble Speakers," "Clerical Speakers," "Parliamentary Speakers," "Naval and Military Speakers," and "Various Lay Speakers;" among which are to be found, the Duke of Newcastle, Lords Cholmondely, Roden, Brougham and Ashley, Rev. Baptist Noel, Drs. Cooke and Croly, Rev. Messrs Wolff and Cunningham, Mc Ghee and O'Sullivan, Benson and Beamish, Mc Neile and Bickersteth. A short account is given of their person, manner, dress, attitude, voice, and style of speaking, and of any special occasion which has distinguished them for the better or the worse. The delineation is not only playful and good natured, but displays a good deal of nice discrimination, and is very little overcharged. Incidentally too it brings out the peculiarities of the place to which it relates; and is a most conclusive witness to two points concerning these meetings, which were antecedently to be expected; first, that their end and object as meetings, is not an act of thanks or praise where it is due, not a contemplation of religious subjects, not even the spread of information on religious subjects, but an exhibition of persons and oratory; and *through* this the advancement of such ulterior ends as have better claim to a religious parentage. Publicity and money are gained for the objects to which the respective societies are devoted on the consideration of a certain quantum of entertainment given or received,—on the terms of seeing a number of noble and other personages, and hearing a number of celebrated or eloquent speakers. And next, as was to be expected, it clearly appears that variety and novelty are principal conditions of these exhibitions, whether they be secured by the judicious admixture of Scotch and Irish eloquence, or of men of rank and men of name, or of old

favourites and of strangers, and of native Englishmen and South Sea Islanders or Kamschatkans.

The author, as we have seen, is anxious to supply for those who do not live in London some portion of that treat, which none but Londoners can fully obtain; and therefore serves up before his readers a number of distinguished persons from various professions and ranks of life. Men are hard to please; we suspect some will be angry that they are left out in the bill of fare; but we are quite sure there are others who will be disgusted at being inserted. However, it is the fashion of the day to sacrifice private property to what may be called the railroad system; and we at least who profess no acquaintance with Exeter Hall are gainers by our author's adoption of it. But for this volume we should not know that Lord Downshire's "eyes are blue with an expression of gravity, his nose long and somewhat sharp, but the greatest peculiarity of his countenance is a nervous twitch in its muscles when he speaks. It gives you the idea *that the right side of his face is jesting with one half of his audience, at the expense of the other*, upon the sentence he has just uttered."—p. 30. Nor would they know that Lord Roden's "gesture is energetic, sometimes vehement, and without much variety," consisting "chiefly of a *powerful wielding of the arm*."—p. 32; nor of Lord Winchelsea, that "the first remark you would make on seeing him is, '*How clean he looks*,' and the second, '*How honest!*'"—p. 37; nor that his action consists in "a short start back, an indignant stamp with the foot, and a repelling motion of the right arm, with a *most indescribable energetic shake of the whole person*."—p. 39; nor that while he declares the "zeal for the good cause which burns within his breast," "he bestows, at the same moment, a *far-fetched stroke, like that of a sledge hammer*, which would nearly destroy a less firmly built frame than that which receives it."—p. 40; nor that Lord Chichester's "hair is dark brown, long and bushy, as well as his whiskers, and as he often dresses in a suit of the same shade," he sometimes looks "as nearly as possible *all of one colour* from head to foot."—p. 42; while his speeches "are of that quiet, *pious* kind which are best described by the common saying, 'It is *as good* as a sermon to hear them.'"—p. 43; nor that "a speech from Lord Mount Sandford is very much like what he often describes himself to have been in his youth, 'a *harum-scarum chap*.'"—p. 54.

Equally interesting and not more reverent are his descriptions of reverend speakers. Of Mr. Baptist Noel he says, "Whatever be his subject, he always touches it with the same accomplished refinement. *I have heard him describe a meal on the hind leg of a kangaroo* with as much grace and dignity as he would have dwelt on the destiny of an empire."—p. 78. On the other hand, the Master of the Temple is said to be "the *coldest looking man* I ever saw; not cold in feeling but in bodily aspect. He seems as if he had been frozen up, and was endeavouring to regain his vital warmth."—p. 85. Again, we learn that Dr. Croly "is built in the Cyclopean style of architecture;" that his gait, movements, expressions, ideas, are all in the gigantic style; that there is something vast and mysterious about him; that "his countenance has a strange antique appearance, well according with the antediluvian kind of majesty which clothes his figure;" that he is like "a thoroughbred gentleman just come from the moon;" that "to comprise his general exterior in a few words, *he is very like a brother of the Three Fates from the Parthenon*."—pp. 87-91. Dr. Croly is drawn not only as an orator on the platform but in the pulpit, where ordinarily "he stands nearly motionless, or, resting his hands on the sides of the pulpit, *he swings to and fro, with his head projected forward, almost in the manner of a Roman catapult on its side supports*."—p. 89. Of Dr. Duff, of the scotch Kirk, we are told that he is "the *brightest star* that has appeared in the mouth of May for some years. No single speaker attracted so much attention, nor *drew forth such perpetual plaudits* during the last season."—p. 95.

The variety of these sketches is not their least merit, as we have prepared our readers to expect.

Different from all the foregoing speakers is the celebrated Mr. Wolff. We are informed that "he is far from tall, and his person is very stout. His hair is of a deep red colour, very thick and long, often falling on his collar;" his complexion is very dark, his eyes small and twinkling, his English unintelligible to many ears, his utterance rapid and his delivery in a shrill chanting tone.

"His action is wild and exuberant in the extreme: he frequently assumes a kind of dancing movement, holding up both his arms to their full extent, and shaking all his fingers; then he clasps his hands on his breast, and steps quickly backwards and forwards; then, perhaps, lays hold of some friend, whom, in the warmth of the moment, he almost embraces, immediately starting away with a loud exclamation, and renewing his dancing action."—p. 102.

Mr. Stowell, of Manchester, presents a remarkable contrast with this singular man. "His face is large and broad;" "his eyes blue and laughing," and "his mouth, which is very wide, *garnished with splendid white teeth*." We are told that "his images are striking, sometimes rather coarse, and his style often the most jocular, *even to broad comic effect*;" that "no speaker more frequently *sets the Hall in a roar*," and that it is a question "which makes the most noise in proportion, Mr. Stowell or his audience."—pp. 112, 113. We are further told,

"Those who have heard Mr. Stowell will allow that no man is more completely calculated for popularity among mixed audiences. His zeal for the Established Church, his vehement Protestantism, his free, strong mode of speaking, his loud voice, merry face, and humorous anecdotes, give him a perpetual untiring interest with them. He appears every year, and at almost every meeting, yet no man is a greater favourite; they are never wearied with applauding him, and always cheer him rapturously."—pp. 113, 114.

Other sketches are equally brilliant, as of "*that splendid binary star, M'Ghee-and-O'Sullivan*;" of Mr. Cumming, with a person not exceeding five feet four or five," and a "complexion resembling alabaster with a deep damask colour;" of "good Mr. Seymour," who tosses his head up and down, when speaking, with such animation, that a young lady observed, that he looked "as if *he had been half scalped by the Indians*, and had forgotten to have it fastened down again;" of Sir Andrew Agnew, whose features express "*despair*," and who confesses "in a piteous tone" that he is "accounted the offscouring of all things;" of Sir Edward Parry, who "looks emphatically a *fine fellow*;" of Captain Gordon, whose voice is heard "distinctly above the tumult of two or three hundred men," and who "seems as if *he could out-roar a lion as easily as he would out-argue a Jesuit*;" and of Mr. Stewart, (whom no one can mention without regretting that he with other excellent men should appear in such mixed company,) who "has a way of rising on tiptoe, with his arms elevated above his head, which has a peculiar effect, especially with his long, slender figure, and in this position he moves very much as if he were going to take wing and fly away."—p. 124. But we must not allow ourselves to enlarge on these and other inviting topics, lest room should be wanting for two or three extracts at length, which will give a much more vivid idea of the state of the meetings and the impressions they create than any thing that has yet been said.

The first shall be "*one of the perpetual favorites of our London audiences*, the Rev. H. H. Beamish, Minister of Trinity Chapel, Conduit Street."

"His popularity as a speaker is indeed well merited, for his talents are as varied as they are delightful; and in the two opposite departments of the pathetic and the humorous he has but few superiors.

"In person he is about five feet nine or ten inches high, and stout, but not inelegant, with a handsome countenance and a very gentleman-like aspect. His hair is dark and thick, his complexion good, and his features well cut. He has dark blue eyes, full of the most vivid and various expression;

I seldom see him without thinking of the poet's address to his country—

“Erin! the smile and the tear in thine eyes

Blend like the rainbow that hangs in thy skies.

“And not only is this the case with Mr. Beamish's own countenance, but he has an irresistible way of producing the same effect on yours. His humour is so keen and natural, yet so refined, and his pathos so tenderly touching, that few speakers more frequently mingle 'the smile' with 'the tear' in the eyes of their hearers.

“He is always fluent and eloquent; his ideas are graceful, and his language appropriate, but his great *forte* lies in anecdote. He tells a story better than any one I know, (always excepting Dr. Cooke,) and he has at command an inexhaustible fund of them, Irish and English, tragic, comic and romantic.

“His voice is sweet and powerful, and his Hibernian accent is of the most polished order.

“He is, like most of his countrymen, what the old writers call 'a man of parts, that hath a subtle and a ready wit;' for he is never at a loss, cannot be taken by surprise, and cannot be put out of countenance. Twice only, in the innumerable speeches I have heard him make, have I ever seen him at all in perplexity, and one really enjoyed the sight, from its rarity.

“The first time was in a long self-defence, in which he laboured hard at a troublesome task, with but limited success; the second occasion was very amusing, for he got really set fast in the middle of an Irish love story. Simplicity is one of his characteristics; a compound feeling or action is not in his line, and he then had to set forth the attachment of a Protestant girl to a young Roman Catholic, in the light of a very pathetic affair, in which he wished us all to be deeply interested; and yet he had, at the same time, to keep up our horror of Popery itself; so that between compassion and blame, he got quite into a labyrinth, and hesitated considerably, a most unusual event.

“He saw also that his hearers were more amused at himself than distressed for his heroine, which a little annoyed him; though amidst his dilemma, he could scarcely help laughing. He persevered, however, till he got past the marriage of the ill-assorted pair, and then, as if to take his revenge upon us, he changed his style, and claiming an undeniable right to our sympathies, wound up one of the most tragic tales I ever heard, of persecution, misery, and madness, in his most harrowing manner.

“He is very fine in his style whenever he attempts it; but, perhaps, I may refer to his speeches at the Naval and Military Bible Meetings, as specimens of his most truly touching anecdotes; while his addresses at the various Irish anniversaries are equally good, as samples of drollery and real wit. I well remember, at a meeting in the west of England, when Mr. Beamish first came over as a speaker, the great amusement he excited by his definition of the word 'boys.' He was describing a visit he had paid to a mine or colliery, and speaking of the men employed there. 'So, when I saw the creatures all coming about us, I said, Now boys, sit down, and I'll tell ye something; for we call every thing *boys* in Ireland, old women and all, ye know.'

“Mr. Beamish, at his first settlement in London, had the Irish chaplainship of the West Street Chapel, St. Giles's, which belongs to the Irish Society; he had, indeed, relinquished his preferment at Kinsale, for the express purpose of preaching to his poor countrymen in their dear native tongue. In 1832, however, he gave up the Irish preaching, in consequence of his declining health; but why he has never resumed that interesting employment, since he has become so well capable of doing it with renewed strength, remains a mystery to most persons, notwithstanding the long

self-exculpation before-mentioned. Some of his private friends declare themselves equally in the dark on this subject.

"Mr. Beamish's private character is amiable and delightful; he is an accomplished scholar and musician, and I cannot but think that he must be a poet, though I never heard the fact stated."—pp. 124-128.

As a suitable set-off to the above, we select the sketch of "Mr. John Hockin, *more familiarly known as 'the Brummagem Blacksmith.'*"

"I have heard loud voices, powerful voices, nay, stentorian voices; but none ever greeted my auditory nerves which could merit to be called more than *moderate* when contrasted with his. Even Captain William Wellesley's speaking-trumpet of a voice will not stand a comparison with it. It has, moreover, this wonderful peculiarity, that the louder it is raised, the more distinct becomes its articulation. At the greatest distance every word is as perfect as though spoken into your ears."—p. 178.

"I had gone into the Hall in the beginning of the day, with a friend, who was anxious to see some expected speaker. We saw the Bishops of London and Chester, Lord Teignmouth, and others, but not the person we sought; and as some inaudible gentleman was speaking, we soon departed, glad to escape the excessive crowd and want of air. We then passed some time in the Lower Hall, where another meeting was going on, and after an excellent speech from Mr. Beamish, we left the room to return home; but we had scarcely reached the main cross-passage, when we became sensible of an extraordinary sound, as though some energetic proclamation were being made in our very ears. We stopped to listen, but could not determine whence the noise came. We only knew that we had never before heard a similar one. We went up stairs, thinking that something extraordinary was taking place in the first-floor gallery; but we were astonished, on reaching that spot, to find the voice as far of as ever.

"We now turned towards the Great Hall and found that it was a speech being delivered there, and of which we clearly heard some words, we being on the *outside* of its walls. Determined to examine into the phenomenon, and knowing that the best approaches were too full to be attempted, we ascended the upper stairs, and on entering at the top of the raised seats, we found that the immense volume of sound proceeded from a dark, active little man, who stood on the platform, haranguing the multitude in tones of living thunder; bestowing, at the same time, by way of emphasis, such tremendous blows on the platform-rail with his clenched fist, as he had been wont to deal upon his anvil, in the way of his calling; for it was indeed no other than John Hocking, the chain and anchorsmith, the reformed drunkard, and at that time the over-whelming *cheval de bataille* of the Temperance Society.

"We looked at each other, sat down, and listened.

"His language was plain and course, but not ungrammatical, and he continued to detail facts, and to put vehement interrogatories to his hearers, all at the same pitch of voice; so that if we had remained on the outside, we need not have lost one word of what he said.

"Some of his narratives had a sufficient lack of refinement about them, and as others almost trenched on the confines of propriety, nothing could be more amusing than to watch the effect on those around him.

"The Bishop of Chester was in the chair, and while some looked up in amazement, and some looked down in a vain pretence of not hearing what the deaf must have heard, while some looked fatigued, and some looked annoyed, (amongst whom Lord Teignmouth's curly hair, uneasy look, and fidgeting movements were conspicuous,) the good Bishop, in the best possible spirit, laughed,

nodded, and cheered, and evidently regarded the exhibition as quite *unique*, and admirable in its kind.

"Place the Bishop of Chester where you will, he always finds his proper level, and always keeps it; he takes all in good part, and never loses either his temper or self-possession. I doubt, however, whether his Lordship's ears have ever forgotten Mr. John Hockin.

"I only wonder how he, after the other sitters of that platform, survived the infliction, without a permanent deafness.

"Such a Niagara of an orator I never before heard, nor do I desire ever to hear such another."—pp. 178-181.

A third picture shall be added in a third style:—

"The painter who wishes to embody on canvass the *beau ideal* of a British Admiral, should paint the picture of Sir James Hillyar. His delightful countenance has all the proverbial openness, good humour, and jollity of an English tar, besides a something peculiar to itself, which makes it a pleasure to look at him.

"The happy benevolence of his round, bronzed face, and smiling blue eyes, is set off by the thick, venerable white hair, which grows in profusion about his open forehead; and his manner has all the vivacity of seventeen, though I should guess his years to be probably seventy.

"He has only spoken once, I believe, on the London platforms, and that, as might be expected, was at a Naval and Military Bible Meeting, in Freemasons' Hall.

"His lively look, his familiar style of speaking, the strangely compounded materials of his speech, the irresistible ludicrousness of his comedy, and the deep pathos of his tragedy, will not soon be forgotten by those who heard him; the ladies, especially, doted on him; they called him a lovely old gentleman, and took, in the best possible humour, his pathetic-comic addresses to themselves, under the complimentary title of "you young petticoats there!"

"He ended his speech very abruptly, and as he returned to his seat, was informed that he had forgotten to name the resolution he had been requested to move. Back he came to the front of the platform, with an indescribable drollery of eye and voice, saying, "It may seem odd, that a man so unwilling to make one speech, should come back to ye to make another; but talking to the petticoats, I forgot my proper business; ah! that's always the way!" And he shook his head at the ladies, who laughed and blushed, and delighted in the old Admiral exceedingly.

"When Mr. Cumming came on, towards the close of the meeting, (for this was his Bannockburn day,) Sir James was in raptures with him. He sat just by him, and the vehemence with which he clapped his hands and applauded that eloquent address, was as great as if the young Scotchman had just captured a French ship of the line. When Cumming concluded, amid enthusiastic cheers from the assembly, he turned round to make his retreat and hide himself behind the chair; and in so doing he had to pass close to Sir James, who, raising his broad Neptunian hand, with a face that said in every feature, "Well done! my little hearty!" bestowed on Mr. Cumming's much-to-be-pitied shoulders, three such strokes of admiration as might be heard half way down the Hall."—pp. 154-156.

If we had not some confidence that the above extracts must interest our readers, we should be diffident about risking another; but, under the circumstances, we think just one more is allowable. It presents a striking subject for a *tableau vivant* or an H. B. At a district Visiting Meeting, Lord Chichester having to vote thanks to the chairman, Lord Cholmondeley, began to enlarge upon the benevolent exertions of the latter; the narrative proceeds:—

"Lord Cholmondeley's modesty was sadly shocked at hearing his own good deeds thus publicly

set forth, and, blushing very considerably, he extended a hand to catch hold of his panegyrist, and stop any further commendations. But Lord Chichester, though looking still at the audience, contrived to see his friend's attempt, and resolved that his just tribute to retiring merit should not be interrupted; and he gently edged himself away sidelong, and pursued his eulogy. The *Praisee* stretched himself farther and farther, trying to seize the corner of his provoking friend's frock-coat, which hung, most temptingly, just beyond his reach; for the Praiser, with a face of the most innocent gravity, and as though quite unaware of the *Praisee's* efforts, kept softly stepping farther off, so as just to elude his grasp, while he continued his remarks as before. After stretching himself sideways, quite to his full length, and nearly losing his balance, Lord Cholmondeley gave up the attempt, and resigned himself to the more common-place expedient of covering his face with his hands.

"Lord Chichester concluded his speech, and then sat down, with a look that fully showed the drollery within. The Marquis rose immediately, half angry, half ashamed, and quite distressed; and disclaimed the praises bestowed on him in the humblest and most modest manner.

"Altogether it was a highly pleasing, as well as amusing scene, and those who witnessed it will not soon forget the dry, grave waggy of Lord Chichester, nor the mingled frown and laugh of the excellent Marquis."—pp. 44, 45.

Now we ask our readers whether the above passages have not abundantly proved the point for which they have been made. The religion of the day undeniably cannot propagate itself by religious means, but addresses itself to means which are not only independent, but even in violation of religion. The tawdry decorations, theatrical displays, and pseudo-mysteriousness of Romanism, at least carry with them a religious profession; but what is there of a religious character in exhibitions, which to a deaf person, or to one who was suddenly introduced to them without knowledge of the societies to which they belonged, taken at greatest advantage, would not differ at all, or scarcely, from those of any other meeting, political or other, which take place in the metropolis? Without making ridicule the test of truth, yet what is to be said when parties actually profess to be ridiculous and make fun of themselves? Though truth may be ridiculed, yet surely error alone plays the buffoon; and, with every wish to be cautious in what we say, we cannot help coming to the conclusion that, while Exeter Hall has throughout all its floors the dry rot of irreverence, some of its speakers are but stage players at best, and at worst actual drolls and merry andrews. Surely truth is not lacquied by Park and Bottom, by flibberty gibbets, and goblin pages, abbots of unreason, and boy-bishops. It is too sacred a matter to be presented to the mind under any but sacred images, and in former ages none have ever done otherwise, but heretics or the lowest rabble. We will not draw the conclusion which seems to follow, but submit with every serious, and we will add kindly feeling, the above reflections to the frequenters or the patrons of the meetings to which they relate. Voices "out-roaring a lion," language "jocular even to broad comic effect," "the hall in a roar," "dancing movements," "wild gesticulations," "fashionable English costume," "agreeable gentleman-like action," "irresistible ludicro-solemn slyness," "roguish twinkles," and "hats and handkerchiefs flying," present but a sorry contrast to the "long and silent prayer," the "weepings and moanings," the "fear of God and orderly discipline," "the Metropolitan with his exhortation," and the "deacon in his albe" of the ancient Spanish council. For ourselves, we do not scruple scruple to confess, that little as we like the playhouse, if we were compelled to go to one or the other, we would as lieve go thither as to this celebrated Hall on a show-day.

ART. II.—Travels in the Three Great Empires of Austria, Russia, and Turkey. By C. B. Elliott, M.A., F.R.S. 2 vols. Bentley. 1838.

[*British Critic*, vol. 25, April 1839.]

WE never fell in with a writer who showed such a horror of the inconveniences of foreign travel, yet who with his eyes open had submitted himself to such voluntary discomfort as Mr. Elliott. He had to absent himself from England from ill health; and he is not content even with Ovid's exile in Pontus; but after voyaging down the Ister amid rocks and falls, he betakes himself to Scythia, shivers with cold, sickens of hunger, and cloyes of vermin in Bessarabia, crosses to Crim Tahtary and thence goes to Constantinople to meet the plague, which is there raging; then he coasts along the bays and promontories and amid the pirates of Asia Minor down to Beyroot in Syria, and thence performs a land pilgrimage to Jerusalem, when he falls ill of a fever, and the work closes. Such is the termination, we are sorry to say, of the wanderings which indisposition forced upon our author, a termination as contrary to the rules of the *Epopée*, as to any but the Homœopathic system of physicking.

There is a story of an Englishman, who, when told of the miseries of foreign travel, said that he was not particular, for so that he had a knife and fork and a good beefsteak for dinner of a day, he could with good heart dispense with every thing else. Mr. Elliott has no such gross dreams floating before him; yet he is not the less possessed with a vision of ideal comfortableness, and is the victim of very definite imaginations, which are never gratified. He is a scholar and an accomplished man; but above all he is a refined English gentleman, and he seeks to be comfortable and English with so strong a yearning, that he woos comfort, "*otium divos rogat*," in a steam vessel on the Danube, in a Moldavian hut, in a lazaret in Bessarabia, on the steppes of Tahtary, on the inhospitable Euxine, in the ruins of the Seven Churches, and amid the desolateness of Syria and Palestine.

It is this phenomenon, the impression of which is carried off by the reader of these volumes. They do not disclose nearly so much about the countries they advertise, as about Mr. Elliott himself; or at least their principal charm lies in the relation existing between the traveller and his adventures, in his exquisite appreciation of the worth of every thing of English manufacture, whether English comfort, or English Ultra-Protestantism, and his consequent annoyance, dejection, or contempt when he meets with things and persons moulded upon a different standard.

He began his voluntary pains in a steam vessel on the Danube in the autumn of 1835; and the first shock which his feelings received arose from the straitened dimensions of its cabin, which was the occasion of some of his female fellow passengers undressing in his presence. Now he certainly mentions breaches of decorum on the part of passengers of his own sex, which might have been avoided, but we do think him somewhat too hard on these unhappy women. The chief part of their offence in Mr. Elliott's judgment is their not being conscious they were committing any; and yet when he gets to Constantinople, in spite of his own sensitive refinement, he cannot enter a whit the better into the feelings of the Turkish women, who in turn accuse English women of forwardness in making a display of themselves in public at all. He says—

"When she [a Turkish female] appears abroad, she is so wrapped up as to conceal her face, any exposure of which, however partial, is regarded as a violation of delicacy. A Frank lady informed us that one day, in the street, her arm was rudely seized, and separated from that of a gentleman who escorted her, by a Moslimah who felt her sex dishonoured by such familiarity; and we heard from another that, only three years ago, a green veil was pulled off her head by a Turkish female, enraged at seeing the sacred colour defiled by contact with an infidel so indelicate as to exhibit her face."—vol. i. p. 442.

Mr. Elliott's notions then of decorum move on a precise and fantastical line; yet from the following remarks on Turkish customs, which he gives from a modern writer, one would think that he had imbibed something of a more philosophical spirit.

"The abhorrence of the hat is well known; but the uncovering of the head, which with us is an expression of respect, is by them considered disrespectful and indecent. A quaker will give no offence by keeping on his hat in a mosque, if his shoes were left at the threshold, The Turks turn in their toes; they mount on the right side of the horse; they follow their guests into a room and precede them on leaving it; the left hand is the place of honour; they do the honours of the table by serving themselves first; they take the wall and walk, hastily in sign of respect; they beckon by throwing back the hand, instead of drawing it towards them; they cut the hair from the head, and remove it from the body, but leave it on the chin; they sleep in their clothes; they look upon beheading as a more disgraceful punishment than strangling; they deem our close and short dresses indecent, and our shaven chins a mark of effeminacy or servitude; they resent an inquiry after their wives as an insult; they eschew pork as an abomination; they regard dancing as a theatrical performance only to be practised by slaves; lastly, their mourning habit is white, their sacred color is green, and their holy day is Friday."—vol. i. pp. 444, 445.

Mr. Elliott, however, in spite of his better knowledge, will look for England in every droshki and caique, and above all, for comfort. For instance, on entering the cuddy of the steamer, he found "the air of the room fraught with unsavoury odours and almost suffocating, several of the passengers having embarked the previous evening, and passed the night in the cabin with every door and window closed"—vol. 1. p. 72. When dinner was expected "vociferations commenced: 'Jacob' was called, commanded, scolded, and abused, but without effect. An universal roar was then raised for *fleisch, fleisch, fleisch*, followed by a bacchanalian yell for *wein, wein, wein*."—p. 76. In Servia he had to pass two nights in "*discomfort*," "on benches and tables without change of clothes."—p. 88. At Belgrade, "close to the sacred edifice," he says, "is the abode of the archbishop, a miserable dwelling, *wholly destitute of comfort*."—p. 104. He returns from thence to Semlin in a carriage, which was provided with a seat, "*not very uncomfortable*."—p. 106. The pleasure of his excursion to Mehadia, "was much diminished by the weather and *the discomfort* of the vehicle."—p. 134. He starts from Teraspol "*lamenting the miserable accommodation* afforded by Russian inns."—p. 249. At Odessa he tells us "there are *no comfortable inns*."—p. 256. The "venerable archbishop," who is president of the monastery of St. George, on the Crimea, has "but one chamber," and in it "only a table and chairs, a sofa and bed."—p. 333. At Baidah he is compelled to sit like the Tahtars, with his legs crossed under him, "*no easy position for a Christian*."—p. 337. In the archimandrite's house at Magnesia, though "the best in the town, not Turkish," Mr. Elliott's room "*was neither large nor comfortable*."—vol. ii. p. 68. The house of the archbishop of Philadelphia, "*is neither large nor handsome*." When Mr. Elliott dined with him, "as a mark of special attention, and kindness, the archbishop every now and then proffered us little balls of rice rolled with his fingers and dipped in gravy, which after witnessing the process of manufacture, *it was impossible to swallow*."—vol. ii. p. 93. And at the khans in Asia Minor, a traveller can but procure "a cup of *sugarless coffee*."—p. 100. Servants are great plagues every where; but what shall we say to the domestics in Moldavia, whom Mr. Elliott thus describes?

"Moldavian domestics appear to be indolent, stupid, and immoral to the last degree. They require to have the same order repeated every day; when the dinner-cloth is laid by one who has performed the office for months, the mistress must sit by and say, 'Now put on the spoons, now the salt-cellars, now the tumblers, now the knives:' and so far every separate article of table

furniture: when reproved, they stand mute, and look on the ground; but neither profess nor exhibit an intention to do better. Their inclination to theft is irresistible; a lady residing here told us that it frequently happened that her pocket-handkerchief, laid down for a moment while she was speaking to a servant, disappeared as she turned away her head: the culprit at first denies the charge; and when the stolen article is found upon him, he evinces no sense of shame.”—vol. i. pp. 203, 204.

But the most strange instance of this sort of criticism upon external things occurs in his visit to the Mosque of Soliman at Constantinople. He mentions the necessity of taking off the shoes on entering it, and implies that some persons might have a scruple in doing so. A religious scruple the reader is likely to suppose; no such thing; he goes on to obviate it thus, “We took off our shoes as a matter of course; *a compliance from which we suffered little inconvenience*, since the marble pavements are *always covered with Indian mats or carpets, never soiled by the sole of a shoe.*”—vol. i. p. 362.

Such is Mr. Elliott’s sense of the refined and comfortable; and that it is keen may be conjectured from the resignation which breathes in the following meditation on the steam navigation of the Danube:—

“It is true, the *inconveniences* we encountered are considerable; but then, no one should *venture* on the excursion who is unprepared for hardships and harassing delays, for it cannot be expected that a project which has to contend against so many obstacles should be perfected at once. *Instead of complaining*, a traveller of *an enlarged and philanthropic mind* will turn with admiration to the enterprize and patriotism which have set on foot so grand an undertaking, and to the important moral consequences likely to be the result, remembering with satisfaction that steam is calculated to prove the precursor of civilization, civilization of education, education of religion, and religion of happiness!”—vol. i. pp. 191, 192.

Frequent indeed, as we may easily conjecture, were the calls on our traveller in the course of his wanderings for “enlarged and philanthropic” feelings. Some glimpses of these have already been given in the foregoing brief intimations; but they deserve to be set before the reader with something of distinctness and circumstance. We present him then with sketches of some of the miseries both of a sea and land journey. First, of the land journey.

“There is but one mode of travelling in Syria. Carriages and carriage-roads are unknown; and the surefootedness of the asinine race points out mules and donkeys as preferable to horses on the dangerous heights and almost impassable tracks which form the only communication between distant spots. A traveller in these regions has no reason to expect wholesome food, except when he may secure accommodation in a Greek or Latin convent: under other circumstances, he must depend entirely on his own provisions. A village will yield him generally sour, and sometimes fresh, milk, eggs, and *dibash*, unleavened cakes which he can ill digest, and bad water. In the towns he will purchase live fowls, rice, and coarse bread; the fowls must be carried ready cooked, and the stores laid in must be proportioned to his distance from the next market. The mattress he takes with him will be unique wherever he goes; and as to further luxuries,—the remembrance of the land in which he is travelling and its surpassing interest must supply to him the place of superfluities. The most serious annoyance to which he is subjected results from the perverseness of the muleteers. Whatever amount be offered by a Frank for mules, it is unusual for the owners to consent without the interference of the authorities, accompanied generally by blows. When the cavalcade is set in motion, the pace at which it advances is about two and a half miles per hour; and the traveller is sometimes obliged to stop sixteen, twenty, or thirty times in the course of a march to refasten on the animal the luggage, which would never have shifted had it been once properly secured. At the close

of a long day's journey, worn out with fatigue and the vexation occasioned by his muleteers, *he expects and finds no comforts*. Instead of the officious alacrity of waiters and the self-satisfied smile of a portly landlord, to greet him and conduct to a clean apartment and wholesome repast, he marches in slow and solemn procession to the house of the principal man, or sheikh, who appoints a room in which the party is to be housed for the night, and perhaps sends a tray containing some milk, eggs, and unleavened bread, with *dibash*, for their supper. The room may be such as Khan Hussein, or it may be better; shared or not, as it happens, with the mules or with twenty dirty Bedouins less clean and wholesome than the animals. No door secures him against the intrusion of twenty more; for in most cases the room is public property, set apart for strangers, and all are equally welcome: a door, therefore, which might lead to exclusive appropriation, is regarded with religious aversion. The first night passed under such circumstances converts the clothes of the stranger into an entomological menagerie, in which every variety of insect familiar to the country may be found; many, which amongst us are nameless or named only *sotta voce*, here obtain importance from their numbers, and celebrate a long carnival upon his fasting frame."—vol. ii. pp. 252-254.

The distress of his voyage is more concisely but not less significantly given.

"My little cabin, regarded by the captain as most spacious and handsome, measured about six feet by three, independently of two recesses each calculated to contain a mattress. It had neither window nor door; but through an opening in the deck a man could let himself down into it, though egress was somewhat more difficult to an inexperienced climber. This opening, while it afforded light and air, exposed the interior and its contents to the full view of the hajeess, who, during the time of our companionship made a point of sitting before it to watch all my proceedings, and to amuse their children by pointing out a thousand wonders in every action and every article of the first Englishman they had seen.

"In order to secure his services when they might be required during the night, I had intended my servant to occupy one of the recesses in the little apartment; but a single experiment convinced me that such an arrangement was impracticable, for the smell peculiar to all Arabs was in Ibrahim's case absolutely unbearable: he had but two suits of clothes; the one, in which he exhibited himself to be hired, glittering with gilt braid, and looked upon by its owner as unrivalled; the other, substituted as soon as we went on board, old and tattered, worn through many an Egyptian summer, filthy as the muddy banks of the Nile, and enjoying the privilege (unshared even by half a shirt) of immediate contact with a body washed once a year."—vol. ii. pp. 144, 145.

But the flower of his miseries, briefer indeed than others according to the old stoical maxim, "*si gravis brevis*," but very acute, was his treatment on entering the Russian frontier at Liova. It is curious on several accounts, and we shall accordingly indulge in an extract of considerable length. It will be observed that Mr. Elliott had been expressly warned at Vienna "that it was impossible to conceive the inconveniences to which those are exposed who enter Bessarabia," owing to the jealousy of the Russian government.

"It was past nine in the evening when we found ourselves among some huts on the bank of the Pruth, at a spot dignified by the high-sounding title of Porte de Liova. By the light of the moon we discerned a ferry; and the loud cry of the guards, stationed on the opposite side and answering one another at short intervals, indicated the vicinity of the Russian quarantine, whither we were bound. This cry of the sentinels is wild and singular. It consists of one high note, which they usually sustain as long as the breath permits, when they conclude by descending the scale in semi-tones.

"A hard-featured, passionate man, roused from his slumbers, soon answered the call of our driver, and came out to ask what we required. We intimated by signs that we were desirous of

crossing the river to Liova: to this he replied by violent gestures and unintelligible vociferations; and after a fruitless effort to persuade him to comply with our wishes, we were beginning to make arrangements for spending the night in the carriage, when a more respectable person accosted us. He understood just two words of German, "Tomorrow morning;" by means of which he intimated that we could not cross the ferry till the following day; and at the same time conducted us to a miserable hut, where a woman and a naked child, rolling themselves off a plank, placed it at our disposal. In a corner, two more children lay on the mud floor. The stove, a broad bench on three sides of the room, and a stick suspended from the ceiling, on which several articles of dress were hanging, constituted the only furniture. Three holes in the wall, provided with pieces of bladder removable at pleasure, served to admit light, but did not exclude the air. Such was our apartment. Our companions had a similar one in another cabin. In a few minutes the vehicle was unloaded and the baggage piled before the door to barricade it against intruders; when, partially undressing and wrapt in our cloaks, we lay down to sleep, with the two children in the corner, thankful for a sheltered spot in which to rest our weary limbs.

"The following morning we awoke to a sense of our miseries, and saw by daylight the full extent of the wretchedness by which we were surrounded. The screaming of the children had compelled us in the middle of the night to put them into the outer room, and they ceased to disturb us: but not so the insects by which we were almost devoured: an entomologist might have made a fair collection from the various species of our tormenters. On opening the door, we found ourselves enveloped in a thick mist; the Pruth flowed under the wall of the hut, and the eye could not penetrate the dense vapour that arose from its surface; but as soon as this was dissipated, we descried the roof of the Russian quarantine on the farther side of a low hill, and recognized in it the site of our future prison. In vain we traversed and retraversed the village in search of some one who spoke French, Italian, or German; but not a creature was to be found whose attainments extended beyond a knowledge of the Moldavian dialect. The uncourteous man who the preceding night had impressed us with no very favourable opinion of his disposition, verified today the estimate we had formed of him; and to our signs, soliciting a conveyance to the opposite shore, he replied only by negations issued with all the assumption of petty authority. In this painful situation we passed several hours, without the possibility of moving or of procuring bread, meat, clean water, or the common necessities of life, till, in the afternoon, a flag raised on the Russian bank intimated that strangers might cross the water: at the same time several Jews arrived, some of whom spoke broken German; and from them we learned the real cause of our detention, namely, that the bureau is opened only twice a day, and on Sunday, which this happened to be, but once."—vol. i. pp. 216-219.

Accordingly our traveller or travellers (with Mr. Elliott the pronoun "we" is sometimes singular, sometimes plural,) cross the river, present their passports, and ask leave to enter into quarantine; the commissary, who spoke no language but Russ, signified in reply, by means of a Jew as an interpreter, that they must go back and return the following day.

"We represented that we had already lost time by the arrangements which prevented our reception the previous night; that we were now in a spot where the necessities of life were not procurable; that we had literally passed fifty-four hours without washing our faces, from the impossibility of procuring any water unmixed with mud, and that we had spent two nights without enjoying the comforts of a bed; that to force us to remain longer in such a condition was cruel, and that some consideration ought to be manifested. All this touched not the heart of the commissary, who replied only that the law must be obeyed. Before we left, the doctor of the quarantine, who

spoke a little French, arrived, and acted as interpreter. Having heard our just complaint, he kindly interceded for us, but without effect; and the sleek little commissary desired him to apprise us that the law requires every foreigner, not French, bringing a French passport, to be detained beyond the frontier while inquiries are instituted regarding him; nor would he understand that the passports of all English travellers are necessarily drawn out in French, that being the diplomatic language of Europe . . . Doomed to pass another day in the miserable Port of Porte de Liova, it was a source of thankfulness and surprise that the means professedly intended to prevent our carrying infection from countries where it was well known no contagious disease existed, did not themselves induce illness; a result which would probably have ensued, but for the wholesome food supplied by our kind friends at Galatz.

"After a second doleful night, we arose with such strength as survived the attacks of the insatiable insects, and were happy to see the flag flying at eight o'clock. Again we resorted to the office of the commissary, who said that it was impossible we should be received, because we must previously take an oath, and we did not understand the Russian language. We inquired why the oath could not be translated? 'Because nobody can translate it.'—'Where is the doctor?'—'He may perhaps come tomorrow or next day.'—'Is there no one in the town who talks German, French, or Italian, and who will translate the oath for a handsome remuneration?'—'No, nobody!'—'Will you not communicate substance of the oath to one of these Jews, and suffer him to repeat it to us?'—'That is impossible—a Jew cannot administer an oath to Christian.'—'But a Jew can inform a Christian what he is called upon to swear?'—'No, he cannot take the name of Christ.'—'A Jew often does take the name of Christ, though in blasphemy: however, the word is the same in all languages, let him interpret the rest of the oath, we can supply the sacred name.' The absurdity of this conversation was the more glaring, as a Jew was at the time actually naming the name of Christ in his office of interpreter between us. To suppose the commissary could not understand the feasibility of this arrangement, were to suppose him without reason, but he would not. We offered him a piece of gold, which he refused, and went away, leaving us to decide whether we should go back to Galatz or make one more effort to overcome the vexatious annoyances of a Russian frontier."—vol. i. pp. 220-224.

At length they gained a permission to enter the house of quarantine; as a preliminary to which they were obliged to make an inventory of all the articles of their luggage. This they did by means of a Jew who spoke a little German and Moldavian, and a Moldavian who spoke a little Russ.

"Arrived on the Bessarabian bank and now in the empire of Russia, we marched in procession, accompanied by a number of Jews going to see their friends, to the office of the commissary, who, after sundry forms and much delay, placed in our hands a French translation of the regulations of the quarantine, all of which were enforced under penalty of death. These being read, we were required to take an oath of obedience, and to give a solemn promise that we would secrete nothing from the inspectors. The great doors were then opened, and we were admitted with our baggage, which was laid out upon the grass, every article being taken separately from the boxes and compared with the inventory written on the other side of the water. The exact number of gold ducats and silver rubles possessed by each of us was entered; every scrap of paper, rag, and leather was examined, and the list made doubly correct; yet, two days afterwards, an official was directed to inform us that a pair of braces was not recorded, which with some garters was then formally added to the catalogue. It is not possible to conceive, without personal experience, the rigidity of this investigation. At length, the shadows of night drew over the horizon, and we were permitted to retire to our apartments; having previously bespoken the best in the quarantine, and particularly

requested that mattresses might be hired for our use from the town.

"Our room, floored with brick, was eleven feet square and seven high; it contained a stove, a small deal table, a wooden stool, and two frames of bedsteads supplied with narrow planks which did not nearly meet one another. This was literally the whole furniture of the apartment in which we were destined to pass four days and nights; there were none of the innumerable little comforts required in a domestic ménage, nor were we permitted to provide them at our own expense. The door opened into a small enclosure, six yards square, in which a soldier, called our *guardian*, remained day and night, the gate being locked at sunset on him and us, and the windows fastened on the outside. One of these (for there were two) faced the little quadrangle, so that the *guardian* could inform himself of all we did; and between eight and nine o'clock in the evening he insisted on our putting out our candle and fire; a requisition the more vexatious, as the place swarmed with field-bugs and fleas to such a degree that, every second hour of the day and as long as light was allowed, we were compelled to wage war against them; giving, as we received, no quarter. For a candlestick we were provided with a piece of clay; a soldier's old cloak, with a coarse canvas bag, was given as a covering for each bedstead; thus no very promising prospect opened before us. We were told that there was a Jew *traiteur* who provided food, but on our admission, he had left his shop for the day, and the following was a Hebrew festival; so that, but for own little stocks laid in without the slightest anticipation of being placed in such circumstances, we should probably have become ill for want of the necessaries of life.

"The first morning, the doctor paid us an early visit to enquire, as well he might, how we had rested on our hard beds, and to tell us that permission would be granted to purchase from the Jew some hay to convert into *paillasses* the sacks thrown over the bedsteads; he likewise informed us that all our goods must be suspended, or spread out, under a roof surrounded by trellis-work, there to remain for three days to be ventilated and purified. But another difficulty had arisen. Our passport was drawn out on the twenty-ninth of August at Vienna, and a *visé* appeared on it which, according to the doctor, bore date the twenty-fifth of August. This looked like fraud, and we were responsible. The document was produced, and the *visé* proved to be written on the eleventh of September; the entry, however, was in German; and the German running-hand S is not very unlike an O with a flourish; the doctor therefore declared it was October: we reminded him that the eleventh of October had not yet arrived; and that, even if the secretary of a public office had made the blunder supposed, a traveller should not be held accountable; at the same time we maintained, that, in point of fact, the word written was September, not October; nevertheless he strongly asserted his acquaintance with German, and it was not expedient to dispute it. At length he departed, and we heard no more of the passport being in French, nor of the date, nor of any other difficulty connected with it."—vol. i. pp. 226-234.

"On the fifth day preparations were made for our liberation, which, however, was not effected as readily as we had hoped. Early in the morning the doctor paid us a visit to assure himself that we were in health. We were then required to take an oath, enforced by a reference to God's presence and the anticipation of his 'terrible judgment,' that we had complied with all the requisitions of the establishment; that we had not been in contact with any person, except those of our party, during the time of confinement; that we had thrown nothing over the walls; and that everything belonging to us had been aired and *turned* each day. To the last clause we objected, observing that, however anxious we might have been to comply with the instructions received, yet it was scarcely practicable to handle daily each minute scrap of paper, &c. and that certainly we could not swear that this had been done. Our hesitation gave rise to a discussion between the doctor,

the commissary, and the director, as to whether we should be detained. At length, it was decided that all our things had been turned *en masse*; and with this understanding, we were suffered to depart.”—vol. i. pp. 231, 232.

When they at length got into the town, they found it “crowded with Jews all talking German,” in spite of the commissary’s assurance that Russ was the only language spoken.

Mr. Elliott reaped the benefit of this painful initiation into the dominions of the Autocrat, by gaining ingress in consequence into the Crimea, the beauties of which he describes in glowing language, he is especially delighted with Count Woronzow’s *English mansion* now building, of which and its gardens he gives an eloquent description. The count is the present governor of New Russia; and Mr. Elliott says that his “personal exertions and influence have converted the wilderness into a terrestrial paradise.”—p. 342. He speaks of the peninsula as abounding in majestic scenery, and covered with gardens, orchards, and vineyards, which seem to strike his imagination more than the mountains, whether of Hungary or Asia Minor.

The following extract will give the reader an idea of Mr. Elliott’s style; though we wish he had not defaced it by an irrelevant and in itself most preposterous remark towards the end.

“As we glided along, village after village passed before our eyes like the scenes in a camara obscura, each beautiful in its way, and each succeeded by beauties different, but not inferior. Foros and Nitschatka are picturesquely situate on the slope of the Ayila chain of mountains, among forests which give cover to herds of deers and antelopes. Beyond these is Simeis, the residence of Madame Narischkine, whose father, General Rostoptchin, is believed to have set fire to Moscow, of which city he was the governor when Napoleon entered it. Proceeding a little further, Aloupka, Χαρὰξ of Ptolemy, a lovely spot embellished by the taste of its proprietor, Count Woronzow, dawned on our view. Here we were saluted with nine guns, and the same playful compliment was repeatedly paid to the name borne by our steamer, ‘Peter the Great.’ On the adjoining estate of Count Narischkine, olives, pomegranates, and figs grow in great luxuriance, with vines which produce the best white wine of the country, called Risling; while the neighbourhood is famous for its Pineau fleuri, a red wine resembling Burgundy, which is made from a vine called Pineau. A beautiful white structure towards the east, surmounted by two towers, proclaims the residence of Prince Galitzin, whose assistance in missions entitles him to the gratitude of every lover of that cause, and next to this is the cottage of the Princess Metchersky, *who is said to have distributed more Bibles than any other female in Europe*. After passing several country seats, all built within the last seven years, and the imperial gardens of Oreanda, the private property of the emperor, we landed at Yalta, a village on the south-east point of the Crimea.”—vol. i. pp. 285, 286.

The mention of Bibles in this extract, to which we just now alluded, reminds us that we have not done justice to Mr. Elliott’s work, till we show his vivid perception, not only of the comfortable, but also of the ultra-Protestant. How extreme a Protestant he is may be conjectured from his speaking of “the *unscriptural* God of Mohammed.”—vol. ii. p. 444; but we would forgive him this, if he had not a savour of another school about him. Indeed his theological opinions, we regret to say, afford us very little satisfaction; and to tell the truth, this is the main concern we have with his volumes, which we should hardly have thought it necessary to notice, were we not alive to the evil of lax opinions, such as his being scattered through Europe, as if in the name of the English clergy. One indication of his state of mind was incidentally mentioned several pages back; and we must say, the general tenor of his remarks does but confirm what there seemed intimated, that a gentleman, who is endued with such shrinking delicacy as regards the proprieties of society in a steamer, and such acute sensibility as regards archiepiscopal and clerical discomfort, yet, unconscious of it as he

himself, is not gifted with equal quickness of feeling as regards the *honour* of religion. He is but partially alive to the risk of approaching the confines of truth and error, nor does he understand that his sense of indecorum might advantageously be elevated into a reverential feeling. The following references will show too truly the correctness of this representation.

We do not for one instant accuse Mr. Elliott of any wilful profaneness—the notion is absurd; but we are sorry to detect in him, what is a great fault in religious matters, a want of duly realizing what he is doing or talking about; so that he use solemn words to round a sentence, speak disrespectfully of sacred subjects, or commit doubtful acts to serve some purpose of the moment; and all this with the same unconsciousness which he imputes to the unrefined women in the steamer. He has, in his conduct towards religion, a rude, coarse, indelicate manner about him. Speaking, for instance, of the site of a heathen oracle, he says,

“The oracle is no more! The deceivers and the deceived now blend their dust around the uncertain seat of the idol they adored, awaiting the solemn call which shall summon them to the bar of the *divine iconoclast*.”—vol. i. p. 195.

Again, speaking of the holy sepulchre,

“Here seven large silver and forty-four smaller lamps are ever burning, while in the adjoining chapels incense ascends day and night, and prayers and praises are offered without ceasing to the *incarnate God*.”—vol. ii. p. 447.

There is something very observable in his mode of speaking of the ancient people of God, whom he unscrupulously degrades to the rank of heathens or Mahomedans. Thus he says that “the principal object of desire with the Moslim, as with the Hebrew women, is children”—vol. i. p. 441; that “the special honour conferred on the parental relation has characterized the inhabitants of Syria from the days of Rachael to the present”—vol. ii. p. 281; that the Turks, “like the Jews, identify their civil polity with religion”—vol. i. p. 445; and that “among the ancient Jews storks were held in abomination, as we learn from the two last books of the Pentateuch.”—vol. ii. p. 38. In another place he has the following most strange explanation of the anathemas found in the book of Psalms; he has been speaking of the recent conscription at Damascus, then he adds,

“Surely it was the sight of tyranny embodied in effects like this—such as men living under a Christian government and well-defined laws cannot conceive—that led David to utter certain denunciations against tyrants *which appear to militate against the principle of universal charity*. But if the execution of God’s wrath on oppressors, and the manifestation of his abhorrence of their cruelties be essential to the well-being of society, then may the infliction of punishment of those who in being to such an extent the enemies of man are especially the enemies of God, be the legitimate object of a righteous man’s desire.”—vol. ii. p. 489.

Yet, while he is thus critical and apologetic as regards the ancient people of God, he seems, as is not unfrequent with men of what he calls “enlarged” minds, as if out of mere perverseness, to take their apostate and rejected descendants under his “philanthropic” consideration. He talks of a “venerable son of Abraham,” whom he fell in with in a ferry-boat, commanding “our respect by his age, and our interest by his birth.”—vol. i. p. 320. He visited a Karaite settlement in the Crimea, where he sees “a number of aged Hebrews in Tahtar costume, with long flowing beards, sitting in conclave”—vol. i. p. 309; and he moralizes over their burying place in the following pathetic way:—

“It lies in a fissure of the mountains, and is darkened by the shade of numerous venerable trees, which cast a sombre hue over the graves, and *give effect* to the scene ... Our last impression of Jorfud Kelah were such as to induce a regret that we were compelled to hasten away, and that our visit

could neither be prolonged nor repeated. *Yet so it is! a regret is mingled with life's every pleasure.*"—vol. i. p. 317.

We have noticed our author's complaisant recognition of the sanctity of a mosque. He repeats the same civility in the Samaritan temple at Nabloos. It was with *no common interest*," he says, "that we entered into the synagogue of these remarkable people, as a prelude to which they required that we should take off our shoes."—vol. ii. p. 397. That there may be no mistake, he ingenuously adds in a note, "the fact of the Samaritans requiring strangers to take off their shoes marks an *interesting distinction* between them and the Jews; as it intimates that they look on their place of assembly for worship as a temple; a light in which it is well known the Jews do not regard their synagogues."

Evidently he is quite at his ease among heretics, and misbelievers. Accordingly he speaks of being conducted to an object of his search in Constantinople "by the kindness of a Turkish gentleman, who heard our dragoman inquiring his way."—vol. ii. p. 374. The same *tone*, for it is of tone that we are speaking, is observable in other passages, as where he speaks of "the Moslem house of prayer," "from whose *consecrated* summits the muezzin invites the congregation of 'the faithful' to the adoration of an anti-Trinitarian God"—vol. i. p. 352; of "the elegant *sacred* edifices erected by Mahommed II., &c."—p. 357; of "all the *sacred* structures being surrounded by a gilt crescent"—p. 368; or when he speaks of his own sensations on witnessing the worship of the False Prophet.

"Time will not soon efface from my memory the impression first made, and often renewed, by the sight of hundreds of Mohammedans prostrating themselves and bowing their foreheads to the ground in the great mosque of Delhi, incomparably more splendid than any building existing at Constantinople, while the imam chanted in slow and solemn accents, and in the sonorous language of the Koran, 'God is great and merciful. There is no God but one God, and Mohammed is the prophet of God.'"—vol. i. p. 363.

Such is his praise of Islamism; his blame is equally unreal and rhetorical; he speaks of Turkey and Persia "exhibiting the remarkable phenomenon (*so characteristic of a fallen world!*) of two monarchies indebted for their origin and continuance to a religion of lies, and founding their political institutions on the reputed visions of an Arabian impostor."—p. 422

On the other hand, with the same forgetfulness of the difference between Christianity and heathenism, he makes out Greeks, and of course Romans, to be far worse than Jew and Turk. Sometimes indeed he does praise an archbishop as "a portly and pleasing man"—vol. ii, p. 91, or even as "venerable;" but on the whole it is easy to see that he has no sympathy with them as rulers, or even as members of the city of God. He speaks of his host at Pergamus as being "a man of comparatively enlightened mind," (*enlightened* is his praise of the Sultan,) and as "expressing himself with some degree of *liberality* on religious subjects."—vol. ii. p. 136. He adds "his nephew is more fully emancipated from the *trammels* which the Greek *heresy* imposes on its votaries." In like manner he elsewhere speaks of the "moral degradation" of the present inhabitants of Palestine, not as being Turks, but because "sunk in the *darkest* errors of the Greek and Romish *heresies*."—p. 216. He says that "a *false* faith and a *dead* faith divide the land. *Mahomet* and *Mary* are raised to an impious rivalry of,"—and then he adds the name of the true God by way of completing his antithesis.—p. 198. He credits the most unfavourable reports of the avarice of the Greek clergy (one should have thought that mere brotherhood in suffering would have restrained a clergyman from this kind of slander); and gravely records the following gossip, which, even if true, avails to show the parties criminals only on the supposition that bad men, and none but they, have a conscience.

"The owner of an English merchantman trading between Trebizond and Smyrna told us that

two of his passengers were a bishop and archbishop of the Russo-Greek church. The vessel encountered a severe gale and was nearly wrecked. The two prelates manifested the greatest terror, and began to *confess their sins to one another*. They then implored our informant to put back; and, conscience-stricken, declared, like Jonah, that the storm was sent in token of divine wrath against their impiety. Shortly after, the captain succeeded in making a port, when they left the ship and pursued their journey by land.”—vol. i. p. 463.

Perhaps the “owner of the English merchantman” did not know of the existence of a text with which his frightened passengers were complying when they confessed their sins one to another, or that the Greek Church enjoins it. As to Mr. Elliott he either did, or he did not.

However he can, in due measure, be liberal to the Greeks and Romans; let us see how.

“The *routine* of church duties entirely engrosses the clerical members, Forms are multiplied without number; and the greater part of the night as well as of the day, is passed with rosaries, crucifixes, and missals. To a Protestant some of their services appear a solemn mockery: but God judgeth not as man, and perhaps under many a pharisaical form and monkish cowl, the Searcher of hearts discerns rectitude of purpose and an earliest desire to honour him.”—vol. ii. pp. 368, 369.

Yet, after all necessary admissions on the score of the undue sacrifice of practical to devotional duties, and of the impropriety of “rosaries and crucifixes,” missals one should have thought no great offence; somehow one should have fancied that devotional books imply the performance of certain devotional acts, and that even the use of rosaries and crucifixes are ordinarily not unattended with an observance which Mr. Elliott does not show that he recollects any better than confession,—prayer.

Mr. Elliott is full of complaints of the forms, legends, and relics of the foreign Churches; nor do we mean to defend them. However, he finds at Buda the following more appropriate memento of a great reformer; “a silver *goblet* which belonged to Martin Luther, formed into a likeness of his *wife*.”—vol. i. p. 63. No wonder, living in the habitual influence of a system which is illustrated by such interesting memorials, he entertains the following relative view of the two great divisions of foreign Christianity.

“The progress of religion has not kept pace with its early advances in this once hallowed spot; and yet there is not one of the Seven Churches of Asia Minor within whose sacred precincts the trumpet of the gospels now gives so distinct and certain a sound. While Mohammed is acknowledged in twenty mosques, and Jews assemble in several synagogues, the faith of the Messiah is taught in Armenian, Greek, and Catholic churches. Yet it is not in the exhibition of Christianity thus perverted and dishonoured that we can rejoice: happily, her doctrines are set forth, sabbath after sabbath, in a purer form, in English, *French*, and *Italian*, in two *Protestant chapels*; one connected with the English, the other with the *Dutch* consulate.”—vol. ii. pp. 45, 46.

He goes on to compare the ministers in these heretical congregations, (for so the conventicles of Calvin may far more truly be called than the Churches of Greece and Rome,) to no less a person than St. Polycarp.

“In Smyrna alone, Greeks, Armenians and Catholics are instructed in intelligible accents; and five resident Protestant ministers labour as missionaries, striving, at however humble a distance, to tread in the footsteps of the blessed Polycarp.”—vol. ii. p. 46.

Shortly before, he had to all appearance brought himself, at least in his aspirations, into a singular relation with the same primitive Saint. Speaking of his martyrdom, he exclaims:—

“Standing on the spot which witnessed this memorable event, the Christian must be cold indeed whose heart does not kindle with a fervent desire that a *double portion* of the spirit of Polycarp may

rest upon him!"—vol. ii. p. 44.

It is safe to make these antithetical statements between parties at the distance of 1700 years; but we suspect that, did the holy bishop appear to Mr. Elliott in that life which he really lived in the flesh, the latter would pronounce his "abode" to be a "miserable dwelling, wholly destitute of comfort;" nay we should not be surprised if his creed and worship needed that finish which, in Mr. Elliott's judgment, pure Protestantism would have given to it. Sad indeed it is that an accomplished man like Mr. Elliott should not have a more clear perception of the principles of the Gospel, and should have had the opportunity of visiting such deeply interesting places without the due gifts of mind to profit by them. And with this reflection we take our leave of his volumes.

ART. VI.—1. Ancient Christianity, and the Doctrines of the Oxford Tracts. By the Author of "Spiritual Despotism." Part I. London. Jackson & Walford. 1839. 2. Brief Memoirs of Nicolas Ferrar, M.A., Founder of a Protestant Religious Establishment; chiefly collected from a Narrative by the Right Rev. Dr. Turner, formerly Lord Bishop of Ely, and now edited with Additions. By the Rev. T. A. Macdonogh, Vicar of Bovingdon. Second Edition. London: Nisbet. 1837.

[?] "In *Opuscula* at B.O., N has note: 'only partly JHN.' N's list at the B.O. gives 'possibly R.F. Wilson, co-author.'"—Blehl.

[*British Critic*, vol. 26, October 1839.]

WE do not intend here to make any formal examination of Mr. Taylor's work, though the first part of it figures in the heading of the article. It is not yet finished; and we are not sure *where* it will end, and what turns and windings it will pursue meanwhile. We see many marks of inconsistency in him already, as might be expected in one who is rather writing against something which he dislikes than possessed of any particular liking for any thing very definite instead of it. His second fasciculus has in some points contradicted his first; and his first contradicts itself. He may be considered then at present under a course of self-refutation; and perhaps like some wonderful performers in a less dignified line, he may finish his exhibition by eating up himself, and save us the trouble of undertaking him. At first we had proposed to leave him for the present to his own tender mercies, and wished him no worse enemy than himself. We consider we understand his position in the controversy perfectly well; he has come to the light of day in his own time, as leaves in the spring; and in his own time he will become sear, crumple up and drift, as other treat theologians, who for a while have been in request during the pending controversy. We had intended then to reserve him; but being not quite sure he will *keep*, we shall say just a very little now upon his first part, and that because it was our intention otherwise to notice a composition, the subject of which is closely connected with what he has selected for his special animadversion in the writings of the Fathers.

The life of Nicolas Ferrar attracts us, by all the eloquence of facts, to certain saintly principles and practices, from which Mr. Taylor would fain frighten us, by all the eloquence of words. The latter gentleman indeed is an alarmist of the first water; nor does he diminish his claims to be considered so, because he writes in a professedly candid tone, and with sufficient freedom from the alarm he seeks to inspire to be able to cultivate the graces of style. He does, undoubtedly, evidence considerable talent all through his work; what, indeed, but a consciousness of power, and a desire, like Milo, of showing it, could have induced him to undertake any thing so difficult as the particular thesis in which he has indulged in his first number? Any candid person, on hearing what it is, will

feel at once that victory, under such circumstances, is not necessary to make a great general. On such a field of battle it is a great thing to have fought; it is a great thing to have retreated safely. It is a feather in the cap even to have hit upon such a position, that is, in the case of a Protestant; for we believe it is not new ground to Romanists. This ground is no other than this, that Christianity, as exhibited in the Church of Rome during what are sometimes called the dark ages and downwards, is, in what the writer considers its essential characters, an improvement upon the Christianity of the Primitive Church; not meaning thereby the Church of the fifth or sixth centuries, but of the age of Ignatius and Cyprian. We have no wish to be thought to misrepresent, which certainly will be our lot, if we do not forthwith back up this statement with some quotations from the author; which shall now be done.

"What, then, I am peculiarly desirous to place in a conspicuous position, is the fact that, instead of a regular and slow development of error, there was a *very early* expansion of false and pernicious notions, in their mature proportions, and these attended by some of their worst fruits. This, then, is the very point and hinge of our argument; and in making good the weighty allegation, I shall use not only all requisite diligence of research, but, as I trust, a strict and conscientious impartiality. It may be, indeed, that later writers express themselves in more fulsome terms, or in worse taste than the earlier, and it may be that the popes and saints of the middle ages exhibit less acquaintance with the classic models of style than was the boast of the well-taught doctors of the third and fourth centuries; but in the substance of their religious system, and *in extent of moral obliquity*, they do not, I venture to say, a whit surpass them."—p. 66.

"This, then, is the gist of our present argument—that there is *absolutely nothing* in the ripe popery of the times of Saint Dominic, (certain elaborate modes of proceeding excepted,) which is not to be found in the Christianity of the times of Cyprian or of Tertullian."—p. 71.

"There is *no degradation of the intellect, no bondage of the moral sentiments, no fatal substitution of forms for realities*; there is *no ineffable drivelling* belonging to the middle age monkery, *that may not be matched*, to the full, in the monkery of the bright times of Chrysostom, Ambrose, and Augustine."—p. 99.

"I would be bold to express my belief that, if we exclude certain crazed fanatics of our times, the least esteemed community of orthodox Christians among us, whichever that may be, if taken in the mass, and fairly measured against the Church Catholic of the first two centuries, would *outweigh it decisively* in each of these qualities; I mean, in *Christian wisdom*, in *common discretion*, in *purity of manners*, and in *purity of creed*. Nay, I am strongly tempted to think that, if our Oxford divines themselves ... could but be blindfolded ... and were fairly set down in the midst of the pristine Church at Carthage, or at Alexandria, at Rome, or at Antioch, they would be fain to make their escape with all possible celerity towards their own times and country."—p. 117.

Such is the wonderful language of a Protestant writer, not a Romanist, not a Unitarian. Let us hear him once more.

"I firmly believe that it were, on the whole, better for a community to submit itself, without conditions, to the well known tridentine popery, than to take up the Christianity of Ambrose, Basil, Gregory Nyssen, Chrysostom, Jerome, and Augustine. Personally I would rather be a Christian after the fashion of Pascal and Arnold, than after that of Cyprian or Macarius; *but how much rather after that of our own Protestant worthies*."—p. 126.

The last clause, which we have put in italics, we consider to have been an after-thought, and doubtless in the MS. was inter- lined. Bating the salvo it contains, the idea of the whole passage seems better expressed in the following statement of one of the Tridentine Fathers themselves. "To

“speak candidly,” says he, in a well known passage, “I had rather trust one pope in matters touching the mysteries of faith, than a thousand Augustines, Jeromes, or Gregories.”

We shall not do full justice to the qualities of mind, which the foregoing extracts evidence in the author under review, if we do not advert to another and somewhat different exhibition of them, which he makes in the course of a dedication and some prefatory remarks. He there intimates as clearly as modesty will permit, his own special fitness for the task he has undertaken. He enlarges upon its difficulties, observing not only that no one has hitherto successfully opposed certain “formidable, accomplished, and flushed antagonists,” but that no one is likely to be able to do so, present company of course being always excepted. He is evidently a man of extensive reading, of enlarged and liberal notions, fettered by no prejudices, intimately acquainted with the bearings of the question, and taking a deep philosophical view of the course and issue of the present controversy. It is impossible to doubt it; and, in consequence, he does not shrink from attempting what others have failed in. It might indeed be pardoned, if, in embarking in such a perilous controversy, he desired to engage on his side all the aid he could, or at any rate to sink minor differences and propitiate the sympathies of others to judge favourably of his own essay. By no means. He disdains any such pusillanimous compromise. He will do it all by himself; nor only so, but he fairly acquaints others, of whatever religious party, what poor creatures they are, and how incompetent in such matters. The staunch Church of England-men, who admire the Fathers of the English Reformation, for going as far as they did, and no further, cannot, he considers, stand their ground, inasmuch as they ought in consistency to go “the whole hog” with the Oxford writers in their veneration for the Primitive Church. Much less can another division of the old high Church party, whom he at once dismisses as mere Erastian establishment men. Neither are the so-called Evangelicals in better case, of whom indeed he speaks with a kind of sly compassion. Indeed he warns them against entering into close controversy concerning externals in church authority, lest they be driven back unawares upon “the dead levels of political expediency, or the swamps of dissent;” it being only a happy delusion, which blinds them to the fact, that they hold opinions foreign to their principles and discipline of their church. Lastly, the Dissenters are in his judgment quite *hors de combat*, as being far too ignorant to enter upon it hopefully. What then is left for the world but the appearance of a Deus à machinâ, or a Jack the Giant Killer?

That there may be no chance of his being interfered with in his great work, our author adds a word of advice to these respective parties, assuring them of their extraordinary shallowness, and of the absurd figure they will one and all present, should they venture within the lines of controversy. And thus having rid himself of rivals, he sets to work in earnest himself.

Now we suspect that Mr. Taylor has been far more careful to be rid of friends than to secure a foe, which is an indispensable requisite when a man is determined to fight. It is a question whether he is not even supporting the Oxford writers in one chief point in which he thinks he is overwhelming them. What he maintains, we conceive, is, that as the Church was after Constantine, such in substance it was from the first; that we cannot take a period in history so *early*, as not to find what are commonly considered the peculiarities of *later* times. Now this surely is just what writers of the Oxford school have distinctly asserted; the difference between them and him lying in this, not whether the early and later times have substantially agreed in doctrine, but whether that substance is good or bad; and again, whether, where earlier and later disagree, the later have or have not improved upon the earlier. Mr. Taylor considers these additions to be improvements; the Oxford writers consider them corruptions; but the substantial identity of the two systems, at least some of them, distinctly maintain. We refer chiefly to a writer in the British Magazine, undoubtedly

of their way of thinking, who, in a series of papers on the Church of the Fathers, uses language which it is worth while quoting: "If," he says, "the Church system be not apostolic, it must, some time or other, have been introduced; and then comes the question, *when?* We maintain, that the known circumstances of the previous history are such *as to preclude the possibility of any time being assigned, ever so close upon the Apostles, at which it did not exist.* Not only cannot a time be shown when the free-and-easy system now in fashion did generally exist, but *no time* can be shown in which there is not evidence of the existence of the Church system."—*Brit. Mag.* vol. x. p. 282. And what the writer includes in the Church system is quite plain a little further on. Speaking of Origen as persecuted in his day by his bishop, and condemned as heterodox afterwards, he says, "here is a man who was persecuted by his bishop, and driven out of his country; and whose name after his death has been dishonourably mentioned both by councils and fathers. He surely was not in the episcopal conspiracy at least; and perchance may give the Latitudinarian, the Anabaptist, the Erastian, and the Utilitarian some countenance. Far from it; he is as high and as keen, as removed from softness and mawkishness, as *ascetic* and as reverential, as any bishop among them. He is as *superstitious*, as men now talk, as *fanatical*, as *formal*, as *Athanasius* or *Augustine.*" The more clearly then Mr. Taylor proves a substantial agreement in doctrine between the respective ages of Ignatius, Cyprian, Ambrose, Pope Gregory, Hildebrand, and Bernard, the better he seems likely to please such writers as this; and if he is eager for controversy with them, it is a pity he has not taken the other side. As it is, however, he comes into direct collision with Mr. Faber and other respected divines of a different school, who draw a line between the creeds of the second and fifth centuries; and doubtless he will have cause to repent his temerity.

We will notice in passing another mistake committed, by our author, if he wanted to reach the parties at whom he aims. In order to disparage the ancient system of doctrine and ordinance, he attempts to depreciate the character of certain ancient writers. Now, if there is one thing more than another on which his opponents have insisted it is this: that they did not rest their cause on individuals, however eminent, and had no need to do so; that Catholicism was an historical *fact*, like any other historical fact, not a creed such as the Lutheran or Calvinistic, originating in this or that teacher, or in any conspiracy of teachers. If our author wished really to engage with them, he ought to have joined issue on this point; and before writing against the Fathers, to have shown, what many others have asserted, but which he is too sharp-sighted to undertake, that the Catholic system was a gradual corruption *through* the Fathers.

And now as to his attack on the Fathers itself. The point he has selected is the view entertained in the early Church respecting celibacy, as being in itself, when religiously used, a higher state of life than the married state; and this as regards Christians in general, not concerning the clergy in particular. The evil of this doctrine having been made apparent, next he would maintain, that from the very earliest times, indeed from the very age of the Apostles, "The notions and practices connected with the superlative merit of religious celibacy, were at once the causes and the effects of errors in theology, of perverted moral sentiments, of superstitious usages, of hierarchical usurpations:" and that the attendant abuses of this system were nearly or quite as flagrant in early as in later times. The line of argument which he pursues is this. He quotes passages in which the honour of celibacy is glowingly declared, and rules laid down for the guidance of persons devoted to it, in their conduct in the plain practical matters of dress, conversation, places of resort, and the like. He also quotes passages reprehensive, in very strong terms, of irregularities in these particulars in the case of parties so circumstanced. It would seem too, that in some cases the most serious guilt was incurred by these persons; and therefore, as the author of Ancient Christianity

appears to argue, it was quite common among them. However, not to insist upon minor defects of reasoning, an argument is raised upon the foregoing foundation, in substance something like the following. The most ancient Christian writers are clear in their praise of celibacy above the married state—persons endeavouring to keep themselves in this estate fell, nevertheless, into grievous sins contrary to their profession; therefore those sins were caused by that opinion. Let us illustrate this reasoning. The commandment says,—Thou shalt not steal: many persons, under vow too, to keep that commandment, nevertheless break it, therefore the command is to be blamed as the cause of their sin. St. Paul puts the matter in a different point of view: “Is the law sin?” he says, “Was that which is good made death unto me?—God forbid.” Yet he grants, “I had not known sin, but by the law.” Or to take a case exactly apposite concerning another “counsel of perfection,” not binding, but yet recommended by apostolic practice. St. Barnabas and others placed the whole of their private fortunes at the disposal of the Apostles. To emulate the honour of their self-denying charity, and to gain credit for what in their hearts they did not purpose, Ananias and Sapphira made a false pretence of so devoting their property. Therefore the example of St. Barnabas and others was the cause of the great sin of their brethren.

Another equally felicitous mode of drawing conclusions, on which great stress is laid by Mr. Taylor, is the following. Passages are quoted, in which persons, resolved to abide in the celibate, are cautioned about love of dress, against entering gay society, and taking part in light conversations. From these it is inferred, what bad sort of people, how inclined to break loose, must they have been who needed to be seriously and earnestly warned on such points ¹⁹. For instance, what very ill disposed people the Ephesian Christians must have been, since St. Paul warns them as he does at the end of the fourth and beginning of the fifth chapters; what bad bishops must have been in St. Paul’s day, considering his twice repeated injunction, that a bishop should be not “given to wine, no striker, not given to filthy lucre!” The Apostle is actually obliged to charge Timothy not to elect a drunkard, a brawler, or covetous person to the office; which he would never have done had he not observed instances of the kind among his brethren, or at any rate a strong inclination to them.

The truth is, there is an open undisguised plainness, a searching truth and severity, in the writings of the Fathers upon all points of morals, which does offend readers; and which requires some painful reflection and self-humiliation rightly to understand and apply. At first we may be inclined to think that we are more refined and pure than they were, afterwards we may come to see, that what crossed us as tokens of greater refinement and purity in our age, are in truth symptoms of the very opposite character of mind. Surely it might be well had we a Cyprian in our age to write a tract “*de habitu virginum*.” Look into one of the modern novels which are praised for the just notion they give of fashionable society, its words and ways, and will it be affirmed that such words and ways are suitable for maidens to have part in? Or look into a modern ball room, and what candid person will say, that there is nothing in the dress of those who give it its brilliancy and life unbecoming Christian maidens, no desire of admiration in drawing the eyes of men, unbecoming in itself, more unbecoming still in the means employed? “It seems,” says the excellent Hammond, “a piece of Christian chastity there is required of women in this kind, that is not generally thought of.” And if this is so in general, how much more does it become a duty in those who purpose in their own minds to continue single, in the hope that they may in that state better serve God, and please him more?

The author of Ancient Christianity, however, seems to think that persons can be chaste and pure

¹⁹Vide p. 76, 80.

without vigilance and effort; and that the primitive Christians evidently were impure, because they took precautions against impurity. Religious obedience can only be learnt by little things: practical precepts must descend to details; yet the writer in question can bear to be ironical and jocose upon the Fathers, because they used "plainness of speech," like men in earnest, and he thinks he better respects "every pure and manly feeling which shall belong to one who is himself a husband and a father," by talking in a light way both of criminality and of the measures employed for preventing and for punishing it. Unchaste women he calls "loose ladies;" a bishop's solemn trial of suspected parties, he calls "gaining warranty to religious character from the report of the obstetrix;" (p. 74.) Because Christian writers, imbued with the Scriptures, are led to inculcate purity by the example of St. Mary, he calls her "this Cybele of the Fathers," (p. 86), and describes one of them as "a most gallant admirer of the Queen of heaven;" (p. 85.) Even Gibbon, amid his sneers against the early Christians, at the lapses of some through vain confidence of their strength, allows the purity of their lives in general; but they meet with less indulgence from the hands of a professed brother. However, Mr. Taylor, as we have hinted above, is not always reconcilable with himself; and it may be as well to notice, before we turn from him, some of the inconsistencies into which his flowing pen has betrayed him. In spite of his bad opinion of the morals of the early Christians, he speaks of them in one place as follows:—

"Our brethren of the early Church may well challenge our respect as well as affection, for theirs was the fervour of a steady faith in things unseen and eternal; theirs a meek patience and humility, under the most grievous wrongs; theirs the courage to maintain a good profession before the frowning face of philosophy, of secular tyranny, and of splendid superstition; theirs was abstractedness from the world, and a painful self-denial; theirs the most arduous and costly labours of love; theirs a munificence in charity altogether without example; theirs was a reverent and scrupulous care for the sacred writings. * * * * While the near coming of their Lord was firmly expected, and while nothing bad happened of which He had not given His people an intimation, then, and during that fresh morning hour of the Church, there belonged to the followers of Christ generally, a fulness of faith in the realities of the unseen world, such as, in later ages, has been reached only by a very few eminent and meditative individuals;—the thousands then felt a persuasion, which now is felt only by the two or three."

Now, who would believe that men who so lived up to the primitive truth, which they had received from Apostles and apostolic men, should, nevertheless, have drifted off from that very truth without being themselves aware of it, and without any being raised up by God's providence to recall them from their error? That all at once there started up in all parts of the Church this full grown corruption, which he considers their notions to be on the subject of celibacy? Yet *audi alteram partem*.

"I boldly say, that Popery, *foul as it is*, and ever has been, in the mass, might yet fairly represent itself as a *reform* upon *early Christianity*."—p. 79.

But perhaps our author is here reprobating the primitive *system*, and would fairly allow the *men* were much better than their system, and good in spite of their evil opinions. Well, let us try again. We have quoted successively page 38 and page 79, let us see what we find in page 60, half way between the two.

"If it were allowed, which I think it must be, that some periods have very far excelled others in *piety* and wisdom, I should still demur to the allegation, that the era immediately following the death of the apostles can claim any such pre-eminence. Nay, I am compelled to say, that the general impression left upon my mind by the actual evidence, is *altogether of a contrary kind*."

One more specimen and we have done.

"I shall, as I confidently hope, succeed in affording the most convincing proof of the fact, that the Christian teachers, *from the very first*," (the italics are his own) "while they held the formal elements of truth, or, as it is called, orthodoxy, grossly misapprehended the genius and purport of Christianity; and as a consequence of this misapprehension, turned out of its course every Christian institute, and *put on a false foundation every principle of virtue*: and thus transmuted the Christian system into a scheme, which could find no other fixed form than that of a *foul superstition* and a *lawless despotism*." (p. 123.)

Are we not justified in the anticipation which we have already expressed, that this writer may in due time finish his performance by the brilliant feat, sometimes advertised on the bills of less intellectual artists, of swallowing himself; and so ridding us of the trouble and disgust of closing with him in so odious a controversy?

It is indeed pleasant to turn from him to a work of a very different description, and which affords a practical answer to his loose and vulgar merriment on the subject of virginity, better than any of those which logic or learning can supply. This writer will find he has arrayed against him not only the whole ancient Church, but he must also number among his opponents some of the best and most revered names in our own: nay, that among moderns too he must make account to find opponents besides the Oxford writers, whom he singles out—men, like the editor of the excellent piece of biography to which we are about to call attention, whom independent thought and reading will not suffer to acquiesce in the shallow views of these nineteenth-century men.

Nicholas Ferrar, the subject of this little memoir, was one of the most remarkable men of his age. He was the son of a wealthy London merchant, and born in 1592. At as early an age as six, not only his great talents, but his deep religious feelings became very observable. Blessed with excellent parents, particularly a mother of rare understanding and piety, none of these beginnings were let fall to the ground, or wanted careful attention. They were also eminently successful in their choice of a school for him; and in his thirteenth year his master, declaring him "more than ripe for the University," accompanied him to Cambridge and settled him at Clare Hall. In 1610 he was unanimously chosen fellow. So well known were his attainments and character by that time, that Dr. Lindsell, his tutor, afterwards Bishop of Peterborough, was wont to exclaim "May God keep him in his right mind! for if he should turn schismatic or heretic, he would make work for all the world. Such a head! such power of argument! such a tongue! such a pen! such a memory withal he hath, with indefatigable pains, that all these joined together, I know not who would be able to contend with him!" His health at this time was so delicate, that, by advice of physicians, he was recommended to travel abroad, as the only means of preserving his life. He travelled in Holland, Germany, Italy, and Spain. Wherever he went his active mind found subjects of interest and inquiry. Not only such general subjects as language, government, manners, and the state of religion, but the strength of fortresses, magnitude of arsenals and magazines, trade, commerce, revenues, expense of garrisons and navies, system of ship-building, on all these he was curious in collecting information. Painters, weavers, dyers, smiths, and other mechanics were much at his lodgings, and he entered eagerly into details of their craft, so completely did he throw himself into all practical matters of real life. How thorough a man of business he was is shown in the following particulars of his life. His travels were suddenly cut short by news which reached him in Spain of great pecuniary embarrassments in which his father was involved. He hastened home, and by his able management the affairs of the house were honourably and successfully arranged. At this time also, through his father, he became interested in the affairs of a company formed

for the colonization of Virginia and conversion of the natives. Many of the nobility and leading merchants were promoters of this scheme, but the conduct of the whole details of the company's business gradually came under Ferrar's management. He drew up the letters of instruction for the government and trade of the colony, which having been examined by the Privy Council, before which certain accusations were laid against the company by the Lord Treasurer Cranfield, Earl of Middlesex, and other powerful persons, received the commendation of many there "for their soundness of matter with respect both to religion and policy, and for their uncommon elegance of language." Even down to the victualling and equipment of the company's ships he was manager. In the year 1624, he was elected member of the House of Commons. And when, in that session, the Earl of Middlesex was impeached, Ferrar, with Lord Cavendish and Sir Edwin Sandys, were ordered by the House to draw up the charge, and Mr. Ferrar was deputed to bring it in. He used to reproach himself afterwards much for his active part in this transaction, as it was known to be against the wishes of the king, and because also of some free speeches, made, as it would seem, by him against the will of his prince; so much so, that he was heard to say, stretching out his right hand, "I would I were assured of the pardon of that sin, though on the condition that this hand were cut off." Perhaps this regret hastened a resolution he had made some time before. This he executed in the following year, retiring with his mother and her children, grand-children, and other near relations, to an estate which he had purchased at Little Gidding, near Huntingdon, and passing the remainder of his life in a monastic seclusion, and almost exclusively given to devotional exercises. He began at once with a regular course, at Church and in the house, dividing the family into parties for the performance of the domestic services. They were in all about forty persons, "of whom above twenty where so descended from Mrs. Ferrar, that they kneeled to her morning and evening for her blessing."

Mr. Ferrar obtained leave of the bishop of the diocese, in consideration of the plague still raging, to use the Litany every day in the Church; and having once introduced it he had licence to retain it after the plague. They had three distinct daily services. Besides this, each hour of the day had a certain proportion of Psalms allotted to be said in it, by some part or division in the family: so that the whole Psalter was duly and devoutly said over by them, verse by verse, interchangeably, within the compass of the twenty-four hours. These household services for the different hours were so framed that the collect, the Psalm, the Gospel and all, lasted but a quarter of an hour. This system was commenced in the summer of 1625.

A little before Whitsuntide in the following year, Mr. Ferrar went to London with his mother for some settlement of their affairs, and on Trinity Sunday he was ordained deacon by Bishop Laud, being presented by his former college tutor, Dr. Lindsell, "by whom the bishop was prepared to receive him with tokens of particular esteem, and with a great deal of joy that he was to lay hands on so extraordinary a person:" his purpose being, as he told his mother when he returned home to her in the evening, to separate himself to serve God in this holy calling, namely, to be the Levite himself in his own house, and to make his own relations, who were many, his cure of souls."

Here then we have a person from his earliest years distinguished for remarkable piety—no fanatic—not disorderly in his zeal, for his biographer records of him, that while at Cambridge (under 20 years of age be it remembered), judgment and discretion were qualities he possessed in a more transcendent degree, his age considered, than any one of his other eminent virtues—with a most powerful mind and prodigious industry—born to a plentiful fortune—one, who had seen the world far more than most of his day—keen in his desire for knowledge upon the most various subjects—moving in good society—a member of parliament, with considerable reputation in the

political world—a person in no way disposed to be eccentric, but conforming, in things indifferent, to the ways of those among whom he lived, and, which is also to be observed, a person of very rare modesty and humility, and devotedly attached to the Church of England; we see such a person deliberately resolving in the prime of life to continue in celibacy, and retire from the world as a higher line than that from which he withdrew. Nor was this resolution hastily adopted or formed upon some sudden impulse. There is proof that he had determined upon it some years before. A rich merchant, one of his brother directors in the Virginian Company, who had an only daughter (who is described by the Bishop of Ely, his biographer, as “a very agreeable person, and a great fortune withal”), became so attached to Ferrar that he quite courted him for her, and when he still pressed him, after Ferrar had endeavoured playfully to turn off the subject, he at last told him, that his resolution was not to marry at all.” His intention to form his family into a kind of monastic society appears also in this, which the bishop, his biographer, has recorded, that “the habit of the young women was a black stuff, all of one grave fashion, and always the same.” Thus we have Ferrar’s own view pretty clearly marked as to the celibate, and the accordance of societies of a monastic character with the genius of our Church.

But we may next look to the opinion of churchmen of his day concerning this experiment, for that it would be much canvassed and discussed may be conceived, were it only from Ferrar’s extensive acquaintance, and his intimacy with some of the leading men of the day. For, conceive in our time, if a young man well known for his great abilities, and industry, and success, of high character during his university career, of independent fortune, a member parliament, to whom many looked as likely to hold a distinguished place in the councils of the state, in case of a change in the government,—conceive if he were to put in execution such a sign as Ferrar’s; would it not be the talk of the day, a subject for articles in newspapers? Would not all sorts of reports, always exaggerated, be spread about his proceedings? Would not clergy, and thoughtful laymen who attend the London Religious Societies be quite alive and aghast at the news? Yet about nine months after Ferrar had followed this system—quite time enough for news of all to travel to London, without losing any thing on the road—he was ordained by Bishop Laud, who expressed singular satisfaction thereat, and Ferrar was introduced by Lindsell, afterwards Bishop of Peterborough. Here then is the testimony of two bishops. We may add Williams, Bishop of Lincoln, his diocesan and visitor of the little academy, who gave him his company at Gidding several times, and highly approved their order and manner of living. And, on one occasion, at his departure gave them all his paternal benediction, and affectionately embracing Mr. Ferrar, took his leave of him with this hearty prayer: “Deus tibi animum istum, et animo isti tempus longissimum concedat.” Cosin also, then Master of Peterhouse, afterwards Bishop of Durham, with Archbishop Laud, presented to the King a work of the religious society’s execution, and communicated with them about the execution of another piece; from which we imagine thus much may be fairly inferred, that he did not think Ferrar held views of dangerous tendency, or not allowable in a minister of the English Church. Turner, Bishop of Ely, was his biographer, and calls his life “not only admirable, but *imitable*—by the gentry especially, or by his fellow-citizens, who gain plentiful estates, and then retire into the country:” and he says, one design of writing his life was, “as an illustrious example of a more illuminate man in the Church of England, than any, I believe, they can show us in the Church of Rome, if they will tell us nothing but the honest truth; or any other sect whatever.” To descend to others of lower note, the clergyman of the neighbouring parish of Steeple Gidding was on most cordial terms with him, coming over always on Sunday morning, bringing his own flock with him, to preach at Little Gidding Church. Their country neighbours, of the better sort, were not afraid of

the Ferrar family, nor were they, on their part, forgetful of due civilities to them.—

“Whenever they were pleased to afford their company at Gidding, (which for the novelty of the thing many frequently did) they were received with all the obligingness, and treated with all the respect to which, according to the rules of Christian politeness and courtesy, they were entitled. The more substantial marks of hospitality also were not wanting; the refreshments of wine or a tankard of ale, with a piece of cake, were offered to all comers of any note; but though many of high quality lingered there, as if desirous to stay their meals, or take up their lodging with them, yet they took it not amiss at their departure, that no invitation was given them, finding that it was not their custom to entertain strangers in that indiscriminate manner, except in cases of manifest necessity or charity ... Hardly one day passed in which some distinguished person, either friend or stranger, did not come to pay him reverence ... He always gave orders, that if any one came to speak with him, though he were at his studies, he should be informed of it.”

Sir Edwin Sandys, son of the Archbishop of York, a pupil of Hooker, was one of his intimate friends. Kennet, in his Book on Improvements, bestows praise on their society. King Charles I., no mean judge of what the spirit of that Church allowed, for which he was a martyr, on an occasion, after much discourse about an harmony of the Books of Kings and Chronicles, which by his request they had executed for him, and regarding their manner of living, concluded thus: “How happy a prince were I, if there were many such families in my kingdom, who would employ themselves as these do at Gidding.” His funeral sermon was preached by the Dean of Ely. And lastly, we have reserved to say, that George Herbert, the model of a Church of England country parson, had a warm regard and very great respect for him, and such opinion of his judgment, that he sent “the Temple,” to him before publication, desiring him to read it, “and then, if he think it may turn to the advantage of any poor dejected soul, let it be made public: if not let him burn it;” and Mr. Ferrar contributed a preface to it.

It will not be supposed, that a family like that of the Ferrars could hold on their way in such a course as they followed, without being censured and condemned by many. They had their share of such critics of their system. They were vilified as papists and puritans, their establishment was denounced, even to parliament, as an “Arminian Nunnery,” in an inflammatory pamphlet full of invective, malignity, and falsehood. The humility of his whole life would be sufficient answer to the imputation, that he placed any reliance on the merit of his works. Two little incidents in his last illness, which remind us of the last days of the excellent Hammond, shall be mentioned. A visitor suggesting that he must have great joy at the many alms-deeds he had done, was hastily interrupted: “What speak you of such things? It had been but a suitable return for me to have given all I had, instead of scattering a few crumbs here and there: God forgive me!” Another time, one reading from the Visitation Service by his bed side, “For what cause soever this sickness is sent unto you, whether it be to try your patience for the example of others,” went on, “or *for our punishment.*” At the unauthorised addition of these words he was much displeased, beseeching him to speak at that rate no more, for he was “a most miserable sinner.” That his views were clear and well defined, and in no way approximated to the peculiarities of Rome, is shown in the following anecdotes. Three learned priests of that Church visited him once at Gidding, and they had a conference, in which (it is said) “they traversed every essential point of difference between Protestant and Papist;” and one of them was heard to say afterwards, that “if he (Mr. Ferrar) lived to make himself known to the world, he would give their Church her hands full to answer him, and trouble them in another manner than Luther had done.” Another time, being asked what he would do, if mass were celebrated in his house without his leave or knowledge? he said, “he

would pull down that room, though he built another.” We doubt whether the zeal of many of our modern Protestants would carry them so far. As in other respects they might say he showed narrow-minded bigotry in approaching too near to Romanism, so in this in being over-fearful and abhorrent of it. Such acts as these are more than enough to answer the vague charges brought against him; and while the latter have fallen to the ground, Ferrar’s example remains. His life has been written and rewritten; and the little volume from which we have made our extracts is the second edition in this modernized form. It is a good sign of a love for what is good and holy, and above our age, that there should be a demand for such a work; and let it never be forgotten, that, notwithstanding the objections raised to him in his day, he had, upon the whole, the approbation of the rulers of the Church, and of the wise and good, not simply as if his life were allowable, but praise-worthy for those who could receive it; though it intimated on the face of it the persuasion that the single state given to devotion was the higher line to choose. For it is evident that every one would have understood this to have been the view of a family so living together and so ordered.

Nicolas Ferrar is the picture of no ordinary Christian—one, who in all times of the Church, and in all countries, would be at once recognizable by his life and manners—his faith and word. Whether brought up at the feet of an Apostle, or, like St. Antony, settled in the solitudes of Egypt, or with Basil, in the more monastic retirement in Pontus—with Chrysostom, in Constantinople—or with Augustine in Africa, or with Ambrose in Italy; whether in the first, or third, or sixth century, or in the “dark ages”—or at the Reformation—or in our own bright days of Hooker, Herbert and Laud—a Christian every where, and in every age, and in all his life: a Christian, such as the author of Ancient Christianity cannot tolerate, and who was guilty of holding most of those views, which Mr. Taylor asserts tend to all sorts of immorality, to narrow formalism, to a reliance on externals, to a neglect of inward purity of heart, to pride and presumption. Certainly, he and his seem to have been singularly preserved from their imminent danger.

Since we are upon the subject, it may be satisfactory to add the testimony of two of our principal devotional writers, of very different schools of divinity, and in estimation among very distinct sections of the church, who appear to hold the doctrine which Ferrar practised. It was, in the judgment of Leighton, “*the great and fatal error of the Reformation, that more of those (religious) houses, and of that course of life, free from the entanglement of vows, and other mixtures, was not preserved. So that the Protestant Churches had neither places of education nor retreat for men of mortified tempers.*”²⁰ Thus Leighton thought the great and fatal error of the Reformation to be the doing away those very institutions which we are now told are so very corrupt in all their forms. Jeremy Taylor, in the most popular of his works, distinctly recognizes it, and used terms to designate that state, and lays down rules precisely of a kind which move the scorn and indignation of our modern writers against the Fathers. The following will be enough: “Natural virginity, of itself, is not a state more acceptable to God; but that which is chosen and voluntary, in order to the conveniences of religion, and separated from worldly incumbrances, is therefore better than the married life,—not that it is more holy, but that it is a freedom from cares, an opportunity to spend more time in spiritual employments; it is not alloyed with businesses and attendance upon lower affairs: and if it be a chosen condition to these ends, it containeth in it a victory over lusts, and greater desires of religion and self-denial, and therefore is more excellent than the married life, in that degree in which it hath greater religion and a greater mortification, a less satisfaction of natural desires, and a greater fulness of the spiritual: and just so is to expect that little coronet or special

²⁰Burnet’s Lives, Ed. Bishop Jebb, p. 288.

reward, which God hath prepared (extraordinary, and besides the great crown of all faithful souls) for those 'who have not defiled themselves with women, but follow the Virgin Lamb for ever.'"

Such is the judgment of the seventeenth century; but strange things are circulated in the nineteenth. We hear, for instance, a wish has been expressed, that bishops should not prefer any one in their respective dioceses who should ever speak ministerially in favor of celibacy. The next step, we suppose, would be that a matrimonial engagement should be a necessary title for orders; or an extract from the marriage register might be one of the ordinary papers sent in together with the *Si quis*, or College testimonial. Expectations, we hear, have been entertained of the effect of the first open avowal of opinion on the subject of celibacy on the part of those who are said to be favourable to it. It is hoped that whenever broached by them, it will be protested against and put down by the "good sense" of the people of England with indignation and abhorrence. It may be so. Meanwhile we would observe that that same English "good sense" is not infallible, particularly in church matters. At least we suspect that the "good sense" of the majority of intelligent men who had never thought on the subject, would at first sight decide that 2000*l.* is ample provision for a bishop, or that it would be an improvement to admit Dissenters to power and station in our Universities. On the other hand, sorry as we are to disturb the peace of mind of many comfortable family men, we are not over-sure that the "common sense" of the nation *would* be altogether opposed to the course under consideration. We are not so sure, that the notion of persons abstaining from marriage in order to give themselves more to God, and not to be entangled with the affairs of this life, or from fear of becoming indolent amid domestic comforts, or covetous from anxieties about a family; or in order to devote themselves to works of charity and self-denial; nay, as a kind of severity towards themselves for trifling and thoughtlessness in times past, would offend people's common sense, at least if they were people who knew what the Bible said on the subject, and especially when they were informed, that persons did not bind this in themselves by a vow, but only purposed in themselves so to abide, if God give them grace to do so.

It is well that this subject should be brought before the public mind. We do not know whither the necessities of our times are tending. There is a strong and awakened sense of the appalling spiritual destitution of our great towns. The public mind is more and more drawn to it. Facts and figures are coming out; and men are beginning to realize this oppressing subject with definite statistical notions of its enormous magnitude, and the difficulty, and yet the absolute necessity for a remedy. Men of all ranks and professions are making sacrifices of money: other personal sacrifices will follow. The more the subject is brought out, the more will it be forced upon the public mind, that our existing parochial system (humanly speaking) is utterly powerless for making head against the tide of irreligion that sets in. But lately, there was a meeting for providing schools and churches for a single district in one corner of London, at which this fearful fact is stated, that there are 700,000 souls, and church accommodation for but 5000. The Bishop of London, as everywhere, was forward with his munificent contribution. But what a time it must be before money can be raised, and churches built, and clergymen settled to begin labour among these Christian souls. Specially then, we envy the lot of him who may have boldness to make trial of associating a number of young men as a collegiate body, for the cheaper supply of an efficient ministry to operate on these dense and dark masses of sin and ignorance, to live with him, not tied by vows, but purposing in their hearts, by God's grace, not to entangle themselves in the affairs of this life, that they may the more devote themselves to this great work. One word from that active prelate, and we doubt not some one would be found, under his sanction and encouragement, to make the attempt, some one perhaps with chance advantages of local connections, which would prevent the experiment

being scorned as not respectable, but might from such chance influence, as it were, command a fair trial. It would be a noble addition to the praise of his lordship's munificent charity, to have brought into practice a plan, by which, under God's providence, so much might be done, and which, if judiciously managed under his advice and patronage, would soon be adopted elsewhere, so that his name might go down to posterity as the *Christianizer of the great Towns of our Land*.

ART. II.—The Court of King James the First. By Dr. Godfrey Goodman, Bishop of Gloucester. To which are added Letters illustrative. Now first published from the Original MSS. By John S. Brewer, M.A. Bentley. 1839.

[?] "Autograph list at Pusey House gives both Newman and Brewer, each with a '?' In *Opuscula* at B.O., N includes only p. 39."—Blehl.

[*British Critic*, vol. 27, January 1840.]

THESE volumes contain a great deal of what may be called the gossip of the times to which they relate, or, in other words, of curious and interesting matter, for such gossip is, so far as it is true. The Memoirs of Bishop Goodman, of which the first volume consists, are published from the MS. copy preserved in the Bodleian Library; and the letters, which form the second, have been collected from various depositories, with a view of supplying a general illustration to the Memoirs. Mr. Brewer, to whom we are indebted for the publication, has added a number of apposite historical notes, which show much reading, and increase the attraction of the work.

Goodman, Bishop of Gloucester in the reign of Charles the First, lies under the odium of having conformed to the Church of Rome; and certain it is, he had a difference with Archbishop Laud, at the celebrated Convocation of 1640. In that convocation a canon was enacted against Papists, and Goodman would not sign it. In consequence he was committed to prison, "where he got by his restraint," says Fuller, "what he could never have gained by his liberty; namely, of one reputed Papist to become for a short time popular, as the only confessor suffering for not subscribing the canons."—*Hist.* iii. In the beginning of his episcopate a petition had been presented against him to the king, by Bastwick, Barton, and Prynne, for having, "at his proper cost," as they said, repaired the high cross in the town of Windsor, and made it a crucifix; also for putting up an altar in his cathedral, and introducing cushions and cloths with the crucifix worked upon them. Moreover, it seems, he had interfered with a clergyman who had been preaching against the "idolatries of the Papists," and declaring that either obstinate Papists, dying Papists, would not be saved, or else Protestants could not. The bishop is said to have wished him to own that in the eye of the law we were still one with the Church of Rome, though politically severed from it; that it was an offence, nay, a deadly and mortal wound against our own Church to say that members of the Roman Church cannot be saved, inasmuch as we have the same orders, church service, ceremonies, fasts, and feasts as they. Shortly before this he had been reprimanded for maintaining certain unsound opinions at Court, and was generally suspected of embracing the tenets of Romanism. In his Memoirs he advocates auricular confession.

An editor is bound to feel chivalrously towards his author, and Mr. Brewer is not behind his duty. He meets ultra-Protestants with their own weapons,—severity in weighing and difficulty in admitting evidence; and fairly argues that it does not *follow*, it is not *necessary*, it is not *certain*, that, because Bishop Goodman said this or that, therefore he was other than "a sound Protestant."

"In his will he professed that as he had lived so he died, most constant in all the articles of our Christian faith, and in all the doctrine of God's holy Catholic and Apostolic Church, 'whereof,' he

says, 'I do acknowledge the Church of Rome to be the mother Church. And I do verily believe that no other Church hath any salvation in it, but only so far as it concurs with the faith of the Church of Rome.' *But* a sound Protestant *might* even profess as much; the only question being what he meant by the terms 'mother Church,' and 'concurs with the faith of the Church of Rome.' A Romanist would rather have professed that the Church of Rome was the only true Church, and would scarcely have admitted the possibility of salvation in a Church separate and distinct from the Church at Rome. At least, if Goodman was consistent, he, having been so long a member of the Church of England, could scarcely say that he had lived most constant to the faith of the Church of Rome, if he considered the Church of Rome to be the only true Catholic and Apostolic Church."—*Introd.* xii. xiii.

However, it is certain that during the latter part of his life the bishop had been in habits of intimacy with the well-known Santa Clara, and died in his company. Wood calls him "a harmless man," "hurtful to none but himself," "faithful to the poor and hospitable to his neighbours." That he was kindhearted and placable is shown by his praising, in the course of his Memoirs, both Laud and Williams, though he had had differences with both.

Bishop Goodman was nephew of Dr. Gabriel Goodman, forty years Dean of Westminster, and one of the translators of the English Bible. He was born in 1583, and educated at Westminster School, under the historian Camden, of whom he has recorded some sayings in his Memoirs. From Westminster he was removed to Trinity College, Cambridge; and came into life about the time of King James's accession and the Raleigh and Gunpowder plots; the latter of which he calls "The most wicked and cursed attempt that ever was practised by man, and generally acknowledged for a truth on all sides."—vol. i. p. 160. There had been abundance of plots in Elizabeth's time, but from the ease and unconcern with which she went into public, the bishop argues, either that she did not fear much from them, or that she was, as was certain, "of a wonderful courage and undaunted spirit."—p. 161.

"In the year '88," he says, that is, when he was a boy of five years old, "I did then live at the upper end of the Strand near St. Clement's Church, when suddenly there came a report unto us, (it was in December, much about five of the clock at night, very dark,) that the queen was gone to council, and if you will see the queen you must come quickly. Then we all ran; when the court gates were set open, and no man did hinder us from coming in. There we came where there was a far greater company than was usually at Lenten Sermons; and when we had staid there an hour and that the yard was full, there being a number of torches, the queen came out in great state. Then we cried, 'God save your majesty! God save your majesty!' Then the queen turned unto us and said, 'God bless you all, my good people!' Then we cried again, 'God save your majesty! God save your majesty!' Then the queen said again unto us, 'You may well have a greater prince, but you shall never have a more loving prince:' and so looking one upon another awhile the queen departed. This wrought such an impression upon us, for shows and pageants are ever best seen by torchlight, that all the way long we did nothing but talk what an admirable queen she was, and how we would adventure our lives to do her service. Now this was in a year when she had most enemies, and how easily might they have then gotten into the crowd and multitude to have done her a mischief! But here we were to come in at the court gates, and there was all the danger of searching.

"Take her then in her yearly journeys at her coming to London, where you must understand that she did desire to be seen and to be magnified ... The queen's constant custom was a little before her coronation-day to come from Richmond to London, and to dine with my Lord Admiral at

Chelsea, and to set out from Chelsea at dark night, where the Lord Mayor and the Aldermen were to meet her; and here all the way long from Chelsea to Whitehall was full of people to see her, and truly any man might very easily have come to her coach. Now if she thought that she had been in danger, how is it credible that she should so adventure herself? King James, who was as harmless a king as any was in our age, and consequently had as few enemies, yet wore quilted doublets stiletto proof: the queen had many enemies: all her wars depended upon her life: she had likewise very fearful examples: the first Duke of Guise was shot; Henry the Third, the French king, was stabbed; the Duke of Orange was pistoled;—and these might make the Queen take heed.”—vol. i. pp. 163-165.

The queen preserved her spirit to the last. Bishop Goodman gives us a curious instance of it, in a different way, only two years before her death,

“when the French king, Henry the Fourth, matching with a daughter of Florence, many nobles of Italy came to attend her to Paris; and when the solemnity of the marriage was past, Duke Prusiano [Bracciano], a very courteous and brave nobleman, did resolve to come over to see England, and to come in a private way. Our ambassador in France, hearing thereof, gave notice to our secretary, who acquainting her majesty therewith, order was taken that one should come in his company, to be a spy upon him, to know his lodgings and to discover his person. The duke (as the fashion was) came to the court upon a Sunday, to see the queen go to the chapel. The queen having notice of this, and knowing him by one that stood next to him, as she came by took some occasion to call the lord chamberlain, as I take it, to tie her shoe-strings, or to do some such like office; and there making a stay, she took the duke by the hand, who followed her into the privy chamber. She did then graciously use him, and after feasted him, and gave him great entertainment, which was very well taken by the French king and queen: and then did the queen dance a galliard very comely, and like herself, to show the vigour of her old age. Even the Italians did then say that it was a wonder to see an old woman, the head of the Church, being seventy years of age, to dance in that manner, and to perform her part so well.”—vol. i. pp. 17, 18.

We are sorry to spoil the mirth, or diminish the wonderment, of the Italians, but we beg leave to state that the queen had no such dignity to support during her galliard as the headship of the Church; nay, that she herself had a great dislike of this title, as being an unwarrantable interference with religion: Henry the Eighth, indeed, among his other excesses, had been bold enough to assume it; but Mary had repealed Henry’s statute; and though Elizabeth seems to have repealed Mary’s with many others of her sister’s statutes, and thus accidentally revived the title; yet that this was an accident, and that the title, if formally legal, does not constitutionally belong to the crown of England, is proved by a number of incontrovertible facts, and acknowledged by the most unbiassed authorities. Instead of “Head of the Church,” Elizabeth took the title of “Supreme Governor,” and that expressly as having, as Burnet informs us, “a scruple about it.” Jewell says the same, writing at the time of Elizabeth’s accession, and adds, *suo periculo*, that “that title could not be justly given to any mortal.” This implies, of course, that the Zurich and Geneva people disliked it, as indeed might have been conjectured; and it is as certain that the title was offensive to Roman Catholics; indeed Burnet informs us, that Elizabeth declined it “to mitigate their opposition.” No pretensions then could have met with a more rough protest, on all hands, than did those of the English Crown to be Head of the Church on the accession of Elizabeth.

Elizabeth died in 1603; and her death was followed by what is called the “Bye Plot,” which was the occasion of Raleigh’s trial. Mr. Brewer has given us a very painful letter from the library of All Souls College addressed by Raleigh to his wife, after his condemnation. It is not unlike a letter to

her which is contained in the Biographia Britannica; but that letter was written from Winchester the night before his reprieve, when he was in immediate expectation of death, whereas the letter which Mr. Brewer has published, though written under a similar expectation, is addressed to her from the Tower. The topics in both are remarkably the same; indeed it is difficult to make out when he could have been a second time in the circumstances described; or, on the other hand, how he could have composed on one occasion two letters so like each other. The Winchester letter observes, that his wife was receiving his last words in these his last lines. "I beseech you," he continues, "for the love you bear me living, that you do not hide yourself many days; but, by your travels, seek to help my miserable fortunes, and the right of my poor child." He goes on to speak of his estate and his debts. After this, occurs a sentence so like what is found in the Tower letter, that we wonder Mr. Brewer should not have noticed it as throwing suspicion upon the genuineness of the one or the other; all that can be said is, that every one gets into the way of repeating certain phrases and forms of speech, especially when under the influence of excitement. The sentence in the Winchester letter to which we refer is as follows: "Have a care of the fair pretences of man ... I speak not to dissuade you from marriage, for it will be best for you, both in respect to God and the world. *As for me I am no more yours, nor you mine.*"

With these remarks we now set before our readers Mr. Brewer's document. He observes that it decides the much controverted question whether Raleigh attempted his life in prison.

"Receive from thy unfortunate husband these his last lines, these the last words that ever thou shalt receive from him. That I can live to think never to see thee and my child more, I cannot. I have desired God and disputed with my reason, but nature and compassion hath the victory. That I can live to think how you are both left a spoil to my enemies, and that my name shall be a dishonor to my child, I cannot, I cannot endure the memory thereof: unfortunate woman, unfortunate child, comfort yourselves, trust God, and be contented with your poor estate; I would have bettered it if I had enjoyed a few years. Thou art a young woman, and forbear not to marry again: *it is now nothing to me; thou art no more mine, nor I thine.* To witness that thou didst love me once, take care that thou marry not to please sense, but to avoid poverty, and to preserve thy child. That thou didst also love me living, witness it to others; to my poor daughter, to whom I have given nothing; for his sake, who will be cruel to himself to preserve thee. Be charitable to her, and teach thy son to love her for his father's sake. For myself, I am left of all men, that have done good to many. All my good turns forgotten, all my errors revived and expounded to all extremity of ill; all my services, hazards, and expenses for my country, plantings, discoveries, fights, councils, and whatsoever else, malice hath now covered over. I am now made an enemy and traitor by the word of an unworthy man; he hath proclaimed me to be a partaker of his vain imaginations, notwithstanding the whole course of my life hath approved the contrary, as my death shall approve it. Woe, woe, woe be unto him by whose falsehood we are lost! he hath separated us asunder; he hath slain my honor, my fortune; he hath robbed thee of thy husband, thy child of his father, and me of you both. Oh, God! thou dost know my wrongs: know then thou my wife and child; know then thou, my Lord and King, that I ever thought them too honest to betray, and too good to conspire against. But my wife, forgive thou all as I do; live humble, for thou hast but a time also. God forgive my Lord Harry²¹, for he was my heavy enemy. And for my Lord Cecill I thought he would never forsake me in extremity; I would not have done it him, God knows. But do not thou know it, for he must be master of thy child, and may have compassion of him. Be not dismayed that I died in despair of God's mercies;

²¹Cobham.

strive not to dispute it; but assure thyself that God hath not left me, nor Satan tempted me. Hope and despair live not together; I know it is forbidden to destroy ourselves, but I trust it is forbidden in this sort, that we destroy not ourselves despairing of God's mercy.

"The mercy of God is immeasurable, the cogitations of men comprehend it not. In the Lord I have ever trusted, and I know that my Redeemer liveth: far is it from me to be tempted with Satan; I am only tempted with sorrow, whose sharp teeth devour my heart. O God, that art goodness itself, thou canst not be but good to me! Oh, God, that art mercy itself, thou canst not be but merciful to me!

"For my state is conveyed to feoffees, to your cousin Brett and others; I have but a bare estate for a short life. My plate is at gage in Lombard Street: my debts are many. To Peter Vanlore, some £600. To Antrobus as much, but Cumpson is to pay £300 of it. To Michael Hext ²², £100. To George Carew, £100. To Nicholas Sanders, £100. To John Fitz-James, £100. To Mr. Waddow, £100. To a poor man, one Hawker, for horses, £70. To a poor man, called Hunt, £20. Take first care of those for God's sake. To a brewer at Weymouth, and a baker for my Lord Cecill's ship and mine, I think some £80; John Renolds knoweth it. And let that poor man have his true part of my return from Virginia; and let the poor men's wages be paid with the goods, for the Lord's sake. Oh, what will my poor servants think at their return, when they hear I am accused to be Spanish, who sent them, to my great charge, to plant and discover upon his territory? Oh, intolerable infamy! Oh, God! I cannot resist these thoughts; I cannot live to think how I am derided, to think of the expectation of my enemies, the scorns I shall receive, the cruel words of lawyers, the infamous taunts and despites, to be made a wonder and a spectacle! Oh, death! hasten thee unto me, that thou mayest destroy the memory of these, and lay me up in dark forgetfulness. Oh, death! destroy my memory, which is my tormentor; my thoughts and my life cannot dwell in one body. But do thou forget me, poor wife, that thou mayest live to bring up thy poor child. I recommend unto you my poor brother, A. Gilbert. The lease of sanding is his, and none of mine; let him have it for God's cause; he knows what is due to me upon it. And be good to Kemis, for he is a perfect honest man, and hath much wrong for my sake. For the rest, I commend me to them, and them to God. And the Lord knows my sorrow to part from thee and my poor child; but part I must by enemies and injuries, part with shame and triumph of my detractors; and therefore be contented with this work of God, and forget me in all things but thine own honor, and the love of mine. I bless my poor child, and let him know his father was no traitor. Be bold of my innocence, for God, to whom I offer life and soul, knows it. And whosoever thou choose again after me, let him be but thy politique husband; but let my son be thy beloved, for he is part of me, and I live in him, and the difference is but in the number, and not in the kind. And the Lord for ever keep thee and them, and give thee comfort in both worlds!"—vol. ii. p. 93-97.

We have already seen in what terms Bishop Goodman speaks of the gunpowder plot, making no question whatever of its real existence. He describes the principals in it to have been men full of zeal for their party, but destitute of personal religion. However, he speaks well of Garnet and some others, and gives the following account of his condemnation;—that the government apprehended him on the general ground of his being the provincial jesuit, and having no evidence against him, had recourse to artifice. They put him into a chamber where he could be overheard, and then introduced a confessor to him and set persons to listen. His confession was reported; in which he acknowledged that in hearing the confession of others, he had come to knowledge of the plot; and

²²Hickes.—See Lodge's *Illust.* iii. 218.

upon this evidence he was condemned and executed. Mr. Brewer adds nothing in elucidation of this point. The Bishop adds that "it hath since appeared that divers priests in their letters to Rome did much complain that they found Catholics very desperate, and that they could not persuade them to any obedience, but did much fear they intended mischief."—vol. i. p. 108. It would be a curious point to ascertain whether Garnet made his confessee renounce the plot, or had refused him absolution.

The despair of the Roman party was the consequence of the hopes which they had entertained of an easier time in England after the death of Elizabeth.

"They did live in some hope that after the old woman's life they might have some mitigation, and even those who did then persecute them were a little more moderate, as being doubtful what times might succeed, and fearing their own case; but now that they saw the times settled, having no hope of better days, but expecting that the uttermost rigour of the law should be executed, they became desperate; finding that by the laws of the kingdom their own lives were not secured, and for the coming over of a priest into England it was no less than high treason. A gentlewoman was hanged only for relieving and harbouring a priest; a citizen was hanged only for being reconciled to the Church of Rome besides, the penal laws were such and so executed that they could not subsist;—what as usually sold in shops and openly bought, this the pursuivant would take away from them as being popish and superstitious. One knight did affirm that in one term he gave twenty nobles in rewards to the doorkeeper of the attorney general; another did affirm, that his third part which remained unto him of his estate did hardly serve for his expense in law to defend him from other oppressions; besides their children to be taken from home to be brought up in another religion. So they did every way conclude that their estate was desperate; they could die but once, and their religion was more precious unto them than their lives. They did further consider their misery, how they were debarred in any course of life to help themselves: they could not practise law, they could not be citizens, they could have no office, they could not breed up their sons—none did desire to match with them; they had neither fit marriages for their daughters, nor nunneries to put them into,—for those few which are beyond seas are not considerable in respect of the number of recusants, and none can be admitted into those without great sums of money, which they, being exhausted, could not supply. The Spiritual Court did not cease to molest them, to excommunicate them, then to imprison them; and thereby they were utterly disenabled to sue for their own.

"These, and many other their pretended grievances, did put that resolution into them as upon the first advantage either they would lose all, or vindicate their religion and their liberty."—vol. i. pp. 100, 101.

Horrible as the particular project fixed upon was, still such is the wickedness of man, it seems not even to have the praise of originality:—

"The Plot of the Gunpowder it was not so strange and new as some will make it; for Bishop Fisher, in Henry the Eighth's time, after his cook had been lured to poison his porridge, whereby, as I take it, sixteen of his family were poisoned, and himself not eating porridge that day escaped: afterwards there was a plot to blow him up in his study. So King James's father; the house where he was murdered was blown up with gunpowder. But the first plot that ever I heard of was this:—In Venice they have a custom, that if any man do find out a new invention or discover any danger, he shall be rewarded for it. Now it should seem the council house there hath certain shops below, and one of the citizens made this objection: what if a wicked traitor, instead of bringing in barrels of oil should bring barrels of powder, and while the senate were sitting should blow up the house? how

easy might a foreign enemy then overthrow the state!"—vol. i. pp. 108, 109.

We do not need more than the sad history of Lord Bacon to show us that bribery and corruption were no strangers to the age of King James, any more than to our own, before that marvellous remedy, the Reform Bill, was administered to the nation, and made us one and all, parliament and people, immaculate. It is curious to look back from our exalted position upon the state of things in the times of Bishop Goodman, when laymen neglected to defend the rights and properties of the Church, even when sworn to do so, except upon mere conservative or acquisitive principles. It must be observed that the Bishop was Canon of the Church to which the following narrative relates:

"The church of Windsor stands within the castle of Windsor; our houses did abut or were contiguous to the walls of the castle; the walls fell, whereby the house were not habitable; we petitioned the King, we had commissions out of the Exchequer, and many orders, that repairing was to be at the King's charge, yet still we could get nothing done; we lost time and expense in soliciting the business: at length, sitting in chapter, one of our canons made a speech to this purpose: 'The times are such that we churchmen are thought to be very simple and weak in judgment in respect of lawyers and great officers, and the reason is because our wit is bounded with honesty, whereas theirs having no such bounds and limitations, it seems therefore to be of a larger extent than ours. Not to speak, then, what is fit to be done, but to speak according to the ordinary practice of the world, men must now bribe that they may have and enjoy their own; and therefore, instead of letters or making means or friends, I could wish that one might buy a purse and put in it one hundred pieces, and present it to such a great officer, and desire his favour.' The dean and the rest of the canons, being wearied and tired out with soliciting the business, hearkened to this man's motion, and it was concluded that the dean in his own person should present the money, only with this message, that the Church of Windsor, remembering their humble duties and service to his lordship, made bold, according to their poor abilities, to present his lordship with a small token, which they did humbly desire his lordship to accept, and to afford them his lawful favour in such a business. The dean did perform the message accordingly, and the lord received the money and said nothing to him. The dean, at his return, as the manner is, instantly called a chapter, to give an account of the business, and there gave his account, that he had done all things punctually according to their desires, and that the lord did not speak one word to him, neither did he add one word but according to his commission: 'Indeed,' said he, 'I thought something more, I confess; but that was private to myself.' 'Then,' quoth one of the canons, 'Mr. Dean, we must have *quid pro quo*: we have parted with our monies, and if we have not actions yet we must have words; and if we have not words, it is fit we should have thoughts; and therefore, to deal plainly with you, I am auditor, and I will not pass this money in our accompts unless you will be pleased to impart your thoughts unto us.' Then said other canons, 'A very good motion: Mr. Dean, we must have your thoughts, or else you must repay the monies.' The dean being pressed, said, that when he delivered the money and the lord received it and said nothing, he looked upon him and thought thus within himself: 'Thou base knave! when thou wert made Knight of the Garter, thou didst swear to protect the Church of Windsor: hast thou so many thousands of thine own, and wilt thou not do us justice without a bribe? What we have is spent in hospitality, for the relief of the poor, and for the honour of God and God's Church; some of us are not worth one hundred pounds: the money shall perish with thee and thine.' And so truly it did, for it did not prosper. This was before Salisbury's time; and so you see it hath been the practice of all times."—vol. i. pp. 205-208.

Nor was Church building either much in fashion among the laity in those young and palmy

days of Protestantism:

"I did once intend to have built a church; and a lawyer in my neighbourhood did intend to build himself a fair house, as afterward he did. One sent unto him to desire him to accept from him all his timber, another sent unto him to desire him that he might supply him with all the iron that he spent about his house. These men had great woods and iron mills of their own. The country desired him to accept of their carriage. What reason had this man not to build? Truly I think he paid very little but the workmen's wages. Whereas, on the contrary, in the building of my church, where it was so necessary, for without the church they had not God's service, and no church was near them within four or five miles, truly I could not get the contribution of one farthing."—vol. i. pp. 295, 296.

We must not, however, lay the whole blame to the laity, who have in no age been found backward to make sacrifices so far as the clergy have led the way. If my "Lord of Middlesex" is to be trusted, his Majesty was in fault in making puritans bishops, "who," he observed, "with their parsimony providing for their wives and children, and by all the courses of their life, did more resemble puritans than bishops, who were wont to be given to hospitality and all charitable works; but now he did fear lest these puritans took their bishoprics to make their uttermost profit of them, and in effect to undo their successors."—vol. i. p. 314. By way of contrast, it is seldom that the Church has had prelates so princely in their benefactions as Laud and Williams were at this very time, men differing from each other in many points, but agreeing together in the observance of those duties which were as essential to their station as archbishops, as holiness was to their calling as clerks. Bishop Goodman, as has been observed, enjoyed the favour or countenance of neither; yet he is eager in bearing witness to their bountifulness. He speaks with admiration of their great hospitality in inviting and entertaining strangers, and of their charitable works; Laud's in his university and college, and Williams's libraries at Cambridge, Westminster and Lincoln, his repairs at Westminster, his care of the young scholars, and his endowments at Cambridge.

"In my life I did never know more honest, more virtuous, more pious, or wiser men than I have known bishops and churchmen. God hath committed his Church into their charge, and to expose them to scorn and contempt is to overthrow God's Church. But I will now instance in the two archbishops, Laud and Williams. There was not a man in England that kept a more orderly house than Laud did, or bred up his servants better. Take all the enemies of the Church throughout the whole kingdom, and I dare undertake that all of them put together have not done so many good works as these two archbishops have done in their time. And so I may truly say for the former archbishops,—Archbishop Abbot at Guildford and Canterbury, Whitgift at Croydon. Or show me any archbishop that left any great estate behind him. How many bishops have I heard protest that they spent all that they had, and, as they thought, to the best uses! One bishop told me, who had but a very poor bishopric, that he did every day constantly relieve one hundred of his poor neighbours. If I might but see the enemies of bishops and churchmen do but half so much, I should think they had some religion in them. I dare boldly say, that one Londoner did leave behind him more wealth than all the bishops, all the deans, all the archdeacons, all the canons and prebendaries—that is, all the dignities of the church—throughout all England left behind them. It is well known that a Londoner died worth three hundred thousand pounds; which I do verily believe is more than all the dignified men in the Church have; and therefore they were not much to be envied, if those who now have the possessions of the Church shall spend the means and revenues better than churchmen did."—vol. i. pp. 287, 288.

All this is very good and satisfactory; though, considering the solemn duties to which the clergy

are set apart and the end for which wealth is given them, it ought to be no great praise to a priest or bishop that he does not make a fortune out of the Church revenues. We wish, however, Goodman had as clear views about the odiousness of seeking, as of misusing, the preferments of the Church, whereas, in common with a number of his brethren of the day, perhaps of other days too, he avows a desire of promotion, which little savors of the Christian spirit in primitive times. We would not indeed measure this weakness by exactly the same standard which might fairly be applied to it now. It was a very different thing to court and look out for the royal favour at a time when the divine right and patriarchal power of kings was believed in, and in this dull age. Then the clergy came to the king as the direct representative of God, and the shepherd both of themselves and their people in religious matters. The power of the keys, indeed, as regards the administration of the sacraments, was ascribed solely to the ministerial office; but jurisdiction was believed to be the king's prerogative, and in jurisdiction the office of teaching was more or less involved, though not immediately. The king of England was the source of ecclesiastical active power; he was believed to have had from Edward the Confessor's time a miraculous gift of healing, authenticating his royal commission, and his smile or his bounty might almost be regarded as of a sacramental nature. Surely such a view of the supremacy was at least an ingredient in the assemblage of thoughts and feelings with which many a clergyman approached the face of majesty. But the case was altered, when, on the accession of the Georges, the king himself disowned the special sacredness of his office, refused to accept his higher functions, gloried in the social compact, and looked at the Church as a part and parcel of the Constitution. Hence, while we are not at all pleased with the tone of an extract which we are about to give from Goodman, we do not put it on a level with the well-known complaints and longings of Bishop Newton, the *suspiria non sancta* with which he woos the good offices of persons in power and influence, and almost worships at a distance the congé d'élire and the seat in parliament. "When he waited on the archbishop at Kew," he says, speaking of himself, after he was made subalmoner, "his grace informed him that the king had said that, as he would now preach often before him, he must desire that he would be particularly short, especially on the great festivals, for he was an old man ... The doctor," *i.e.* himself, the writer, "had before taken care in his sermons at court to come within the compass of twenty minutes, but after this, especially on the great festivals, he never exceeded fifteen; so that the king sometimes said to the clerk of the closet, 'a short good sermon.' Stories such as this certainly do not imply any high mystical view of the office of the supreme governor and patriarch of the English Church. But this is not the place to enlarge upon the tone of mind which distinguished the author of the well-known and popular Commentaries on the Apocalypse.

All this is not pleasant, and sets off Bishop Goodman to advantage; yet we allow that the following passage is not pleasant either:

"Give me leave, for the discharge of my own conscience, and in my thankfulness to God and the memory of King James, to relate a truth, and so let God be merciful to my soul as I shall relate nothing but the truth. Being a little known to King James, when I never used any means unto him, nor to my knowledge did ever any man speak one word in my behalf, then did King James in a morning send John Packer unto me, to tell me, that his majesty had a full resolution to prefer me, and to bring me to some good place in the Church; and lest his majesty should forget me, he had therefore commanded Buckingham to put him in mind of me; and lest Buckingham, having many suitors, might forget me, the King commanded John Packer to put him in mind of me; and lest John Packer should forget me, the King had sent him unto me, to engage himself unto me that he would solicit my business. Hereupon I never came unto John Packer but I had instantly access: I never

proposed anything unto him but I had a true and real answer; no dilatory or complimentary words. The year following, I displeased his majesty, and thereby I lost a very good preferment; the year after, I had the deanery of Rochester, which was a very good preferment and very agreeable to my disposition, for I did ever love seamen, and those of the King's navy were my special friends. When I came to give his majesty thanks, his majesty did seem to be more joyful in giving it than I could express joy in receiving it, using these words,—that I should not give a farthing. When I was made bishop, in my instruments there was the mistaking of some words, which I did fear was wilfully done, only to draw on a fee; then the secretary had for mending those words twenty pieces; then I sent a piece of plate to Buckingham, which I think cost me between forty and fifty pounds. This he would not receive, but sent it back again and rewarded the messenger with three pieces. So that I think no honest man could blame King James or the Duke of Buckingham.”—vol. i. p. 355-357.

While on the subject of love of lucre and preferment-hunting, we are reminded of the well-known De Dominis, of whom the bishop gives us almost a memoir, part of which we will extract, and after doing so, shall consider we have given the reader sufficient idea what he is to expect from these volumes.

Antonio de Dominis was Archbishop of Spalato, a poor see in the Venetian territory. The Venetians have not the reputation of being very good Catholics, and so it was that in Paul the Fifth's time they were ranged against the Pope, and the Archbishop of Spalato with them. Henry the Fourth of France managed to reconcile them, and in such reconciliations, as Bishop Goodman observes, it is as “with great trees falling one upon another,” which “do themselves little hurt, but the bushes and shrubs which are between both are beaten down or shivered to pieces.”—p. 337. And so in this case the higher powers, Pope and Republic, did not scruple to “fall heavily upon those who were active on both sides, and did nourish the differences.” Spalato being one of these, betook himself to the English ambassador at Venice, Sir Dudley Carleton, and candidly confessed to him his conviction of the corruptions of the Church of Rome, and of his own inability to reform them, yet his desire to live in a pure reformed communion, and above all his great admiration and love of the Church of England, and his regret that his own preferment did not happen to lie within her happy patrimony; and he added, that “if my lord ambassador could but procure an exchange,” he would with joy live and die an Anglican, and would daily pray for his lordship.” The ambassador entered into his views, and they settled upon these terms, that De Dominis was to have a pension of 200*l.* a year, which the English bishops were to make up among themselves, Abbott, the archbishop, offering him a maintenance at Lambeth. He was received in England very honourably, and precedence was allowed him next but one to the Archbishop of York. In course of time he became Master of the Savoy and Dean of Windsor, and in the latter capacity collated himself to the living of Illesley in Berkshire; King James rejoicing in so rare a convert, and having thought from the first that the quarrel of the Venetians with the Pope had been the effect of one of his own books.

After a time, however, the pleasure of novelty ceased on both sides; first, the bishops and then the king got tired of him. His precedence was with difficulty allowed, and his views developed upon the Protestant basis more than the king approved. He defended in a sermon the sleep of the soul between death and judgment. The prince went to Spain; symptoms of good understanding with the Roman party appeared at court; Paul the Fifth died, and an early friend, if not relative, of De Dominis succeeded him in the popedom. The Archbishop accordingly made secret overtures to the new Pontiff.

“He wrote unto him to congratulate his election, and that he did assure himself that God had a

hand therein, and that it was for the great good of the Christian world, and that he himself should think himself very happy to die a member of that Church wherein God had made him his high priest; that himself was never alienated in mind and affection from the Catholic Church, only did desire to fly from persecution, and the more to ingratiate himself unto them who were to receive him, he did only palliate some plausible opinions, yet with no contumacious mind, but a full desire and resolution to submit himself to better judgments, that is, to the voice of the Shepherd and to the determination of the Catholic Church. Notwithstanding his interest in the pope, yet he durst not commit himself to his mercy, but he went to the several Catholic ambassadors that were then resident about London, and began to comply with them, telling them, that his coming over into England was to do some great good service to God's Catholic Church, which he thought he might be the better enabled to do if he were but an eye-witness and present in person, and so to procure the peace of God's Church; but having now had sufficient experience, he finds that the time is not yet come, that things are not ripened for the settlement and establishment of that peace, and himself being now grown very old, not fit for labours and employments, he did desire to return to his own country, to die a member of the Church of Rome, and to be buried with his fathers: and whereas he had offended the Church, he desired the several ambassadors to be means to their masters and princes that they would procure his pardon; which they promised very effectually to do, so desirous they were to make a convert, and that his return to the Church might take way that scandal and offence which was occasioned by his fall; and this they did very speedily, and their masters returned their answer that they would interpose for him."—vol. i. p. 345-347.

The news of what was going on came to the king's ears, and perplexed him much. He thought it would not stand with his honour to hinder or imprison a stranger coming with leave to his kingdom, an old man too and an archbishop, alleging moreover conscience and religion and accused of no crime. His deliberations how to proceed were cut short by a letter from De Domninis, thanking him for his favours and begging to resign them. He expressed his great gratitude to his majesty for his hospitality, assured him that he should spread the fame of it on the continent, alleged that his reason for coming over was to bear ocular testimony of the state of the English Church, that he had received great satisfaction from the sight, should report favourably of it, and doubted not he should do it more good abroad by returning home than by remaining in it. He added that he was now old, and had the infirmities of age, and he desired to close his days in his own country. He followed up this representation by hiring a house, near Greenwich at the water-side, convenient for flight, and conveying his plate and property to the house of an ambassador who was leaving the country.

The termination of the drama was as follows:—

"But, like a provident man, he left his trunks and his treasure, no doubt but with the ambassador's leave, in the custody of some of his followers, his steward not knowing thereof. And when the trunks were come to Gravesend and the steward was ready to convey them to the ship, an officer came to him, and told him, that sometimes when ambassadors had had great entertainment of the king and had been richly rewarded, yet their servants did colour and transport other men's goods; therefore they had command to search whether any other goods were there but the lord-ambassador's. The steward did assure them that there were none others. This did not suffice, they would search; and so coming to Spalato's trunks, they knew them very well and seized upon them. In the trunks there was what he had in New-year's gifts, and what he had saved out of his pensions, the sum of sixteen or seventeen hundred pounds. Moneys to be transported out of the kingdom are forfeited by law, and so the King did him no wrong in seizing and detaining them. Whenas once Spalato heard that his trunks were intercepted, lying now in Holland in expectation of his

trunks, he wrote to the King and procured all the ambassadors to join with him, that seeing it was all his stock and treasure and the means that he had to live upon, which he confessed he had by the King's own bounty and free benevolence, that therefore the same goodness would permit him to enjoy it, whereby he might live and subsist daily to pray for his majesty, and that he might not starve in his old age. When the King had made it appear that he was as provident as Spalato was deceitful, and what he had, as it was his own free gift, so the carrying away was but his courtesy, then he permitted him, and caused his trunks to be restored.

"Now Spalato having his trunks, posted to Rome, where the princes had procured his pardon, so that he lived securely; but most of the cardinals would not vouchsafe to look upon him or have any acquaintance with him. Some of the inferior clergy were appointed to treat with him and to cause him to make a recantation, which he did in a very strange manner and so lived there very contemptibly. Some English came sometimes to visit him, to whom he gave this counsel, that they should forbear coming, for it was not safe for them to come, nor safe for him to give them access. And not living long, when he was upon his deathbed, they that were about him sent up and down all Rome to find out Englishmen, and that they should repair there at such an hour; and at that time the ghostly father brings them all into Spalato's chamber, and speaks to Spalato to this effect: 'My lord, by your forsaking the Catholic Church and going to the Church of England, you have thereby given great offence, and many are much scandalized thereby; and by your printing of books and your opinions therein many still doubt how you stand affected in religion. You are now passed hope of life, and here are many English gentlemen come to see you. It is fit that now you should declare in what faith and religion you die, that so you may make some satisfaction for your former revolt.' Whereupon Spalato took a crucifix which then lay upon the bed and kissed it, and used these words: 'I do die a member of the Roman Catholic Church.' And when he was dead, his study was searched, and there were found certain papers which did imply his opinion to be that there was *Inequalitas personarum in Sanctâ Trinitate*. This being added to his former revolt, it was thought fit to proceed against him. Advocates were retained on both sides, and after much discussion it was resolved that he died in a state of heresy, and so his body was burned."—Vol. i. pp. 351-354.

Hacket, in his *Life of Archbishop Williams*, makes mention, as Mr. Brewer reminds us, of a visit paid to De Dominis, after his return to Rome, by Sir E. Sackville, afterwards Earl of Dorset. He found him shut up in a ground-chamber, narrow and dark, and looking out upon a blank wall about three paces distant. In the course of the conversation, Sir Edward said to him: "My Lord of Spalato, you have here a dark lodging; it was not so with you in England: there you had at Windsor as good a prospect by land as was in all the country; and at the Savoy you had the best prospect upon the water that was in all the city." "I have forgot those things," he made answer: "here I can best contemplate the kingdom of heaven." Sir Edward was accompanied by Dr. Fitzherbert, rector of the English college, and moved by this reply he took his companion aside, and asked him whether he thought the archbishop really was so occupied. Hacket proceeds: "Says the father rector, I think nothing less: for he was a malcontent knave when he fled from us, a railing knave while he lived with you, and a motley, parti-coloured knave now he is come back!" Such is the uncomfortable history of De Dominis, and with it we take our leave of Mr. Brewer.

ART. IV.—1. The Protestant Exiles of Zillerthal: translated from the German of Dr. Rheinwald. By J. B. Saunders. London: Hatchard. 1840. 2. Persecution of the Lutheran Church in Prussia from 1831 to the present Time, compiled from German Publications: chiefly translated by J. D. Löwenberg. London: Hamilton and Adams. 1840.

[*British Critic*, vol. 28, July 1840.]

THE former of these little works is an account of the expatriation of certain Protestants from the Catholic Tyrol, and the latter of certain Protestants from Protestant Prussia. They are both addressed to "the Protestant public;" the former being intended to promote "a juster appreciation and improvement of our own privileges, civil and religious"—p. xi.; while the latter appeals to the Protestant Churches of Great Britain, in the confidence that they will, on the grounds of an enlightened humanity, "bind up the wounds" of "their Lutheran sister." The former is intended as an argument against the Pope; the latter carries it on in its application to Protestant monarchs. In this "keen encounter of wits," we feel obliged injustice to award the prize to the Liberal over the more Conservative writer. The compiler of the second volume certainly proves against the translator of the former, that persecution is no peculiar badge of Rome; besides that it is more preposterous to persecute for not abjuring than for abjuring a received faith, and more unnatural that Protestants should suffer from Protestants than from Catholics. Austria harasses those who desert their own faith as well as hers; Prussia those who will not desert her own faith as well as theirs. One further observation deserves attention; Prussia receives "the Protestant exiles of Zillerthal" into the very country (Silesia) from which she drives her own Lutherans.

As to these Zillerdalers, their story, as contained in the friendly narrative before us, is as follows:—In the summer of 1826 nine heads of families among them informed their respective priests of their intention to become Protestants, and expressed a wish to take the preliminary steps required by law for a change of religion. The Dean of Zell and other ecclesiastics met this demand with moderation and kindness; but elsewhere angry feelings showed themselves on both sides. The application, however, was refused, and the government confirmed the refusal. So matters stood till the beginning of 1832, by which time the numbers of Protestantizers had increased to 240. They then sent a deputation to the emperor, to petition for leave to organize a Protestant Church; and opposite petitions were presented by the Catholics, deprecating the introduction of religious division into a peaceful region. The emperor's decision was received in the spring of 1834, and seems to have had it in view, as far as might be, to satisfy both parties; it prohibited the Protestants from introducing a schism into a united country, but allowed them to betake themselves to provinces of the empire where Protestant congregations already existed. Persecution even in a mitigated form is always invidious; but those who take up strong religious views should not be unwilling to suffer for them; and whatever is to be thought of the conduct of the imperial government, we must confess our opinion that the Zillerdalers had not so much cause to complain of it as our canons prebendaries of the penalty of *præmunire*, which lies against their rejection of a crown candidate for the episcopate. To lose goods and chattels, and to be outlawed, is somewhat worse than to be told to depart with bag and baggage to another part of the country. "To such a transportation," however, as our narrator tells us, "the greater number showed no disposition. They had already directed their eyes to a foreign country, and accordingly in the summer of this year, some of them requested a passport."—p. 20. But they had not yet given up the hope of remaining at home; again they petitioned for toleration in the Tyrol; and nothing was done up

to 1836. In the course of this year their bishop, the Prince Archbishop of Saltzberg, visited them. "His mild demeanour," we are told, "inspired them with confidence; but on their requesting his permission to attach themselves to the Protestant Church, he answered, 'That would be as if you wished to throw yourselves into the fire; to that I cannot consent.'"—p. 20. In the beginning of the following year they resolved on emigration, and received the imperial sanction for so doing.

It was not in human nature but that during these years of agitation and suspense, much angry collision should go on between the hostile parties. Specimens of such disputes are given in Dr. Rheinwald's narrative; of these, some were unavoidable; in others, the blame at one time lay with the Catholics, at another with the Protestants. One of the greatest grievances of the latter was their inability to obtain the rite of matrimony. The Catholics of course could not be expected to administer it; and the government did not allow a merely civil contract except to such as were members of specific denominations, whose toleration was formally recognized. In consequence, "it cannot be denied," says our panegyrist, "that there were instances among the Protestants of children being born out of wedlock."—p. 63. Here again, we do not pronounce what was the *State's* duty; but looking at these Zillerdalers, we do think that persons engaged in so momentous and awful a step as changing their religion, might have been expected, if in earnest, to suspend for the time any thought of marrying and giving in marriage."

If we credit the account before us, individual priests and others behaved cruelly. One wished that Christ might enter the room, that he might say to Him, "See, these are the people, destroy them at once, by casting them into hell fire." When the leader of the dissenting party had recovered from a severe illness, the priest said to him, "Bartholomew, you look very ill, there is no great while longer for you." At another time "there was invective, mockery, &c. concerning the Protestant Church and its dogmas, interchanged with stories about the reformers, the preachers, their wives and children, and the like."—p. 41. And, when they were on their journey, "at Iglau, they were granted no lodging in spite of the badness of the weather;" but it is candidly added, "such treatment was contrary to the will of the supreme authorities, nor was it repeated to those who came after."—p. 93. The government indeed was most anxious, and not unnaturally, to avoid the odium of a persecution, and as the most discerning of the seceders acknowledged, did only what "its circumstances and difficult position rendered unavoidable,"—p. 47; and though many acts occurred of the same character with the above, which may be fancied without our detailing them, yet these honest Protestants seem to have given as good as they took, and to have received as much kindness from some as opposition from others.

Such is the celebrated case of the "exiles of Zillerthal," being in number about 600 persons; and now for its moral, which is not the least important part: "May we not hereby learn," says the translator, "the still unchanged spirit of intolerance and persecution of the Romish Church? The Austrian government seems even to have inclined to a lenient policy, and to give effect to its toleration-edicts; but there was an influence paramount to that of law and justice, and even the imperial will, and what was that but the *dominancy of the priesthood*?"—p. viii. It is plain, that unless the Church of Rome were involved in the history, we should never have heard a word from Mr. Saunders about the wrongs or the virtues of the Exiles of Zillerthal.

The proof of this surmise is to be found in the little book which we have placed in connexion with his publication. Unless Mr. Saunders's object was not to reprobate persecution, but to cast a stone at Rome any how, why does he not hear the cries and groans of the Silesians, under persecution, longer, more grievous, and more unjust, which they have endured from that Protestant sovereign, who, in his narrative, only appears as the magnanimous patron of the oppressed? Any

one would think, for all Mr. Saunders tells us, that Calvinists or other reformed communities, never interfered with the religious opinions of others. We intend no personal reflections on a prince who since the date of these publications has been taken from the world, and whose early misfortunes claim a respectful memory. We speak of his policy towards his Lutheran subjects, mainly with the view of exposing that hollow political and party spirit among ourselves which can bitterly condemn in Roman Catholics what it passes over in a Protestant. Let us condemn it in both. We assure the Reformation Society, Protestant Association, and their partizans, that this not the spirit which will make progress against the church of Rome.

Let us see what Fleidl, the Zillerdaler, addressed to the Prussian court:

"To the most illustrious, most mighty king.—Most gracious king and lord, in my own name, and in the name of my companions in the faith, whose number amounts to about 430 to 440, I venture a cry of distress on the magnanimity and grace of your majesty, as the august defender of the pure Gospel. With my whole soul I had desired to lay this prayer personally and orally before your majesty, yet I am content if permitted to do so only in writing. After more than a hundred years, another act of persecution and banishment has been repeated in our fatherland." **
* "Already once, Prussia gave to our persecuted forefathers a secure asylum; we too have placed all our trust in God and the good King of Prussia." *** "We pray your Majesty to receive us paternally, that so we may live according to our faith. *Our belief is grounded entirely on the doctrine of Holy Scripture and the Augsburg Confession.*" ***

"May God reward your majesty for all the kindness which your majesty may show to us! Faithful, honest, and thankful will we remain in Prussia, and will not lay aside the good qualities of our Tyrolese nature. We shall only increase the number of your majesty's brave subjects, and stand in history as a lasting monument that misfortune, when it dwells near compassion, ceases to be misfortune; and that *the Gospel, when obliged to fly from the Papacy, ever finds protection from the magnanimous King of Prussia.*"—*Exiles of Zillerthal*, pp. 73, 76.

Now to change the scene, and turn to the rival volume, which thus opens:

"In the summer of 1839, a company of interesting strangers, in the German costume, were observed to enter the port of Newcastle-on-Tyne. They stayed there but a few hours, and then proceeded to Liverpool, from whence they were intending to take shipping for North America.

"Inquiry was made by the agents of the Bible Society as to their supply of the Holy Scriptures, and most satisfactory answers were elicited. Their deportment was very pleasing, but they appeared to have no letters of introduction to any parties in this country; and little could be learned of their history, excepting that they were *Lutheran emigrants, proceeding from the Prussian dominions to the wilds of America on account of severe persecution for conscience' sake in their native land.* A week or two afterwards, another similar company arrived; and was followed by successive parties during the summer months, amounting altogether to about 640 individuals ²³.

"Public attention was roused, and more minute inquiry was made respecting their circumstances; for 'severe persecution for conscience sake,' in the present enlightened age, appeared a new and startling fact. These inquiries have been numerous and particular, and the result unravels a *piteous tale of arbitrary and cruel oppression.*

"For 300 years past, the forefathers of these people *have adhered to the creed laid down in the Confession of Augsburg*, and have never materially deviated from it. It is well known that this creed not only received the sanction of the champions of our Protestant faith, Luther and Melancthon,

²³400 more passed through England at the same time, by way of Hull.

but has also been incorporated with the laws of the German empire, and with various treaties of peace, and other privileges of the state.

"For the last twenty years, the Prussian government has attempted to blend the two existing Protestant churches—the Reformed and the Lutheran—into one; and for the last seven, the most coercive measures have been used to effect this purpose. *Heavy fines* have been levied continually; and those who were unable to pay them, have been harshly *thrown into prison*, and allowed to lie there for months, and even years. Their *clothing, furniture, cattle, agricultural implements, &c. have been sold*, and the parties thus oppressed reduced to the lowest ebb of misery and want." * * *

"Close inquiry was made whether anything like disaffection to their government could have led to the course they were pursuing; but this was always met by the most clear and satisfactory replies. On one occasion, when this question was directed to a group of young men, apparently peasants, their colour rose indignantly; and, with an unanimous burst of loyalty, they exclaimed, 'Any one of us would lay down his life for our king.'

"Even their oppressors cannot impugn their integrity, but are compelled to acknowledge their moral character unimpeachable. Various documents, respecting their sufferings and past history, have been received from Germany. These are too clear and circumstantial for any doubt to arise as to their veracity: they were printed on the continent, and have circulated there.

"This persecution continues; and by the latest accounts, *many pious Lutheran pastors are still in prison*. Should the Prussian government refuse to relax its coercive measures, *some thousands of these worthy but oppressed people are intending to follow their friends* in the course of the coming year. Those who have already reached America are in very straitened circumstances, and it is feared will have to pass through many severe trials before their settlement can be formed.

"Several letters on these subjects have been received at Newcastle, from Pastor Grabau, since his short visit to that town. *This excellent minister has been twice imprisoned, for six months; and was only released last spring, on account of apparently declining health.*"—*Lutheran Church in Prussia*, pp. vii-xii.

Emigration to America, and a prison in the interim, looks like greater intolerance than rough words and looks, with the liberty of returning them, and at length a land journey of three weeks amid Protestant sermons, songs, and triumphal greetings. But let us descend to particulars.

In the year 1817, when the Lutherans celebrated the third centenary of the Reformation, the King of Prussia had taken occasion to give effect to a project of which the foregoing extract speaks, and in which doubtless he thought he saw great advantages to the cause of Protestantism. However highly its advocates may be disposed to rate the blessings of that form of Christianity, one unfortunate blemish they have ever lamented in it, and that is its tendency to encourage disunion. Had it but a definite creed and worship, and strength enough to command the submission of its professors, it would be all that its warmest friends could desire; but even they must grant that it sanctions the principle of division, and encourages the spirit of change. Nor is there any remedy for this radical defect, but the authority of the State, which, by incorporating it into the structure of civil government, may infuse into it vigour, and, by the application of civil penalties, may force it into concord. The king of Prussia understood his mission as a Protestant prince, in relation to the differences of the followers of Luther and Calvin; and nothing was needed for the success of his benevolent intentions but that the said followers should understand it also. Unhappily they did not; and in consequence the Prussian government has but exchanged the old inconvenience of private judgment for the scandal of persecution.

In furtherance of his plan the king had, as early as 1822, framed a liturgy, which he intended, in

the first instance, for the Royal Chapel at Berlin. By degrees it was imposed upon other churches, towns, and villages; a part of the clergy voluntarily receiving it, and all henceforth being called on to subscribe to it, as a condition of their appointment to the pastoral charge. Next it was urged upon general reception through Prussia. A great opposition followed; and, among others, on the part of the celebrated Schliermacher. The magistracy of Berlin rejected it, and twelve clergy of Berlin. A second edition was prepared, and the majority of the clergy, including the twelve at Berlin, were gained in its favour. These advantages being secured, the great Lutheran festival in 1830 was chosen as the day for introducing it into all churches. Some of the clergy, however, still resisted, and were suspended. After a time others laid it aside, and were dismissed from their posts. The liturgy was professedly in accordance with the Confession of Augsburg; but statements were published by the recusants in proof of its utter contrariety to that celebrated formula. The court, however, persisted; and in 1834 an edict was passed, prohibiting *any* religious meetings, except with express permission of the consistories; which consistories, having subscribed to the act of Union, did not grant permission to those Lutherans who had not adopted it, and thus *all Lutheran divine service was rendered illegal*.

This illegality is no matter of words, but of deprivation, fine and imprisonment. By the year 1835 nineteen ministers had been either dismissed or imprisoned by the civil authorities for refusing to conform to the state religion. The congregations, following the example of their preachers, were also fined and imprisoned. The fine of twenty dollars was imposed for once attending the Lutheran service. The poor were imprisoned, and those who had any thing to lose were distrained upon to the amount of three or four times the fine levied. Farmers have lost their cattle and ploughs; mechanics and workmen were obliged to give up their tools; some persons were even stripped of their clothes. One of the leaders of a congregation of Militsch was imprisoned with a common thief. He was left for four days with no food but what the charity of his companion gave him from his own allowance. Another, called Sattler, who had been an officer in the army, was lined to the amount of seventy-nine dollars, and imprisoned for nine weeks.

"When in prison they tried to make him retract, proposing to set him free, and remit the fine, if he would promise to hold Lutheran worship no more. They invited Sattler (who is an elder) to accept liberty on these terms, and told him he might return to prison again, if he found himself unable to fulfil them. This otherwise firm man allowed himself to be over-persuaded, and accepted this condition of liberty on the 26th of August; but he found neither comfort at home nor joy in prayer. The Lord gave him a great support in his truly Christian wife, who, with his children, was distressed that he had accepted liberty on such terms; and his conscience becoming burdened by the thought, that, as an elder, he at least ought to have remained firm to his confession, after a few days he was induced to revoke his promise, and voluntarily return to prison, and allow the distraint to proceed.

"He and his family have since recovered their former cheerfulness; and when, on the 15th of September, the court again invited him to return home, on the same conditions as before—at least for the day when the bailiff was to distrain the goods—he firmly refused. On the 16th of September the distraint was effected; and for the eighty dollars fine, the bailiff took ten pigs, two capital milch cows, and a horse, which the bailiff valued, altogether, at seventy-nine dollars and three-quarters. On Sunday, the 20th, the cattle were publicly sold at Guhre."—*Luth. Church in Prussia*, pp. 58, 59.

At Juliusburg the police broke open the door of a Lutheran meeting, and dispersed the congregation, the members of it being visited by heavy fines. The fines in the village of Lutziene alone have been levied to the amount of 3000 dollars, and are imposed to the amount of 9000.

"In Great Tschunkawe, the fines of ten individuals for having attended Lutheran worship amounted to 250 dollars. One female paid her fine in cash, from the rest they took away pigs, geese, leather, shoes and boots, earthenware, clocks and watches.

"At the public worship held in the beginning of September, the police took down the names of two hundred and forty persons, who were fined two dollars each.

"In September the fines already amounted to 1400 dollars; which even Prince Hatzfeld assured Baron Von Koszutski would be remitted if he would promise to abstain from holding Lutheran worship. A poor old man, named Zoller, from Suhlau, was fined four dollars, for having, with his son, a youth of sixteen years of age, attended Lutheran worship; and being too poor to pay this fine, and nothing equivalent being found in his dwelling, they were both sent, on the Sabbath evening, to Militsch, where they were thrown into a dreary dungeon, and kept behind iron gates, secured with heavy locks, the son for two, the father for three days."—*Lutheran Church in Prussia*, pp. 59, 60.

A child at Cattert, baptised by a Lutheran pastor, was carried off by the police to the state minister of Suplaw for re-baptism; another at Schwiebedawe was re-baptised at Militsch. Children, old enough for education, were taken away to the United schools, and if they had been confirmed by a Lutheran minister, the sum of five dollars a month imposed on the parents. The fines exacted from these poor people, since 1830, are said to amount to £10,000 sterling.

The following outrage seems to have occurred in the end of 1834.

"On Tuesday, at 12 o'clock at noon, a body of troops, consisting of four hundred infantry, thirty cuirassiers, and fifty hussars, advanced upon Hönigern, in Mikowski, (Silesia,) from their quarters, about a mile from that place. They were well received, and were astonished at finding a pious people; for they had been described to them as Polish rebels. Upon their march, when a short way from the church, the Major asked Weber Scholz, from Saabe, 'Is it true, as they have written from Berlin, that the people stand before the church with pikes and pitch-forks?' 'Oh, no!' was the answer, 'only with their hymn-books!'

"On the first day the soldiers were friendly; and, in order that the people might not collect on the day following before the church, a report was spread that the military were merely passing through on their route to Poland, the baggage waggons were also ordered to be loaded early on Wednesday morning.

"At half-past four A.M. the next day, the whole of the troops marched up to Hönigern. Then the infantry surrounded the church on all sides; the hussars posted themselves on the east, the cuirassiers on the west, and thus the 200 members of the community, who had watched their beloved church through the whole snowy winter night, were hemmed in. The cavalry blocked up the approaches, and drove away those that came near.

"The President and the commanding Major then summoned them to leave the church, reminded them of the obedience due to the King, and warned them of the consequences of refusal. Reply was made, 'We stand here in defence of our faith, and ecclesiastical freedom.' *Answer*: 'We leave you your faith.' *A Voice*: 'But not the undisturbed confession of it.' The Major then gave them five minutes for consideration. The congregation sung. The Major summoned them again, and gave another five minutes. They continued to sing. He then summoned them for the third time, and ordered the soldiers to load their guns. Here a gun went off. The ball passed through the second window from the altar, and struck the northern side of the building. The hedges round the church were then broken down. The soldiers advanced in close ranks, and pushed away the people, and with the butt ends of their guns broke open the door and rushed in. This deed was done early in the morning, while it was yet dark.

"The people fled without so much as raising a finger in opposition, and dispersed on all sides: but how were they terrified when they found they were not allowed to go home in peace, the cavalry turning upon them, and striking them with the flat sides of their swords—many of the blades breaking with the violence of the strokes! Some of the broken pieces are still preserved.

"Several of the women received severe blows; the names of these are Schulz, Muller, &c. (others given in the original.) A child of twelve years, and an aged person of seventy, are mentioned among the sufferers. The first-named woman lost much blood from a cut in the head, so that it flowed through her straw bonnet. This happened at a distance from the church. Many fled, and took refuge in houses; but they were dragged from thence by the soldiers, one by the hair of his head; the police crying out, at the same time, 'The name of the King must be respected!' One woman was dragged from a stable, and beat so unmercifully, that she was confined to her bed for several days. Two other persons were rode down by the horses; and another was struck so severely, that he fell down senseless.

"Eight persons were taken up and imprisoned; one named Charlotte Schlemmel, for saying, 'If our beloved King, for whom we have prayed so often, could see how ill we are treated, his heart would bleed.' Some other inconsiderate words escaped the sufferers; for instance, one who had formerly been a soldier, and whose wife had been severely beat, till she bled, exclaimed, 'I would know how to finish those gallant cuirassiers.' This man was handcuffed and taken to prison. The attack lasted for two hours."—pp. 28, 30.

The troops proceeded to quarter themselves upon the people of the place, the major and his adjutant taking possession of the pastor's house, who lay ill at Breslau. The narrative continues,

"The first day, the quartering of the soldiers upon the inhabitants was general and equal, except that eight individuals, who had joined the State Church, received none; but on the Wednesday, the most faithful of the Lutherans were burdened with the greatest number of soldiers. The deputy Hillman, who had been beat, carried to prison, and deprived of an ox, received fifteen men; the deputies, Litze, Berger, and Tabitz, twelve hussars; and Klunz, twenty of the infantry.

"On Christmas-day there was church parade. The soldiers were ordered to provide themselves with their military hymn-books and cartridges. Hahn, the Counsellor of the Consistory, the Superintendent Kelsch, and Pastor Bauch, stood by the altar. The Superintendent handed to the latter the new agenda, or prayer-book. The Counsellor of the Consistory delivered an address from the altar, not on the birth of Christ, but to prove to the congregation that his Christian sentiments coincided with those of their dismissed pastor. Pastor Bauch explained in his sermon, that the community showed little love to him, and spoke evil of him, and yet he was innocent of their misfortunes, and only obeying the royal commands. The few members present wept. Not that they were touched by the sermon, but from affliction at being compelled to listen to the voice of a stranger, instead of to that of their dearly beloved pastor. What had induced them to attend the service? Surely not free will; for the soldiers had been ordered to persuade some one from every house to visit the church. A serjeant, who was quartered with twelve men in the house of Wenzel, a peasant at Eckersdorf, said to him, 'Dear host, go yourself, or send some one to church, otherwise you will have to pay dearly for it; for we do not march until there is order re-established in the attendance at church.' The country being a poor one, and this a year of unusual scarcity, the quartering was a pressing burden to the people.

"The President went from place to place, accompanied by the Counsellor of the Consistory and the Counsellor of the Province, and declared 'The introduction of the New Agenda is the will and command of the King, and you are disobedient and refractory if you do not go to church.' It

was continually laid before the people, that till they did this they would not get rid of the soldiers. The Counsellor of the Consistory constantly assured them, that, though the New Agenda was to be used in the church, yet they might remain Lutherans as before, and receive baptism and the Lord's-supper according to the old Lutheran forms, and that the sermon also might be Lutheran. But all these were but verbal assurances. No one can be surprised that with such persuasions, and under the heavy burdens occasioned by the quartering, most of those who had previously stood firm to the church of their fathers, and to their beloved pastor, went to church, some on the second festival, and others on the Sunday following the festival.

"Those who were frightened, to whom the most incredible things had become a sad reality, saw that attendance at the church was the only means of preventing these military devouring the whole of their scanty provisions. The following words were used to Squire Fogdt: 'You are a perjured man; for as a vassal you have sworn obedience to the King, and you are for the Old Agenda, though you are aware that the will of His Majesty is decisive for the New one.' The landlords were at length induced to go to church on the Sunday following the festival, and on Monday the military marched off, after a stay of six days.

If they had not been instructed to compel the people to go to church by quartering the soldiers upon them, orders would have been given for their removal after the capture of the building. At the present time only a few individuals attend the service there, and fewer still receive the Lord's-supper. A still smaller number would do so, if a report had not been spread, that those who did not visit the church would have to pay the fifteen hundred dollars previously imposed on them. In addition to this, policemen have been stationed at Hönigern, to prevent those visits by which one might strengthen another in his faith. Under all these circumstances, but few stand firm; none, indeed, but those who, as Bible Christians, enlightened by the Spirit of God, have looked through the State Agenda and State Union, and would rather suffer the loss of all their property, than become members of such a church."—Lutheran Church in Prussia, pp. 31-34.

No wonder that, under such circumstances, the poor Silesians turned their thoughts, as did our friends the Zillerdalers about the same time, to emigration. The clergy in particular felt that even an unknown or barbarous soil would be better than the prisons into which a Protestant sovereign had thrown them. Of these, M. Krause was kept in close confinement for a year in Militsch, then for three-quarters of a year in the fortress of Erfurt. From this place he contrived to make his escape, and got off safe to: the United States. His congregation has since emigrated also, though after heavy fines to the amount of 5200 francs—a large sum in the case of a poor community. M. M. Grabau, of Erfurt, for speaking against the persecution from the pulpit, was suspended, and carried off to prison at Heiligenstadt. The following is the account of his journey:—

"When it became dark, the extra mail by which Grabau was to be sent away, was driven into the court-yard of the mayoralty house. The pastor was then delivered to a sergeant, a commissary of the police, named Rochlitz, who loudly boasted of being a free-thinker. The latter first placed his dagger in the carriage, then the pastor was obliged to get in, and the commissary of the police took his seat beside him. In order that no human eye might see the deed, the leather curtains of the carriage were buckled fast, though Grabau objected to this with the remark, 'wherefore was it done? he was no criminal.'

"The people of Erfurt, who have spoken of this event, say that they remembered at the time the words of Holy Writ—'He that doeth evil hateth the light, neither cometh to the light, lest his deeds should be reproved.'

"The burgomaster (mayor) had assured the wife of Grabau, that every attention should be paid

to his comfort, and that he would not miss the things required. But this was not true. He was but partially covered with a light woollen blanket, and exposed to a draught, and the severe cold of a winter night. Pastor Grabau's usual health is but delicate, and he was only provided with a light cloth coat, single boots, common hat, and light cloak. The sergeant sat carelessly by his side. When Grabau prayed on the road, the free-thinker felt great anguish, as he afterwards confessed.

"Grabau soon became dangerously ill; being seized with cramp in the stomach and violent sickness, so that the sergeant had serious apprehensions that his victim might die before he could be brought into the prison. In order to prevent this, he offered him some warm beer; but it was refused from such an evil-doer. On the second of March, a stay was made at Heiligenstadt. Here they intended to lock the pastor in a prison for criminals, the cell having scarcely half a window, barred up with iron rails; but he protested against this, and was afterwards brought into another apartment, of larger size, but damp, and containing a bed too dirty and disgusting to be used. Here he was obliged to do as well as he could. His food consisted of the same soup, both at dinner and supper, as was given to the criminals, and was consequently but ill suited to his weakly constitution.

"These were therefore the comforts which the burgomaster had promised to the wife of the pastor! It must also be remarked, in addition to the above, that he was not allowed to be alone, but a coarse felon was locked up with him, who chiefly spent his time in drinking and swearing. When the pastor endeavoured to impress him with the wickedness of such conduct, he one evening attempted to give him a severe beating. After some time, however, he left off swearing. Upon his return home, Rochlitz, the commissary of police, spoke publicly, and with malicious joy, of the miserable place in which he had left Grabau. This news spread quickly through the whole town, and induced Grabau's wife to reproach the burgomaster. The latter replied, 'this is not the case, your husband, is treated like a gentleman.' In a letter to Erfurt, Grabau described his situation. As this letter had to pass through the criminal courts at Heiligenstadt, it was opened and read, and the contents were written upon the outside. The letter was then sealed, and sent to the government at Erfurt, which instead of removing the evil, sent the letter back to the prison of Grabau. Thus they wished to suppress the publication of their barbarous cruelty."—*Lutheran Church in Prussia*, pp. 75-78.

It is difficult from the documents before us to trace the line of his history after this; but the following is his general statement of his sufferings. He has since passed through Liverpool *en route* for America.

"On the 10th of June, I left the prison at Heiligenstadt, in the Prussian province of Eichsfeld, by way of Magdeburg to Hamburg, accompanied by a gens d'arme. Since the 1st of March, 1837, I have spent above eight months in prison; then ten months as a fugitive, pursued day and night by gens d'armes; and then again nine months in prison. During the last month, my imprisonment was rendered in some measure more tolerable, in consequence of my illness."—*Lutheran Church in Prussia*, p. 17.

In an account of the persecution written by M. Ernst in 1837, we are told that "the pastors Kellner, Berger, Gessner, and Bichler, were still in prison : Kellner since October, 1834; and Guerike in Halle under town arrest." Lasius of Berlin has since 1837 been thrown into prison and has been in want. Laymen and women have suffered in like manner, if influential persons. The countess Henkel of Donnersmark and two noble ladies of Lobeck were condemned as rebels to a fort for one year. Gerkendorf, a non-commissioned officer, was imprisoned on Palm-Sunday, 1837, because he could not conscientiously attend the garrison church parades." But the most detailed account

of lay persecution given us, in the small volume under review, is that relative to the Baron von Koszutski, who opened his own house for Lutheran worship after the neighbouring churches had been closed against it. He is a young nobleman, originally a Roman Catholic, who united himself to the Lutherans at a time when the persecution had already commenced against them. The account is also interesting as letting us into the view taken of the whole affair by his persecutors.

"Death deprived him of his wife after they had been married but a short time, and from that period he occupied himself with the management of his estates, and the education of his infant daughter, with whom he lived in retirement. Family worship was regularly held in his house, and conducted by Gessner, then a candidate, and now pastor of the Lutheran community, in the circle of Lowenberg, where his labours have been greatly blessed. But the authorities were not long before they began to regard these proceedings with suspicious eyes; and, believing that the hated flame of Lutheranism was chiefly fanned by the presence of Gessner, his further residence with Baron von Koszutski was forbidden by the Council of the circle of Militsch.

"Pastor Krause was afterwards invited by Von Koszutski, and domestic worship continued; but the police were sent as spies, and in many instances disturbed the proceedings. In February, 1835, Von Koszutski was fined ten dollars; then again, for worship held in his house on the 8th of March, twenty dollars.

"Pastor Biehler, having been invited to Kaulwitz, went thither, and, on the 20th of March, administered the Lord's-supper to thirty-one communicants. This religious festival was discovered; and the fines levied upon Von Koszutski in consequence amounted to sixty dollars, and the others present were fined the same sum. A policeman was quartered in Pastor Biehler's house to keep constant guard over him; and as the government considered Von Koszutski to be the main support of the Lutherans in that district, their attention was naturally directed toward him.

"A certain part of the castle at Great Tschunkawe had been set apart for public worship, and service was performed in a regular manner according to the Wittenburg Agenda; sermons were also preached, and the Lord's-supper was administered. This was generally at a very early hour in the morning, or late at night, on account of the spies; yet the number attending these services was so great, that pastor Krause was, on some Sundays, occupied for eight hours successively. On the 6th of June, pastor Krause received notice that he might expect to be severely fined if he persisted in conducting worship at Baron von Koszutski's, and on Sunday, the 19th of July, he was accordingly arrested at the conclusion of the service, and taken as a prisoner to Militsch, where he was quartered at an hotel under the guard of a patrol. Von Koszutski was then absent from Great Tschunkawe, having gone to Karlsbad, in Bohemia, for the re-establishment of his health. While there, he received a rescript from the Royal Government at Breslau, dated June 5th, which stipulated that he should no longer hold Lutheran church service in his house; and threatening him, in case he would not agree to this demand, with the loss of his liberty. If he would not promise to obey this order, a policeman was to be quartered upon him, at his expense, to watch his movements, and send back all who repaired thither for worship. In reply, Von Koszutski stated, that conscientiously adhering to the word of God, he could not obey the government in this matter, but would submit to their impositions, in humble subjection to God's will. On July 25th, he returned to Great Tschunkawe; and on the following day (Sunday), just as service was concluded with his fellow-believers, two policemen appeared from Militsch, and summoned Von Koszutski to follow them to town. He was in too weak a state to do so just then, but gave them his word of honour that he would appear before the Council on Monday, the 27th. Though expecting his physician that day, a policeman appeared, and he was obliged to follow him, and prepare for his imprisonment. All

his rooms *were sealed up*, except two, one belonging to his little girl, the other to her governess ²⁴, and he was himself quartered at the hotel at Militsch, under the surveillance of a policeman, at his own expense.”—*Lutheran Church in Prussia*, pp. 36-38.

Here he remained some time, till he fell into a serious illness; upon this he was allowed to take private lodgings,

“but no one was allowed to visit him besides his little daughter Clara. Her governess was not allowed to accompany her. The fines levied upon him, on account of worship, amounted to three hundred dollars; but it was intimated to him, that he would immediately be set at liberty, if he would promise to hold no more religious assemblies. Truly, no small temptation! But Von Koszutski remained firm; and when he was afterwards again pressed to accept this offer, and even told that his fines would be remitted, and that he would be allowed to have family worship, if none but his own household were present, and also that duty to his king called for his submission, Von Koszutski refused to accept his liberty on such terms, saying that it was his highest duty to obey the King of kings, and asking, how he could receive the sacrament without a church communion. In the meantime Von Koszutski did not neglect to petition the royal government at Breslau, for the redress of his grievances, according to legal forms. In the first of these petitions, dated the 4th of August, he says, ‘must not the body as well as the mind suffer, under such treatment: I have a beloved child, my greatest joy on earth, whose education is dear to my heart; I am informed this child is not to visit me with her governess; what a prospect for the future!’ * * *

“‘I am, besides, the proprietor and manager of two extensive farms; no plans have been laid down for the future—I do not even know in what state the different branches of rural economy are, as I was not allowed time to review them. The law of our land honours conscience; and to compel men to violate it, is nothing less than to force them to commit moral suicide. The practice of Lutheran worship is, besides, confirmed by the treaty and peace of Westphalia; therefore, however ignorant government may appear to be of it, no pen can be used to dictate these persecutions, but conscience will whisper to the writer, ‘what thou doest is contrary to law.’ But setting aside the earlier guarantees for religious liberty (which seem now to be mere formalities in the most civilized state of Europe), how can the measures employed against me be justified by the royal commands, which, indeed, prescribed fines for holding Lutheran Church service, and in consonance with which edict, I have already been fined more than three hundred dollars, and the country will shortly behold the tragic-comic spectacle of the sale of my best cattle: but have the scaling up of my rooms and my imprisonment been also prescribed by the king? the imprisonment of an invalid—of a father—of a landed proprietor, who ought to see that order and discipline are maintained? It has been reported, that I am to be tried for rebellion; but I can only take this for idle talk, as a child may see that holding prohibited religious worship cannot be identified with such assemblies as meet to oppose themselves to the commands of government.’ * * * ‘Surely when his majesty visits the province, it will be no joy to his heart to hear that the prisons in Silesia are filled with Christians, persecuted on account of their faith. The monarchs of Spain were shown such prisoners by the inquisitors, but our sovereign is no Spanish king of the times of the inquisition! I trust that the government, after conscientious and calm consideration of the above-mentioned reasons, will grant my humble request: viz., that I may be liberated from prison, and that an order may be given for my rooms to be unsealed; and I only add, that if this should not be done, my grief and bodily

²⁴“The same measures were taken at Schwiebedawe, Von Koszutski’s other estate, where, however, in compliance with the urgent request of the magistrate, his sitting room and a small room in the upper story, were left open for his daughter and her governess.”

weakness may cause my death.”—*Lutheran Church in Prussia*, pp. 42-46.

The reply made to this petition on the part of the government, is well worthy of the attention of all who may be disposed to accuse the Austrian government of intolerance, for deciding that the Zillerdalers should not disturb with religious feuds a hitherto quiet district.

“In reply to your representation of the 4th inst. we can only say that we find, with deep regret, that the essence of your faith, and the dictates of your conscience, *rest in forms*; by the observance or non-observance of which, you, and *your fellow-sectarians*, separate yourselves from the rest of evangelical Christians: for a *doctrinal* change has never been intended by the government; on the contrary, the state never wished to limit either your liberty of conscience, or that of any other individual. Domestic worship, therefore, in any form whatever, has never been prohibited. It may be seen, then, that the conscience of each individual is free, but that the state will not tolerate assemblies which exceed the domestic circle, and that there is no violation of liberty of conscience, in the prohibition of such assemblies, as might be self-evident to you, and any impartial judge; nay, in fact, to every one having the smallest idea of the constitution of a state.”—*Luth. Ch. in Prussia*, 46.

To this the Baron gave the very obvious answer, “The sacraments of the Lord’s Supper and Baptism do *not come within the compass of domestic worship*, and are therefore not included in that liberty of conscience which the state allows.” p. 48. How the affair terminated does not appear from the narrative: Von Koszutski remained in confinement for some months; and a letter from Germany, of the year 1838, speaks of his wishing to emigrate.

By the year 1837, the King had forbidden all public transactions with the Lutherans, and *withdrawing their cause from the courts of justice, had made it over entirely to the police*. It may be asked what the effect of these vigorous measures has been on the community? It is pleasing to find that they have greatly increased the number of devoted Lutherans. A great many of those who had conformed to the state church have returned to them. Communities have been formed in Pomerania, Posen, Magdeburg, Halle, and Berlin; the members of which some years ago amounted to the number of 20,000.

We have already noticed, that some of these poor people have escaped to North America; others have betaken themselves to Australia. Klavel, one of the exiled preachers, thus writes from Adelaide, in the latter country.

“Here, in Australia, no one scoff’s at us hitherto. It seems almost as if Prussia—on which the Lord has shed such a bright light—contained the largest number of scoffers. This we have sufficiently experienced. The most illiterate individual in the towns and villages of that country, if he can do nothing else, can violently blaspheme the word of God.”

* * * *

“But such a scorner is a most pitiable individual; and I can explain to myself the cause of his mockery somewhat in the following manner. Supposing such a person to stumble upon one whom he regards as devout, he may perhaps feel his conscience affected by the Spirit of God, and think within himself, Such an one ought I to be. Now, the louder the monitor speaks to his soul, and the less inclined he is to obey it, the more strongly and strikingly is the picture of his own wickedness, in comparison of the pious man placed before him; and where repentance does not result from it, the basest mockery is manifested. How often have I experienced such treatment in my native land, and the town where I last resided; although I never took any notice of it, and have often been astonished at the existence of such degeneracy. May the Lord forgive these scoffers! Our only object in mentioning them here is, that if this should meet the eye of such an one, he may perceive that his conduct does not appear to be very magnanimous. Thank God! the savages are not such degraded

characters, and probably scarcely know that it is possible to be so depraved, although they are certainly in a very pitiable and neglected state. Boast, if you will, of having driven the Lutheran church fourteen thousand miles across the sea! a voyage of this length is certainly preferable to living in such society."—*Luth. Ch. in Prussia*, 134.

Having brought our confessors to a land of rest, we conclude: in doing so, we cannot help avowing that we much prefer the Silesians to the Zillerdalers, and the hierarchy of Salzburg to the anti-catholic government of Prussia.

ART. VI.—1. Catena Aurea, Commentary on the Four Gospels, collected out of use Works of the Fathers. By S. Thomas Aquinas. Vol. I. St. Matthew, Part 1. Oxford: J. H. Parker. 1841. 2. The Gospel Narrative of our Lord's Passion harmonized, with Reflections. By Rev. Isaac Williams, B. D. Fellow of Trinity College, Oxford. Rivingtons. 1841.

[?] "In Opuscula at B.O., N breaks off at p. 200."—Blehl.

[*British Critic*, vol. 30, July 1841.]

THE name of Aquinas is almost synonymous with all that is popish, superstitious, sophistical, fanciful, and pedantic, in the minds of most of us. We conceive of this great oracle of the Church of Rome, as of one whose life was spent in his closet in busy trifling, in the incessant labour of abstract reasonings upon questions of fact or sacred doctrine, minutely followed out, ingeniously defended, and dogmatically enforced. If there is any thing harsh, corrupt and repulsive in the popular Roman theology, any possible narrowness in an Aristotelian, or any bigotry in a schoolman, we look upon St. Thomas of Aquinum as the type and model of it. Even in the most powerful exercise of his intellect, we expect nothing higher and nobler than the discussion how many spirits can stand on the point of a needle, or whether we are bound to love a possible angel more than an actually existing fly. Yet we now have before us the first portion of a Commentary on the Gospels, not composed indeed, but compiled by him, which certainly gives a very different idea of his character and talents, which has nothing in it but what is grave, impressive, and profitable, and put together with remarkable good sense and skill; and, stranger still, which really contains nothing at all, or next to nothing, of those corrupt tenets and opinions, which we so much deplore in Romanism.

That there is much in his theology, as well as in the notions of his age, which we cannot receive, and can only lament, need scarcely be said; but what we would insist upon, and what is most pleasant to observe, is, that whatever there was in his doctrinal views, which members of our own Church are unable to receive, be it less or more, still it does not interfere with the existence of a deep and broad substance of religious sentiment and opinion, which is the very same that is in esteem among ourselves, and, moreover, in the work before us is expressed in the very words of the primitive divines. In this work he seems to invite us and his own disciples, to lay our mutual differences aside, and to repose together under the shade of the ancient Church. He seems to say, "I will not enter into controversy with you for your new notions, your Protestantism, philosophism, and worldly wisdom, and I will not provoke you by what you consider my scholastic venturousness; but I challenge you to say what there is you can possibly object to in these extracts I shall put before you, from the writings of our common fathers in the faith; do not Augustine, Chrysostom, Ambrose, Leo, Gregory, approve themselves to your religious judgment? for they are the very guides which I too wish to follow. If there be any one vital point in our common religion, must it not be in the feeling with which we regard our Lord, His person, His teaching, His actions,

as recorded in the Gospels? Now do not both parties take one and the same view of it, and one and the same with that which the ancient doctors and bishops took of it? Why then need we unduly magnify those secondary points in which we differ, when we agree in what is primary and more essential?"

We believe that an inspection of the history and writings of divines in the middle ages, would, in a very great number of cases, lead us to the same conclusion, viz. that, in spite of serious differences in formal profession, yet, in the tenor of their lives and the staple of their thoughts, serious men then were like serious men now, with only such varieties as the peculiarities of the human mind and the state of society render unavoidable. This is remarkably illustrated in the letters of our present author's namesake, St. Thomas the Martyr, and his contemporaries, which, though of an highly ethical cast, yet, after striking out one or two sentences or phrases here or there, would not be recognized by any one as belonging to the school of Romanism.

More than this, we have no right or reason to expect in any age of the Church. It is impossible that truth ever should be taught, without its perversion attending on it, like its shadow. Truth of whatever kind, when received by a mind unfitted for it, necessarily becomes *ipso facto* a perversion and corruption. Error is the form which truth takes in unsuitable recipients, just as an oar looks crooked in the water. To desire that doctrinal corruption should not be in the Church, is to desire that good men and bad should not be mixed together in it; and to desire that it should not be prominent, is to desire that the elect should be the many; and the higher the truth, and the wider the field which it occupies, the more solid will be the substance, and the more huge the dimensions, of the error which apes it. And since superstition is the perversion of faith, therefore, while men are men, an age of faith will necessarily be an age of superstition; and in like manner, an age of zeal will be an age of violence; and a theological age, an age of dogmatism and bigotry; and again, an age of benevolence, on the other hand, will be an age of laxity. And, moreover, sometimes the very same men will be examples both of the grace and its perversion; and much more, for one man who is a pattern of the grace, shall we have a hundred specimens of the perversion. St. Augustine had to oppose himself to the Pagan superstitions of Catholics in his day, as well as the Protestants of Exeter Hall now; and the Protestant teacher of this day has to warn his followers against the Antinomianism with which he may be indoctrinating them unwittingly, and which St. Augustine could find only in the Gnostic or Manichee. That the age then in which Aquinas lived was superstitious or bigoted, nay even were he such himself, need tell us little against his substantial faith and holiness, as the fact that our age, or ourselves are presumptuous, tells against our religious vitality; and it is a great satisfaction to find from such works as that before us, that what is abstractedly possible, was, in the case of this great man, true in matter of fact.

It will be observed, that we are speaking as if the prejudices with which the name of Aquinas is encompassed in this age and country, were founded on some real knowledge of what he was or what he taught, or as if his *Catena* were an exception to the bulk of his writings, and accidentally disclosed a secret truth, which they rather negative; whereas, commonly, his writings are only known to us by hearsay; and as to his life, though any biographical dictionary would enable us to form some opinion of it; we are ordinarily ignorant even of his century and country, and the part he played in ecclesiastical and theological matters. We know he was a schoolman; we have our own idea of a schoolman, however obtained; and we thence consider ourselves to have a tolerable notion of St. Thomas, by a mode of reasoning as antecedent and abstract as any we impute to him.

Most men, on hearing of a great schoolman or divine, at once dress up such a personage with whatever is most unimaginative and unromantic. He is the inmate of a cloister from his youth

to age, with logic and metaphysics for his only sciences, and books for his sole companions or informants, knowledge of life he actually has none; he never saw a human being except in a monk's cowl or scapulary, or in surplice and cope. He never conversed, except through the medium of the disputations of the schools, or in the alternations of the sacred choir; and the range of his travels circles round his monastic garden. He never heard of the printing press; he never had the privilege of a newspaper. At other times a more modern notion is entertained of him, as a fellow of a college, or an aged bachelor in some retired lodgings, with a range of dusty folios, a cat, a teapot, and a snuff-box. But in any case, we have commonly presented to us a consistent type of something unsocial, selfish, dry, abstract, and narrowminded. In any case his devotion is form, and his faith is dogmatism. Tenderness, fervour, affectionateness, and poetry, we should as little attempt to associate with him, as to set the Thames on fire. Now it is not here maintained that we know enough of St. Thomas as an individual, to be able to refute these anticipations of him one by one in detail; yet some broad and bold outlines of his character and history we do possess, sufficient to show us that, whatever were his defects, intellectual and ethical, he cannot be said to have prejudice and bigotry so entirely to himself, but that we share it with him; nay, that it is far more certain that we misrepresent him, than that he misrepresented Christianity. We do not mean to say that he was, after all, a married man, or belonged to any fashionable clubs; but a few sentences will be sufficient to dissipate the notions popularly entertained of him.

St. Thomas was the son of Landolph, Count of Aquino, and Lord of Loretto and Belcastro, nephew to the Emperor Frederic, and allied also to St. Louis of France, and to the royal houses of Sicily and Arragon. His mother also was of a noble family. He was born about the year 1226 or 1227; and his place of birth is variously represented as Belcastro, Rocca Secca, and Aquino. When he was five years old he was placed under the Benedictines of Monte Cassino, where he made such progress in his youthful studies, that at the age of thirteen he was sent to the University of Naples, which had lately been founded by the Emperor Frederic II. Both at Cassino and at Naples, he was noted for the religiousness of his deportment. Here he fell in with some monks of the order of St. Dominic, who had himself died about twenty years before; and Thomas formed the resolution to join himself to their body. His tutor acquainting his father with what was in progress, the Count of Aquino exerted himself by all means in his power to divert him from his purpose. Thomas persisted, and at the age of seventeen commenced his novitiate at the Dominican convent at Naples. On the news of this step his mother set out for that city; Thomas had removed to Rome; she followed him thither; Thomas had gone forward towards Paris. Upon this she sent her two other sons after him, who were soldiers in the Emperor's army, who surprised him on his journey, and brought him back to Rocca Secca, the family castle. There they shut him up in confinement, and among other modes of shaking his firmness, had the atrocious cruelty and wickedness to introduce a young married woman into his chamber, of great beauty; he drove her from him with a firebrand from the hearth. Even under these adverse circumstances, however, his influence began to be felt on those around him; his sisters had been sent to work upon his feelings; he succeeded in converting them both, and they supplied him with a Bible, Aristotle's Logic, and the Sentences of Peter Lombard. At the end of one or two years, Pope innocent IV. interfered, as well as the Emperor: his mother seemed disposed to connive at his escape; and one of his sisters contrived to let him down out of his tower in a basket. Such was the early history of this celebrated man, and it ended the following year in his making his formal profession at the Dominican convent at Naples, when he was not yet twenty years old.

The influence of his conduct on his family was not confined to relittings of a temporary

character, under the circumstances which have been described. In the event, to use the words of Alban Butler, "his eldest sister consecrated herself to God in St. Mary's, at Capua, and died abbess of that monastery; the youngest, Theodora, married the count of Marsico, and lived and died in great virtue; as did his mother. His two brothers, Landulph and Reynold, became sincere penitents; and having some time after left the emperor's service, he in revenge burnt Aquino, their seat, in 1250, and put Reynold to death."

Albertus Magnus, who was also of the order of St. Dominic, was at this time teaching at Cologne, and to him Aquinas was sent by his superiors. It was not to be supposed that a youth, whose history commences in so wild and enthusiastic a manner, would so give himself up to scholastic pursuits as to neglect his ascetic and devotional exercises; yet he furnishes a proof of the proverb, that at least "prayers," if not "provender," take up no time. He divided his hours between devotion and study, with a very niggard allowance out of them for meals and sleep. At the same time he observed what Ribadaneiro calls a "Pythagorean silence." This was taken by his companions for stupidity, and, added to the circumstance that he was of a plump habit (*obesulus*), as well as tall, gained him the nickname of the "dumb ox," or the "*bos magnus Siciliae*," as the process of his canonization words it. One of them offered to explain his lessons to him, to whom he thankfully attended; another, not knowing better, told him to pronounce a word with a wrong quantity, and for obedience sake he so pronounced it. His master, Albert, however, had formed a different opinion of him; the lowings "of this ox," he said, "will one day be heard all over the world."

Albert was sent to Paris by the Dominicans in 1245, when he taught in the college of St. James, from which the Jacobins lately have taken a name, which raises very different associations. Thomas went with him, and here he took his degrees of M.A. and afterwards D.D.; in the meanwhile, whereas thirty-five was ordinarily the earliest age for teaching divinity, he was allowed, by a dispensation of the University, to give lectures when only twenty-five. He now began to write those works which have had so wonderful an influence on the theology of the Church. It appears, though it is almost incredible, that he sometimes dictated to three or four secretaries at a time, and it may be added, that he never wrote, lectured or disputed, without earnest and continued prayer beforehand. He took his Doctor's degree at Paris the same year with his great contemporary Bonaventura, who was of the Franciscan order, and with whom he formed a close intimacy. It is said that once, when Thomas had come to see his friend, he found him busy on a life of St. Francis; on which he withdrew, saying, "Let alone a saint in his labours for a saint."

The Dominicans are called the "Order of the Preachers," and Thomas took care to fulfil his profession in this respect as in others. At Cologne, Paris, Rome, and other Italian cities, his sermons excited the most extraordinary sensation; Pope Urban took him about with him wherever he went, and the Jews ran to hear him, and many of them, especially two Rabbins, were converted. One Good Friday, when he preached on the divine love to man, his whole auditory was melted into tears, and he was obliged to stop his discourse several times.

He was much revered by St. Louis, who often asked him to his table. One day Thomas, whose mind was full of a controversial subject, to which the errors of the Albigenses gave rise, cried out at table, "Here is the answer to the Manichæans;" his prior brought him to himself, but the king obliged him to dictate his answer to a secretary without delay, in spite of his confusion and apologies.

His repartee to Innocent IV. is well known. Calling on him one day he found him counting money. The Pope, by way of apology, said, "You see the Church can no longer say, 'Silver and gold

have I none;” “True, holy Father,” answered Thomas, nor can she say to the paralytic, “Take up thy bed and walk.”

When asked, on one occasion, who is in the way to become learned, he answered, “Whoever will content himself with the reading of a single book.”

Clement IV. and Urban IV. attempted in vain to persuade him to accept preferment. He had received priest’s orders at Cologne, but he would not suffer himself to be raised to a see; and in the year 1263, when he was about thirty-seven, he obtained permission to release himself from his duties as a teacher. This was on his attending a chapter of his order at London; about ten years afterwards he died, at the age of forty-eight. Three months before his death, which took place in 1274, he laid aside all theological studies. In the spring of that year, Gregory X. convoked the second council of Lyons, and required the presence of Thomas. Accordingly he set out from Naples at the end of January, but was soon seized with a fever. He stopped at Fossa Nuova, a Cistercian abbey, near Terrocina. As he entered, he used the words of the Psalm, “Hæc requies mea in sæculum sæculi;” and after lying there a month, he was removed from his earthly toils. In this interval, the monks, who attended him with the most earnest affection and devotion, asked him to dictate an exposition of the Canticles after St. Bernard; he answered, “Give me Bernard’s spirit, and I will do it.” However, he attempted to comply, and the Comment which remains is commonly assigned to this closing period of his labours. When he was dying, he requested to be taken off his bed, and laid upon ashes spread upon the floor. On the holy Eucharist being brought to him, he prayed the Lord, in whose presence he was lying, “that whatever he had written well, such as it was, he would graciously accept; and what otherwise, he would pardon, seeing that he had ever set it before him, not to deviate, even by a hair’s breath, from the divine will.” He died on the 7th of March, after thanking God that he was called out of the world so early.

Considering St. Thomas died at so premature an age, and that his life was spent, not only in those vast intellectual works, of which the nineteen volumes folio to which his name is attached are but an inadequate token, but in various important theological negociations in which the popes of his day employed him, it is a fresh wonder to find that he had time for reading the works of his predecessors, and a special to find that reading so mature, orderly, and well digested as appears in the comment which has given rise to these remarks.

Mr. Pattison, the translator of the portion which is occupied on St. Matthew, has drawn up a very luminous account of the history of Catenas generally, and the characteristics of St. Thomas’s in particular. By a Catena is meant a string or series of passages from the Fathers in illustration of some portion of Scripture; and he considers that such compilations originated in the short scholia or glosses which it was customary to introduce in MSS. of the Scriptures, between the lines or on the margin, perhaps in imitation of the scholiasts on profane authors. These, as time went on, were gradually expanded, and passages from the homilies or Sermons of the Fathers upon the same Scriptures added to them.

The earliest commentaries on Scripture had been of this discursive nature, being addresses by word of mouth to the people, which were taken down by secretaries, and so preserved. While the traditionary teaching of the Church had the force and life which were its original characteristics, and stamped, as it were, a definite impression of itself upon the mind of the Christian expositor, he was able to give reins, if we may so speak, to his thoughts, and to allow himself to comment on the sacred text freely, in the confidence that, however wide might be the range which his exposition took, his own deeply fixed views of Catholic truth would bring him home at last in safety and without extravagance. Accordingly, while the early comments preserve a very remarkable unanimity in

their principles and matter, they are at the same time singularly individual, and one writer would never be mistaken for the other. About the sixth or seventh century, however, this originality disappears; the oral or traditionary teaching became fixed in a written tradition, and henceforward there is a uniform invariable character as well as substance in Scripture interpretation. Mr. Pattison considers Pope Gregory as the last of the original commentators; and all later comments as catenas or selections from the earlier Fathers, whether they bear the form of quotations, or of remarks, in form extempore, upon the lesson or Gospel of the day. Mr. Pattison then continues as follows:—

“All such commentaries have more or less merit and usefulness, but they are very inferior to the ‘Catena Aurea,’ which is now presented to the English reader; being all of them partial and capricious, dilating on one passage, and passing unnoticed another of equal or greater difficulty; arbitrary in their selection from the Fathers, and as compilations crude and undigested. But it is impossible to read the Catena of St. Thomas without being struck with the masterly and architectonic skill with which it is put together. A learning of the highest kind,—not a mere literary book-knowledge, which might have supplied the place of indexes and tables in ages destitute of those helps, and when everything was to be learned in unarranged and fragmentary MSS. But a thorough acquaintance with the whole range of ecclesiastical antiquity, so as to be able to bring the substance of all that had been written on any point to bear upon the text which involved it, a familiarity with the style of each writer, so as to compress into a few words the pith of a whole page, and a power of clear and orderly arrangement in this mass of knowledge, are qualities which make this Catena perhaps nearly perfect as a conspectus of patristic interpretation. Other compilations exhibit research, industry, learning; but this, though a mere compilation, evinces a masterly command over the whole subject of theology.

“The Catena is so contrived that it reads as a running commentary, the several extracts being dove-tailed together by the compiler. And it consists wholly of extracts, the compiler introducing nothing of his own but the few connecting particles which link one extract to the next. There are also a few quotations headed ‘Glossa,’ which none of the editors have been able to find in any author, and which from their character, being briefly introductory of a new chapter or a new subject, may be probably assigned to the compiler, though even this is dispensed with when it is possible; when a Father will furnish the words for such transition or connection, they are dexterously introduced. In the Gospel of St. Matthew there are only a few other passages which seem to belong to St. Thomas. These are mostly short explanations or notes upon something that seemed to need explanation in some passage quoted, and which in a modern book would have been thrown into the form of a foot note.

“This continuity is expressed in the title which the author gives his work in his dedication to Pope Urban IV. ‘*expositio continua*,’—the term Catena was not used till after his death ... The sacred text is broken into paragraphs longer or shorter; the shortest less than a verse, the longest twenty verses, and the exposition of each part follows this order. First, the transition from the last paragraph to that under review; if they are events, the harmony of the chronology with the other Evangelists is shown, S. Augustine (*de Consensu Evangelistarum*) being the authority used for this; then comes the literal, or, what is called, the historical exposition. Where different Fathers have given different explanations, they are introduced generally in the order of the most obvious and literal first, and so proceeding to the most recondite, by the words ‘*Vel aliter*.’ Then if any important doctrine hinges upon any part of the passage or comma, selections are given from the most approved treatises on the subject; ... And the comment on the portion is wound up with what is variously called the mystical, moral, allegorical, tropical, tropological, and spiritual sense. The

peculiar exposition of Origen, which seems to hold a mean place between the historical and the authorized mystical interpretation, is accordingly often inserted between these ...

"Nor is it the case with this Catena, as it seems to be with every other, that some one commentary has been taken as a nucleus or basis, into which other extracts have been inserted. Dr. Cramer says, that Chrysostom is the staple of all the Greek Catenas on St. Matthew; but though St. Thomas held Chrysostom in such esteem that he is reported to have said '*malle se uti Chrysostom libris in Matthæum quam possidere fruique Lutetia Parisiorum*,' (præf. Ben.) and though he has drawn upon the Homilies very largely, it is no more than he has done upon nearly all the principal commentaries. If any book might be supposed to have been his guide more than another it would be Rabanus Maurus; though we should not say that he quoted any other writers mediately through Rabanus, yet this compiler seems often to have guided him to quotations in St. Augustine, Gregory, and the general treatises of the Latin Fathers."—iii.—vi.

We shall now present the reader with one or two ample extracts from the Catena, taken almost at random, in illustration of its character. We think they justify the strong words of the editors, that the work "will be found as useful in the private study of the Gospel, as it is well adapted for family reading, and full of thought for those who are engaged in religious instruction."

The first shall be the comment on the text in the Sermon of the Mount,—"*Swear not at all:*"—

"*Gloss.* It is written in Leviticus, *Thou shalt not forswear thyself in my name*; and that they should not make gods of the creature, they are commanded to render God their oaths, and not to swear by any creature. *Render to the Lord thy oaths*; that is, if you shall have occasion to swear, you shall swear by the Creator and not by the creature. As it is written in Deuteronomy, *Thou shalt fear the Lord thy God, and shalt swear by His name.*—Jerome. This was allowed under the Law, as to children; as they offered sacrifice to God that they might not do it to idols, so they were permitted to swear by God; not that the thing was right, but that it were better done to God than to demons.—*Pseudo-Chrysostom.* For no man can swear often but he must sometimes forswear himself; as he who has a custom of much speaking will sometimes speak foolishly.—*Augustine.* Inasmuch as the sin of perjury is a grievous sin, he must be further removed from it who uses no oath, than he who is ready to swear on every occasion; and the Lord would rather that we should not swear, and keep close to the truth, than that swearing we should come near to perjury.—*Id.* This precept also confirms the righteousness of the Pharisees, not to forswear; inasmuch as he who swears not at all cannot forswear himself. But as to call God to witness is to swear, does not the apostle break this commandment when he says several times to the Galatians, *The things which I write unto you, behold, before God, I lie not*: so the Romans, *God is my witness, whom I serve in my spirit*? Unless, perhaps, some one may say, it is no oath unless I use the form of swearing by some object; and that the apostle did not swear in saying, *God is my witness*. It is ridiculous to make such a distinction; yet the apostle has used even this form, *I die daily by your boasting.*—*Id.* But what we could not understand by mere words, from the conduct of the saints we may gather in what sense should be understood what might easily be drawn the contrary way, unless explained by example. The apostle has used oaths in his epistles, and by this shows us how that ought to be taken, *I say unto you, swear not at all*, namely, lest by allowing ourselves to swear at all we come to readiness in swearing; from readiness we come to a habit of swearing; and from a habit of swearing we fall into perjury. And so the apostle is not found to have used an oath but only in writing, the greater thought and caution which that requires not allowing of slip of the tongue.—*Id.* Therefore in his writings, as writing allows of greater circumspection, the apostle is found to have used an oath in several places, that none might suppose that there is any direct sin in swearing what is true, but only that our weak

hearts are better preserved from perjury by abstaining from all swearing whatever.—*Jerome*. Lastly, consider that the Saviour does not here forbid to swear by God, but, by the heavens, the earth, by Jerusalem, by a man's head; for this evil practice of swearing by the elements the Jews had always, and are, therefore, often accused in the prophetic writings; for he who swears, shows either reverence or love for that by which he swears. Thus, when the Jews swore by the angels, by the city of Jerusalem, by the temple and the elements, they paid to the creature the honour and worship belonging to God; for it is commanded in the Law that we should not swear but by the Lord our God.—*Augustine*. Or, it is added, *By the heavens, &c.*, because the Jews did not consider themselves bound when they swore by such things. As if He had said, When you swear by the heaven and the earth, think not that you do not owe your oath to the Lord your God, for you are proved to have sworn by Him whose throne the heaven is, and the earth His footstool; which is not meant as though God had such limbs set upon the heaven and the earth, after the manner of a man who is sitting, but that seat signifies God's judgment of us. And since, in the whole extent of this universe, it is the heaven that has the highest beauty, God is said to sit upon the heavens, as showing Divine power to be more excellent than the most surpassing show of beauty; and He is said to stand upon the earth, as putting to lowest use a lesser beauty. Spiritually, by the heavens are denoted holy souls, by the earth the sinful, seeing *He that is spiritual judgeth all things*. But to the sinner it is said, *Earth thou art, and unto earth thou shalt return*. And he who would abide under a law, is put under a law, and therefore He adds, *it is the footstool of His feet. Neither by Jerusalem, for it is the city of the Great King*; this is better said than 'it is mine;' though it is understood to mean the same. And because He is also truly Lord, whoso swears by Jerusalem owes his oath to the Lord. *Neither by the head*. What could any think more entirely his own property than his own head? But how is it ours when we have not power to make one hair black or white? Whoso then swears by his own head, also owes his vows to the Lord; and by this the rest may be understood.—*Chrysostom*. Note how He exalts the elements of the world, not from their own nature, but from the respect which they have to God, so that there is opened no occasion of idolatry."—pp. 192-195.

Next we select the comments on a very different part of the same divine discourse:—

"*Chrysostom*. Having shown that it is not right to be anxious about food, He passes to that which is less, (for raiment is not so necessary as food), and asks, *And why are ye careful wherewith ye shall be clothed?* He uses not here the instance of the birds, as the peacock, or the swan, but brings forward the lilies, saying, *Consider the lilies of the field*. He would prove in two things the abundant goodness of God, to wit, the richness of the beauty with which they are clothed, and the mean value of the things so clothed with it; for lilies within a fixed time are formed into branches, clothed in whiteness, and endowed with sweet odour, God conveying, by an unseen operation, what the earth had not given to the root. But in all the same perfectness is observed, that they may not be thought to have been formed by chance, but may be known to have been ordered by God's providence. When he says, *They toil not*, He speaks for the comfort of men; *neither do they spin*, for the women.—*Chrysostom*. He forbids not labour, but carefulness, both here and above when he spoke of sowing.—*Gloss*. And for the greater exaltation of God's providence in those things that are beyond human industry, He adds, *I say unto you, that Solomon in all his glory was not arrayed like one of these*. *Jerome*. For, in sooth, what regal purple, what silk, what web of divers colours from the loom, may vie with flowers? What work of man has the red blush of the rose? the pure white of the lily? How the Tyrian dye yields to the violet, sight alone and not words can express.—*Chrysostom*. As widely as truth differs from falsehood, so widely do our clothes differ from flowers. If then Solomon, who was more eminent than all other kings, was yet surpassed by flowers, how shall

you exceed the beauty of flowers by your garments? And Solomon was exceeded by the flowers not once only, or twice, but throughout his whole reign; and this is that He says, *In all his glory*; for in no one day was he arrayed as are the flowers.—*Pseudo-Chrysostom*. Or the meaning may be, that Solomon, though he toiled not for his own raiment, yet he gave command for the making of it. But where command is, there is often found both offence of them that minister, and wrath of him that commands. When then any are without these things, then they are arrayed as are the lilies.—*Hilary*. Or, by the lilies are to be understood the eminences of the heavenly angels, to whom a surpassing radiance of whiteness is communicated by God. *They toil not, neither do they spin*, because the angelic powers in the very first allotment of their existence are of such a nature, that as they were made, so should they ever continue to be; and when, in the resurrection, men shall be like unto angels, He would have them look for a covering of angelic glory by this example of angelic excellence.—*Pseudo-Chrysostom*. If God then thus provides for the flowers of the earth which only spring up, that they may be seen and die, shall He overlook men whom He has created, not to be seen for a time, but that they should be for ever?—*Jerome*. Tomorrow in Scripture is put for time future in general. Jacob says, *So shall my righteousness answer for me tomorrow*. And in the phantasm of Samuel, the Pythoness says to Saul, *Tomorrow shalt thou be with me*.—*Chrysostom*. He calls them no more lilies, but *the grass of the field*, to show their small worth; and adds, moreover, another cause of their small value, *which today is*—and he said not, *and tomorrow is not*—but what is yet greater fall, *is cast into the oven*.—*Hilary*. Or, under the signification of grass the Gentiles are pointed to. If then an external existence is only, therefore, granted to the Gentiles, that they may soon be handed over to the judgment fires, how impious it is that the saints should doubt of attaining to eternal glory, when the wicked have eternity bestowed on them for their punishment.—*Remig*. Spiritually, by the birds of the air are meant the saints who are born again in the water of holy baptism, and by devotion raise themselves above the earth, and seek the skies. The apostles are said to be of more value than these, because they are the heads of the saints. By the lilies also may be understood the saints, who, without the toil of legal ceremonies, pleased God by faith alone, of whom it is said, *My beloved, who feedeth among the lilies*. Holy Church also is understood by the lilies, because of the whiteness of its faith, and the odour of its good conversation, in which it is said in the same place, *As the lily among the thorns*. By the grass are denoted the unbelievers, of whom it is said, *The grass hath dried up, and the flowers thereof faded*. By the oven eternal damnation; so that the sense be, if God bestows temporal goods on the unbelievers, how much more shall He bestow on you eternal goods.”—p. 255-257.

The following passage belongs to the miracle of the raising the ruler’s daughter:—

“*Gloss*. After the healing of the woman with the issue of blood, follows the raising of the dead; *And when Jesus was come into the ruler’s house*.—*Chrysostom*. We may suppose He proceeded slowly, and spake longer to the woman whom he had healed, that He might suffer the maid to die, and thus an evident miracle of restoring to life might be wrought. In the case of Lazarus also, He waited till the third day. *And when He saw the minstrels, and people making a noise*; this was a proof of her death.—*Ambrose*. For, by ancient custom, minstrels were engaged to make lamentation for the dead.—*Chrysostom*. But Christ put forth all the pipers, but took in the parents, that it might not be said that He had healed her by any other means; and before the restoring to life he excites their expectations by His words; *And He said, Give place, for the maid is not dead, but sleepeth*.—*Bede*. As though He had said, To you she is dead, but to God, who has power to give life, she sleeps only, both in soul and body.—*Chrysostom*. By this saying, He soothes the minds of those that were present, and shows that it is easy to Him to raise the dead; the like He did in the case of Lazarus;

Our friend Lazarus sleepeth. This was also a lesson to them not to be afraid of death; forasmuch as He himself also should die, He made His disciples learn, in the persons of others, confidence and patient endurance of death. For when He was near, death was but as sleep. When He had said this, *They mocked him.* And He did not rebuke their mocking, that this mocking, and the pipes, and all other things, might be a proof of her death.—*Jerome.* They that had mocked the Reviver were not worthy to behold the mystery of the revival; and, therefore, it follows. *And when the multitude was put forth, he entered, and took her by the hand, and the maid arose.*—*Chrysostom.* He restored her to life, not by bringing in another soul, but by recalling that which had departed, and, as it were, raising it from sleep, and through this sight preparing the way for belief of the resurrection. And He not only restores her to life, but commands food to be given her, as the other evangelists relate, that that which was done might be seen to be no delusion. *And the fame of him went abroad into all that country.*—*Gloss.* The fame, namely, of the greatness and novelty of the miracle, and its established truth; so that it could not be supposed to be a forgery.

“*Hilary.* Mystically; the Lord enters the ruler’s house, that is the synagogue, throughout which there resounded, in the songs of the Law, a strain of wailing.—*Jerome.* To this day the damsel lays dead in the ruler’s house; and they that seem to be teachers are but minstrels singing funeral dirges. The Jews also are not the crowd of believers, but of *people making a noise.* But when the fulness of the Gentiles shall come in, then all Israel shall be saved.—*Hilary.* But that the number of the elect might be known to be but few out of the whole body of believers, the multitude is put forth; the Lord indeed would that they should be saved, but they mocked at His sayings and actions, and so were not worthy to be made partakers of His resurrection.—*Jerome.* He took her by the hand, and the maid arose, because if the hands of the Jews, which are defiled with blood, be not first cleansed, their synagogue, which is dead, shall not revive.—*Hilary.* *His fame went about into all that country;* that is, the salvation of the elect, the gift and works of Christ are preached.—*Raban.* Morally; The damsel dead in the house is the soul dead in thought. He says that she is asleep, because they that are now asleep in sin may yet be roused by penitence. The minstrels are flatterers who cherish the dead.—*Greg.* The multitude are put forth that the damsel may be raised; for, unless the multitude of worldly cares is first banished from the secrets of the heart, the soul which is laid within cannot rise again.—*Raban.* The maiden is raised in the house with few to witness; the young man without the gate, and Lazarus in the presence of many; for a public scandal requires a public expiation, a less notorious, a less remedy; and secret sins may be done away by penitence.”—pp. 351-353.

Mr. Williams’s work, on our Lord’s Passion, is on too sacred a subject to allow of our going at length into it in this place; but our judgment of its merits will be understood by our putting it into so close a connection with the work of a saint. It is indeed in great measure actually composed from the Aurea Catena, but with much original matter interspersed. We heartily hope that, as the author hints, he will be induced to complete the whole work, of which it is but a specimen, though an important one: meanwhile, we make a series of extracts from one passage of it, which, while they give a fair idea of its general character, are as removed from the solemn events which are its main subject as any portion which could be selected.

“There have been some who have considered that Mary Magdalene is the same person as the sister of Lazarus under another name; but on inquiry, we usually find that there is no evidence to support this opinion either in Holy Scriptures or among the early Fathers; we are then, perhaps, apt to dismiss the supposition altogether as untenable and erroneous; and yet at length, on further thought, there are some reasons which dispose one not altogether to reject it. For although we cannot find sufficient authority to support the opinion by direct evidence, yet, when we have formed

unconsciously a picture of Mary Magdalene in our minds, we find that it extremely resembles that which we have unconsciously been forming, at the same time, of the sister of Lazarus. If any one, judging from the circumstances recorded in the Gospels, were to give an accurate description of what he supposed to be the character of either of these, it would be in great measure a character of the other also; with this difference perhaps, that with Mary Magdalene we connect something more of penitential sorrow; with the other, that calmness of piety which belongs to one that had always 'chosen that good part which shall not be taken away from her.' And yet perhaps it may be shown, that there is not sufficient reason for even this supposed discrepancy, either in their histories or their characters.

"The few circumstances recorded of St. Mary Magdalene are such as to excite in us an exceeding interest. We behold her standing among the nearest to our Saviour's cross, sitting the last at his grave at night, and coming the first there in the early morning; and more than all, the circumstances of our Lord's interview with her rivet our strongest attentions and emotions. So eminent among those holy women for her devoted service; and eminent, even among those holy women, in the favour and acceptance of her Lord. Now, in the previous history we have circumstances recorded of an equal and similar interest in Mary, the sister of Lazarus. The same attachment to our Lord, the same favour expressed towards her, and the occasions on which they are mentioned, bring out the same points of disposition in both. In both the same calm, yet intense devotedness, of character; in both, a disposition retiring and contemplative, and yet in both, at the same time, earnest and unshrinking. We have here Mary Magdalene sitting by the sepulchre, and withdrawing from the busier company of her friends, the Galilean women, who had gone to prepare spices to do honour to their Lord. We have on another occasion Mary, the sister of Martha, sitting at Christ's feet to hear his instructions, and in so doing, separated from her more active sister, who was busied in preparations to do honour to our Lord, by receiving him worthily. We have Mary Magdalene sitting in grief at his grave. We have the sister of Martha sitting in grief in the house, mourning for her brother Lazarus. Again, we have self-sacrifice and self-devotion in both; in Mary Magdalene, when she stood at the foot of the cross in that most trying hour, amidst taunts and revilings, unmoved; in Mary, the sister of Martha, when she seems to have sacrificed her livelihood to embalm our Lord's body with great cost, and that in spite of the reproaches of the bystanders. In both a depth of feeling which would be considered contemplative, and yet in both it was combined with a most active energy. Under circumstances of the same kind, they both come forward to our notice by a development of a similar character; and yet the conduct of each of them, under those circumstances, is different from that of others on the same occasions. Thus, at the death of Lazarus, we read of Mary his sister, 'but Mary sat still in the house,' in the position and character of a mourner; but on our Lord's coming, it is said, 'as soon as she heard that, she arose quickly.' The earnest activity which marks this movement displays also incidentally the deep and strong devotedness of her disposition; for the Jews who knew her concluded she had gone to sit at the grave as an action naturally expected of her character and affections, supposing that she was going to act as we find Mary Magdalene now doing. 'The Jews, therefore, which were with her in the house, and comforted her, when they saw Mary, that she arose up hastily, and went out, followed her, saying, She goeth unto the grave to weep there.' Now let this account be compared with that of Mary Magdalene on our Lord's death: the one, as was observed, sat still in the house mourning; the other now sits still at the grave mourning. But from that posture the former arose hastily on hearing of our Lord; and again, there is the same active intensity shown, when on perceiving in the twilight that the stone was removed, she hastened to inform the disciples, anticipating even her

companions, who waited after her at the place, and saw the angel. Again, when they come into the presence of our Lord himself, there is something very similar in the character displayed by both of them; and yet not similar to anything mentioned of any other of our Lord's followers. At the grave of Lazarus, we read, 'when Mary was come where Jesus was, and saw him, she fell down at his feet, saying unto him, Lord, if thou hadst been here, my brother had not died. When Jesus therefore saw her weeping ... He groaned in the spirit, and was troubled.' At the sepulchre of our Lord, and Mary Magdalene's interview with him, we read, 'Mary stood without at the sepulchre weeping;' and the angels say unto her, 'Why weepest thou? And soon afterwards our Lord says unto her, 'Woman, why weepest thou?' The words that follow are few, but in the highest degree expressive, and set before us, in vivid colours, the person of Mary Magdalene, when she acknowledges our Lord by the single word 'Rabboni!' and our Lord replies to her 'Touch me not.' Words, doubtless, mysteriously and divinely intended to support the human weakness of her nature; but, at the same time, indicative of some action of intense devotedness and adoration in her. Throughout this touching scene we cannot help imagining that we see the same person again at our Lord's feet, who was weeping at his feet at the grave of Lazarus, when he was troubled and wept at the sight. There is in both a singular forgetfulness of self; the same intense but deep and calm affection of Divine love. To these points of identity of character may be added the remarkable fact of there being no mention made of Mary, the sister of Martha, at our Lord's death and resurrection."—pp. 405-409.

He then answers the objection drawn from the circumstance that Martha is not mentioned at this time any more than Mary. He observes, that on other occasions also Mary is separated from Martha in her mode of acting, owing to the marked difference of character which exists between the sisters. As Martha was busied about serving on a former occasion, while Mary sat at our Lord's feet, so now the former might be preparing spices while the latter was sitting over against the sepulchre.

Mr. Williams continues:

"There still remains the question, if these descriptions are of one and the same person, why are there distinct appellations usually applied to them? But this would not be the only case of the kind in Scripture; as there occurs no distinct intimation that Nathaniel and Bartholomew are but different names for the same individual, as we reasonably conclude that they are. If Mary Magdalene was a widow, and belonged to or possessed a place called Magdala, in Galilee, by marriage, she might have been generally known under that title, excepting when in the house of, or spoken in connection with, Lazarus and her sister at Bethany. And it may be also noticed that St. Matthew, St. Mark, (*i.e.* perhaps St. Peter), and St. John, who speak mostly of her, and under the title of Mary Magdalene, would naturally have known her by that name, as men of Galilee. St. Luke speaks of her under this title, not as a familiar appellation, but as a person so 'called.' He twice mentions her as the person 'out of whom went seven devils,' which is the designation of a stranger, and so also is that other term, when he speaks of her as one 'who ministered unto our Lord in Galilee.'

"One would indeed be glad to think that there should have been two such persons: for it is certain that the sister of Lazarus had given herself up to the one thing which is needful with singleness of heart; and also that Mary Magdalene was a person of most fervent piety. Theophylact observes, that although the evangelists mention different women, 'yet they all speak of Mary Magdalene on account of her fervent affection.' And St. Augustine says of her, that Mary Magdalene came, without doubt as being much more fervent in affection than the rest of the women which ministered unto the Lord; so that not undeservedly John makes mention of her, while he says

nothing of those who came with her, as the other testify.”—pp. 409, 410.

Our author then comes to the question whether St. Mary Magdalene is the same with the “woman who was a sinner, who anointed our Lord’s feet in the Pharisee’s house.” He observes that for many centuries this has been commonly answered in the affirmative, though there is no evidence of the fact either in Scripture or among the early Fathers. Granting then that the supposition is incapable of proof, still he considers that certain considerations may be urged in favour of it, which it may be right to mention, out of respect to the persons who have maintained it. As to the Fathers, if there is no evidence in favour of this supposition, at least there is none against it. Origen, Ambrose, Chrysostom, and Augustine plainly decide on conjectural grounds. St. Ambrose suggests that there might have been more than one Mary Magdalene. Pope Gregory speaks of St. Mary Magdalene as the sinner who, by loving the truth, had washed away with tears the stains of crime. St. Austin considers Mary, the sister of Lazarus, who anointed our Lord at Bethany, as the same person whom St. Luke records as the sinner who anointed him in the house of the Pharisee. His reason is this, that *before* the anointing at Bethany, upon Lazarus’s being raised from the dead, St. John speaks of her as the person who had anointed our Lord, and wiped his feet with the hair of her head. This argument will introduce a further passage from Mr. Williams, with which we shall conclude this article.

“In answer to this argument of St. Austin’s, it might be said that St. John thus designates her, not by an action which had at that time taken place, viz. at time raising of Lazarus, but by an action for which she was afterwards known. But still the expression of her ‘wiping His feet with her hair,’ although St. John records this circumstance in the anointing at Bethany; whereas the other two evangelists only speak of her anointing His head: yet this circumstance itself seems more characteristic of the action in St. Luke than it is of the later one at Bethany. The action of wiping His feet with her hair is in itself so beautiful and so extraordinary, that we feel a love and desire to connect it for ever with the same person: it was an action that could not have been done by a second person from imitation: and would scarce have spontaneously occurred to two different persons. But when we consider both these anointings to have been by one and the same individual, the change that takes place in the action, that she who once anointed Christ’s feet only, should now, after many expressions of His favour and approbation, venture to combine the head also in that deed of honour, is most touchingly significative; expressive of her improved condition, of her higher acceptance, and of her overflowing gratitude for the same. Now this new case of question appears indeed greatly to increase the difficulty of the former; for many would be inclined to allow the former, that St. Mary Magdalene may be no other than Mary, the sister of Martha; and many also would be disposed to take it for granted, that, St. Mary Magdalene was ‘the sinner’ we are speaking of. But most persons would be very loth to suppose that the good sister of Martha should have been ‘the sinner’ described by St. Luke.”—pp. 413, 414.

Mr. Williams answers this difficulty by suggesting, first, that the term “sinner” has not that force which at first sight we should be apt to give it; and next, by insisting on the power of our Lord’s absolution, whatever the woman’s sins were; an absolution very different from any that is vouchsafed to us who have already in baptism received the gift of grace, and have profaned it.

Notices of Books

[*British Critic*, July 1838.]

SINCE our last number the long anticipated Life of Mr. Wilberforce by his Sons has made its appearance; we hope to have an early opportunity of reviewing it, meanwhile it will be enough to notice, what is on the surface of the work, the exceedingly great pains which have been spent upon it, and its importance as an addition to the historical records of the times to which it belongs.

The most important theological work which has lately appeared is Mr. Palmer's Treatise on the Church, which also will, in due time, receive from us the careful attention which it claims from all Churchmen. Whatever judgment be formed of the conclusions to which he has come on the variety of points which he has had to consider, we cannot contemplate without admiration, and (if it were right) without envy, the thorough treatment which his subject has received at his hands. It is indeed a work quite in character with the religious movement which has lately commenced in different parts of the Church, displaying a magnificence of design similar to that of the Bishop of London's plan of fifty new Churches, and Dr. Pusey, of Oxford's, projected translation of the Fathers.

This latter arduous undertaking, we rejoice to know, is now beginning to show fruit, the original text of St. Austin's Confessions, for which five Oxford MSS. have been collated or re-collated, is now through the press, all but the index; the translation also will issue from the press in the course of a short time, as will also the translation of St. Cyril, of Jerusalem. A portion of St. Chrysostom's Comment on St. Paul's Epistles has been printed since Christmas; but an important reason for suspending it has lately occurred in the researches which have been made into the Paris MSS. which Montfaucon used in the Benedictine text. Nothing has been found to throw suspicion on his theological honesty, but enough to show that readings may be materially improved by re-collation. Re-collations are proceeding for the same reason in the Oxford text of St. Cyprian; but they will not interfere with the translation, which is ready to go to press at once. Meanwhile Mr. Bickersteth has brought out an interesting little volume of portions of the works of the Fathers of the first and second Century. The work is conceived in the best spirit, and can but elicit kind and respectful feelings even from those who consider that Mr. Bickersteth does not enjoy in full measure the pure light of catholic truth. May there be less difference year by year between such men as him and them, and we think he is taking the way to fulfil the wish!

In Oxford, Mr. Parker's series of select Religious Works continues. Bishop Taylor's Golden Grove, Archbishop Laud's Devotions, Bishop Patrick's Heart's Ease, Dr. Sutton's Meditations on the Lord's Supper, and Hymns from the Paris Breviary, have already been published. These volumes present an appearance most appropriate to their contents, being beautifully printed and embellished, yet without an approach to the bad taste of the day. We are not quite satisfied with the judgment on which the Breviary Hymns are edited, *A selection* has been attempted; now this seems to be impossible. In such compositions Romanism obtrudes itself sometimes in a mere word, where the hymn is otherwise catholic and beautiful; and thus reduces a selector to the dilemma of omitting it altogether, or of seeming to countenance what is erroneous, We incline to think that in a second edition, which we hope soon to see, *all* should be printed, and the task of discriminating between them, which is not difficult, left to the reader. It is a curious coincidence, considering how little Dr. Sutton's works have been known of late years, that while his Meditations were publishing at Oxford, his *Disce Mori* (Learn to Die) has appeared in London, without any understanding between the respective editors. Our readers will not be sorry to have had this little work also warmly recommended to their attention.

Archbishop Laurence has published a third edition of his celebrated Bampton Lectures, also

of his Treatise on Baptism, which is scarcely equal to them, and of his Translation of the Book of Enoch.

The little tract called "A Catechism on the Holy Catholic and Apostolic Church," has, in the course of a few months, reached a third edition. As its sale shows, it is well adapted to distribution. In connection with which, though with no real connection beyond that of subject, may be mentioned a small Catechism, "Of Scriptural Episcopacy," published at Belfast. It contains much information in the course of a few pages.

A volume of Poems has been published at Oxford called the Cathedral, with a number of elegant wood cuts. These Poems have obscurities, as a great deal of poetry must have, and ever has had; but we are greatly mistaken if they have not a long course of prospective influence in store for them.

No. 81 of the Tracts for the Times, which has been long expected, has at length appeared, and forms, by itself, a volume of above 400 closely printed pages. It is a catena of our divines on the subject of the Eucharistic Sacrifice, and is preceded by an historical sketch of the doctrine in our Church during the last 300 years. It completes vol. iv. which, though the longest, contains fewer Tracts than any of the former. We wish to draw particular attention to the deep thoughts contained in No. 80, on the right mode of preaching the Gospel.

The first volume has appeared of a uniform edition of the Theological Works of that lamented prelate and most excellent man, Bishop Van Mildert.

We grieve to have to notice that Dr. Faussett, Margaret Professor, who is favourably known to the world by a volume of Bampton Lectures before he was Professor, and a sermon against Mr. Milman since, has preached and published a Sermon against Mr. Froude's Remains. We trust this ill-advised step will not plunge the University into a new controversy. It is indeed deplorable that at a time when our enemies are at our gates, Dr. Faussett, without being able to point out one doctrine of our Articles or Prayer-book as infringed, should choose such a moment above all others for suddenly breaking silence in an attack on some of our Church's most devoted sons. No step more acceptable than his to Dissenters and Papists, Liberals and Destructives, can be conceived; and the more so as taken by a man who, however he himself may draw subtle distinctions, is in their eyes quite as much a bigot and a formalist as those whom he attacks. At this time of day the word of no one man, unsupported either by argument or by appeal to authority, can stop the course of thought in the University, or deter inquiring minds from following the paths of Hooker, Andrews and Bull, or of their masters, Irenæus or Cyprian. It is understood that a letter is being addressed to him by Mr. Newman. Before our next number it is to be hoped this lamentable affair will be at an end.

Dr. Adams, of Cambridge, Lady Margaret's Preacher, has published a Treatise to show that the "sealed book" in Rev. v. 1. is the Old Testament; that its unsealing is still to come, and will be equivalent to a new revelation; that its authentic copy was carried from Jerusalem to Rome, is still in the Vatican, and when brought to light will be the means of converting the Jews.

Various volumes of Sermons, some from distinguished persons, have been published in London during the last quarter. Bishop Mant's Sermons, on the Church and her Ministrations (Rivingtons), are but a specimen of what that excellent man is and has been all through his life, a witness for catholic truth against innovation and heresy.—Dr. Moberly's "Practical Sermons" (Rivingtons) unite singular clearness and exactness of thought, with the earnestness and profitableness which their title promises.—Mr. Smith's, preached at the Temple Church (Fellowes), are sound Sermons, sometimes deep, and sometimes rather dry, on the subjects to which he limits himself. It is that

limitation which occasions this dryness so far as it exists.—Though we have pleasure in agreeing with Mr. Melvill on many most important points, there certainly are others on which we differ from him. Yet in spite of this we should feel his Sermons (Rivingtons) as impressive as they are beautiful, were it not for his never-ending use of the word “we,” “we,” “we;” which, as often as it occurs, unpleasantly draws one back from his subject to himself, and makes his volume like a series of reports of speeches and sermons extracted from a newspaper.

In Mr. Harness’s Sermons (Moxon) there is much that is sensible and useful, and “calculated for being read aloud in families,” which he proposes as his object in publishing. When, however, he calls the Church “a party,” p. 81, and the Lord’s day “the Sabbath,” p. 272, he shows himself tainted with the religious peculiarisms of the day. Nothing is more common in every age than sacrificing one part of Christian truth to another; or buying off general strictness of life by attention to one particular duty. At present this temper shows itself in endeavouring, by laying a stress on the duty of sanctifying a seventh of our time, to make up for the neglect of all other positive ordinances, such as the Apostolical Succession, Church Communion, the Priesthood, Sacramental Grace, and Tithes and Offerings. We do not mean to include Mr. Harness in this censure, but are speaking of the system to which he has in one point given in. It is this circumstance which makes Sabbath Societies, Sabbath Bills, &c. so *hypocritical*, if we may use the word; “these ought ye to have done, and not to leave the others undone.”

Mr. Bennett’s Sermons (Cleaver) are not to be confounded with the run of such publications at this day, than which nothing can be more feeble. They are the composition of an able and thoughtful mind, and contain earnest and practical remarks, clothed in plain and natural language. However, they are not written as if he had a clear and consistent grasp of the truth. We do not mention as more than symbols of what we mean, that he, too, calls the Lord’s day the Sabbath, that he confuses together the Catholic and Sectarian ascetics of the Primitive ages, and quotes Doddridge and Chrysostom in the same Sermon.

Mr. Fulford’s Course of Plain Sermons on the Ministry, Doctrines, and Services of our Church (Rivingtons), are among the pleasing evidences of the growth of sound Catholic principles among what are called “the working Clergy.” Here is a laborious parish priest, showing that it is possible to stand his ground in a mixed population without sacrificing principle. His Sermons contain a good deal of sound matter in a small space.

Mr. Vogan, known already by his Bampton Lectures, has published five sound and useful Sermons, apparently as a companion to them.

Mr. Poole’s Testimony of St. Cyprian against Rome is a careful and perspicuous Essay, showing that Rome is not legitimately what she claims to be, “the Mother and Mistress of all Churches.” He considers that, in St. Cyprian’s judgment, St. Peter was a symbol and not the instrument of unity, that all bishops are such instruments, and are what St. Peter typified; that Rome, as being the sedes Petri, has a natural primacy of honour and of deference in faith and practice among the Churches, not a power of jurisdiction; that over those Churches, which trace their orders to Rome, she is in some sense the instrument of unity as being the witness of the truth, but loses her privilege when and so far as she declines from the truth. Mr. Poole will allow us to ask why he says “Peter” instead of “St. Peter;” the usage of Latin and Greek divinity is no authority; give us back the early ages and we can dispense with such ceremonial observances; but in times when irreverence is rife, we must make up for what we have lost as we may; and this is one of those means which remains to us of preserving a tone of mind which the world would fain take from us.

Mr. Cape, B.A., of Balliol College, Oxford, has added to an “Inquiry into the Use of Church

Authority, &c." a catena of English Divines, "who have regarded Scripture as the *only test* of the divine will," and thereby incurred an *ignoratio elenchi* in the controversy in which he engages; the point in dispute being, whether, in *interpreting* that "only test" as regards matters of faith, an individual is to be guided by his own private judgment or by Catholic tradition. However, we highly approve of the principle of such undertakings; and though we think his to be defective, both as regards the point to be proved, and testimonies to prove it, we desire nothing better than to see others of the same kind. Let us know *how* and *where* English divines stand by all means. The persons he opposes have too much candour to aim at making the body of our divines more consistent than they really are, or at appropriating a Chillingworth and a Whitby, or even a Hall and a Cranmer. At the same time we feel assured, that at the end of the examination, those writers among our divines "whom all the people count as prophets," those whom they read and consult, know and revere, will not be found with Mr. Cape.

The Third Part of Mr. Girdlestone's Commentary on the Old Testament (from Joshua to Samuel), has been published; and to judge from the portions we have read, contains much sensible and useful application of the sacred narrative.

Mr. Lathbury's State of Popery and Jesuitism in England, forms a useful volume of reference for the series of historical events, connected with the subject, since the Reformation; but we fear we must say we agree in opinion with scarce a page of it.

We are glad to observe, that Mr. Knox's Treatises on the Sacrament are published (Duncan) in one small volume. So original a thinker as Mr. Knox, and with such deficient opportunities of instruction in the full "deposition" of faith, cannot of course be unreservedly recommended. But we believe this highly-gifted and religious man to be an instrument (if it is right so to speak) in the hands of Providence, of extensive good in the Church at this moment; and we are sure that, even granting he might mislead if followed exclusively, he will be found to impart most valuable information, and to suggest many deep, important, and practical views on a variety of subjects.

We invite attention to an Abridgment, just published, of Bishop Hall's "Episcopacy by Divine Right asserted" (Hatchard). The Bishop's name stands so high with a large portion of the religious public, and is so respected by all, that the republication of this Treatise promises to be very useful at this moment.

Another very important publication is that of Leslie's Case of the Regale and Pontificate (Leslie, Great Queen Street). All persons who have their minds to make up on the subject of Church and State, should study this celebrated work of one of the clearest and most powerful of our Divines.

It is encouraging to witness so many reprints of specimens of our standard theological and devotional works. A third reprint, which needs no notice of ours to recommend it, is Bishop Cosin's Devotions for the Hours of Prayer. It both indicates and, we trust, will further the growth of a devotional temper among us.

And another valuable reprint is a small Tract of the beginning of the last century, called Pietas Londinensis (Burns); from which it appears that at that time there were daily prayers in no fewer than seventy-one London churches and chapels.

In connection with this last subject may be mentioned a most cheering occurrence, the re-opening of Lincoln's-Inn Chapel for daily service; on occasion of which an excellent Sermon, since published, was preached by the Rev. R. W. Browne, Assistant Preacher and Classical Professor in King's College, which deserves attention, both from its contents and the reputation of its author.

Mr. Irons, a young clergyman of great promise, has published a second series of Parochial Lectures, which, besides their intrinsic excellence, exhibits an additional instance how mistaken

the common idea is, that the recent spread of Church doctrines is connected with any one place or set of persons, instead of being, as it is, *the necessary effect of increased theological reading*. In the case of the clergy this effect *must* follow, if they are honest, or a necessity of retiring from their existing engagements. Mr. Irons observes, in his Preface, that his religious views, which are in accordance with those of the first ages, were formed quite independently of those sources to which the present improved tone concerning Church doctrine is commonly ascribed.

Mr. Coxe, of St. James's, has published an impressive Charity Sermon, under the title of "The Lowly Station dignified." Nothing can convey more strikingly the low standard of religious knowledge and principle in the Metropolis, than to find from the author's preface that so unexceptionable a composition has been accused of being too political and too high Church.

We are in expectation of two interesting works by Mr. Wigram, "The Schoolmaster's Manual," which is a collection of Practical Hints for the information of National Schoolmasters; and "Occasional Papers," on the same subject. The intimate knowledge of his subject, which Mr. Wigram's situation as Secretary to the National Society gives him, will add great weight to his opinion.

Dr. Hook, of Leeds, has published a carefully considered Tract on the Athanasian Creed: in which he has shown the coincidence between it and Scripture on the doctrines which it expounds. A controversy has arisen in his neighbourhood about some of those points of doctrine which are now so generally under discussion. The Rev. Miles Jackson opened the controversy with an attack on Dr. Hook, on the ground that persons in Oxford had written Tracts which Mr. Jackson considered Popish; and which Dr. Hook approved, so far as he considered them not Popish but Anglican. In an unassuming and effective Pamphlet Mr. Ward, of Leeds, has shown that the several propositions, gathered from the Tracts by Mr. Jackson, in favour of baptismal regeneration, &c. &c., are all held by Bishop Jeremy Taylor, whom Mr. Jackson had spoken of as "a very Shakspeare in divinity," an authority "to which it would be fatal to stand conspicuously opposed." Mr. Poole has published a learned answer to the same charges, in which he clears up the misrepresentations and sophistry on which such statements are commonly based. From the same place has appeared an Appeal on the Doctrines of Sacramental Efficacy, Apostolical Succession, and Church and State, by a Dissenting Minister named Ely. Of him we know nothing; but we are bound to state that he writes in a subdued and thoughtful spirit (though, of course, with most erroneous views of the Gospel), and far surpasses any pamphlet on the same side which has proceeded from Churchmen.

We have to thank Mr. Pratt, of Cruden, for Three excellent Sermons on Scottish Episcopacy. It being very important to circulate information in England concerning our deeply injured sister Church, we are glad to be able to refer our readers to any publications, like the present, which are devoted to that object. Mr. Ramsay has published his Sermon preached at the consecration of the Bishop of Glasgow and the Bishop (assistant) of Brechin. It is one of those testimonies to the doctrine of the divine origin and privileges of the Church, which are now happily so common.

Several interesting publications have reached us from Burlington (New Jersey). Bishop Doane's eloquent Sermon at the Ordination of Mr. Wolff; the Journal of the Fifty-fourth Annual Convention of the Church over which he presides; and Translations of the Epistles of Clement, Ignatius, and Polycarp.

The importance of the Christian Knowledge Society makes it necessary to attend to their proceedings in proportion as it is painful to do so; for this reason, we subjoin the following short account of what has taken place in the last several monthly meetings. A few months ago Mr. Clarke brought forward a motion, the purport of which was to expunge from the list all the tracts which had been suffered to go out of print within a certain period. The feeling of the meeting was strongly

against this resolution; when Dr. Russell moved, as an amendment, "that all tracts which at any time shall have been out of print for *five* years shall be considered as no longer on the list." This was carried.

A more injurious regulation cannot well be conceived, since it obviously tends to destroy the *permanency* of the character of the tracts; *e.g.* if any subject should not excite attention for a few years, and the tracts relating to it go out of print, the lovers of old opinions will be placed under the disadvantage of having to get new tracts on the list, instead of having merely to revive the old ones already there. There would be no hope in this day of getting on the list a tract entitled "*The Christian Sacrifice*;" Nelson's, to wit.

At the April meeting, Dr. Spry brought forward a resolution to the effect that it shall not be lawful for any member to furnish to any newspaper a report of the discussions which took place at the Board. An amendment was moved by Mr. Tyler, extending the prohibition to all periodical publications. This was carried in a very large meeting, about two-thirds of the members present supporting it.

At the meeting in May, a Report from the Standing Committee was taken into consideration; the purport of which was to recommend "that the Tract Committee should be empowered, with the approbation of the Episcopal Referees, to place Books and Tracts on the Society's Catalogue." The object of this resolution was to get rid of the unseemliness of taking a ballot in the general meeting on the admission of tracts, which had already received the sanction of the five Bishops. The recommendation of the Standing Committee was adopted, 210 members voting in its favour, and 65 against it.

Notwithstanding the resolution passed in May, the "Record" newspaper continued to report the discussions; this being noticed at the meeting, Mr. Gordon, on June 5th, moved "that the resolution entered upon the minutes of the April meeting in regard to the non-publication of reprints of any discussions which take place at the meeting of this board is altogether null and void."

Mr. Gordon's resolution was discussed and negatived, by a majority of about 2 to 1.

In the course of these meetings much miserable wrangling, much boisterousness and unseemly confusion occurred: such exhibitions are, unhappily, no novelty now in the Society; but what is a novelty, and demands serious notice, is the introduction of the principle of parliamentary divisions. It was once the aim of the Society to pass every thing without division at all, even by showing of hands. Then division was only called for when the decision was doubtful; but now it is called for the purpose of showing *the strength of parties*, an object altogether inconsistent with the character of such a meeting.

Notices of Books

[*British Critic*, October 1838.]

MR. JACOBSON'S Edition of the Epistles of St. Clement, St. Ignatius, and St. Polycarp, lately published, we suppose, to be the commencement of an undertaking on the part of the Oxford press, which was reported to be in agitation some years since, of editing a number of the works of the Fathers. The University is fortunate indeed, if the editions which follow are executed with one half the pains and critical skill which Mr. Jacobson has evidently taken with this.

Dr. Pusey's Edition of the Original Text of St. Austin's Confessions is just published, as well as his Translation of the same Work, and the Translation of St. Cyril's Catechetical Lectures. Much pains seem to have been bestowed upon all of them. A most elaborate and instructive account of the Manichæan tenets is added to the Translation of the Confessions. Dr. Pusey's arduous work

having now at length commenced, we trust that no obstacles will lie in the way of its regular progress.

We are indebted to Mr. Dowling for one of the most important works to a theological student which has appeared for a long time, "An Introduction to the Critical Study of Ecclesiastical History" (Rivingtons.) It consists of the list of historians of the Church down to the present day, and an Essay upon the sources of Ecclesiastical History generally. The work is the more important, as we cannot but hope we see in it the augury of some more extended and methodical attention to this great subject, than has ever been paid it in our Reformed Church. Mr. Dowling at least has begun at the foundation, and that alone is an omen of a superstructure.

Mr. Dowling's work commenced in the pages of the British Magazine; a publication which, more than any of the day, has been successful in bringing churchmen together, making them feel confidence in each other, and giving occasion to works some of which at least would not otherwise have been written. Dr. M'Caul's instructive Sketches of Judaism and the Jews, which has just been published in a separate form, is another instance of the last mentioned service.

A series has commenced of most interesting reprints from the works of some divines of the 16th century, under the title of "Tracts of the Anglican Fathers." Those which we have seen are "Cranmer's Sermons on Holy Baptism;" on "the Apostolical Succession and the power of the Keys;" on the "Blessed Sacrament of the Altar;" and on "the Gifts of the Holy Ghost in the Holy Catholic Church." If the series continues as it has begun, it will exercise an important influence on the theological points at present in controversy.

Mr. Parkinson's instructive Hulsean Lectures (Rivingtons) have a value even beyond their intrinsic worth, as indicating and promoting the advancement of ethical studies at Cambridge. They are intended to show that the doctrines of the Gospel are but the great conclusions to which the phenomena of this world tend; "that their specific defects are exactly such as meet with their specific remedies in the very revelation which we possess; that they stop short just where revelation begins; and that it appears by the deficiency on the one side being exactly met by the sufficiency on the other, that they each form part of one harmonious plan, and were originally designed by the artificer of that plan to be united together for the great end of furthering the moral advancement of man." Accordingly he brings the testimony of ethical philosophy, of the intellectual powers, of the human body, of man as related to external things, to his fellow men, and to himself. It is curious, as a coincidence, that the same subject has lately, as our pages have shown, been discussed, independently of Mr. Parkinson, by Mr. Woodgate and Mr. Oakeley. The subject is most important.

A third edition has appeared of Mr. Miller's well known Bampton Lectures.

Mr. Faber has published an Inquiry into the History and Theology of the ancient Vallenses and Albigenses, (Seeley and Burnside,) which is conducted, as might be expected, with the research and vigour which are the usual characteristics of his works.

Mr. Townsend, the Master (we believe is his title) of the Peculiar of Allerton, has published a charge, which, were we his enemies, we should delight in seeing run to the "fifth thousand." It is written *against* speaking with reserve to the world at large on the more sacred subjects of religion! The style is as extraordinary as the matter. In any one else it would be pompous. It is not so in Mr. Townsend. It is his own style.

Mr. Vernon Harcourt's Doctrine of the Deluge (Longman) is a work of much ingenuity in its design, and most elaborate research in its execution. Its object is to vindicate the Scripture account "from the doubts which have recently been cast upon it by geological speculations;" and he does so, by setting out to show that the Noachical deluge was the type of the doctrines of "expiation of past

guilt" and "regeneration," that it is attested by "evidences impressed not upon the surface of the earth, but upon the memory of its inhabitants, and derived from their traditions, their superstitions, their monuments, and their usages," and that "the doctrine which it inculcated was kept alive obscurely in various parts of the world, till it was finally enlisted in the service of true religion, and obtained a permanent place in the institutions of Christianity, and was consigned to holier purposes and endowed with a more operative practice and exalted to the dignity of a Sacrament." In a word, he proves the fact and doctrine to come under the "quod semper, quod ubique, quod ab omnibus." "Ever since," he says, "the family of Noah issued forth into the air and light of a new life, and stepped once more upon the renovated earth now cleansed from its former guiltiness by the waters of the deluge, the providence of God had so overruled the superstition thence arising, that a notion of some mystical regeneration by water and expiation of sin had been kept alive among all the nations, with whose history we are well acquainted; and thus the world was prepared to receive that doctrine of a moral regeneration by baptism and forgiveness of sins, which is the commencement of a new life to every Christian." There is an important chapter at the end, on the view of the early Church concerning the regenerative power of baptism, in which Mr. Harcourt nobly upholds our Church's doctrine and the authority of the Fathers against the schools of the 16th century. "The nearer," he says, "we ascend to the fountain head, the purer will the waters flow; the three first centuries therefore after the Apostles were more likely to know in what sense the Apostles themselves used a theological term, *than any three centuries that have since elapsed*. I do not say that they are free from error, or that any uninspired writers are absolutely safe authorities for doctrine: but *they are unexceptionable witnesses to a mere matter of fact*; and in the present instance the fact with which we have to do is this: were the first converts to Christianity in the habit of considering baptism equivalent to regeneration, and necessarily attended with some spiritual grace, or were they not?" What can be desired clearer or more sensible than this? Mr. Harcourt considers Antiquity to supply the *comment* on the text of Scripture.

Dr. Shuttleworth has taken the opposite side, in a little work (Rivingtons) either on "Not Tradition but Scripture," or on "Not Tradition but Revelation," we are not certain which; for the title-page promises the one, and the body of the work undertakes the other. The advertisements have given both. This, we consider, will perplex editors some centuries hence. We hope we are not uncandid to Dr. Shuttleworth, when we say, that this ambiguity at starting is no unfair symbol of the whole production. For instance, he says, that "the great leading principle of Protestantism" is "the entire *sufficiency* of Scripture, independently of tradition, as a rule of faith and doctrine." Sufficiency for *what*? teaching or proving? for the persons Dr. Shuttleworth writes against do not dispute the proposition as he words it. However, in spite of this defect, we rejoice to say, what no one could ever doubt in a work of Dr. Shuttleworth's, that, unlike some other controversialists, who shall be nameless, he uses much courtesy of language towards his opponents. He even extends it to the ancients. He calls St. Irenæus, for instance, "the good Father," "this good and singleminded man," and "with more honest simplicity than soundness of sense or accuracy of logic" in his arguments. We wish, in turn, to be as courteous to Dr. Shuttleworth. Mr. Holden (Rivingtons) has written a work on the same subject, which we prefer. We do not agree with him, but he sees the difficulties of the subject. All is plain and easy to Dr. Shuttleworth.

The Bishop of Oxford has just published his Charge, which will be read with much interest. The most remarkable part of it is the energetic protest which it enters against the Board of Ecclesiastical Commissioners, "a power," his Lordship says, "as irresponsible as it is gigantic, an imperium in imperio, which, before long, must supersede all other authority in the Church, and whose decrees

are issued in such a manner as to render expostulation and remonstrance unavailing." The Charge is also remarkable as giving judgment upon the Tracts for the Times. This is a memorable precedent, and shows what lies before us. *The Church is returning her judicial power*. We only wish that *other parties* may defer to her as frankly as would, we feel assured, the writers of the above-mentioned Tracts were there a call made on them.

Sermons by the late Rev. John Marriott (Hatchard) are a collection of earnest, serious, practical Discourses, made still more impressive by the circumstances of their publication. They are especially valuable at this moment, as showing that religious views lately put forward, which many persons would represent to be an innovation on received doctrine, are not only to be found in our divines of the seventeenth century, but even in the popular sermons of divines of the generation immediately before us. We direct attention to the sermon on the Danger of Schism.

Mr. Butt has lately published a volume of Sermons, occasioned, as he tells us in the Preface, by Mr. Keble having said that the view of Gospel Truth given by Mr. Butt, in his Strictures upon Mr. Keble's Visitation Sermon, was such as might "be literally accepted by an Arian or a Sabellian." We do not believe that Mr. Keble had any intention of saying that Mr. Butt's views were Arian or Sabellian; far from it; but that the theory he was in his Pamphlet advocating against Mr. Keble, had actually involved him in the necessity of so attenuating his statement of fundamental truth, that an Arian or Sabellian might agree with that particular statement, as far as it went. And so far we must say we agree with Mr. Keble; but we should be sorry to seem to say more, against so highly respectable a clergyman. Mr. Butt ought, we think, to have quoted Mr. Keble's words. They are as follows:—"May it not be taken as an indication of the *tendency* [sic] of the theory, that the list of fundamentals, offered in exemplification of it, includes no express affirmation of the doctrine just mentioned? [that of the Holy Trinity.] Is it not a test which might be accepted, as far as the letter of it goes, by an Arian or Sabellian? And this consideration is more serious, *the more entirely we are convinced of the orthodoxy and judgment of the person drawing up such a confession*. So much the stronger does the argument become, &c."—*Postscript*, p. 47.

Plain Parochial Sermons, by Rev Daniel Parsons, (Rivingtons,) are written on a very sound view of doctrine, and in an easy popular style. There is, however, a want of maturity, or we might even say, in a certain sense, of reality, which perhaps is unavoidable in the writings of a young man, as the author seems to be. It is encouraging, however, to find the younger clergy speaking in the tone of Mr. Parsons.

Single Sermons, published as they are commonly at the request of bishops and clergy, or of numbers of clergy, are perhaps as good a test as can be of the feelings uppermost in the mind of the clergy, or what in mathematical language may be called their *differentia* at the time. Those which we have fallen in with give a most satisfactory result, as their titles will show; and we name some of them as well for that reason as for their intrinsic excellence. Such are Mr. Vogan's Sermon, "The Doctrine of the Apostolical Succession developed and proved;" Mr. Fulford's Assize Sermon, "The Interpretation of Law and the Rule of Faith;" Mr. Woodhouse's, on "that Branch of the Holy Catholic and Apostolic Church to which we belong;" and Mr. Maurice's, on "The Responsibilities of Medical Students."

We must draw especial attention to a learned sermon of Mr. Manning's, at Chichester, on the Rule of Faith, which contains a great deal of matter and much useful theological information; and a beautiful sermon of Mr. Christie's, at Gloucester.

Mr. Baxter's Sermon, on Scripture Knowledge the Source of National Stability, is excellently principled, as far as its subject leads it to state principles.

"Laud and Leighton," a sermon by Mr. Mortimer, is written in an excellent spirit. He considers that there are two schools in our Church, of which those two archbishops are the respective representatives. Are there then no Kenns and Hammonds on the side of Laud? Is all the meekness gone off with Leighton to the Record, Christian Observer, the Dublin Statesman, and Mr. Townsend?

But of all the single sermons during the last quarter none is to be compared in importance with Dr. Hook's Sermon before the Queen, which, having since delivering gone through so many editions that we have left off counting them, is the most remarkable instance in our time of a religious protest made to high and low, rich and poor. And the plainness and clearness of its statements make it just the sort of composition which should have such a destiny.

Mr. Wilberforce's Essay on the Parochial System (Rivingtons) gained the premium of the Christian Influence Society. Little as we like the principle of that Society, we feel much satisfaction in finding it recognizing and approving the sentiments put forward in this little work. It is the plain, serious, clear, and most impressive appeal of a sound Churchman to Englishmen to exert themselves for the increase of the Parochial System up to the present state of our population. Under the circumstances of its publication, we suppose it will be largely circulated, else we should recommend it to the attention of the reader.

Would this same Society had done as well in the prizes awarded to another subject! There is a passage in one of them, which, though not uncommon in this day, is rank Apollinarianism, and gives sad and anxious warning of the (unconscious) growth of heresy among us. The author says, "*Deity* dying in the flesh as the commutation for man's eternal punishment." In like manner the author of Essays on the Church, in a new edition of his work, avows Nestorianism, and, we are sorry to say, involves in his implicit heresy others besides himself. "The Christian Knowledge Society," he says, "has latterly erased from one of its publications the phrase 'the Mother of God,' rightly judging it to be Popish." It is easy plausibly to account for such mistakes in the individual instances, but, we may depend on it, there is a more serious leaven at work at bottom.

We welcome with much satisfaction a reprint of Wogan on the Proper Lessons, (Cowie,) a work of a very primitive cast, and full of instructive matter. It is truly a Church of England book. We think our readers will not be sorry to have their attention called to it.

"Plain Conversations concerning the Church of England" is a series of dialogues between a clergyman and one of his farmers, on the Church contrasted with Romanism and Dissent. It is written on the soundest principles and with a good deal of careful research, and is well adapted to give instruction on the important subject it handles.

An unpretending volume of poems has made its appearance, consisting of "Translations from the Lyric Poets of Germany," by Mr. Macray, (Black and Armstrong). They show a good deal of poetical taste, and a power of easy versification.

No. LXXXIII. of Tracts for the Times has appeared under the title of "Advent Sermons on Antichrist."

A pleasing little book has just appeared, called "A Voice from the Tomb" (Longman). It is a sort of lament over the existing state of things; it abounds in beautiful Catholic sentiments, and will interest a great many persons.

A "Companion to the Book of Common Prayer" (Low) is a useful analysis of its contents, with a view of adapting it to private or social devotion.

An instructive Pamphlet written by a Dissenter has reached a second edition, called "What! and who says it?" (Ward). It is to show the coincidence of judgment about the Anglican Church, between Mr. Binney, who thinks that it has destroyed more souls than it has saved, and Dr. Chalmers, &c.

&c.

We are very sorry to have to allude again to Dr. Hampden, but the present letter, addressed to a contemporary Magazine, as bearing upon the theological views of the late Mr. Davison, claims a place in our pages.

“TO THE EDITOR OF THE CHRISTIAN REMEMBRANCER

“SIR,—I presume to trouble you in consequence of a paragraph in a published letter from Dr. Hampden, the Regius Professor of Divinity in Oxford, to his Grace the Archbishop of Canterbury, in which Dr. Hampden states that ‘the late Mr. Davison, the highly gifted and excellent author of the “Discourses on Prophecy,” had both read and expressly approved his Bampton Lectures.’

“I have the best reason for believing that Dr. Hampden is mistaken in his impression upon the subject. I was never absent from Mr. Davison but for one short interval after the period of the publication of those Lectures, and am well satisfied they were not read by him. Mr. Davison never mentioned the work to me, with approbation or otherwise: and I possess the presentation copy, received in August, 1833, which was *uncut* at the time of Mr. Davison’s removal from me, with the exception of *two leaves*; and it remained so till the year 1836, when it was seen by several friends in its unopened state.

“I have thought it hard upon me, and upon the friends of Mr. Davison, that his name should, at a distant period, be implicated in the controversy arising out of these Lectures; and under the circumstances, I felt it to be due to his memory to ask of Dr. Hampden his authority for the assertion contained in the letter to the Archbishop; but to my surprise and mortification, I have had from him a *positive and final refusal*. I am therefore obliged to take the only means within my reach of relieving Mr. Davison from the responsibilities in which Dr. Hampden has involved his name.

“I shall feel obliged to you to give this letter a place in your CHRISTIAN REMEMBRANCER for the following month.

“I have the honour to be, Sir, your very obedient humble servant,

“MARY DAVISON.”

“College Green, Worcester, 7th August, 1838.”

We think it may interest the reader to have a few remarks set before him on the State of Theological Literature at this time in Germany. If we may judge by the space which it occupies in their periodical publications, the discussion caused by Dr. Strauss’s late work still excites great interest in that country. Most of our readers are probably aware that this work consists of a critical examination of our Saviour’s life, which ends in his reducing those events which he considers to be based on historical truth to a most meagre outline, and treating as mythical and legendary all those sacred facts on which are built the faith and hope of a Christian. We do not propose to put either ourselves or others to pain, by entering into the nature of Dr. Strauss’s theory in detail, but only to make two or three remarks on the general subject, and on the mode in which the controversy is being carried on.

If his views were a mere individual extravagance, they might well be left unnoticed, but it seems to be allowed by many of his countrymen, that they are symptomatic of the tendency of their modern theology, and do but embody its inevitable results. To us it certainly appears that the germ of Dr. Strauss’s work lay in such productions as Schleiermacher’s essay on the Gospel of St. Luke, only he has had the boldness to extend to the whole history those principles which had before been applied to its outset. And we think we can trace a half-consciousness of this in the minds of that section of German writers who seem to have felt themselves more especially called upon to meet the work in question, and who have done so the most elaborately.

In one of a series of Polemical Tracts, which Dr. Strauss has begun in defence of his work, he divides his opponents into three classes; —the Pietists, or those who believe the Scriptures to be divinely inspired, and that their truth must be received in faith, not submitted to criticism; the pure Rationalists; and an intermediate School, who, proceeding on a supernatural basis, give a large license to criticism in details. As regards their opinion of the matter before us, the first and second classes are easily dismissed. The former considers that the truth of the sacred volume approves itself at once to the spiritual mind, and that not to accept it unreservedly is a moral transgression, to be met by reproof rather than argument. The latter hail all speculation whatever as the only mode whereby truth, hitherto undiscovered, can be evolved. But the third class, which forms, we apprehend, the chief portion of the German learned world, and may not unfairly be taken as the representative of the tone of their Theology, have not so compendious a mode of dealing with the subject. They have given up the possibility of defending every thing in Scripture as literally and historically true; they have admitted the *mythical* principle of interpretation; so that they are obliged to go into the subject, and vindicate each event, which they consider as real, from the grasp of this tide, the floodgates of which they have themselves set open, and which they now find advancing upon them. Whether they will succeed in this attempt; whether they will be able to show that the mythical principle may be admitted, yet the fundamentals of the Gospel-history maintained in their integrity,—that many of the Old Testament miracles, and some of the New, may be given up without detriment to the remainder, is still sub judice. Meanwhile, what a strange and saddening thought it is, that in a neighbouring country the science, which so intimately concerns us, should be in so undetermined a state that the professors of it should feel themselves obliged, on the appearance of every new theory, to lay aside their ordinary studies, and to hasten to its examination; that there should be nothing placed out of the reach of discussion, no question which may not be reopened and investigated! What an impediment it must be to the acquisition of learning, what a constant source of labour and anxiety to the disputants, and of excitement and instability to all! And from this thought the mind naturally proceeds to another. Must there not be something radically wrong in a system which affords scope for such extravagances? and what (over and above differences of national character and the like) is our own safeguard against such evils? And when we consider that the fundamental difference between us appears to lie in this—that whereas they contemplate the Bible as a self-dependant and isolated fact, it has been placed in our hands with an accompanying guarantee and testimony of its truth, and its great outlines have been arranged, defined, and fixed for us in the creeds and services of the Church. And if this be so, we cannot but feel apprehension that without this safeguard, that elaborate structure of external and internal evidences, which was raised with such care in the last century, would avail but little against the assaults of scepticism; that whether they furnish in their result proofs intellectually conclusive or no, they would never lead to practical conviction. This consideration should make us thankful for the blessings we of this country enjoy in the Apostolical Church; and we would suggest to those, who, yielding to none in their devotion to the Sacred Scriptures, nay, making such devotion their peculiar watch-word, are disposed to look with jealousy on the upholders of what has been well called “Transmissive Religion,”—whether these last are not in fact fighting their battle for them, only on ground more advantageous than they could themselves occupy? What we mean is, that the spirit which in Germany attacks and questions the authority of Scripture and the credibility of its contents, is one and the same with that which at home impugns the authority of Catholic antiquity, and rejects the doctrines of which it is the witness. And further, that the only *solid and convincing* arguments for the former, have equal force and applicability to the latter; and could they

be overthrown in this latter case, and the doctrines which rest upon them discredited, it would only be a signal for a similar attack upon the canon and contents of Scripture itself.

Notices of Books

[*British Critic*, January 1839.]

DR. CRAMER has given to the theological world a new Catena on the Acts of the Apostles from MSS. Existing in Oxford and Paris. Chrysostom is the principle author used in it; after him, Cyril, Didymus, Ammonius, and Severus.

Jewell's celebrated "*Apologia Ecclesiæ Anglicanæ*" has been republished, (Rivingtons); as has also, Bertram's or Ratramn's Book "*de Corpore et Sanguine Domini*," with a translation, and Ælfric's "*Homily*," (Parker, Oxford.) This book, it is scarcely necessary to say, is a remarkable historical confutation of the Roman doctrine of Transubstantiation, though, as being controversial, it is of course *cauté legendum*.

Dr. Neander's "*Life of St. Chrysostom*," translated by Rev. J. C. Stapleton (Seeley & Burnside,) is the very learned work of an eclectic Christian. The English reader will profit by his learning without being induced probably to embrace his peculiarities.

The publication of the original of St. Cyril's "*Catechetical Lectures*" is, we we understand, delayed under the hope of obtaining some important collations of the text from Rome as well as Oxford. It is in contemplation to collect sums with a view of defraying the expenses of foreign collations.

It is with pleasure we announce the republication of Dr. Brett's Work on "*the Ancient and other Liturgies*," (Rivingtons,) which may be recommended to all who need information on the sacred subject of which it treats. Another useful little work of the same author has been published at Oxford (Talboys,) "*The Honour of the Christian Priesthood*."

Mr. Manning has published an Appendix to his Sermon on the Rule of Faith, in which he goes more into the details of objections urged against the Catholic view of it, than any one who has taken part in the controversy. It is a work of considerable research, much independence of thought, and great promise of usefulness.

Dr. Hawkins has published two admirable Sermons, (Fellowes,) on very distinct subjects; the one is an almost parochial sermon preached in aid of the two Societies; the other was preached before the University of Oxford, and on "*The Duty of Private Judgment*."

Dr. Pusey has published two Sermons in aid of the Society for the Propagation of the Gospel, (Rivingtons,) called "*The Church, the Converter of the Heathen*." Dr. Pusey cannot touch any subject without exhausting it. The present contain a vast mass of information on this subject, and doubtless have been, and will be, much consulted by clergymen who, in obedience to the Queen's letter, have to bring it at this time before their parishioners.

Mr. Oakeley has published a Sermon on the same subject. (Parker: Oxford) Why does a writer, whose style is so attractive, and matter so sound, stint us with single sermons?

A Funeral Sermon preached at Calcutta, by Krishna Mohana Banerjee, an Anglican clergyman, on Baboo Mohesh Chunder Ghose, a superintendent of the Church Missionary Schools, in the same place, (Rivingtons, Seeley, and Nisbet,) gives rise to a number of pleasurable and serious reflections. The unity of that faith and temper which the One Lord vouchsafes through the One Church, is what most obviously suggests itself. We are surprised too to find a Sermon of a recently converted native so free from even the phraseology of Ultra-Protestantism. How is it? do converted heathens bring with them a more healthy taste and robuster appetite which refuses to feed upon air?

We have a satisfaction in noticing two Sermons on the death of the late Bishop of Moray, (a name which will be long remembered, in the Scottish Church especially,) by the Rev. W. C. A. Maclaurin, M.A., and the Rev. Charles Pressley, A.M.

Sermons by the Rev. T. T. Haverfield, B.D., 2 vols., (Straker,) have a good practical aim, and contain right views on the Sacraments. Some of the doctrinal ones however are scarcely clear.

Mr. Hutchinson's "Plain Discourses (adapted for family reading) on the Catechism and Book of Common Prayer," (Hayward and Moore,) are sound, unpretending sermons. They give right views of the Church and Sacraments, and are evidently the productions of a serious mind.

Mr. Cameron's "Parochial Sermons," (Seeley & Burnside,) contain views superior to those of most modern preachers; but still have some of the defects of our popular theology.

Mr. Kilvert's Sermons (Taylor and Walton,) are written in a pleasing easy style, which strikingly contrasts with that which preachers commonly think they must adopt, in order to prove themselves what preachers should be.

Mr. Bramston's excellent Sermon on "the Church and Ministry" (Hatchards,) is calculated to instruct and raise the views of persons who are in doubt or ignorance about the subject. We wish he was somewhat more definite in his language about the Sacraments: but it is evident that his meaning is right, even when his words are not well chosen.

"Condensed Discourses, or Pulpit Helps" (Hodson,) are written by "a Minister," but whether of, what the Author calls "the Establishment," or of Dissent, is more than we can say. We must be content to know that he has been "prompted by motives as pure as" many others, and determined by "sudden, unexpected and disastrous circumstances," "to seek repose and relief in revising for the press some of these discourses which it had been his delight and privilege to deliver from the pulpit," and which "were not heard in vain." Can self-complacency go further?

"A Treatise on the Power, Wisdom, and Goodness of God, as displayed in the Animal Creation," by C M. Burnett, Esq. (Burns,) contains a great deal of information respecting the different physical theories of the day; together with the author's own views and decisions on them. Mr. Burnett reasons well and soundly, and we are glad to add reverentially. On the subject of geology, e.g. he is opposed to that rude handling of the sacred text, which is so common amongst us. Our men of science evidently *like* bringing their views into collision with Scripture. They like putting themselves in the *attitude* of unbelief; though at the same time they will have us think that they are not opposing Scripture; Scripture not having been written with a view to science. Mr. Burnett, on the contrary, is of opinion, that many physical subjects "have too close a connexion with God's *moral government*, to admit of being discussed with a freedom wholly regardless of revelation." This observation, we think, would apply in an especial way to the Mosaic account of the common origin of mankind, which some have ventured to set aside. If it be true that we are to consider the natural world typical of the revealed, nothing evidently can be more hazardous than this meddling with the Scripture account of the former.

"Historical Sketch of the Reformation in Poland," by Count Valerian Krasinski, (Murray,) is a work of considerable pains, and its author states facts sometimes against the Polish Reformers. But as a whole it has all the common faults of Protestant histories of the Reformation.

An Enquiry has been published respecting "Love, as one of the Divine Attributes. By Thomas Gisborne, M.A." (Cadell.) We are really sorry to find this writer taking up such a subject. With respect to the book itself, the best we can say of it is, that though there are some good parts, it makes but an unsound and indifferent whole. The author evidently avoids acknowledging the justice of God, as an independent attribute co-existing with Love; and this leads him to some unjustifiable

statements, towards the end of the work, on a very sacred doctrine.

"Portrait of an English Churchman," by the Rev. W. Gresley, M.A. (Rivingtons,) is a spiritedly written book, and reads pleasantly, and we hope will be read a good deal, as it is calculated to promote sound views on Church subjects. Mr. Gresley very properly distinguishes between Churchmen and Conservatives; and makes his hero a union of the two. We wish he did not lean so much to Establishmentism.

"Lives of Sacred Poets," by Robert Aris Willmott, Esq. (J. W. Parker,) are nicely written volumes, and contain a good deal of general information on literature and poetry; which is sometimes indeed introduced out of place, and so as to interfere with the particular life in hand. The author has evidently good views, but is rather afraid of bringing them into collision with the subjects of his biographies.

"Cornelius, the Centurion." From the German of F. A. Krummacher, D.D. This book has far too much of the character of a certain German school in it to please us. We feel afraid when we see imaginative and sentimental views of religion brought out, without any intermixture of severity. But this is too large a subject to enter into here.

Mr. Pauli's "Analecta Hebraica: with Critical Notes and Tables of Paradigms of the Conjugations of the Regular and Irregular Verbs," (Parker, Oxford,) is calculated to be very useful in progressively impressing upon learners the several portions of Hebrew Grammar. The grammatical observations are intended as a critical correction and supplement to the Grammars of Philipps, Lee, and Stuart; they appear to contain much useful matter of fact, with some unsound theory. The Rabbinical criticism, &c., which is plentifully interspersed appears generally of a sound and interesting character, though belonging (we think) to a higher order of students than those who commonly use Analecta: it adds however to the value of the whole;—which is further increased by a set of verbal tables, which really appears the most comprehensive we have seen, and will no doubt be of great use to Hebraists in general.

"Nordheimer's Hebrew Grammar," (Wiley and Putnam,) contains a good deal of curious philological matter.

The author of the Cathedral has published another Volume of Poems, called "Thoughts in Past Years." (Parker, Oxford.) Those who enjoy the wild and spontaneous in poetry may even prefer parts in the present volume to any of the author's former Poems; we would mention particularly "Spring and Autumn," p. 279, and the lines which begin "O Vanity," p. 289, though it is not fair to particularize whereon two readers will pitch upon the same instances.

"Passages from the Poets," (Cowie,) is a selection made from their works with great diligence, great taste, and great success. It is a pleasant contrast to undertakings of the same kind commonly met with, which are conducted no governing principles, and mistake extravagance for variety, and want of nature for refinement.

Mr. Boone's pamphlet on "The Educational Economy of England, Part I," (J. W. Parker), pleases us a good deal better where he attacks the plans of others than where he proposes his own. Chapters 3 and 4 on the Province of the State, contain some good arguments, forcibly, nay newly put against the State and centralizing Systems of Education. "If the State," he says, "should teach the whole population, its system, —it seems strange, but is true, to say, —would of necessity be narrow and confined. The narrowness of the plan in one way must bear a direct proportion to its extent in the other. It cannot include both all recipients and all studies. *If it would be universal as to those whom it teaches, it must be partial as to that which is taught.* And "this unphilosophical narrowness of instruction," he proves will not be confined to religion only, but extend to education *in general*.

"The very essence of teaching and training is to implant certain notions and dispositions, and to preclude the implantation or effect the extirpation of others. *So far, therefore, as the State teaches and trains, it tends to fix the national sentiments in one particular mould.*" We quite agree with Mr. Boone in these remarks; but when he proposes "the plan of the State affording assistance to all parties and denominations, in a certain determinate proportion," as a measure for the Church, under present circumstances, to "acquiesce" in, we can do, and need do, no more than express our dissent from him. We regard the question as one of principle, on which the Church cannot "acquiesce" in any thing which she thinks really and in itself objectionable.

"The Rev. G. A. Jacob's Letter to Sir Robert Peel, upon National Education on a Christian basis," recommends a system which should be "in its *teaching* conformed to the formularies of the Established Church—in its *tenets and regulations*, opposed to no sect or party." We have hardly a clear idea of what Mr. Jacob means. The Dean of Norwich has published a sound sermon on the same subject.

The Bishop of Exeter's Speech on the Church Discipline Bill has been published. (Painter.) It contains the following memorable passage: "Over the clergyman's civil state he had no power, but he had power over him in a spiritual point of view; and (said the Right Reverend Prelate) before his Master and my Master, I will remind this erring clergyman of his folly or his vice. I will reprimand him for it. If he will not obey the remonstrance, I shall proceed to that sentence, which this bill tells me I shall not pass: *I shall proceed to excommunicate him.* Then if this be done, your lordships in parliament may pass a bill of pains and penalties against me—you may deprive me of the seat which I now hold (but of which I shall never make myself unworthy) —you may rob me of my see—you may take from me my robes—but my integrity to heaven I shall maintain inviolate."—pp. 7, 8.

"A Letter to George Palmer, Esq., M.P., on the dangerous Principles and Tendency of the Tithe Act," (Rivingtons,) takes the double ground, first of common justice and expediency, and secondly of religion. The author is not ashamed to argue for the divine right of tithes; but first he ably exposes the defects of the present bill, considering it only as a political measure. It is a very interesting and well-written pamphlet, both in point of matter and of style.

"The Voice of the Church," (Newcastle,) is a clever overthrow of a pamphlet almost too free-thinking and profane to deserve it.

"A Clergyman of South Wilts," has written anonymously a "Dissection of the Queries" of Lord John Russell, on the amount of Religious Instruction and Education, (Rivingtons,) with so much cutting force and such felicity of exposure, that it is a thousand pities he has not operated on a more public stage.

All that need be said of "Millenarianism Unscriptural," (Crofts,) is that the arguments are based on the author's *own* views of certain passages of Scripture: which is the only mode of arguing, he thinks, which can be applied to the subject.

Mr. Perceval has published a useful Tract, entitled "The Plain English Churchman guarded against the Priests of Rome," (Rivingtons.)

A short but pithy and convincing Tract has been published, (Burns,) having for its title "Is Baptismal Regeneration a Doctrine of the Church of England?" and enjoining the affirmative from our services.

Mr. Todd's "Authentic account of our Authorized Translation of the Bible," contains interesting facts on that subject.

"Examination Questions and Answers selected from Mosheim's Ecclesiastical History," (J. W.

Parker,) appear to put prominently forward the most objectionable points in Mosheim.

The same may be said of the "Questions on Burnet's Articles."

Mr. Crawford's "Questions on Butler's Analogy," (J. W. Parker,) will be useful to students in divinity.

"Questions and Answers for Young People of the Church of England," (Roake and Varty,) have a good Church tendency.

"The Daily Service of the Anglo-Catholic Church, adapted to Family or Private Worship, by a Priest," (J. H. Parker and Rivingtons,) is a little tract which aims at supplying what we very much want under present circumstances. The directions in it are clearly and carefully given.

"Horæ Sacrae, a Manual of Prayers, &c." (Burns,) is one of those selections of really Christian devotions, now happily so much more frequent than of late years. The prayers are taken from Bishop Andrews, Taylor, Patrick, Ken, Cosin, and Hickes, Kettlewell, Nelson, &c.

We have to acknowledge the receipt of very interesting collections of ecclesiastical pamphlets from New York and New Jersey.

We are truly pleased to be able to state that the SOCIETY FOR PROMOTING CHRISTIAN KNOWLEDGE has returned to its old rule concerning its monthly meetings, in order to pay that due reverence to the Holydays of the Church which its members who wished to attend from a distance have hitherto been unable to show. The rule now stands as follows; the addition made to it is put in italics: "That a general meeting be holden at the Society's house on the first Tuesday in every month, *except when such Tuesday shall fall upon a Holyday of the Church, for which on Epistle and Gospel are appointed in the Book of Common Prayer; and then upon the first Tuesday not such a Holyday; and except the months of August and September, at one o'clock.*" The resolution embodying this provision, which Mr. Goldsmid moved, and the Reverend J. Jennings seconded, was carried without a division.

A memorable decision has been given by Sir Herbert Jenner, Judge of the Court of Arches, on occasion of an action instituted by a Clergyman in the Isle of Wight against a parishioner who set up a tombstone with an inscription from the 2d book of Maccabees, "It is a holy and wholesome thought to pray for the dead," with the addition of the words "Pray for the soul of Joseph Woolfrey." It is to the effect that whereas prayers of the dead were a usage of the primitive Church before the Roman tenet of purgatory was heard of, they were (on certain grounds) discouraged by the Church of England at the Reformation, but are not prohibited. Besides the intrinsic importance of this judgment, it is valuable on another and temporary ground. Certain doctrines and opinions lately avowed in our Church after a season of oblivion, have been accused of being contrary to the Creed of the Church, and demands have been made on their upholders to give them up or the Church. Now it is not often possible to procure an independent unbiassed judgment on *the matter of fact*, viz. the Church's view of the subject, as the history of past centuries discloses it. With this we have now accidentally been furnished from as high an authority and public an officer as an Ecclesiastical Judge; and as regards a tenet which no one can say has been prominently put forward by the parties who have shown a leaning in its favour. If the usage of prayers for the dead turns out not to be prohibited by our Church, what would be the result of a judicial investigation into *the matter of fact* as regards her view of Catholic consent or episcopal succession?

We are glad to report that the Church is beginning to take a lead in the EDUCATION of the People; it is not merely opposing bad schemes, but executing good ones; and this, not by making a compromise with the novelties of the day, but by building upon the solid foundation of the National Schools of thirty years, the Grammar Schools of three Centuries, and the Cathedrals, which are

coeval with the National Church itself. In different parts of the country the Chapters are calling to their aid the principal Laity and Clergy of their neighbourhood, with a view to organize Diocesan and Local Boards, "under the authority of the Bishop of each Diocese, and in connection with the NATIONAL SOCIETY;" that is, with the collective Episcopate incorporated by the Crown for the purpose of directing Popular Education.

The subject has been brought before their Clergy by the Bishops of London, Gloucester, and Bristol, Oxford and Chester; public meetings have been held in the dioceses of Canterbury, Norwich, and Bath and Wells, for the purpose of taking active measures to further the plans which emanate from a Committee of the National Society; and Diocesan Boards have been formed upon the principles suggested by it for the Dioceses of Canterbury, Norwich, Bath and Wells, Exeter, Lichfield, Salisbury, and are in progress of formation in Lincoln, Gloucester and Bristol, Winchester, Chester, Chichester, Ely, and Ripon. Archidiaconal and Local Boards, in subordination to that of the diocese, have already been organized at Doncaster, in Aylesbury, and other places.

The objects of these Boards are, 1. to educate young men to be afterwards trained as Schoolmasters; 2. to improve the tone of Education of Farmers and Tradesmen; and, 3. to secure generally the efficiency and integrity of Church Education, by connecting it with the Collegiate and Diocesan Institutions united under the Primate, who presides, not only nominally but really, over the counsels of the National Society.

To judge from some Reports drawn up by members of these Boards, and privately circulated, there is reason to expect much good from the manly good sense and sound principle which have been locally brought to bear on the subject.

Two results are showing themselves already; 1. We shall have accurate returns of what the Church *is doing*, and of what it *is capable of doing*, for the complete instruction of the people; 2. Men of different parties are acting heartily together, each one in his appointed sphere, and on acknowledged principles. In one quarter only, where party spirit always runs high, have we heard of any prospect of disunion. It seems to have arisen from a misunderstanding of what was aimed at, and to have soon yielded to a mutual good feeling, and to a deference to authority. In the case we allude to, the enemies of the Church were looking forward with glee to a public collision, and consequent failure; but they were disappointed. In such cases one is thankful that the Church is enabled to shed her maternal influence over the hearts of those within her pale, who in theory do not acknowledge the privileges which they enjoy.

The fact that the above-named Dioceses are working on the same plan, with the active concurrence of their several Bishops, is surely an answer to those who would fain have passed by the National Society, in vain hopes of uniting all in some new plan of their own. Meanwhile we understand that the National Society itself is taking most active steps in London, and that we may hope, ere long, to see an Institution for educating Schoolmasters established at Westminster, on a scale worthy of the Church of England. Already the Metropolitan Commercial Institution, under the patronage of the Archbishop of Canterbury, and the joint presidency of the Bishops of London and Winchester, is in active operation. The two plans must materially assist each other; there are obvious advantages in their being distinct as regards London; while it is essential that every where else they should be worked by one machinery. We who wish to see Chapters, and not their money, made efficient, would fain see St. Paul's at the head of the *Metropolitan* plan; and Westminster a Royal Peculiar, at the head of that which is *National*.

We hear, and with much regret, a rumour that the SOCIETY FOR THE BUILDING AND ENLARGEMENT OF CHURCHES AND CHAPELS, has it in contemplation to alter one of its

fundamental rules. At present, as our readers are well aware, no grant is made by the Society, but upon the condition that one half of the new sittings shall be made free and unappropriated for ever. And what we have heard is this, that as to some considerable portion of these sittings, it is to be, in future, in the power of the bishop of the diocese to direct, that instead of being thus free, they shall be let at very low, or what are called pepper-corn rents; not, as is admitted, for the sake of the money which would accrue from this source, but, as is avowed, for the sake of fostering, in the minds of the humbler classes, the notion that their places in the house of God are their own; that they have a *right* to them because they have paid for them. Such, we say, is the rumour, but we should be reluctant, indeed, to give it credence, for we do not hesitate to say, that in adopting such a motive of action as this, the excellent Society in question would be adopting a principle irreconcilably opposed to the general principles and system, we will not say of the Church of England alone, but of the Church Christian and Catholic throughout the world. The teaching of that Church has ever been, as it was bound to be, that the sinner comes by favour, not by right, into the more immediate presence of his God, in the fellowship of the faithful. Here in England, she permits him not to join in aught beyond the confession of his sins before her minister has given sanction to his further devotions by pronouncing her absolution, in that very act reminding him that he is where he is by sufferance, and that, on fitting cause, her sentence of excommunication might banish him from her walls. If this is more generally thought of than it is, the fact is, in all probability, owing to that very system of pews, and of a right to them in their occupants, which, as we hear, it is now sought to extend. That system, such as it is, has hitherto been borne with by our ecclesiastical authorities, not approved, has been viewed as a matter of necessity, not as a theme for gratulation. And the adoption, by the Society before us, of the change in question, would be the first act by which, in appearance, the Church's voice would be raised in favour of the renting of seats as of a practice good and desirable in the abstract. Such renting, for renting's sake, is, we know, approved of by Dissenters; it is too much akin to that ungodly spirit of independence in which dissent originated, not to be so. Such renting, we know too, aids them to fill their chapels, nor do we doubt that if the Church would follow their example in this respect, many of those who are willing to join in worship as by right, though not as by favour, would be drawn from their shrines to hers. But it would be as Israelites of old might have been drawn from their unhallowed high places by the idols painted on the sacred walls of the Temple. Now it is true, the "fishers of men" are to draw into their net all classes of mankind, but not, surely, by all manner of means. The Church is not, assuredly, to draw men from her unauthorized rivals, by proffering to them within her sacred pale, that pabulum to the correct passions of their nature, which they had been accustomed to seek and find in the world without her. We must, therefore, express our confident hope that this unpleasing rumour will prove unfounded.

Notices of Books

[*British Critic*, April 1839.]

ANOTHER volume of the "Library of the Fathers" is on the point of making its appearance, containing the Translation of St. Cyprian's Treatises; the translator is the Rev. C. Thornton, of Margaret Chapel.

To Mr. Lancaster the Church is indebted for some of the most striking and original views which have appeared in this day. His "Alliance of Education and Civil Government," and Bampton Lectures on the "Popular Evidence of Christianity," entitle him to respect and gratitude. Having said thus much, we hope he will not take it ill if we express much regret at the present publication, which

consists of a Sermon preached against Dr. Hampden, with a Postscript; and a Correspondence which has arisen out of it between him and several university authorities. We will not enter into the merits of the question between them and him, because we are not so much reviewers of deeds done in Oxford, as of books published. Such a publication should not have come from such a quarter.

Mr. Merivale has published four beautiful Sermons preached before the University of Cambridge (J. W. Parker), to show that the Established Church is well adapted to impregnate the nation with the "spirit" of Christian truth. It is impossible to read them without feeling interest and respect for the writer, and being profited by his remarks; at the same time there is much fear lest such views of the character of the Christian Church as he implies should lead to the substitution of a secular spirit and mere literary taste for faith and practice. Mr. Merivale perhaps is in so little danger of such a calamity himself, that he does not see its likelihood in the case of others.

Mr. Crosthwaite has performed the very important service of editing Archbishop Potter's "Discourse of Church Government" (Tegg, where, however, *Mr. Crosthwaite's* edition must be inquired for.) He has corrected the Scripture references, examined the notes, printed at length the authorities, and added remarks of his own; besides appending at the end of the volume, indexes of texts, of authors, and of the principal matters. We earnestly recommend all students in divinity to avail themselves of the assistance afforded them in this valuable and authoritative work.

We are very glad to be able to rectify a misapprehension of ours relative to Mr. Palmer's views of Articles of faith in No. xlviii. of this work. We will give his own words as they occur in a supplement to his volumes which he has just published:—"I have not any where maintained," he says, "that the whole Catholic Church does even at this day preach every where one and the same doctrine, except in *very minute secondary points*, or except as popular errors interfere with it."—*British Critic*, p. 364. A reference to what I have above stated, p. 567, will show that I am not on principle bound to sustain this position; nor do I practically admit it, because, in my opinion, several of the errors and abuses of the Roman Church are of a very important nature, and very detrimental to Christian piety, though they be not, strictly speaking, contrary to the articles of faith.

"I know not what part of my work has led to the notion that I hold 'that the faith of the Church admits of addition,' and that 'any doctrine which has once been generally received must be apostolic, or, in other words, that the majority cannot be wrong.'—*British Critic*, pp. 368, 369. I have expressly argued against the latter position (vol. ii. p. 136, &c.); as to the former, I have distinctly stated that the articles of our faith were but once revealed and admit of no addition (vol. i. p. 89). Perhaps it may be supposed that in admitting that, before the universal Church has decided some question of controversy different opinions may be held without heresy, while I hold that, after the judgment of the Church, there should be no more diversity, I may seem to admit the articles of faith to be capable of addition. This was not my intention; I only mean that in the heat of controversy, when different opinions are supported by men of learning, it may for a time be doubtful what the revealed truth is, and therefore persons may for a time not receive that truth, may even hold what is contrary to it; and yet, until the authority of the universal Church has decided the question, and left then without excuse, they may be free from the guilt of formal heresy. I only speak here of controversies which the Church had not decided in former ages; or in which the testimony of tradition as well as Scripture is disputed."

Mr. Oakley has just published a volume of Sermons preached at Whitehall Chapel (Rivingtons), which makes us very grateful to the Bishop of London for having ended the delicate and difficult arrangements, of which the preacher-ships have been the subject, by such an appointment. In a brief notice of this nature, we cannot do more than direct the reader's attention to the preface, in

which the *Internal Evidence* for the divinity of the Church system is drawn out from the tendency of its doctrines to produce those graces which Scripture especially inculcates; in other words, he shows that to be Catholic is *the way*, and only way, to be evangelical.

That mild-tempered and candid man, Mr. Bickersteth, has lately published three works, all of course characterized by his peculiar views, viz., "Christian Truth," "A Voice from the Alps," and "Dangers of the Church." The second of these will be valuable to those who wish to know the state of the French and Swiss Protestant Home Missions, or "Evangelical Societies." Mr. Merle D'Aubigné, whose Discourses are embodied in it, upholds the three first centuries as the time when the Church was "a living form." Mr. Bickersteth seems to be of the same way of thinking from his volume of extracts from the early Fathers.

How remarkable a contrast to such thinkers does the author of "The Natural History of Enthusiasm" present, who, speaking of the Fathers' views about celibacy, "says boldly," in a new work which we have noticed in another place, that "popery, foul as it is, and has ever been in the mass, might yet fairly represent itself as a *reform upon early Christianity*."—p. 79. We may here add how much we are obliged to this latter writer for his seasonable production, which must do good. He gives high praise to the authors of the Tracts for the Times for their opposition to Rationalism, summarily disposes of Dissenters and Ultra-Protestants of all sorts, and brings out usages and opinions in the early Church which the Oxford writers have been amiably reluctant to insist upon.

We have several other pamphlets to announce in the same controversy, one is on the "Idolatrous Tendency of the Oxford Tracts;" another, on the Heathenism of the Reserve inculcated in them (by Mr. Bird), we have noticed above; a third is, it seems, to show that their writers are *not members* of the Church of England; a fourth, by Mr. Fitzgerald, has the appearance of being the work of a young man, which the affix of B.A. to his name would confirm. It is not very deep, but the tone is good and Christian. Mr. Bird also exhibits an improved temper in the controversy, which is encouraging, and deserves the thanks of all lovers of peace.

Dr. Pusey, in a Letter to the Bishop of Oxford, discusses at length most of the subjects in controversy, under the heads of the Rule of Faith, Justification, Sin after Baptism, the Sacraments, Baptism, the Lord's Supper, Apostolical Succession, Prayers for the Dead in Christ, Invocation, and Celibacy.

Two more Tracts for the Times have been published, No. 85, "On the Scripture Proof of Church Doctrines," and No. 86, "On the Indications of a Superintending Providence in the Preservation of the Prayer Book, and in the Changes which it has undergone."

Mr. Pugin has written an intemperate attack on the Cranmer Memorial, which its supporters have very rightly not answered. The subscriptions to this "national work" amount to more than £5000. £25,000 are wanted for the whole design, including the decorations on the exterior. In consequence some prominent persons on the committee propose to pull down St. Mary Magdalen Church, which lies nearest to the place of burning, and to rebuild it with the money subscribed; this would be a saving of site and endowment. We are glad to see that some Wesleyans have contributed their mite to this truly Protestant undertaking.

"Reminiscences of Rome" is a Roman Catholic production forming a superfine illustration of that species of talk which Mr. Burchell recognised in Miss Carolina Wilhelmina Skeggs, or viewed at the best estate resembling the courtesy dropped by Sisters Angelica and Seraphina to the Pretender, which was "so profound that the hoop-petticoats which performed the feat seemed to sink down to the very floor, nay, through it, as if a trap-door had opened for their descent." If we are to be converted to Romanism, we certainly shall bargain for something in the way of argument more

manly and robust, less puffy and mawkish than is exhibited in this and other productions of the same school.

A valuable work has been commenced called "The Voice of the Church" (Burns), being selections from Divines and other writers of the Church. The part now published contains a great deal of matter and is very moderate in price.

We recommend to notice "Letters of a Reformed Catholic" Nos. 1-3, on the leading Principle of the Reformation, on Private Judgment and Authority in matters of Faith, and on the Apostolical Succession; they are written clearly and solidly, and will prove useful for distribution. The last of these advertises, as likely soon to be published, "The Tree of Apostolical Succession, from an Engraving published in 1672." Such a table has been long a desideratum, and it promises to be an appropriate decoration for the chimney-piece or closet of the Churchman.

If any one wants information on this last subject, he should read a bold and striking publication called "The Church, the Bishop, or Corah, which?" (Roake and Varty.) It is not always written in good taste, but it contains enlarged and noble views becoming an Anglo-Catholic, and suited to these times.

Maclaurin's "Plea for Primitive Episcopacy" (Bell and Bradfute, Edinburgh), is a spirited but not very discreet or well-judging composition. We have no doubt it will do good among Dissenters.

Mr. Oldknow's essay on "The Catholic Church" (Rivingtons) is a work of the same kind in a very calm and pleasing spirit. It was to have been dedicated to Mr. Rose, instead of which the author has been forced to satisfy himself with an announcement, of which we cite the first sentence:—"The English branch of the Catholic Church has recently lost one of its greatest ornaments, who devoted to its service, and to the maintenance and spread of that religion which it is its object to perpetuate, the rare endowments of commanding talent, extensive learning, high and undeviating principle, and Christian piety; and whose exertions in its behalf, both in removing misapprehension and prejudice, in exposing the designs of its enemies, and in furthering plans for its greater efficiency, it may be safely said, were not less effectual than those of any living man." The concluding words might well be made stronger than they are.

The "Vox Ecclesiæ" (J. W. Parker) is a collection of the Judgments of our Bishops against the Ecclesiastical Commission. It is well worth attention.

Dr. Dealtry has published a Charge "On the Obligations of the National Church." It is full of interesting facts, and contains in an appendix Remarks on our Church by an American Writer, in which there is much that is valuable, not a little that is inconsistent.

Mr. Molesworth's "Domestic Chaplain" (Rivingtons, London), is a collection of sermons on family duties for every Sunday in the year. Mr. Molesworth's name is known and respected by all Churchmen; and these Sermons are in the tone and on the principles of his former works. He is always instructive, but we could wish there were always *consistency* in his theological and ecclesiastical views. Consistency, he may be quite sure, is the only strength and security of doctrine in an age of inquiry; all other teaching jars and cracks.

Mr. Scott, Fellow of Balliol College, has published an excellent sermon (Rivingtons) on the important subject, which elicited Dr. Pusey's and Mr. Oakeley's sermons noticed in our last number, the Claims upon Churchmen of the Society for the Propagation of the Gospel in Foreign Parts.

We have to notice also Mr. Wilberforce's sermon on "The Power of God's Word needful for National Education" (Rivingtons), Mr. Dodsworth's on "Romanism successfully opposed only on Catholic Principles" (Burns), and Mr. Gray's on "Church Union" (Southampton).

Mr. Bartlett has published "Memoirs of Bishop Butler" (J. W. Parker). There seem to be such

slender materials for a life of this eminent man that we ought not to sever but rather grateful towards those who attempt it. At the same time we must confess for ourselves, that we had rather read but a little of Butler than much of Butler's admirers and critics. We care less than Mr. Bartlett does what Sir. J. Macintosh, Dr. Parr, or the Edinburgh Review thinks of Butler's Sermons (ch. 2), or of the Analogy (ch. 3); and we scruple at his devoting a chapter to Secker's character and habits (ch. 12), and another to Berkeley (ch. 13), in so brief a memoir.

"The Pilgrim's Staff," (Ball, London) is a pleasing and useful collection of meditations and prayers from the most various sources adapted for every day of the year. It is compiled, however, on the delusive notion that men of opposite doctrinal sentiments think and feel alike. St. Cyprian, Romaine, Hopkins, St. Anselm, Wesley, and the present Bishop of London, among others, are made to contribute their portion.

Mr. Bosanquet's "New System of Logic" (J. W. Parker) is not a work which can be despatched in one or two sentences. We are not prepared to say that we should agree with all he advances or that he has placed his argument upon its simplest principles; but it bears the marks of an original, and (what is better) a deep and true thinker. We thoroughly acquiesce in the statement with which Mr. Bosanquet opens:—"Aristotle's system of reasoning is not consistent with Holy Scripture. The sacred writers adopt a style of reasoning which is wholly opposite to it in character."—p. v. No one can doubt that the Aristotelian system provides an *adequate analysis* of the reasoning process; but so might theories of physical astronomy before Newton solve adequately the motions of the heavenly bodies. The question is not whether it is not sufficient, but whether it is the most simple, natural and Christian.

Mr. Smart in his "Beginnings of a new school of Metaphysics" (Richardson) agrees in criticising the Aristotelian logic: but excels neither in his metaphysical principles nor his tone.

Collins' "Cheap Edition of Select Christian Authors" (Glasgow) has started with giving us two good works and spoiling them by introductory essays. Why administer Thomas-à-Kempis in a dose of Chalmers and dash Mr. Wilberforce with the present Bishop of Calcutta?

"Christian Literature" (Fraser and Crawford, Edinburgh,) is a work apparently of the same kind. It has published "Leslie's Short and Easy Method with the Deists," Bishop Taylor's "Holy Living" and Witherspoon on "Regeneration."

"Pascal's Thoughts" have been newly translated and published at Glasgow (Collins), but here again we are haunted with an introductory essay, though from the pen of an able man, Mr. Taylor.

"An attempt to illustrate the Connection between the *Catechism and Articles* of the Church in a Letter to a Friend" (Parker, Oxford,) is well calculated to remove the difficulties which certain minds find in understanding the latter.

Mr. F. W. Faber's Tracts on the Church and Prayer Book are now published in one volume. They are, what some persons would call, *young*; but that does not interfere, to say the least, with their being eloquent and interesting, as well as instructive. They are well adapted for distribution.

Bishop Henshaw's "Horæ Succisivæ, or Spare Hours for Meditations," have been republished (Darling). The volume consists, as its title implies, of short reflections upon religious subjects. It is one of those books which have been condemned to an oblivion of years, and which changes in the religious world have brought down from the book shelf. The profits are to go towards defraying the expense incurred lately in erecting a chapel in Edinburgh. It is a pleasing publication for an excellent object.

Notices of Books

[*British Critic*, July 1839.]

MR. EVANS has published a second series of his "Biography of the Early Church" (Rivingtons). Mr. Evans is one of those writers, members of the University of Cambridge, such as the late Mr. Rose and Mr. Chevallier, who, before any thing was published elsewhere, directed the attention of the rising generation to higher and more primitive views of Christian truth than had latterly been in esteem among us. May he long continue to edify the Church by his writings! We do not profess entirely to acquiesce either in his views or his tone; his tone especially is somewhat too literary and intellectual, and, in consequence, too eclectic, to please us; but we are very grateful to him for so good a deed as his dedicating the stores of a rich and imaginative mind to the service of antiquity.

While we are utterly surfeited and sick of "Evidences" for Revealed Religion, as we have explained at length in the early part of this Number, we are addressed, as if our appetite was fresh, by a series of fourteen Demonstrations, all about "the necessity of a divine revelation, the genuineness and authenticity of Scripture, its Inspiration, its Miracles, &c. &c." by Ministers of the "Established Church in Glasgow," (Collins) extending to nearly 600 pages, and to copies "8000," stereotyped, and "placed within the reach of the humblest classes." This is munificently and charitably done by a number of gentlemen in Glasgow, but it is melancholy that any serious man should think that this is the way in which truth is savingly propagated or maintained. A suggestion is thrown out in the Preface that "the Evidences" should be "taught in a catechetical form in our juvenile schools." Unhappy scholars! unhappy Church, which having no root in itself and not venturing to speak with authority, is obliged to betake itself to disputations, "never-ending, still beginning!" Can alliance more ill-matched and strange be imagined than this, which sheer necessity has brought about, between pseudo-spiritualism and the evidential method? More venerable surely were the old Covenanters who upheld their Puritanism by the sword, than those who would make Christians by Littleton and Paley.

Mr. Coleridge's "Companion to the First Lessons on Sundays, Fasts and Festivals," (Rivingtons) is intended, and well adapted, "to explain briefly and familiarly those passages that occur in them, which, from any cause, are not obviously intelligible by an ordinary reader;" and so to encourage "conversation among the members of a family on the facts of Scripture which they have heard read." It is a useful little book, and will be found perhaps to convey instruction to the respected author's brethren in the priesthood, as well as to those for whom it is immediately intended.

"Letters to the Authors of the Plain Tracts for Critical Times by a Layman" (Cadell) are thoughtfully written in defence of the doctrine of baptismal regeneration, and the author finds, "*upon perusal*, that they directly and most powerfully" tend to a "breach betwixt the Evangelical and High Church parties," and therefore "has been led to attempt a refutation of their contents. This is fair. However, with respect to the Oxford Tracts, the Author begs to observe that he has "*abstained from the perusal* of them;" yet he has been "led to conclude that" their system "is liable to just exception." This is not fair.

Mr. Tyrwhitt's Sermon on the Institution of Baptism by our Lord, (Parker, Oxford), is published in consequence of one of the "Plain Tracts for Critical Times." It is to prove that our Lord's action in John xiii. was really the *baptising* of His Apostles. Thus he answers the question, frequent in early times on the part of heretics, as to the apostles' baptism. The appendix contains an able and elaborate disquisition upon John iii. 5.

Much as we respect Joseph Milner, we have not respect enough for his history of the Church to welcome with any great eagerness a "Continuation" of it. Such, however, has Mr. Stebbing given to

the world (Cadell) in one volume, which is to be followed by two others, so as to bring the reader to the eighteenth century. The volume already published contains an account of the proceedings of the Diet of Augsburg, and the events which followed upon it, and of the state of the Reformation in the several countries of Europe at the opening of the Council of Trent. It appears to be carefully written, but with somewhat too much of a didactic air at times. We cannot, of course, be expected to acquiesce in Mr. Stebbing's view of Luther and the Reformation, but as we claim the right of protesting against it, so we freely grant him that of maintaining it, if he is able.

"Bellingham, or Narrative of a Christian in search of the Church," by the Rev. W. Palm (Parker), is the lively graphic work of one who seems to write from actual observation. It is a defence, in the form of a tale, of the Church as a divine institution and an establishment, and contains much which will be serviceable to the general reader. The story itself is not so satisfactory. The hero is the son of an, in every sense, respectable shopkeeper, has a "good plain education at a day school," gets acquainted with a dissenting neighbour, falls in love with Miss Bathsheba his daughter, reads the newspapers, leaves the Church, joins a Reform Club, becomes a student in a Dissenting Academy, is chosen minister of Bethel Chapel, then of Ebenezer Chapel, is converted again to the Church, and rewarded with ordination, a living, and, above all, with "Emily Russell," a blooming girl of nineteen, as fair in mind as in person.

Dr. Philip's "Life, Times and Characteristics of John Bunyan," (Virtue), is written under the impression that "Bunyan is the Shakespeare of theology;" and that "a stranger who admires and loves Bunyan, approaches Bedford as a poet or a divine would enter Smyrna; the former thinking only of Homer, and the latter only of Polycarp." 'We have no wish to disparage Bunyan's great abilities, but considering that we discern both in Homer and Shakespeare tokens of a higher theory of moral truth than Bunyan realized, (not to bring S. Polycarp into unseemly comparison with him,) we do not share Dr. Philip's interest in reviewing Bunyan's boyhood, soldiering, marriage, reformation, conversion, conflicts, counsellors, relapses, temptations, revivals, crisis, baptism, sickness, call, trial, imprisonment and pastorship.

Two useful little books have been published, one called "The Church Calendar" (Parker), the other, "An Ecclesiastical Almanac" (Leslie), names which speak for themselves. Each has its own excellences; the former is got up with a care and expense suitable to its object. The latter evidences much learning and a comprehensiveness of view, which gives it the preference in our own minds. We heartily recommend and wish well to both. They are the commencement, we trust, of something to come, more perfect than either of them.

"Observations upon the several Sunday services prescribed by the Liturgy throughout the Year," by the late Bishop Jolly (Grants, Edinburgh,) has been republished, with a Memoir of the venerable Author, by Bishop Walker. The late Bishop's name speaks for his work without any notice from us, but why should its sound be injured by the unmelodious twang of "one of the Bishops of the Protestant Episcopal Communion in Scotland?"

We wish we could satisfy ourselves that Mr. Caunter's Poetry of the Pentateuch (Churton) might not go into a quarter of its actual bulk, which is two thick volumes. The idea of the work is very good, and the execution interesting, but it is swollen by interpolations, which have no legitimate place in it. Thus chapter 21 of vol. 1, on the poetical beauties of the Bible, is wholly made up, after stating the subject, of seven four-lined stanzas, "by an anonymous" English "poet of the 17th century" upon the duty of avoiding slander, and evil speaking, cowardice, and drunkenness, and of observing prayer, reading Scripture daily, and hallowing the Lord's day; then an hypothesis that "the cherubins" guarding the tree of life, were *Equi tonantes*; then 60 blank verses from an

American translation of Herder's version of one of Ezekiel's Visions; and last a prose translation of a passage from Herder's "Spirit of Hebrew Poetry," concerning the death of Abel. In like manner chapter 2 of volume 2, which introduces the subject of Balaam's fourth prophecy, "I shall see Him, &c." begins with a description of Balak's anger against Balaam, remarks that Balaam did not on this occasion betake himself to heathen rites as before, quotes the prophecy, and then, apropos of Balaam's neglect of his conscience, observes that the prophet *never* "could have felt that repose of mind expressed by a somewhat quaint, but nevertheless eloquent writer of a much later age," Sir Thomas Browne; which gives occasion to a long quotation from the Religio Medici upon peace of mind. This is like, "Did not I hear a gun? Well, whether or not, since we are talking of guns, &c. &c."

We do not mean to contend for the sobriety or depth of the late Mr. Stephenson's Christology of the Old and New Testaments (Rivingtons), nor can we at all admit his notion that the prophecies of Scriptures were all fulfilled immediately upon our Lord's coming, and that none remain for time to come; but his work evidences much thought and diligence, and, in the words of the Editor, "a principle will be found working through it which will enable Christians better to understand the course of God's government in the world, to harmonize the different portion of His word, and to estimate the greatness of their own spiritual privileges."

The Rev. J. Prosser, the author of "a Key to the Hebrew Scriptures" (Duncan), has evidently taken a good deal of pains, although we are sorry to think on a mistaken plan. Some help of this sort may be needed by such as would learn Hebrew without a master; but the sooner it can be dispensed with, the better. It can never be necessary through the whole Bible. One who swims with corks, should not venture out of his depth, nor one who uses a "key" into the more difficult Hebrew books. Its only use can be at the beginning. This attempt appears also to us to be wanting in simplicity. The author has wished to combine the two objects of helping a beginner, and shewing the depth of the meaning of Hebrew words. Whether right or wrong in his details, they seem misplaced for one who needs a key. A beginner should learn Hebrew as simply as possible; it will only perplex him, to try to remember that "coming" is derived from "mingling," or "day" from "tumultuous motion," or "to say" from "branching out." Mr. Ollivant's is a better key, where one is needed. As Mr. Prosser, on his own experience, speaks against the use of points, we must say that we know some striking cases to the contrary, in which persons having studied Hebrew without points for years, found the study unsatisfactory and uncertain, and being persuaded at last to study it with points, found it satisfactory and definite.

There is a pleasing tone about much of Mr. Wemyss's elaborate work on "Job and his Times" (Jackson and Walford), and yet it is unsatisfactory too. He tells us from the sacred book he translates, that "man's best deeds may be pleasing, but are no way profitable to God," p. 78, no mention being made of the necessity of divine grace; that "a clear view of the perfections of God, has a powerful effect in producing repentance," p. 79, that "the dispensation by Jesus Christ enforced" the fundamental principles of patriarchal religion, "by new motives, and placed them under higher sanctions, *adding* also a distinct revelation of a *life to come* and a *future judgment*," p. 114, and that Satan, mentioned in the first chapter, was not the evil spirit, but the "public accuser in the celestial court," or "perhaps general inspector of manners," or "simply the recording angel." p. 280-282. If we knew more of his writings, perhaps we should have no difficulty in the matter.

What a pity that any one should so mistake things that "from the age of eighteen to that of thirty-seven years the *aim and end of his ambition* has tended towards one point, to *prove* himself a poet!" Such, however, is the case with Mr. Reade, the author of "Italy, a Poem" (Saunders and

Otley). He has just before told us that "poetry has no politics;" it would be more correct to say that it has no ambition; as it is an axiom in philosophy that "*Poeta nascitur non fit*," so surely is it likewise that "*ma vult esse quam videri*." One is unwilling to say discouraging things to a person who has already, it appears, met discouragement, and has borne it good-naturedly, yet we do wish the author had taken a more real view of things around him and in him than such statements imply.

The late Mr. Rich's "Narrative of a Journey to the Site of Babylon," with "Memoirs on the Ruins," and a "Narrative of a Journey to Persepolis," is in a great measure a republication, and will be acceptable to those who are interested in its solemn and even religious subject.

We are exceedingly pleased to have to announce a new edition of Bishop Beveridge's Explanation of the Church Catechism, (Parker, Oxford.) A churchman naturally looks for such books on the list of the Christian Knowledge Society, and has reason to be grateful to those considerate persons whose liberality from time to time removes his disappointment.

We can believe that Mr. Fletcher, of Madeley, was an interesting man, in spite of Mr. Dunn, who, in publishing a selection from his works under the title of Christian Theology (Mason), has adduced the testimony of the "venerable Dr. Adam Clarke," "the gifted Richard Watson," and "the perspicacious Samuel Drew," to that effect. There is, as would be supposed, much that is striking in Mr. Fletcher's writings, with great defects and mistakes. By the way, the following passage strikes us as curious; would that he had carried out the doctrine contained in it! "If He speaks of His Essence otherwise than they have conceived it to be, they ... wrest and distort it ... in direct opposition to the plain meaning of the words, to the general tenor of the Scriptures, to the consent of the Catholic Church in all ages, and to the very form of their own baptism."—p. 120.

A recent Oxford publication, "The Psalter in English Verse, dedicated to the Bishop of Oxford" (Rivingtons), will attract so much attention, that nothing shall be said of it here but to announce its appearance.

Mr. Holt has published, in a pocket form, the Act on Pluralities and Residence, with an useful analysis, notes and index (Rivingtons).

Mr. Best's Parochial Ministrations (Hatchard) contains much practical information about the mode of conducting the economical plans incidental to the care of a parish.

"The Voice of the Church, or Selections from the Writings of Divines and others" (Burns), has reached a third number. It is the best work of its kind which has appeared.

A second and third series of "Plain Sermons by Contributors to the Tracts for the Times" (Rivingtons), have appeared. The first series has already reached a second edition.

From New Jersey we have received Sermons by Bishop Doane, on Speaking the Truth in Love, and a republication of Dr. Hook's celebrated sermon, "Hear the Church." And from Gambier, a sermon on "The Apostolical Commission," by Bishop M'Ilvaine.

If we were forced to criticize Mr. Howorth's excellent volume of "Sermons, Doctrinal and Practical" (Rivingtons), we should say that they were sometimes wanting in definiteness of statement, and should express a wish that a writer, who is so practical upon the sacraments, had been led to inculcate in the same way the doctrine of the ministry.

Mr. Pearson's "Sermons preached in a Country Parish" (Hatchards), are *practical* ones, which is the highest kind of praise that can be given.

Mr. Poole has published two seasonable Sermons (Burns) entitled, "The Church the Teacher of her Children" and "The preaching of the Gospel to the Poor a Sign of Christ's Presence with his Church."

Dr. Silver's Letter to Sir R. Inglis, "on the Spoliation and Captivity of the Cathedrals in England"

(Rivingtons), is a publication such as might be expected from a learned and original-minded man.

Mr. Wilberforce's "Letters to the Marquis of Lansdown on National Education" (Murray), is a very clever and useful little work, and will gain attention from those who are interested in the important subject it treats of.

An interesting Auto-biography of Bishop Patrick has lately appeared, being now first printed from the original manuscript, (Parker, Oxford). Considering the high name of the Author, such a work must attract attention even viewed as a literary curiosity. The Editors are said to be the Rev. J. and C. Marriotts, of Oxford.

Also we have to announce Selections from Hooker, illustrative of the Discipline and Services of the English Church by Mr. Keble, (Parker, Oxford).

"Fables from Ancients and Moderns," by the Rev. James Gorle, (Langbridge, Birmingham), form a lively little volume which, having amused ourselves, we in gratitude recommend to the notice of those younger readers whom it is still more likely to interest, and to whom it more properly belongs.

"The Revival of Religion," by Mr. Douglas of Cavers, (Blacks, Edinburgh) is one out of the many specimens which now occur of the spirit afloat in the religious world, dissatisfied with the existing state of things, conscious that the ground is crumbling under it, feeling more or less the needs of the human mind, and not knowing of the full remedy provided for them in the Apostolic Church.

As to Mr. Lucas's "Reasons for becoming a Roman Catholic," addressed to the Society of Friends (Booker and Dolman), we will but observe, that no philosopher can be surprised, and that no consistent Anglo-Catholic be sorry, at any one exchanging Friendism for Romanism.

Mr. William S. Villiers Sankey, in his "Epitome of Christian Institutions," (Edinburgh, W. S. V. Sankey,) informs us that in early times "the wife of the Bishop, Episcopus, was called Episcopa, *Episcopess*; the wife of the Presbyter was called Presbyteria, *Presbyteress*; the wife of the Deacon, Diaconus, was in like manner styled Diaconissa, *Deaconness*." There is truth in this. We presume in like manner the wife of the Monk, Monachus, was called Monacha, *Nun*.

A series of publications is in preparation, to be called "The Englishman's Library" (Burns), on subjects connected with Church History and Biography, such as the lives of fathers and reformers, eminent missionaries, religious princes, statesmen, judges, soldiers, &c., memoirs of European Colonies, memorable periods in English history, &c. It is to be superintended by Mr. E. Churton and Mr. Gresley, and together with those gentlemen to have the sanction and, if possible, the literary assistance of Mr. Chamberlain, Mr. Chevallier, Mr. Dodgson, Mr. Dodsworth, Mr. Evans, Dr. Hook, Mr. Massingberd, Mr. Molesworth, Mr. Oakeley, Mr. Paget, and Mr. S. Wilberforce; names which sufficiently guarantee the moderation, temper, judgment and ability with which it will be executed.

Among the publications on the Church and Priesthood, now issuing continually from the press, we have met with the following: From Scotland, 1. a new edition in a new form of Mr. Sinclair's excellent Vindication of the Episcopal or Apostolical Succession (Rivingtons). 2. Tracts for all Places and all Times, edited by Scottish Churchmen; No. 1 being a reprint of Bishop Onderdonk's Episcopacy tested by Scripture, with an original appendix, (Davidson, Edinburgh). This series has our best wishes for its success. 3. Dean Horsley's able Sermon on "The Pillar and Ground of the Truth" (Dundee). 4. From Ireland, Archdeacon Mant's *Horæ Apostolicæ* (Rivingtons), a learned and careful publication, arising out of a Visitation Sermon preached before the Archbishop of Armagh. From England, 5. Mr. Graves's eloquent sermon on "The System of the Church and the consequent

Obligation of her Ministers" (Whittaker, London), preached at the Visitation of the Commissary of the Archdeaconry of Richmond. 6. "Essay on Episcopacy," by Mr. Jones of New Church in Winwick, (Hatchards). 7. Mr. Ross's "Two Sermons on the Christian Church and Priesthood," (Hatchards) to which are appended some useful collections of passages on ecclesiastical subjects, from our standard writers. 8. "Tracts of the Anglican Fathers," being a sermon of Bishop Andrews on "Remission of Sins." 9. Sermon at Broadstairs on "The Ministerial Succession," by Rev. F. Merewether, (Rivingtons) evidently the composition of a thoughtful, well-react, and warm-hearted man. 10. "The Rubric; its strict Observance Recommended," (Burns). 11. "Duty of Christian Unity," by Rev. Irvin Eller (Groombridge), a tract written for farmers, small shop-keepers, and mechanics. 12. Church of England defended against the Church of England Quarterly Reviewer," (Burns) a pamphlet too good for so poor an object. 13. Dr. Hook's "Call to Union defended," (Burns) an able answer to an article in Fraser's Magazine.

But the most remarkable and important testimony which has met our eye, at once to the growing influence, and the claims of apostolical doctrine, upon the religious world, is contained in the following noble passage of the Dean of Chichester's Charge (Parker), who will be found to sanction with the weight of his high authority, the views we maintained in our last number, that the present state of religious opinion is the result of a *movement* of the public mind, not of individual exertion:—After speaking of the Rebellion and its consequences, the very reverend writer proceeds, "Then followed a time, occupying the close of the 17th, and the greater part of the last century, when the standard of public opinion, and the general principles of men who were invested with authority, and gave the cast and colour to their age, were lamentably debased; and the Church, in close harmony with the State, was low in principle, low in its tone, both of doctrine and of discipline. One by one she saw, and saw without a struggle, her rights and privileges abridged,—the terms on which she united herself with the State violated, and herself reduced to be little more than a mere instrument and engine of civil government. If during this period a few notes of a higher sound were occasionally uttered, they were lost on ears little accustomed to hear and to understand them. The first movement went to revive some of the peculiar and distinguishing doctrines of our holy faith, which had been too much left out of sight by a system of teaching that had well-nigh substituted ethics for theology, Seneca and Epictetus for Christ in our pulpits. But in matters that concerned the visible constitution of the Church, she still slumbered on, under the benumbing influence of friendly governments, till she began almost to forget herself and her heavenly origin. When this friendship was at length withdrawn from her, she at first felt herself astounded and bewildered. The props on which she had so long leaned being withdrawn, she hardly knew for a while how to use her own limbs. But by degree she recovered herself. She learned to feel her own strength, and to look to her own resources. She became sensible that, however desirous to act in unison with the State, however grateful for any kindness rendered to her by the State, she could boast of an independent origin, and could, as she before had done, exist in a state of independence.

"This change of feeling, this mighty movement in the minds of Churchmen, was the natural and spontaneous effect of the altered circumstances in which they were placed. *I should be sorry to connect it even in idea* with any particular publications of the day, because this would mix us up with all the doctrines and opinions therein maintained. On many of those questions we may entertain sentiments, variously modified, and yet there still remain certain grand cardinal truths, on which, as, Churchmen, we now can hardly differ, although they have arisen of late almost as novelties to our consideration ... We have learned better to value and more firmly maintain the dignity of our orders derived from the bishops, who are themselves descended in an unbroken and uninterrupted

succession from the Apostles; and we have learned to insist more strenuously on the virtue and efficacy of the Holy Sacraments, administered by those to whom the office of imparting them has been duly communicated," &c. &c.

It would be well if the Venerable Society for the Promotion of Christian Knowledge would resume a practice which it dropt in 1833, of publishing in its yearly report a list of the tracts and books which it has at various times allowed to go out of print. By a recent regulation no works, which have been out of print for five years, can be reprinted without going through the process of approval by the Tract Committee for the time being. For this reason Kettlewell's Tracts, among others, are virtually struck off the Society's list, his "Office for the Penitent," his "Trial and Judgment of the Soul," and "Office for one troubled in Mind." The Report for the year 1825, at which time the said Tracts were put aside, give the *general reasons* for this proceeding, which are worth citing, considering the character of the particular works which have been the victims of it. "*The length of time* which has elapsed since many of these works were adopted, and the change which has subsequently taken place among all ranks of society, have shown both the necessity of some alteration and the extent to which such alterations should be carried. Those works, which, after mature examination, appear *unsuited to the present wants* of the people," (e.g. we suppose, the Office for the Penitent,) "will be suffered to remain out of print; while others which are partly of a similar description will be offered in an *abridged form* for the especial use of the Society." (Worse and worse—abridged! and by revisors of "*a similar description*" to the writer of this paragraph! O terque quaterque beati Queis ante ora patrum, &c. &c.) "Thus it is hoped, without any sudden or violent change, the Society will be gradually disencumbered of works which have served to swell its Catalogue to an inconvenient bulk, *without producing a corresponding advantage to the public.*" Poor Kettlewell! So far, however, is plain that, at least since 1825, malign influences have been at work in the Society.

GERMANY.—The revival of Church-feeling among bodies, whose fore-father's forfeited Episcopacy, is one of the cheering signs of the present times. It indicates surely that the growth of corresponding feelings among ourselves is no chance circumstance, nor to be accounted for by the influence of individuals, or any temporary events, as the hostility of Dissenters, or the lukewarmness of the state. When many hearts are turned independently the same way, surely one must recognize His hand, who guideth the hearts of men. This longing for a Church and for Church feeling is especially perceptible in Lutheran Germany, as having departed less than the "Reformed" from the model of the ancient Church. The following passage from a work recently published, "Cyprian's Doctrines of the Church," by a Candidate for Orders, Huther, is one among many evidences of this yearning. We do not, of course, further make ourselves answerable for his views; e.g. the very fact that in our own Church, though partially dependent upon the state, there is that ardent love for her, which this writer thinks incompatible with a state of bondage, shows that in this case he has not gone deep enough. So long as the Church remains unmutilated, her children will retain this devoted attachment to her, whether she be in the Holy Land or "by the waters of Babylon."

"We boast of having been, through the word of God, set free from the manifold errors of the [Roman] Catholic doctrine, and especially from the wrongful narrowing of the Church prevalent in [Roman] Catholicism, and rightly; but it is, methinks, not to our honour, that we are so deficient in that enthusiasm which the Catholic feels in being a member of the communion of the faithful, the Church of Christ. Truly, we ought not to remain behind him in this! So long, indeed, as it is the prevailing opinion among Protestants, that 'the error of Catholicism partly consists in attaching an

extravagant value to the communion of the Church,' so long as they regard the visible Church as 'an institution for individuals, and an aggregate of individuals, whose relation to Christ is independent of her,' so long must Protestants remain strangers to all true enthusiasm for the communion of the Church; for how can the heart beat enthusiastically for a mere aggregate of individuals? But must the Protestant then of necessity only hold it to be such? May he not, without abandoning his principles, account it somewhat else and higher? True, he cannot admit of the Catholic limitation of it, for this is arbitrarily drawn, contradictory to its true nature; he must give up the idea of an Unity resulting from any outward organization of a definite constitution; but must he therefore give up the consciousness of a Communion, the feeling that, only as a member the Church is he a partaker of the blessings of Christ? True, he must not in such view identify his own particular Church with the Church of Christ, as that the bounds of both should be the same; he must acknowledge that the Church of Christ is to be found out of his own, that his is only one manifestation, of the Church Universal; but must his love for his own Church be therefore of necessity less than that which the Catholic bears to his? True he cannot admit that the visible Church, at any time or place of her earthly development, fully represents the Church invisible, in that she is always more or less clouded with the shades of sin; but must his zeal for the Church of Christ be therefore necessarily less than that of the Catholic? Who would answer all these questions in the affirmative? If then this defect no ways results from the principles of the Protestant Church, whence does it? A full examination of this question would lead too far; here we would only remark briefly, that whoso is destitute of faith in Christ, who seek for salvation in themselves and not in the Lord, can naturally have no true and living interest in the communion of the Church founded on Christ and living in him; but that even among believing Protestants this interest is but too faint, that, knowing themselves to be in communion with the Lord, they do not *equally* feel themselves to be members of His Church; this is an unnatural state of things, which will only then be corrected, when it shall be generally acknowledged, that the Lord has imparted the whole fulness of his Life and His Gifts and Blessings to His Church, i.e. to the Communion founded by him; a Communion, neither simply invisible, nor simply visible, but essentially and of necessity both at once, so that each individual has any share in the Invisible, only as a member of the Visible, and only in the Visible and through her does he ripen to a perfect man;—when it is acknowledged that any such division of the Ecclesia Invisibilis, and the Ecclesia Visibilis, which shall make the Visible Church a secondary thing, and almost an accidental appendage to the Invisible, is inadmissible and false, inasmuch as in truth the Invisible Church only exists, where is the Visible also. Not less unnatural and pernicious, moreover, is the indifference with which most among us Protestants regard the particular Church to which they belong, whereas a communion can only really prosper, when all individuals are animated by a living interest for its well being. To account for this unnatural state of things, one need go no further than the perverted position which Protestant Churches generally occupy to the state, whereby their independent existence is annihilated, and they are given over to that which is foreign to themselves. In the beginning indeed of their existence, it was necessary and beneficial for them to lean on the power of the state; but must they continue in this dependance for ever? 'We neither believe,' says Leo, 'that the Church was originally born to be a poor bondswoman, nor that she will pass her whole future existence in the condition, into which, in Protestant Germany, she fell soon after the carrying out of the Reformation, but we take comfort as to her actual condition, since it is evidently ordered by the wise hand of God.' Doubtless, we must recognise the wisdom of God in this order of things, yet on the other hand, we must not overlook, that a bitter fruit has resulted to the Church from being made a 'poor bondswoman,' viz. that so many of her members have

forfeited all sense of the freedom, which essentially belongs to her, and with it, all real interest for the Church, so that we may well pray her Lord, once more of his goodness, to set her free from the bonds cast around her."

Notices of Books

[*British Critic*, October 1839.]

MR. Gresley, in his Sermons on "Zeal and Moderation, preached before the University of Oxford" (Rivingtons), writes like a man who had something to say, which is one of the highest praises we can give a sermon. He understands that at the present moment a great problem lies before our Church, how to be what it *once was* without ceasing to be what *it is*, how to adapt primitive principles to existing circumstances without sacrificing the former or overshooting the latter. They are the sermons of an able and reflecting mind, which has attained to great truths and is consolidating its acquirements.

"Sermons preached before the University of Oxford, by the Rev. S. Wilberforce" (Burns), are eloquent and pleasing discourses on practical subjects, which must have been very effective in delivery; they abound in references to the Fathers, a style of preaching suited to, and which we are glad hereby to find sanctioned by, the learned body whom Mr. Wilberforce in these sermons represents.

A very beautiful and useful selection of Prayers and Meditations on the subject of the Holy Eucharist has been published by the Rev. S. Wilberforce, under the title of *Eucharistica*.

We are glad to find that a new edition of Dr. Field's *Book of the Church* is in the course of publication, in three volumes, 8vo., (Bohn), under the able editorship of Mr. Brewer.

The first number has appeared of one of the most important works of the day, *The New General Biographical Dictionary*, projected and partly arranged by the late Mr. Hugh James Rose, and edited by his brother, assisted by the contributions of many distinguished persons. It is no bad compliment to them to say the number before us was an agreeable surprise. We did not realize beforehand that it could be, at the same time, so comprehensive, and yet so interesting. We will particularize the lives of Abelard, Archbishop Abbott, and his brother, Lord Colchester, Abdel-Munen, and various other Mahometan Califs, Abernethy, Addison, Ælfric, and Adams, the Patriarch of Pitcairn's Island. The present work proposes to itself a middle plan between manuals and those voluminous biographies which are libraries in themselves; it must be observed, that from the nature of the case, every year takes away from the value of existing works of this class, and increases the call for new ones.

Mr. Benson has published "Discourses upon Tradition and Episcopacy" directed against persons whom he calls "Tractarians." He says the English Church "is *not only* constituted according to the Apostolic model, but it has enjoyed that blessing by *an unbroken succession* from the earliest times;" and that ministers in "Episcopal Churches" are by external call "clearly to be reckoned among the legitimate successors of the Apostles in their ministerial office." had Mr. Benson but said this six years ago, when there was more call for it than at present, probably he would not be writing against "Tractarians" now. He proceeds to enforce the evils of disunion, and, still, after the manner of the Tracts of the Times, he pleads necessity for the foreign Protestants (*vide* Dr. Pusey's Letter, p. 152, &c), and for our dissenters at home the neglect of the Church (*vide* Tract 86). So far then Mr. Benson walks with the "Tractarians." He parts with them on the subject of Church authority. His theory of Church authority is this, that "every branch of the Christian Church upon earth *has a right* to form and enjoin on" its "members whatever it conceives" asserted or implied in Scripture, (p. 3,) and that those individual members on the other hand *have the right* of disobeying (pp. 4, 5), or

partially obeying, according to their private judgment. Here is certainly implied the existence of a difference, not of view only, but of moral principle, between him and his opponents, which, as time goes on, will be more and more developed. It is the point at issue all over the world, that of submission to authority or independence. The question is, "are there any points on which persons are to submit to the authority of the Church before and apart from their own conviction?" The writers in the Tracts answer, Yes, on the points contained in the Creeds; but the ultra-protestants contend that every one must satisfy himself that every truth which he receives is contained in the Bible. Mr. Benson, speaking of the busy layman and unsettled labourer, says, "there must be no absolute surrender of the *reason* and conscience, which God has vouchsafed to be his guide." "*Every individual Christian is bound, under a sense of the same awful responsibility, to resolve to teach nothing as a minister, and accept nothing as a member of the Church, but that which he is persuaded may be concluded and proved by Holy Writ.*" "It is a matter of consideration with *every man* to determine to what *particular community of professing believers* he will consent to attach himself or continue to belong." How melancholy are such statements! It is but the least fault of the principles contained in them that are so very unreal. If it be meant to extend to the doctrine of the Creeds, to which it properly relates, we are bound plainly to avow our conviction, grounded on experience, that it is tempting men to unbelief, to seek for wrong grounds of belief in a wrong spirit, to pull down their own house with their hands, with the foolish women in the Proverbs, in order to build it up with the fragments as best they may.

Mr. Mountain's "Summary of the Writings of Lactantius" (Rivingtons), is a useful analysis; but, we are obliged to add, the tone of divinity is far from Catholic; nay, far from Protestant, that is to say, if our Homilies may be considered such. For instance, the Homily says, "that merciful alms dealing is *profitable to purge the soul* from the infection or filthy spots of sin;" but our author speaks of it as the elements of the *fatal error* of Popery, "to speak of carnal sin as purged away by a course of good works," p. 80.

Reprints of several of Dr. Hook's works have been made in America, chiefly under the sanction of the well known Dr. Doane, Bishop of New Jersey.

We are glad to see that proposals have been put forward by Mr. Sherman of New York, for publishing, by subscription, "a Selection of the most interesting and valuable among the Writings that have appeared within a few years in England, and which are commonly known under the name of the Oxford Theology." The plan embraces as many as six to eight volumes 8vo., of 554 pages each, which are to be completed in weekly issues.

Dr. Pusey's second edition of the first of his three Tracts on Baptism has at length made its appearance, and the size sufficiently accounts for the delay. It is the most complete book on the subject we have in the language; and is already almost out of print again. His object seems to have been to bring together all that Scripture directly teaches concerning Baptism, and to show how this was understood by the early church, and in consequence how much higher a doctrine Scripture contains than is commonly supposed.

The Oxford Translations of St. Augustine's Confessions, and St. Cyril's Catechetical Lectures, have reached a second edition. The first edition consisted of 1500 copies. A volume of St. Chrysostom's Commentary on St. Paul's Epistles is on the point of publication.

"The Listener in Oxford" (Seeley and Burnside) observes, that "Evangelical religion has been the fashion; the tide is turned;" that "life is not long enough to examine all that we must receive or reject;" that "the religion of Christ is unchanged from the beginning;" that "it has never had so much as a new dress;" that "the Lamp that illuminates" the Door, "is not removable." This is

good Catholic language; but alas! the illusion is soon broken; the Listener confesses she is speaking against such a "Goliath" as "Southcote, Irving, or Pusey." Though a "*Listener* in Oxford," she says she "cannot speak personally of the present men," but she does know "how far from holiness such leaders usually are, how arrogant, how restless, how insubmissive and disorderly, how confident and boastful of themselves, how irascible and impatient of contradiction;" and she asks, "do these Oxford theologians believe in the Holy Spirit's agency at all in carrying on the work of salvation?" We would put it to a religious woman, is not all this random imputation against individuals whom she does not know, a sort of "bearing false witness against her neighbour?" People in their zeal forget this.

Dr. Hawley's work on "Genuine Christianity" (Lindsay, Edinburgh), begins with what we are obliged to call a dangerous principle, that Christian evidence and Christian doctrine are subjects "altogether distinct from each other," and that "the great principle, the division of labour" must "be applied" to theology; and defends it by the instance of Sir I. Newton, who, though a thorough believer in revelation, has been at length ascertained to have given "credit to the Arian heresy." We are sorry to find a speculation put forward, p. 60, which can only be *consistently* maintained by Sabellians or Nestorians, viz. that as the Word is incarnate in this world, so probably the "Supreme God rules every world He has made by an *emanation from Himself*, united with the highest intellectual being who inhabits that world." Hence he talks of "the Christ of each world." We are the more concerned at this, for the work is written in a tone of seriousness and earnestness, and contains express and satisfactory statements of the doctrine of the Trinity.

"Charlotte Elizabeth" has written some sentimental and dreamy pieces called "Glimpses of the Past," (Seeley and Burnside), and has been ambitious enough to introduce "the Reformation Society," "Protestantism," and the glorious '88, with a view of making *them* sentimental, dreamy, and poetical also. Protestantism takes the shape of King William on horseback in College Green, and the "innocent statue" is spoken of in a way to make us fear that sentiment was compromising Protestantism. Old Foxe is drawn writing his history "in a soft sheltered valley, where gurgles a pure spring, overhung with fair trees, from whose branches depend many a cluster of ripened fruit." "There he rests and ponders." The authoress has a little dog called Fidelle, which sneezes "most piteously" at a snuff-box; and she has sweet flowers which "a young minister calls her painted idols." She recounts her own experience; and makes mention of a house where "it was one of the special privileges allowed her to take every day a glass of wine actually made from the grapes that grew on the mountain of Lebanon."

The second edition of "A Text-book of Popery," by John Mockett Cramp, (Wightman), has in view especially "many influential members of the Protestant University of Oxford." It professes, according to the title-page, to give "a brief history of the Council of Trent," and "a complete view of Roman Catholic Theology." The "history" may be serviceable and the "view" is innocuous.

We have received what calls itself "The *Church* Edition of the, authenticated Report of the Discussion between the Rev. T. D. Gregg and the Rev. T. Maguire." Mr. Gregg came forward under the benediction and "God-speed" of "a *very large body* of the Clergy of the Established Church from *all parts* of Ireland," headed by the Archdeacon of Derry; who, without "identifying themselves with him in the controversy," still "felt bound to present him an assurance of their regard and prayers, commending him to God as a brother minister of their Church." This, it will be observed, was before the controversy. We do really think, now that they know what it has turned out, our brethren ought to clear themselves from all participation in so unchristian a contest. Never did we look into so unholy a book, not written by a professed libertine or scoffer. To take one of the

merely vulgar specimens: "Away with your wretched sophistry;" the Protestant champion says to his opponent; "Pray, how much salt would it take to make a hogshead of holy water? ... Now come, pray do, like a worthy priest of Belial as you are, do tell us how many holy candles it would take to drive away the devils that tempt a poor Irishman to get drunk? ... Now salt-blessor! ... I shall condescend to instruct you. Come, then, to my knee, thou mass-priest, and learn wisdom." Is this the style of St. Paul or Luther?

"Seals of the Covenant of Grace, by J. J. Cummins" (Seeley and Burnside), is a little work in recommendation of one of the coldest doctrines we know; that the office of the Sacraments is but to represent and pledge to us the blessings of redemption. We can understand persons being warmed and carried away by the doctrine of justification by mere faith; but to those who, having faith, have the *substance* of salvation, how impotent is the sacramental *figure*! what need we to be assured externally of what we already feel inwardly? and what assurance is there in a *sign* without, which is supposed to have no *sense* till interpreted by an assurance within? Either the Sacraments convey grace or they convey a cold comfort.

How melancholy to find an intelligent traveller like Mr. Fellowes deliberately publishing, in his "Journal of an Excursion in Asia Minor" (Murray), such a fanatical sentence as the following, "in architecture and in sculpture the cross is a brand always attended by deformity in proportion and total want of simplicity in ornament."—p. 169. Elsewhere he talks of temples "dedicated to *nominal* Christianity."—p. 288. He is enthusiastic in praise of the Turks; becomes "sincerely attached to their manners, habits, and character;" "to their truth, honesty, kindness," and "devotion to their religion." "Prayer is with them universal." "Every one pursues his own devotions, independently of a priesthood, which here does not exist, with perfect simplicity and without ostentation."—p. 294. On the other hand, he speaks of "the early Christians" as he might of "the early Egyptians," or "the Aborigines" of America, or fossil elephants or elks, beings with whom he can have no possible connexion; yet he shows no signs of being what would commonly be called an irreligious man,—the contrary.

Mr. Bickersteth's "Book of Private Devotions," or "Collection of Devotions of the Reformers and their Successors" (Seeley and Burnside), embraces under this title the prayers of Bishop Andrews, Archbishop Laud, Bishop Cosin, Bishop Kenn, Bishop Taylor, and Bishop Hicks. We were particularly pleased to find the compiler saying in his preface, that "he has from no book of devotions derived more personal advantage than from Bishop Andrews' Devotions." May he induce many to seek a like benefit from them!

"Light shining out of Darkness, by Rev. A. Roberts" (Nisbet), is the production of a thoughtful and reverential mind. It takes the form of a work of evidence drawn from the internal characteristics of the four Gospels; but this is only its form. It is really a thankful and edifying contemplation of the tokens they contain that a Divine Presence was with the writers, and an attempt to realize the scenes and to hold communion with the deeds and feelings, of which they are the record.

There is great deal apposite and pleasing in Mr. Woodward's "Shunammite, a Series of Lectures on 2 Kings, iv. 11-17" (Duncan and Malcolm), (e.g. vid. his remarks on the sanctity of St. Mary,) but we suppose his religious sentiments differ a good deal from those which we should feel it right to maintain.

A new edition has been published of Sir J. Stonehouse's "Sick Man's Friend" (Washbourne), a little book which, with a great deal which is good and useful, discovers a very low tone of theology and deplorably deficient views upon the Sacrament of the Lord's Supper.

We particularly recommend to our readers "Hymns, translated from the Parisian Breviary by

the author of the Cathedral," (Rivingtons). They are very beautiful, though as being detached from the services to which they belong, they are like Gothic cornices or finials torn from a church.

"Preparations for a Holy Life" (Hodson) is a convenient pocket selection of prayers and meditations answering to its titles.

Archdeacon Todd has published a brief but pleasing "Selection from Sandys' Metrical Paraphrases of the Psalms, Job, &c." (Rivingtons.)

Mr. Burgh's "Sermon on Antichrist, With an Appendix," (Holdsworth), is intended to show that Rev. xiii. does not apply to Rome Papal, and exposes some grievous mistakes of facts in Mr. M'Neile's historical proof that the Pope is Antichrist.

Dr. Duff, in his "Missions the chief end of the Christian Church" (Johnston, Edinburgh,) confesses and laments, what Mr. O'Connell has lately urged, that Protestantism, since its first burst, has lost its *expansiveness*.

We observe with much satisfaction that a theological controversy is opening between Mr. O'Connell and the Wesleyans. This is as it should be. They owe us a stand-up fight with the Romanists; and they could not possibly sit down under his rude attack on their founder.

We suppose the Correspondence between some Clergymen of Ripon and Lord Londonderry falls under the head of theological literature, and may be mentioned here. Not that a few words can do justice to it; but we do not like to omit expressing our thanks to the clergymen who took part in it. The church knows no difference between men of peace and men of war, noble and peasant. "The kings of the earth and the great men, and the rich men, and the chief captains, and the mighty men," must all bow down before her, and dutifully obey. It is no favour in Lord Londonderry to defend her with the sword, but a high privilege. The only drawback on our satisfaction in this proceeding is, that it was not a bishop who addressed him.

The "British Association" has celebrated its annual meeting at Birmingham, and under circumstances which show that the anticipation of its imminent declension, expressed by us in a recent number, are rapidly fulfilling. But we allude to the meeting, not for the purpose of mentioning this fact, but to show how far the dangerous tendencies of the body in question have now developed themselves. We would speak in blame of no individual—we censure systems—and strange must be the working of an institution which can lead a reverend president of the association, even in the act of formally defending its religious character, to assert that even the facts "that all men are the children of one human father and the handiwork of one Almighty God," would not be supported by evidence sufficient to claim the belief of this enlightened age without the testimony brought forward to sustain them by recent physical researches. We quote from the Athenæum, which may, and we would fain hope does, in some degree misrepresent the reverend speaker. We would fain hope that we ourselves misunderstood the report, but the following extracts will enable our readers, on this latter point, to judge for themselves.

"Scripture ... does provide for us, and has evidently aimed at providing for us, from the earliest times to the present hour, the knowledge of two facts; that all men are the children of one human father, and the handiwork of one Almighty God ... And what, gentlemen, is the common quality of these two facts? Are they not the very facts on which the system of human duty subsists, on which humanity and piety depend?

"These truths, gentlemen, nursed for a thousand years in the ancient Scriptures of the Jews, led forth into new day and with new accessions of the same kind of knowledge by our holy religion, have walked through the world, and been believed alike by the ignorant and the wise, before our sciences were born; and here observe the method and the course of Providence; how, as in

process of years the current of traditionary belief runs weaker,—how, as the advance of human intellect looks for other kinds of proof, the arts and sciences come in to support these essential truths; printing gives them stability and extension, optics and astronomy pour in an infinity of evidence, comparative anatomy brings up its convictions, and geology subdues the sceptical mind with hitherto unimagined demonstrations.

“And now, gentlemen, we are in a condition to draw an inductive conclusion, and even to hazard a prediction. We may safely predict that truths thus firmly established by evidence, will never be shaken by the researches of that reason which has hitherto lent them all its support; &c.”—*Athenæum*, No. 618, p. 654.

The association, it would seem, if the above be indeed an official declaration of its sentiments—feels that it has at last arrived at the happy period in which—whatever else may be doubted—these two simple tenets may be considered as irrefragably and definitely established. Such are the arduous points which it has at length attained, in the midst of a land long blessed with the full light of Christianity;—such the discoveries for which its labourers, in the conclusion of the speech under comment, are told to look for “the approbation and the blessing of the great Father of Truth.”

Notices of Books

[*British Critic*, January 1840.]

THE Dean of Christ Church has published (University Press) an edition of Theodoret's *Græcarum Affectionum Curatio*, with collations of Oxford and Paris MSS. Students in divinity are deeply indebted to this celebrated scholar for thus directing his labours to their benefit.

Mr. Dowling has published a valuable account of the various Collections of Ecclesiastical Treatises which have appeared since 1700 (Oxford, University Press).

Mr. Parkinson's Hulsean Lectures for 1838 (J. W. Parker) are on the following important subjects: the Authority and Inspiration of Scripture; Creeds; Articles of Religion; Liturgies and Rituals; Church Authority for restraining Error and propagating the Truth. It is, as this list of subjects shows, one of the most systematic works which have appeared of late years, and is well calculated to raise the tone of opinion in our theological schools.

Mr. Vaughan Thomas's Address delivered at the Birmingham Royal School of Medicine and Surgery (Parker, Oxford), is an erudite and luminous argument upon the connection of medical studies with revealed truth. It is intended as a “specification of the intentions of Dr. Warneford,” in endowing an annual prize essay in this institution.

Dr. Hook's Sermon, “The Gospel, and the Gospel only, the Basis of Education” (Rivingtons), is written with that author's usual strength and clearness. The words of his title are proposed as a substitute for that ill-timed and unfortunate watchword, “The Bible and the Bible only,” into which many well-intentioned Church people have been betrayed, and now find to their cost that “the ministers of the crown have taken them at their word,” and they have all the time been playing into the hands of the Socinians.

The same Author's Sermon on the “Novelties of Romanism” (Rivingtons), is not only a clear argumentative composition (perhaps the best of his publications), but written from the *heart*, with the power which earnestness gives. There is no one to whom the cause, of what are sometimes called High Church principles, is more indebted at this moment than Dr. Hook. Not to speak of the services of years past, he is now in the front of the battle, bearing the odium of others, and suffering for views and sentiments which inflict on them little inconvenience. As to the present Sermon, we

recommend it for distribution.

Mr. Norris's deeply interesting and affecting Sermon on the death of Archdeacon Watson (Rivingtons) will humble many a reader at his own inferiority to the picture drawn in it, and lift up his mind in humble thankfulness that our Church is not yet given over by her Divine Master. The Archdeacon's Charge, delivered in 1816, on "The Divine Commission with Perpetuity of the Christian Priesthood," has been reprinted, as being seasonable at this time.

Dr. Pusey has published a Sermon, preached at Brighton, on the Last Judgment (Rivingtons), which will be read, as every thing which comes from him, without notice from us.

Sermons have also been published by Bishop Russell on "The Historical Evidence for the Apostolical Institution of Episcopacy," (Edinburgh, Oliver and Boyd). By Dr. Hawkins, Provost of Oriel College, on "Church Extension," (Fellows). By Sir G. Prevost, on "Corruption and Schism hindering the free Course of the Gospel," (Rivingtons). By Chancellor Raikes, on "The Man of God," (Hatchard). By Precentor Lowe on "The Divine Commission and Authority of the Christian Priesthood," (Exeter, Spreat). By Mr. Medley, on "The Union of the Members in Christ's Body," (Exeter Hanneford). And by Mr. Moore on the "Church and Holy Scriptures," (Rivingtons).

We warmly recommend to notice Mr. Oakeley's Sermon on "Christ manifested to the Faithful through his Church" (Rivingtons), and Principal Le Bas's Sermon at Harlow (Rivingtons), on "The Uses of the Offering," with its introduction.

"The Church, a Gift of the Saviour" (Burns), a Sermon preached at Salford by Mr. A. Watson, shows much zeal for the truth and the whole truth.

"The System of the Church, and the consequent Obligations of her Ministers" (Rivingtons), a Visitation Sermon preached at Kendal by the Rev. R. P. Graves, sets forth the Church as a divine, harmonious, and a living system, only requiring to be acted upon; "a city that is at unity in itself." Perhaps we should say that the excellent writer approaches too near to the spirit of the last century in a certain contemplative admiration of the "Ordinances and Formularies" of the Church.

"The Unity and Holiness of the Church" has been treated in a somewhat warmer and more practical style, by Mr. William Dodd, at the visitation of the Archdeacon of Northumberland. We beg; by the way, to commend one passage to the notice of those who at once profess the creeds and decry all reserve: "The same Creed which declares that Jesus Christ was 'crucified for us,' teaches also that there is 'one Catholic and Apostolic Church,' and 'one baptism for the remission of sins.' We must preach the first doctrine; but we may not, as faithful and consistent Pastors, practise *Reserve* in regard to the others."

Two more Parts of the Oxford translations of the Fathers have lately made their appearance, containing St. Chrysostom's Comment on 1 Corinthians. The translators are Rev. H. K. Cornish, late Fellow of Exeter College, and Rev. John Medley, Vicar of St. Thomas's in the city of Exeter.

Dr. Byrth has published an Essay to prove that "The Fathers have no Authority to determine Articles of Faith." (Talboys). Who in the world, beyond the walls of Bethlem or St. Luke's, ever dreamed of maintaining that divines, who have been in their graves many centuries, could in this day *determine* anything! We suppose he means "no authority in our determining," a very different and a very paradoxical proposition.

Two more Volumes have been published of Mr. Froude's Remains; containing the compositions published by himself, or intended for publication. They are written in a grave, calm style, and appear to be mainly directed to the elucidation of one or two theological points—principally the nature of the Church of Christ, and its relation to the civil power.

Mr. Parker's (Oxford) Series of Theological and Religious Works, has been lately enriched

by several considerable additions; Bishop Sparrow's "Rationale," edited by Rev. G. Berkeley, of Pembroke College; Sutton's "Disce Vivere;" Wells' "Rich Man's Duty to contribute to Church Building &c.," and "Archbishop Laud's Autobiography," an interesting volume, carefully compiled from his Diary, history of his Chancellorship, and History of his Troubles and Trials. No other service is needed for this singleminded man's fame, than to exhibit him to the world in his own private thoughts and letters. These small volumes are beautifully "got-up," and some of them embellished in the headings and vacant spaces with small woodcuts, of great elegance both in design and execution.

We have to thank Mr. Paget for his republication of Bishop Patrick's "Treatise on Repenting and Fasting," (Parker, Oxford). It is a small volume, with a striking preface and well adapted for general use, where the important subject which it discusses has been forgotten.

"Presbyterian Rights Asserted" (Burns) is a defence from the pen of a vigorous writer, of the *rights of the presbyterate*, and deserves the serious consideration of all Churchmen. He draws attention to plain defects in our present Ecclesiastical system; whether he has gone to the bottom of the question we have not a clear view. If a Bishop is distant towards his Presbyters, as he complains, to the neglect of their *spiritual* rights, is not this because the latter have *legal* rights, which sometimes they are not slow to insist on, viz. that their benefice is their freehold &c. &c.? It is the *law* which creates jealousy and disunion between the orders of the hierarchy. If a Bishop treats his clergy as "his subjects," is not this because the clergy have not taught the laity that *they*, the laity, are his subjects, nor brought *them* forward on public occasions for his instruction and his blessing? Certainly the Bishop *is* a ruler, and if the clergy will turn the *ruled* into arbiters, judges, and patrons, *they* must become the ruled instead. Let them cease to rely on great men, or many men, but on their Bishop, and their Bishop will be strengthened to rule the great and the many, not them. There are some admirable remarks at the end of the pamphlet on the inconsiderate interference which is sometimes exercised in high quarters with the concerns and flocks of the parochial clergy.

The attack upon the Tracts for the Times, begun by Dr. Faussett, Margaret Professor, and continued by the Sun and Standard Newspapers, seems gently drawing to its end. It has travelled eastward. The controversy is at present in the hands of Sir Peter Laurie, who has addressed a letter to Mr. Cator on the subject of "Puseyism."

Mr. R. W. Evans has published a Series of Tales from the history of the Ancient British Church, (Rivingtons). They are written with his usual beauty. There are marks, however, of Lutheranism in them. Mr. Evans speaks as if the need of *forgiveness* were the one idea which haunted a spiritual mind ignorant of the Gospel. Why of forgiveness *alone*? Why not forgiveness *and* holiness? Surely unaided man is as destitute, and the awakened mind is as desirous, of one as of the other. Why separate what Scripture and our conscience join together? Nor can we go along with the views of this respected author about Augustine and his monks.

Mrs. Philps's "Short Reflections on the Gospels for every Sunday in the year; for the use of young People, and Sunday and all other Schools" (Rivingtons), is a very pleasing little work, addressed to children in a simple and affectionate manner, and at the same time with a well-weighed discretion in the practical advice, and a soundness and distinctness in the doctrine, not usually to be met with in such works.

"Delineations of Scripture Characters" (Nisbet), by Mrs. Frederick Montgomerie, presents the veriest contrast imaginable to the last-mentioned work. So far from being what its title pretends, it is, what Mr. Beamish has the candour to explain in the preface, a series of attacks on Catholic doctrines and usages, in the most petulant tone of feminine controversy.

"An Arrangement and Classification of the Psalms, by W. N. Darnell, B.D." (Rivingtons), is made with a view to render them more intelligible and easy as a manual for private devotion. Accordingly Mr. Darnell divides them into Prayers, Thanksgivings, Praises, Instructions, Prophecies, and Histories. Many persons will feel the benefit of such a disposition of them, and will thank him for having made it.

Rev. E. Ramsay's "Catechism for St. John the Evangelist's, Edinburg" (Grants), is a careful, orthodox, and serviceable expansion of the Church Catechism, admirable on some points of doctrine, but not so definite on others as we could desire from a clergyman of Mr. Ramsay's reputation.

A reprint has appeared of "The Service for November 5, as revised and passed in Convocation, April 26, 1662, being the only form authorized by the Church or recognized by the State." (Oxford, Parker.)

The "Protestant Exiles of Zillerthal," translated from the German by John B. Saunders (Hatchards) are drawn in a frontispiece, sitting on a bench as if to be looked at, and bearing themselves independent and magnanimous accordingly. Thus we wrote when we opened at the title-page; but the most strange thing was to find, when we got as far as p. 4, that this attitude, if we understand the author rightly, is intended to represent them at their prayers. And sure enough their hands *are* clasped. We intend nothing unkind against these poor people themselves, about whom a book like this does not enable us to judge, but it is miserable to find them used for a party purpose, as if to impart some positive shape and substance to negative principles.

Mr. Robert Anderson has written a few pages in a calm and pleasing strain of reflection, with the title, "The Book of Common Prayer, a Manual of Christian Fellowship." (Hatchard). He explains its design to be to circulate in a popular and inviting form, the substance of Bishop Jebb's remarks on the truly Catholic spirit of our Church. We are, however, tempted to ask why he *begins* with quoting an observation of the able Mr. Taylor, in his Physical Theory of Another Life? The words quoted are, we will venture to say, the least useful and intelligible in the whole book: and are after all, when understood, what nobody in his senses ever doubted; and certainly the name of this writer looks rather out of place in pages which quote Bramhall, A. Knox, the Collect For All Saints day, the Prayer for the Church militant, the Burial Service, Vincentius, and Mr. Manning on the Rule of Faith.

"The Popery of Methodism" (Burns) is a well intentioned but not a discrete and sober publication. The author or compiler, who makes use of Bishop Lavington, implies blame of Mr. Whitfield for fasting twice a week, and Mr. Wesley for sleeping on the floor; and St. Francis for eating bitter herbs without oil. And he compares St. Philip Neri to Thomas Kitchens, a tinner. There is subjoined an excellent and striking selection of "reasons" against separating from the English Church, in Mr. Wesley's words.

Mr. H. Fox Talbot's "Antiquity of the Book of Genesis" (Longman), is written in an excellent spirit, and contains curious matter, though we do not quite like the plan of appealing to collateral evidence in proof of the divine authority of the Pentateuch, instead of resting it on our Lord's Word.

Mr. Baylee's "Institutions of the Church of England" (Dublin, Curry,) is the work of a quick and apprehensive mind, brought up in Dissent but now a clergyman connected with the "Missionary Settlement at Achil," and conceiving, perhaps rashly, that *though*, or (as he would say) *since* he once was wrong now he is certainly right. His volume is mainly directed against such Dissenters as denounce the Church of England "as Babylon," "parallelize her ministers with Apostate Rome;" state as their "deliberate conviction that the *notion* of a clergyman is the sin against the Holy Ghost;"

and that at the Reformation the king did but “take the place of the Pope.” We have come across one passage in his Appendix which astonished us, from a writer apparently so serious. “*Barnabus* and *Clement* are made *honourable mention* of in the New Testament.” The author goes on to say, that their works prove that piety is no safe-guard against error.” This of St. Barnabas the Apostle! We had rather belong to the Church which he is so eager to repudiate, than write such a sentence.

Mr. R. C. Sewell’s “*Viindiciæ Ecclesiasticæ*” (Longman), is a legal and historical argument, conducted with great learning, against the abolition of Bishops’ Courts. No common man has the reading on the subject treated of, to venture a judgment on a work such as this. All we can say is, that it abounds with instruction for those who wish information on its important subject.

The Church Pastoral Aid Society is developing its episcopal functions, as the following magnificent circular will show: —

“Temple Chambers, Falcon Court, Fleet Street,
September, 1839.

“Rev. Sir,

“The committee of the Church Pastoral Aid Society having anxiously reviewed its resources and operations, with reference to the various and accumulating claims upon its funds, *are convinced of the necessity of more effort* to make known its important designs and operations in order to obtain the support of the members of the Church of England, and have *resolved* that the clergy, aided by the society, *be informed* that it is *thought reasonable* that wherever the Society’s assistance is extended, there, *at least*, should its *claims be stated and a sermon be annually*” (*annually* scored in the original) “preached in its behalf.

“We are accordingly desired most respectfully and urgently *to solicit of you this proof of your appreciation* of the *great objects* of this society, and of the *aid* it has extended to your parish. If you are among those who have already taken the course suggested, the committee beg you will accept their grateful acknowledgments; but if not, *they trust the present year will not pass* without your affording to your parishioners an opportunity of uniting in the good work which this society is instrumental in carrying forward to the glory of God and the welfare of our country.

“Although collections after sermons on Sundays are generally most *productive*, the committee *will be content and thankful* if any other day most convenient and desirable in your judgment be adopted, and whatever be the amount of collection, *they will feel grateful*, receiving it as of Him ‘from whom all good things do come.’ Their single anxiety is that the *means* be used, and the *issue* they humbly leave to God.

“In regard to the advocacy of the society’s cause, the committee will, if required, render every help in their power; but *they would very much prefer* that each incumbent aided, should in his own pulpit state its claims.

“If the society’s papers (as enclosed) be put into the pews on a Sunday, with notice given that on the ensuing Sunday or other day a collection will be made, a *simple appeal to the hearts of the people* for the sake of Christ and for their country’s weal, *will*, under the divine blessing, be productive of cheerful contributions towards carrying on the beneficial designs and operations of this society.

“Another important result may be traced to sermons on behalf of this society. Its papers and operations convey information to the people on the condition of their country, the inadequacy of the means of the clergy, and the necessity of a better provision for carrying out efficiently the objects of the Established Church, and while its aid tends to forward the designs of every kindred institution, it directly influences the public mind to seek at the hands of the legislature due national provision for Church extension, commensurate with the wants of our population.

"We are, Rev. Sir,
Very faithfully Your's,
JOHN HARDING,
NADIR BAXTER,
FRED. SANDOZ,
Hon. Secs."

Notices of Books

[*British Critic*, April 1840.]

BISHOP MANT has added to his unwearied services in behalf of the Established Church of the sister country, by publishing an elaborate "History of the Church of Ireland, from the Reformation to the Revolution" (Parker). It is a work of much research, and its venerable author's principles are too well known to need any account here of the ecclesiastical views upon which its materials are disposed.

A third edition of Dr. Wordsworth's "Ecclesiastical Biography" (Rivingtons), has appeared with important alterations. The life of Philip Henry has been omitted, partly in deference to the feeling that its value does not compensate for its length, and that its character and subject are unsuitable to the leading design of the work. "The new lives adopted are only two. The first a short account of Dean Colet, founder of St. Paul's School, consisting of extracts, brought together from sundry letters of Colet's friend, Erasmus: and the other is an interesting narrative by himself, of the troubles of Thomas Mountain, a London clergyman, published by Strype, from Fox's papers." A two-fold introduction has been added, containing a history of the corruptions of popery, derived from Dr. Job Inett's Church History, and from Dr. Richard Bentley's Fifth of November Sermon. This new appendage is designed to show, that while we are theoretically bound to admire, we are in a practical point of view equally bound not to imitate "the early champions of respiring freedom and truth." This important collection is undoubtedly more consistent in its new shape; and the great number of notes added will proportionably increase its value as a book of reference. We are not sure, however, but that the venerated author has somewhat narrowed his ground, at least in appearance, for in reality the alteration is not so considerable. He has excluded a good many pages of Non-conformity, and supplied their places with *æquuntum sufficit* of the more sober, more discreet, and better favored, but perhaps, on the whole, less interesting material of Protestantism.

Archdeacon Hale has selected and edited some of Bishop Hall's Epistles (Rivingtons) on subjects especially adapted for seasons of affliction. He has printed them in a large type, for the use of the aged and the sick.

Mr. Todd's "Lectures on the Prophecies relating to Antichrist" (Dublin, University Press), are too valuable and important to admit of any notice here, except that of their publication, which has been anxiously expected for some months.

We are glad to announce the publication of several of the series called "The Englishman's Library" (Burns), edited by Mr. Churton and Mr. Gresley, viz. Dean Howard's Scripture History; Bishop Patrick's Parable of the Pilgrim, edited by Mr. Chamberlain; Mr. Gresley's Clement Walton; Mr. Chamberlain's Help to Knowledge; and Mr. Palmer's history of the Church. The last of these is an especial boon to Churchmen at this time. It consists of a series of beautiful sketches of holy men in every age of Christianity; and thus it supplies a desideratum which has long been felt in our religious literature, of a history of the Church, pious and interesting like Milner's, yet on deeper and truer theological views. Like Milner, the author holds himself at liberty to drop such parts of

characters or facts as he considers not to conduce to edification.

We rejoice to see a reprint of "Bishop Ken's Practice of Divine Love, or Exposition of the Church Catechism" (Burns). Such a book requires no recommendation from us.

Also a new edition has appeared (Parker, Oxford) of "Bishop Ken's Prayers for Winchester Scholars," signed and dated "G. M. Winchester."

A new number of the "Tracts for the Times," No. 87, is on the point of making its appearance, being a second Tract upon Reserve. This will be an advance towards completing the fifth volume, and from its subject cannot fail to attract attention.

The papers which appeared in the British Magazine, under the title of "The Church of the Fathers," have been published in a duodecimo volume (Rivingtons), with some additions. The writer almost confines his sketches to the fourth century.

Mr. Merewether, of Cole Orton, has published "Strictures on Mr. Benson's Sermons on Tradition and Episcopacy" (Rivingtons). They are learned, courteous, and convincing.

The celebrity of the Reverend R. I. Wilberforce's "Second Letter to Lord Lansdowne" (Hatchards) has outstripped a quarterly publication like this. It is already well known, from the large extracts which have been made from it in newspapers. It is written with great spirit and effectiveness. We wish he had not called the Roman system "the great imposture;" though of course those who accuse others of excessive language respecting Rome, should be sure they have never at any time used it themselves, which few indeed can boast at this day.

An admirable letter in the best tone has been addressed to the Bishops of Exeter and Salisbury, by Mr. A. Acland, on the present state of religious societies, and the *mode* of obtaining contributions in aid of Christian objects. Mr. Acland suggests the revival of the practice of inviting the alms of the congregation, whether at the offertory, or by collections at the church-door, on every Sunday. And he lays down the principle that "the Church is the appointed channel of public Christian charity. Our alms and oblations belong to the Church, and are through the Church to be offered to God." The pamphlet has come to a second edition; other writers, some of name, have lately been advocating the same views; and the American Church is setting us the example. There is promise in all this.

We are very glad to notice an interesting tract on "Restitution to the Church a sacred Duty" (Burns), as it shows the higher and juster views on ecclesiastical subjects which are coming into light. The writer would have the Parliament, as entrusted with the revenues of the crown, restore to the Church all the crown plunder; and he hopes that, if private impropiators showed a spirit of restitution, Parliament might be induced to interfere, and award them compensation, as in the case of the West India slaveholders.

We are very sorry to have to notice a work of Mr. Steven, with an unobjectionable title, indeed, "The Spirit of the Church of Rome" (Hastings), but a most objectionable vignette in the title-page—a crucifix, a mitre, a bible, crosier, a whip, a chain, and a pair of hand-cuffs. We fear, however, it is a compliment to call this a fair specimen of the work itself.

A very remarkable volume of Sermons has been published, the writing of the late Mr. Vaughan of Leicester. We do not pretend to have studied every part of it, nor to assent to or approve every word that it contains; but wherever we have read it, we have been struck by evidences of original thought, and a startling anticipation of statements made on one side of certain controversies now pending among us.

"The Irish Pulpit" (Curry and Co.) contains as much eloquence and affectionateness as most importations from that quarter, and rather more soundness and discretion.

Mr. Melville's "Sermons preached at Cambridge, in November, 1839," are composed with his usual fertility of thought and expression. But with all due respect for his talents, we are constrained to say, that we lament the publication of his Sermon, preached at Brighton, on "Angels rejoicing in the Gospel" (Rivingtons). What a pity that a mind so rich and brilliant has not been submitted to the chastening and refining discipline of St. Basil and St. Gregory!

Mr. H. Wilberforce has published, by request, a beautiful Sermon (Rivingtons), on occasion of the rebuilding of the ancient Church of St. Laurence, in Southampton.

Mr. Kynaston's Sermon on "Church Extension," preached at Lichfield, is in many respects worthy of the high reputation with which its author left the University. If Mr. Kynaston takes care always to attend to the meaning of what he says, he will not only be a very fluent, but a really eloquent, writer. For instance, how can the Dissenters be like St. John the Baptist, or the Apostles, in any stage of their ministry? Does Mr. Kynaston mean to maintain that they are not only divinely permitted, but commissioned?

A Sermon of much promise has been published at Launceston (Rivingtons), by command of the Bishop of Exeter, before whom it was preached by Mr. Gibbons. It is full of excellent doctrine, put forth with much animation.

Rev. H. Townsend Powell, of Stretton, has been engaged in an active controversy with the Roman Catholics, the fruits of which are given to the public in "A Letter and Historical Table" (Hamilton and Adams), got up with great care, and likely to be very useful to minds of a certain character. His excellent and important object is to show that the Church of England had not "its origin in the Reformation," nor "her ministers derive their authority from the king." On the Table is drawn out the progress of our Reformation from the 20th of Henry VIII. to the 11th of Elizabeth, with the contemporaneous line of reformed and unreformed Bishops.

Rev. Kirby Trimmer's "Curate's Manual" (Rivingtons) begins with a translation of Mr. Stearne's Latin work on the Visitation of the Sick, a useful work for those who need such a help. The offices for Private Baptism and Sick Communion follow, and extracts from Stonehouse's "Sick Man's Friend," which we do not very much like. The greater part of the volume, however, seems to be original. We hope it may do all the good which the pious writer desires from it.

Some well written and useful weekly tracts and tales have been put out at Leeds, under the sanction of the Bishop of Ripon (Burns).

A very pretty book for children has been published by a Clergyman, under the name of "Agathos and other Sunday Stories" (Seeley and Burnside). It is written with a wise object and on unexceptionable principles. We are not satisfied with the Greek names from "Agathos" down to "Edone."

"The Liturgy of the Church of England catechetically explained by Mrs. S. Maddock" (Nisbett), is a useful and well-principled little book, which those who need such a work will be thankful to have heard of. Mrs. Cuthbert's "Practical Exposition of the Church Catechism" (Rivingtons), is a work of similar excellence.

"The Ecclesiastical Almanac for 1840" (Leslie) has many improvements upon that of the former year. Rules are given for fasting and abstinence, as revived in the great body of Western Christendom; and biographical notices of the Saints who are named in the calendar. We do not altogether subscribe to some things in these accounts, particularly the cold and unfair mention which is made of King Charles, under January 30. But on the whole this small publication will be welcome to all ritualists; and as such we have noticed it in an early place in the number.

A Prayer Book for private use or for a family has been published (Graham, Oxford) under the

title of "Christian Catholic Prayers." It is compiled on the truest and best model of devotion, that of the Breviary and Church Prayer Book.

Mr. H. W. Acland, of Christ Church, being obliged to voyage for his health, has profitably employed his time in preparing a most striking panoramic drawing of the Plains of Troy, taken on the spot, and a map constructed after the latest survey. Classical students will thank us for the information.

As far as a superficial survey will allow us to judge, Dr. Giles' new Greek Lexicon (Longman) appears to be, in some respects, an improvement on our old school manuals. A good deal of useless matter has been got rid of in the Greek-English part; and room thus made for an English-Greek Lexicon much fuller than usual, a great help of course in the first steps to Greek composition. The substitution of English for Latin is a questionable advantage, which we have not here space to observe upon.

J. T. Smith's "Comparative View of Ancient History" (Souter, Fleet Street) brings into a few pages a good deal of space and time. In the course of his chronological observations occur some curious notes on the elective character of the crown of England. One passage we will quote: "So much was this the case, that the chronicler of Henry II., alluding to the length of time between Stephen's death and Henry's recognition, says, 'England was therefore without a king for six weeks.'"

The "New General Biographical Dictionary" (Fellowes) has advanced to the Fourth Part with the same spirit and variety as at the first. The work does not seem likely to exceed the compass originally intended.

"The Glossary of Architecture" (Parker, Oxford), which so rapidly passed through two editions a year or two ago, has now appeared in a third. It has grown into two volumes, the second of which consists of plates. It is beautifully illustrated, and contains as many as 700 woodcuts. Articles are added on domestic architecture, stained glass (under the title "Window"), &c.

A classical and elegant writer, under the title of "Vigornensis," has published an "Historical Review of the Nature and Result of Vaccination" (Rivingtons), which we recommend to all persons who wish at once entertainment and instruction on that important subject. We wish, however, he had not put the discovery of vaccination above "the gold of Ophir, the precious onyx, and the sapphire stone."—p. 95.

The "Chapters on the Modern History of British India," by Edward Thornton, Esq. (Allen), present as exclusively a story of war as Cæsar's Commentaries. They forcibly remind us of the one fatal condition on which we have obtained and now hold that vast empire, viz. the denial before men of the name of Christ.

The "Travels in South-Eastern Asia," by Mr. Malcom, an American Baptist missionary (Tilt), contain so much curious matter as to deserve a larger notice than we have room for. They give an incredibly discouraging account of the prospects of Christianity in the East, and the unchristian policy and practice of the Europeans. Is it possible that our government has, as he states, appointed a Unitarian preacher "to visit various parts of India, and to report on the state of education?"

Dr. Wolff is a person whose merits will be better appreciated when time has softened the effect of his eccentricities, and placed him beyond the reach of vacillation or change. The censures which his "Journal" has drawn on him from the enemies of right Church principles, supersede the necessity of commendation from us. That very interesting, though desultory, book, fully establishes and accounts for the fact, that the present state of the writer's views is the result of his own experience.

"The Oriental Annual for 1840" (Tilt) is a most splendid drawing-room ornament. The beautiful

engravings impress us more strongly than ever with the affinity of the Indian or Mahomeddan architecture to the Gothic or Catholic, as though they had diverged from the common stock of the Roman.

Mr. Plumpton Wilson's "Christian Services" (Murray) vies with the last-mentioned publication in external magnificence. The author can hardly expect many to acquiesce in his plan, which is to make the book of Genesis the historical framework of a weekly course of devotions.

The "Poems by Eliza Cook" (Tilt), possess great sweetness and spirit; but the subjects are not always well chosen, and the religion, with an indication here and there of something better, is in general that of Pope's Universal Prayer.

Mr. Riddle has published (Parker, Strand) "A Manual of Christian Antiquities," professedly on the plan of those well-known school books, the Antiquities of Greece and Rome, treating the ceremonies and institutions of the primitive Church, "not only independent of polemics, but apart from the general materials of Church history." The utility of this plan appears to us very questionable, being likely to give a mere antiquarian, low, and superficial knowledge of a most important subject. Yet Mr. Riddle has intruded into polemical questions, and in the following tone: "We may reasonably believe that episcopacy is a Divine institution; but we have no right to contend that it is the only system to which that honour is attached." Again, of the Athanasian Creed, "Indeed, if our Church should resolve upon altogether expunging the clauses commonly called condemnatory, it is possible that the cause of truth would suffer no detriment."

"Extracts from Holy Writ and various Authors, for Soldiers and Seamen, by Captain Sir W. Willoughby," is a pious and well-intentioned compilation from a very heterogeneous set of authors, Sturm, Tillotson, Jay, Bogatzky, Hawker, à Kempis, H. More, Newton, Watts, Mason, the Prayer Book, Horne, Locke, Hall, and Stillingfleet.

Mr. Wackerbath has drawn attention, partly in his own words, partly in those of a friend, to Dr. Croly's Visitation Sermon, in a pamphlet called "The alleged Connection between the Church of England and Lutheranism examined" (J. W. Parker). We must confess we were quite astounded, though not wishing to use great words, at Dr. Croly's view, which if held consistently (which doubtless it is not by him), differs little or nothing *in its fundamental principle* from Mahometanism, Neologianism, or St. Simonianism. He conceives that Protestantism is a *new interposition* upon Christianity, as Christianity upon Judaism. "It is true," as says one of the writers before us, "Dr. Croly affirms that he does not intend to assert that there have been three revelations, but in spite of this, the whole scope and tenor of the sermon leans to such a conclusion. 'Such,' he says, 'are the tremendous cycles by which Omnipotence rounds its career. The concurrence, the similitude, the almost identity of the originating circumstances of Judaism, Christianity, and Protestantism, is beyond all question.'" Dr. Croly then contrasts, we still extract from the pamphlet, the second and third interpretation thus: *Second*, "In Christianity, the Son of Man came as an obscure Israelite, wholly unconnected with the public excitement of the times, and a priest of the order of Melchizedek. His religion was subsequently transmitted into the hands of the first Christian emperor, and it was embodied in the Established Church of the empire." *Third*, "The German Reformation commenced with the agency of Luther, a priest, a monk of the Augustinian order. On him the new delivery of the Gospel devolved; its protection on a British sovereign; its duties on the Church of England, the chief among the Churches of Protestantism." What portentous language is this? What does it omen? What is coming on us? And this in St. Paul's Cathedral. And the Sermon has reached a fourth edition.

William Smith, Esq. author of "A Discourse on Ethics of the School of Paley" (Pickering), says

"The only immutable morality is this, that the happiness of all be protected and cultivated,"

"Questions and Answers for Young People of the Church of England, to guard them against its Enemies. By a Layman. 6th edit. 1st edition, 1838, one year before 'the Glory departed from Israel'" (Rooke and Varty), is, as the title would dispose one to consider, bold and zealous, with some oddities. The proposition to baptize or confirm all foreign princes and princesses (not episcopalian) into the Reformed Catholic Church of England, before marrying into our royal family, besides its questionableness in a theological point of view, would, we fear, lead to frequent profanations of the sacrament.

"John Brown, D. D. Minister of the United Associate Congregation, Broughton Place, Edinburgh, and Professor of Exegetical Theology to the United Secession Church," to judge from his pleonastic and at the same time self-contradictory titles, must by this time be quite *au fait* at all questions of submission and resistance. His "Supplementary Notes to The Law of Christ respecting Civil Obedience, especially the Payment of Tribute," is a collection of some hundred passages from all sorts of authors strung together, like prisoners of war tied to their captors on a march. By way of a frontispiece, Hooker is introduced, handcuffed to Hoadley: then come in Pope, Wickliffe, Herodotus, Jeremy Taylor, Hume, Hammond, T. Cartwright, Bishop Butler, Priestley, Holy Scriptures, T. B. Macauley, Froude, Gibbon, &c. &c. Mr. Gladstone's book appears to be the spark which has exploded this miscellaneous magazine of combustibles.

Mr. Edward Swaine considers that "Dissent wears no sword," and "the principle of Dissent is its shield;" and therefore he has composed a book called "The Shield of Dissent," with strictures on Dr. Brown's work on Tribute (Snow), but without "ambitious and general championship." This, if put into our language, would be that Dissent is a negative principle, which creates nothing, simply undoes, like discontent or lukewarmness. In the author's language it seems to come to this, that *while* a man keeps to the dissenting *principle*, he cannot be forced to *advance* forward to Church practice. "Under shelter of its *principle*," he says, "it is prepared for all attacks that *argument* may deal with." The drift of the work then is to show that the said principle is not open to certain objections which has been urged against it.

We find that in the frontispiece to Mr. Saunders's account of the Protestant exiles of Zillerthal, noticed in our last number, it is intended to represent them, not as Protestant exiles, but as Catholic inhabitants of the country.

It is a great relief; that Professor Lee's Hebrew Lexicon has at length appeared, and all will sympathize with him in the afflictions and attendant ill-health which delayed it. For the beginner it is of especial value, as giving him the advantages of the modern German Lexica (in the comparison of the cognate dialects), without the neology which more or less is found in them, and with which we should be sorry that a young mind should be familiarized, even while rejecting it. Professor Lee's name is, moreover, a guarantee of a sounder and more thorough acquaintance with Arabic, than is possessed even by Gesenius. We hope, however, that Professor Lee's health will permit him to make this the basis of a larger work, which may bear the same relation to this as Gesenius' Thesaurus to his Lexicon. Even for this lexicon we should have desired a different arrangement (the old way of classifying derivatives under their roots was much more beneficial even to the learner than the strictly alphabetical method, which Gesenius introduced into his manuals, while for more advanced study it may be said to be indispensable); but chiefly we should have desired to have had from Professor Lee a fuller illustration from the cognate dialects than the nature of a manual admits; and we should have been glad also of a fuller notice of common words in passages where their

meaning is doubtful. (To explain our meaning by cases which occur at the moment, ²⁵ (Eccl. v. 7), which we doubt not refers to Almighty God; the meaning of ²⁶ (Eccl. v. 8); whether ²⁷ (Eccl.) signify "uprightness," or only (as Professor Lee gives it) "prosperity, profit;" the meaning of ²⁸ (Eccl. xiii. 11), which some have explained as in apposition to the "nails," "firmly joining;" others "authors of collections;" the English version, "masters of the assemblies;" which we should adopt, only with a different construction. "The masters of the assemblies have been given by One Shepherd," i.e. the teachers set over the Church, though many, have been given by the One Shepherd of Israel, and, though many, speak one voice. Professor Lee has only "collections, i.e. of stores or money, or, as some think, storehouses." The Latin Vulgate, "a council or assembly of persons.") Professor Lee, we infer from the preface, made the Concordance the basis of his labours, referring continually to the Biblical text (which is manifestly the only way); we only wish that he would, in a larger work, pursue this plan more fully; enter more into discussion than was admissible in a manual; explain more fully the meaning of ordinary words (to us the space assigned to words of natural history or antiquities, which are the least important, seems rather disproportioned); insert the proper names, which often throw light on other words; give summaries, at least, of statements, where he now simply refers to his Commentary on Job, or his Sermons; and lastly, give us more of his treasures of Arabic knowledge. We could not but think that his Commentary on Job contained much which was more suited to a lexicon, and which we should have liked to have seen transferred thither. There are also some few things, which we need not specify here, which we should be glad to see omitted; nor do we think the continual correction of Gesenius necessary; it takes much space, and is an unpleasant way of giving information: it is better to teach truth positively than negatively; error often finds its way into the unsound mind by means of the refutation. However, whether Professor Lee be willing or be enabled to undertake this larger work, we are much indebted to him for one which we can put safely into the hands of students, and from which the more advanced may learn.

Notices of Books

[*British Critic*, July 1840.]

ONE of the most remarkable publications of this quarter is Mr. Blunt's "Introduction to his Course of Lectures on the early Fathers" (Parker). When such clear and forcible statements of truth come from a divine in the station of the Margaret Professor of the University of Cambridge, what result may we not, under a divine blessing, expect?

Nor is Dublin behind her sister University. Two very eloquent Sermons on "Church Education in Ireland" (Fraser), have been published by Professor Butler, of Trinity College. They are a noble witness to Catholic doctrines, and cannot fail, we should trust, of promoting it.

The Reverend J. C. Crosthwaite has published a volume of Sermons (Rivingtons), which, as all which comes from his pen, is valuable and instructive. We particularly recommend for the attention of thoughtful persons the two Sermons upon the Doctrine of the Holy Trinity.

Mr. Palmer, of Worcester, the well-known author of the "Origines Liturgicæ," has added to his other services to our Church by publishing "Episcopacy Vindicated" (Rivingtons), in answer to some papers of Dr. Wiseman, in which he takes that gentleman's own ground, descending into the details of historical facts, and occupying a position from which it is quite impossible for an

²⁵

²⁶

²⁷

²⁸

opponent to dislodge him. In its form it may be mistaken for a defence of the Tracts for the Times, but the substance of the work looks far beyond any ephemeral or local object.

The speech of Mr. Palmer, of Magdalen, read at the May meeting of the Christian Knowledge Society (Rivingtons), is said to have made a great impression on its hearers, and will not make less on its attentive readers. Of course it will be spoken against, but it has that in it which will outweigh many critics.

A very pleasing little work has been sent us, consisting of Poems, by Members of Magdalen School, Oxford. "They are the production," says the Preface, of a few members of a school consisting of not more than twenty scholars, and none of the authors are above sixteen years of age."

Mr. F. W. Faber, of University College, has published a Second Series of eloquent and beautiful "Tracts on the Church and Prayer-Book" (Rivingtons). They are well adapted to interest and improve a large class of persons; the only fear is, lest people should be so interested as to forget to be improved.

We beg to direct the attention of our readers to a well-timed work, which we know to have been compiled with great diligence, and with a strong conviction of the practical importance of the subject. We mean "A Series of Documents and Authorities on the Duty, Advantage, and Necessity of Public Catechizing in the Church," by the Reverend John Ley, Fellow of Exeter College, Oxford, to whom we are indebted for the republication of Bishop Beveridge's work on the Church Catechism.

"Christian Catholic Prayer" (Graham, Oxford), is for a family or individual; it consists of forms for morning, six, nine, twelve, and three o'clock; evening, bed-time, midnight, and on the eve of the Holy Communion. In saying that they answer to their title, we say as much of them as their author can desire. We heartily wish them extended circulation.

Mr. Marriott's Lecture, delivered at the Diocesan College, Chichester (Mason, Chichester), has about it a reality and moral strength which argues well for the society committed to his superintendence.

Mr. Brewer has edited that serviceable work, Bishop Cosin's "History of Popish Transubstantiation" (Leslie), and has printed the authorities at full length. He has subjoined a curious account, now for the first time printed from a MS. of Cosin's in the Bodleian Library, of two Conferences held between the Church and the Puritan parties, on the subject of Montague's celebrated "Gagger gagged."

Mr. Churton's "History of the Early English Church" (Burns), forms a volume of the Series called "The Englishman's Library." We need not say that, as coming from him, it is a work of much learning and judgment. It contains in a small space a great deal of information which it is difficult otherwise to obtain; and by its candid and temperate tone will do good service by disposing ecclesiastical students to more catholic views of theology.

Mr. Selwyn has continued his "Attempt to Investigate the true Principles of Cathedral Reform" (Parker), in a Second Part, which we hardly like to notice in this brief way, but which his name will recommend too powerfully to need any other.

"The Old Paths," by the Reverend J. B. Pratt, of Cruden (Rivingtons), is a Treatise on the Notes of the Church, in defence of what the author not very happily calls "the Protestant Episcopal" or "Protestant Catholic Church," meaning by "Protestant," "true, primitive, or apostolic."—p. 209. It is a learned, careful, and instructive work, though we do not agree with all the author says concerning the Church of Rome.

We cordially recommend Mr. A. Acland's "Liturgia Domestica, or Morning and Evening

Services for the Use of Families" (Rivingtons). It is far the most systematic work of the kind which has appeared, and cannot, we feel sure, be used without tending, through God's blessing, to form the minds of those who use it upon a Catholic model of devotion. It contains a great deal in a short compass.

We are glad to see a reprint of Bishop Jolly's Treatise on "Baptismal Regeneration" (Burns). It forms one of a series, which we like altogether, except its motto, "Evangelic Truth and Apostolic Order."

In "Outlines of Church history" (Seeley and Burnside), we have a proof of the growing interest in ecclesiastical history in the least promising quarter. It is a mildly written work, following the general hypothesis attempted by Milner, that Athanasius and Basil go off into the Paulicians and Protestants in essence, and into the Papacy in accidents.

We have read with pleasure Mr. Skinner's excellent Letter to Lord Uxbridge, on the Observance of Lent (Burns), occasioned by recent occurrences. These occurrences will have conferred on the Church a benefit, as others of a similar nature have done before them, if they elicit such reflections and such protests from Churchmen.

The Reverend G. A. Poole, of Leeds, has published an excellent pamphlet (Burns) on "The Anglo-catholic use of Two Lights upon the Altar," which demands an answer from those who find fault with the observance.

Mr. Mac Neile has succeeded Dr. Chalmers in what he considers the "chair" (p. 7) of Lecturer to the Christian Influence Society. He proposes in his Lectures, which have been published (Hatchard), to prove that "our venerated Church Establishment" (p. vii), which he calls "Cranmerism" (p. 264), is not only an instrument of popular instruction, "the most economical, and in every practical point of view safest and most efficient" (p. 2), but that it is "*scriptural*" (p. 5). The author goes through a number of important subjects, such as the power of the keys and the indefectibility of the Church. On the whole, however, the book seems to us flat, though there is a good deal of bustle in it; but this may be because we do not agree with it.

Bishop Doane, of New Jersey, has given in a funeral sermon a very full and touching account of Mr. Winslow, the assistant to his lordship in the rectory of St. Mary's.

Mr. Craufurd's Sermons (Duncan and Malcolm) are published with a view of "augmenting the funds raised for the purpose of re-building the author's parish Church, and erecting a new Church in a distant part of the parish." They contain far more matter and thought than is usual in parish Sermons; we are not always satisfied with the style or the quotations.

"Clark's Plain Sermons" (Hatchard) are the animated and pleasing compositions of a young man. They are on general subjects. Some things in them we could have wished otherwise.

The best recommendation of "Sermons by the Reverend H. Jelly" (Rivingtons) is, that they are unlike the common run of sermons. They are plain and simple, and discuss a number of important subjects.

Two Sermons have been published by Mr. Oakeley, on the Dignity and Claims of the Suffering Poor (Burns), which should be read in connection with the Article in this Number of our Review.

Mr. Walker's Sermon on the "Way which they call heresy" (Richardson, Newcastle), is a manly defence of Gospel truth against the Puritanism and Erastianism of the age.

Many of our readers will be glad to be told of an edition of the Psalter (Burns), *pointed for chanting*. It is small and cheap, and includes the hymns, canticles, &c.

We have been favoured with a sight of a very interesting collection of "Prolusiones Literariæ," recited this year in St. Paul's School. We have seldom read a little work of the sort which has so

pleased us.

Two Letters (Rivingtons) have been addressed, in a pleasing and conciliatory spirit, to Dr. Hook and Dr. Shuttleworth respectively, on the subject of a late work of the latter divine, by a Churchman, and a Friend of Unity.

"Gatherings," by the Author of the "Listener" (Seeley and Burnside), is a work of more merit than we had expected from the last and only publication of the author or authoress which we have fallen in with, "the Listener in Oxford." We do not mean, however, that we agree with every sentiment expressed in it.

The Reverend G. Sandford has addressed a Letter to Mr. Spencer on the subject of his conversion to Romanism, in a style which unites the gentleness and earnestness appropriate, but rarely found in the controversy to which it belongs.

We have received a letter from Mr. Ward, courteous and friendly as regards ourselves, but strongly remonstrating with us about a portion of our article on his Translation of the Magdalen Statutes. We can say most sincerely that we intended him no pain except what is inseparable on all hands from differences of opinion on an important subject, and such as he would be a party to inflicting as well as undergoing. His principal charge is, that we have accused him of publishing the Statutes in question against the will of the Founder, as declared in those Statutes, whereas they do but prohibit the publication of the Evidences, *i.e.* title-deeds and similar documents; and further, that in order to make this appear, we have unfairly quoted only a portion of the sentence as it stands in the Statutes, and supplied a termination of our own favourable to our opinion, and contrary to their real sense. Mr. Ward supports his construction by various collateral considerations.

Such is the substance of Mr. Ward's complaint; to which we reply, that as we have reason to believe that Mr. Ward's construction of the passage is wrong in point of law, a belief which has been confirmed by the opinion of lawyers who have been consulted in the matter, we cannot *honestly* retract, and can but repeat our own statement, which he resists, that the word "Evidences" *does* include the Statutes. So much, however, we will grant, that the passage may *admit* of Mr. Ward's interpretation, and therefore, as far as our charge against him of inconsistency rests on this passage, and not on other considerations which were introduced into our Review, he certainly is not open to it. So far then we are ready to express our regret at what we have said, and we cheerfully unsay it. We are grieved, however, to find that Mr. Ward supposes that we accused him, not merely of an *inconsistency*, but of a *moral offence*, or *crime*, in publishing what the Founder wished concealed. We assure him with great sincerity that no such intention ever crossed our minds; and we have pleasure in thus setting ourselves right with any persons who so understood us. We know too much of Mr. Ward to suspect it, and if he knew the writer of the article in question as well, he would be as slow to impute to him what was uncourteous or inconsiderate, as himself intentionally to commit it.

Notices of Books

[*British Critic*, October 1840.]

Dr. Hawking's "Inquiry into the connected Uses of the principal means of attaining Christian Truth," forms the Bampton Lecture for 1840, and is treated in a way for which the public is well prepared, by the sound and convincing statements of his Dissertation on Unauthoritative Tradition. His intention, he tells us, in this new publication, is, to continue his former work, and that with a view of relieving it of certain exaggerated conclusions which have been drawn from it. He has no

wish to enter the lists of debate; but this does not deprive us of his valuable judgment on a number of points of detail, but indirectly connected with his subject, relative to the opinions, writings, and proceedings of other parties, at present in controversy.

Dr. Pusey has published a fourth edition of his Letter to the Bishop of Oxford, to which he has prefixed a Preface, chiefly on the subject of Justification.

We are much gratified by Mr. Holden's work on Justification (Rivingtons). Its general view of the subject is as satisfactory as its mode of treating it is perspicuous. One passage we are tempted to quote. "Allowing," he says, "such a necessary connexion between justification and sanctification, it is unreasonable to wrangle about their being two distinct things. Supposing them to have separate marks and characters, and supposing, moreover, the one to be in the order of grace successive to the other, yet if they are invariably united, they may be properly considered as *one work*. The act of justification by the Deity may be divisible into parts, in their nature and in the *order* of causality distinguishable; all that is contended for is, that they are never disunited; that they invariably appertain to the same person; that infused sanctification is ever present with those who are justified; and therefore that *it truly belongs to the act of grace*, which we denominate justification," p. 39. This view *must* prevail in the end, except amongst Antinomians.

It is with great satisfaction and gratitude to the author, that we notice Mr. Sewell's "Christian Morals" (Burns). Of course we do not mean to state our agreement with every sentiment of a work full of matter and ardent in expression, but we do really trust good must come to the Church from an ethical creed so deep and attractive as that which this volume sets before us.

Mr. Poole's volume on the Life and Times of St. Cyprian (Parker, Oxford), is sufficiently described by its title. It aims, according to the author's profession in his preface, "to recommend that tone of religion—calm, reverential, implicit, self-sacrificing, and objective—which is well and commonly called Catholic," a tone, which, great as are its merits, it does not always succeed in exemplifying itself. It is besides a carefully executed defence of Anglicanism against the Church of Rome.

Mr. Beaven's sound and sensible remarks "On the Intercourse between the Church of England and the Churches in the East" (Rivingtons), are very seasonable at this juncture, and will doubtless have a wide circulation.

Mr. Beaven has also published two pamphlets on "The Doctrine of Holy Scripture, and of the Primitive Church on the subject of religious Celibacy" (Rivingtons), in answer to the author of Ancient Christianity, which are a remarkable proof how much the efforts of enemies are tending to advance the cause of Catholic truth. What may not be expected for that cause in our Church, when a writer so free from what is called crotchitness as Mr. B. uses the language which we find in these publications?

Mr. King, of Trinity College, Dublin, has published (Grant and Bolton, Dublin) "The Psalter of the B. M. V." commonly ascribed to St. Bonaventura, with an analysis of the authorities on which its genuineness or spuriousness depends. From this it appears, 1st, that Alban Butler or his editor denies its genuineness, appealing to Fabricius, Bellarmine, Labbe, and Natalis Alexander, of whom no one expresses any doubt concerning it, while Waddington, to whom some of them refer, affirms it 2. That Sbaralea, Perron, Oudin, and Chemnitz doubt it, from its internal characters. 3. That Manning asserts, though without appearance of reason, that it was placed on an index of prohibited books; and 4. that a papal bull has stamped all St. B.'s works, it inclusive, with approbation.

A new monthly publication has made its appearance in Dublin, called the Irish Ecclesiastical Journal. It aims at "promoting *unity* among the members of the Church;" its "proprietors are

determined to know no party whatever in the Church; they design neither to put down one party nor to exalt another," but "to promote truth, to defend the doctrine, discipline, and constitution of the United Church, and to make known and uphold the principles of the English Reformation." To a work conducted with such views and feelings we cordially wish success, and we think it will attain it. Some learned articles have already appeared in it. By the bye, what is meant by the "*principles of the English Reformation?*"

There is much good matter in Dr. Stonard's "Six Sermons on the Church and her Ministry" (Rivingtons), but we cannot follow him in saying that "binding and loosing" means "forbidding and permitting," p. 38; that the Christian clergy do not offer sacrifice, p. 73; or that "the pope and the papal monarchy" are "typified by St. Paul's man of sin, as well as by the beast and harlot, and by the man the number of whose name is 666," p. 166.

Accordingly we cannot agree with his "Dissertation on the Discourse of our Lord, Matt xxiv. &c." (Rivingtons), in which he makes the Pope and Mahomed rival "agents of the Prince of Darkness," and considers the Reformation "the sign of the son of man in heaven."

Dr. Smith's "Digest of Hooker's Treatise on the Laws of Ecclesiastical Polity" (Rivingtons), is one out of many proofs of the increased attention which is being paid to this great author, and to theology generally. There is much to like and commend in this volume—it is careful, clear, and succinct; but we wish that, in the Dedication, Lord Lyndhurst and Hooker were not said to be "kindred minds."

"Narrative of a Tour through Armenia, Kurdistan, Persia, and Mesopotamia, by the Rev. H. Southgate" (Tilt and Bogue), is the work of a clergyman of the United States, travelling under the direction of the Board of Missions. He appears to be a well-principled and well-judging person, and is full of interesting and important information.

Dr. Sale's "True Catholic and Apostolic Faith," re-published by the Rev. J. Allford (Whittaker), is curious, from the circumstance of the author, who lived in the reign of Charles the Second, being a converted Jesuit, a remarkable phenomenon.

Sermons by Thirty-nine living Divines of the Church of England (Rivingtons), are published with the excellent object of aiding in the liquidation of "the debt on the Sunday school in connexion with St. Andrew's Church, Ancoats, Manchester;" and, if matter abundant yet not luxuriant, and doctrine various but not distinctive, will secure the sale of a volume, this is likely to be successful. What may not be expected of a volume which unites the respected names of the Bishop of Chester and Dr. Hook, Mr. Buddicom and Mr. Churton, Mr. Prebendary Townsend and Mr. Dodsworth?

We have seen a book, printed at Leeds, on "Scriptural Principles, as applicable to Religious Societies," which will serve well to direct persons who are perplexed in the matter. It lays down first, that a society, to be supported by the Churchman, should *consist of Churchmen*; second, that it should have *the Diocesan's sanction*; thirdly, that it should be according to Church *principles*.

We have also seen a specimen of a new series of Tracts called "Leeds Tracts." "A Church Dictionary," the first number of which lies before us, is in its idea one of the cleverest and most seasonable publications of the day.

A Leeds Magazine has also started, with the best prospect of success. All this is cheering.

Of "An Outline of the History of the British Church, by Philecclesia" (Burns), we would speak with respect, since it certainly is "necessary for these times;" still it seems to us unreal, both in its general theory, which is to prove we are originally independent of Rome, and in various of its phrases. What, for instance, does the author mean by Henry the Second's "jurisdiction over the clergy," "independence of Englishmen," "Morning star of the Reformation," "Spiritual

Protestantism," "Protestant Church of England," and "venerable Cranmer?"

"The Churchman's Brief Manual of Baptism," by the Rev. C. Kennaway (Nisbet), is written "with the view of correcting the error strongly held, and industriously circulated in the author's parish" by the Baptists. It is written in a very pleasing spirit, and evidences thought and research; and, though we cannot follow it in all points, is well calculated to raise the views of the multitude of persons who are more or less infected with the lax notions of the day on the subject of baptism.

A new edition of Bishop Bull's Sermons and Discourses in one volume (Parker, Oxford), will be acceptable to the theological student.

Mr. S. H. Parker's (Oxford) Series has been augmented by Bishop Patrick's Discourses on Prayer, edited by Mr. Paget; Bishop Wilson's Parochialia, Bishop Patrick's "Book for Beginners," being a help to young communicants; Bishop Bull's Vindication of the Church of England; Scandret's "Divine Service;" and Saravia's "Christian Priesthood."

Mr. Gresley's Tale, called "The Siege of Lichfield," (Burns), illustrative of the Great Rebellion, we hope will soon cease to be, what it is at present, the last of the author's entertaining and very useful publications. There is a great deal that is beautiful in it, always excepting the love scenes. "Sobbing girl," "Henry's arms," "brief embrace," "dreams of happiness," are unworthy Mr. G.'s intellectual powers.

Mr. Fulford has published a second volume of Sermons, on the Church and her Gifts (Rivingtons), containing well-written, sensible, and forcible statements on the subjects treated. We have met with few volumes so well calculated to approve themselves, and to be useful, to the general reader.

The principle of Mr. Ashe's "Old Religion" (Curry, Dublin), or an inquiry into the doctrine of the Holy Eucharist, is Catholic and admirable; his conclusions are Calvinian, nay, almost Zuinglian.

Lessons for the Days of the Week (Burns), are short texts, doxologies, hymns, and collects, arranged, or (as may be said) *harmonized*, for each of the seven days, according to the great events which have happened on them respectively. It is well suited for private or social prayer. We are very glad to see such continual proofs, as now reach us, that Christians are changing their long, languid, pompous, and cumbrous pharisaical or puritanical exercises of devotion for more healthy and Catholic forms.

"A Practical and Doctrinal Exposition of the Church Catechism" (Burns), will be found a valuable assistant to those who are engaged in catechetical instruction. It is a small work with a great deal in it, and that sound and useful. Mr. Henderson's "Catechist" (Rivingtons) is a small work of the same kind, with an analytical table of the Church Catechism, and a list of difficult words.

The English Mother, and Early Lessons on the Church of England, by a Lady, promises a great deal of information for young people, and is adapted to raise the tone of thought in members of our Church, and to give them more of a Catholic and ecclesiastical temper than was common with the last generation.

Some writers have lately broken ground on a very important field of religious literature, which we have long wished to see worked by true Catholic implements, in the publication of tracts and little books for the young and poor. Among these we have to notice some admirable tales and conversations published by Burns, "James Ford," "Children of Hazlewood School," "Little Mary's Trouble," &c. We hear of others on a similar plan in course of publication.

"A Dialogue between John Thoroughgood and Thomas Simple" (Langbridge, Birmingham), is a naturally and forcibly-written Tract, well adapted to distribution where there is danger of Chartism

or Socialism.

We do not like such anomalies as "A Dissenter's Apology for an Established Church, in a Letter to his Minister" (Hatchards). This is like "His Majesty's opposition." Non tali auxilio, &c, He has first to look at home and apologize for himself.

Among sermons lately published, we are glad to notice "The Church her own Revivalist," by the Rev. F. M. Knollis, at the visitation of the Bishop of Peterborough (Rivingtons). "The Case of St. Paul and the Necessity of Appointment to the Ministerial Office," by the Rev. T. Farley, at the visitation of the Archdeacon of Oxford. "The Christian planted together with Christ," by the Rev. R. Anderson, on a very sacred occasion (Hatchards). "The Affairs of this World all ordered with a reference to the Welfare of the Church," by the Rev. T. Stone (Burns).

We recommend to notice a little work called Ancient Models, by C. Anderson, Esq. (Burns), written in an excellent spirit, and containing much useful information on the subject of Church Building.

Mr. Lewis has published the first part of his "Illustrations and Description of Kilpeck Church, Herefordshire" (Smith and Elder). They have been some time expected, and will not at all disappoint the high anticipations which have been formed respecting them.

Great exertions are apparently being made to obtain attention to a pamphlet, entitled "Observations on the Prohibition of Marriage in certain cases of Relationship by Affinity. Second Edition." In the circular accompanying its distribution, it is stated to be by a Clergyman: and that, although it embraces two other cases, the object of those who circulate it is to obtain "the repeal of the existing law which prohibits marriage with a deceased wife's sister." The circular is signed by some respectable solicitors, acting "at the request of a number of gentlemen interested in that repeal." This organization, in such a cause, is somewhat formidable, as well as very revolting. The pamphlet itself states that the petition in behalf of the repeal "has already been signed by upwards of eighty parochial clergymen in the diocese of Norwich alone," and that "two of the ablest prelates of the Church, his Grace the Archbishop of Dublin, and the Lord Bishop of Llandaff, have promised their active support." It is then earnestly to be desired that the Church may not be taken by surprise by an *exparte* statement. It is admitted in the pamphlet, that the marriage pleaded for has been forbidden by all the canons of the church, from the Apostolic (which, on the authority of Daillé, are summarily set down as subsequent to A.D. 450,) downwards; and that commentators, until Michaelis, &c. have supposed it to be included in the prohibition to marry a husband's brother; it contends, however, that it is not necessarily so included, since it is not in the letter of Holy Scripture; and, because in Lev. xviii. 18, marriage with a wife's sister is prohibited "during her lifetime," it infers that it was permitted during her death. The writer speaks strongly against the inference prohibitory of such a marriage, on the ground that it is an inference, although supported (which is remarkable) by the Karaites, (the literalists of their day, who received only what was in the letter of Scripture), by individual commentators, and by the Church, which founded her canons upon it; and he rests the whole weight of the scripturalness of the marriage upon another inference. He argues against drawing any inference, when Scripture does speak upon a case, the same in principle, (that of the "brother's wife," Lev. xviii. 16), and he himself founds the lawfulness of a marriage, whose principle is thus condemned in Scripture, upon an inference, where Scripture does *not* speak. "In this way," says St. Basil, who had to speak on this very case, (Ep. 160, ad Diodor.), "whoever would dare such a deed, might take the sister even during the wife's lifetime. For the same sophism will fit this case also. For it is written, he will say, 'Thou shalt not take, *to vex her*;' so then he hath not prohibited taking her, where there is no 'vexing.' Whoso then pleadeth for passion,

will decide that the tempers of the sisters hath nothing 'vexing' in it. The reason then being done away, for which he prohibits his living with both at once, what is to hinder his taking both sisters?"

We cannot bring ourselves to contemplate such an union being legalized; it were much to be deprecated, even on the ground that it would countenance the notion that purity in the one sex is different from that of the other, that an union which would be incest in a woman, is lawful in a man. It would also do much to destroy the oneness of the married state, which gives it so high a dignity, as a symbol of things spiritual; for this law presupposes that the husband and wife are so one, that the relations of the one become the very same relations to the other; as St. Basil says, l.c. "Those words, 'None of you shall approach to any, near of kin to him, to uncover their nakedness,' embrace also this sort of kin. For what can be more akin to a man, than his own wife, yea rather, than his own flesh? for 'they are no longer twain, but one flesh.' So that, through the wife, the sister passeth into the kin of the husband. For as he would not take the mother of his wife, nor the daughter of his wife, because neither would he his own mother, nor his own daughter, so neither the sister of his wife, because neither would he his own sister. And conversely, neither may the wife be joined to the kin of her husband. For the rights of kin are common to both." But, chiefly we should much dread the punishment of such impiety, if the state were to sanction a mixture, condemned by nature itself, which it would confound, making the offspring (as St Basil argues) brothers and sisters, and cousins at once; contrary to the spirit of the Word of God, as it has ever been understood by the Church. "First in order," says St. Basil, l.c. "which is of the greatest moment in these things, is the custom with us, having the force of law, because these ordinances have been handed down to us by holy men. And the custom is this: if any one, mastered even by an impure passion, shall have fallen into the lawless union with two sisters, neither to account this a marriage, nor to receive such into the body of the Church, So then, even had we nothing else to say, custom had sufficed as a safeguard of what is right." We trust then that the two bishops, whose names have been brought forward, if they have in any degree at first sight countenanced such a plan, will yet withdraw from supporting what the Church in St. Basil's time counted "profanation" (*agos*); which he could not believe a bishop could advocate, but thought the plea must be "a forgery;" that few English clergy will be found to petition for, what St. Basil thought, whoso heard, must "shudder at the very question being asked." It is, we hope, only one of those unhappy cases, in which persons, by following their own notions in interpreting Holy Scripture, involve themselves unknowingly in grievous errors of faith and practice; but that the better sort even of those who have fallen into it, will shrink even from the risk of advocating, upon a precarious inference, what they must feel it may have been the purpose of God to condemn. They will feel, we trust, this to be the only safe side. At the same time, we must say that there is something unspeakably disgusting in forming a combination for such an end!

Notices of Books

[*British Critic*, January 1841.]

ARCHDEACON Lyall's "Propædia Prophetica" (Rivingtons) is an original, deep and powerful argument on the grounds on which Christian evidence rests. We do not profess to follow him at every step, but it is most encouraging to find such views from one so high in the Church both in rank and name.

Mr. Tyler's "Primitive Christian Worship, or the Evidence concerning the Invocation of Saints and Angels, and the B. M. V." (Rivingtons) is dedicated to "the One holy Catholic and Apostolic Church," and fully answers to its motto of "Speaking the Truth in Love." It is impossible to open

the volume without meeting proofs of its brotherly tone; and on the other hand it is a book of *facts*,—at this time the most useful book of all. It is a professed attempt to win over members of the Church of Rome to Anglicanism, by showing that *their own* communion is not infallible.

Mr. Gladstone has published a second volume, on “Church Principles considered in their Results” (Murray).

We have to thank Mr. Jebb for his “Divine Economy of the Church (Duncan and Malcolm).—It is a thoughtful, perspicuous, and beautiful comment on the articles of “the Holy Catholic Church” and “the Communion of Saints.”

We are not going here to enter into the question of “Mehemet Ali, Lord Palmerston, Russia, and France,” by W. Cargill, Esq. (Reid), but we will take occasion of this pamphlet, to express our surprise at two things, for which, however, Mr. C. is not responsible; first, that persons should have thought that the success of Mehemet could in any case compromise the prophecies about Egypt, after the dynasty of the Ptolemies, as if each were not a *foreign* power; and next, that a correspondent, favourably introduced into a well-known religious publication by its editor, should have advocated the settlement of the Jews in Palestine and *building for them their Temple*. So Julian, it seems, is at the bottom of these pseudo-evangelical principles.

“Israel’s Return, or Palestine Regained,” by Joseph Elisha Freeman, (Ward) shows that the last statement is no mistake. He quotes Mr. Frey as “justly inquiring” thus—“And now dear reader, why should it be thought strange that my dear people, who have for nearly 1800 years most conscientiously observed all the religious rites which God gave to our fathers, . . . would, when they are brought back by the wonderful goodness of God to the land which God gave to our fathers, *build again a temple for the worship of God*, erect an *altar* unto the Lord, and offer up their *sacrifices*, and observe *all other* ceremonies which they observed before their dispersion by the Romans?—p. 227. Yet in his preface the author says, “So far as concerns the general outline of his subject,” in which the point in question surely ought to be included, ‘the author feels *unbounded confidence* (sic), and were he, from a feeling of false, humility, to speak in language less strong, he would be affecting doubt, diffidence, and uncertainty, where (whether right or wrong) he is not in the *slightest degree* (sic) conscious of possessing them.”

Very different is the unaffected and temperate tone, and the perspicuous method in which is conducted “An inquiry respecting the Destiny of the Ten Tribes, by a Layman,” (Rivingtons) though we do not concur in the conclusion, which is, that the present population of Europe is descended from the ten tribes.

Mr. Atkinson’s “Principles of Political Economy” (Whittaker) are devoted to the excellent object of showing that the only real mode of relieving the physical wants of the productive classes, is by subjecting their exertions to a moral law;—that love, not self-interest, is the true social bond, and that labour is efficient according as it is directed by justice. He attempts to treat this practically. We are rejoiced to see such symptoms of an improved philosophy in the important department of science which Mr. Atkinson has undertaken.

Mr. Bowden has begun a new line of history in his “Life of Gregory the Seventh,” 2 vols. (Rivingtons), unless the recent Becket Letters may be said to have anticipated him. It is very learned, and, if possible, still more interesting. The history is quite dramatic, and reads like a romance.

Count Valerian Krasinski’s “Historical Sketch of the Reformation in Poland” (Murray) is written with remarkable ease and idiomatic propriety for a foreigner, and in a temperate and amiable tone. Much information will be derived from it on its subject, but of course we cannot be expected to

approve the views of a continental Protestant.

Mr. Lathbury in his "Guy Fawkes" (Parker, London) gives a sketch of the two events commemorated in the 5th of November service, and endeavours to prove that rebellion on religious grounds against the sovereign is wrong in Papists and right in Protestants.

Dr. Biber's "Standard of Catholicity" (J. W. Parker) contains much thought and some great truths. We have taken some pains not to misunderstand him, and we are sure he cannot hold what yet he seems to us to say, viz. that there is no Christianity without union with the visible Church, and no heterodoxy in those who sincerely seek divine communion in it. Hence, that orthodoxy is neither necessary for those who belong to it, nor available for those who do not. How this holds with maintaining the Athanasian creed does not appear; nay, according to Dr. Biber, "creeds or articles," p. 194, must be incumbrances, or rather stumbling blocks and snares. Surely a member of the English Church may fairly ask for a solution of these preliminary difficulties before he throws his mind into Dr. Biber's reasonings.

"The Protestant's Armory" (Seeley and Burnside) is a collection of authorities to make it certain that the Church of Rome is apostate, idolatrous, and anti-Christian. The writers selected are Keith, Newton, Faber, Burkitt, Jewell, Ussher, M'Ghee, Whitby, Doddridge, &c, &c.

As to Mr. Scott's careful work on the "Suppression of the Reformation in France," (Seeley and Burnside) considering *what is meant* by the French Reformation, we can only say that, unlike the author, we are well satisfied that it was suppressed.

The three volumes of the Edinburgh Cabinet Library on "British America" appear to be a useful compendium for those who want information on colonial affairs. The chapter on the social state of Canada gives an interesting account of the French *habitans*, and a sad contrast in the manners of the mixed multitude of later emigrants. Amongst much which it is painful to read, we find—"Sir John Colborne expressly says, that the established clergy have not effected any Indian conversions." Can this be true?

"Ecclesiastical Colloquies," by L. J. Hobson, (Roake and Varty) were first published in 1816, and are one out of many witnesses to the continuity of apostolical principles among us even in the least satisfactory times.

The "Book of the Universal Kirke, Re-opened by a Presbyter," (Whittaker) does not do itself justice in its composition. It is a book of excellent views (bating some unchristianisms against Rome, into which right-principled persons are beginning to fall, and which will be sure to have an uncomfortable re-action,) delivered continuously without break or table of contents. It is a thoughtful, practical, and convincing argument upon Church unity.

"The School Girl in 'France'" (Seeley and Burnside), a caution against "the Snares, Pitfalls, and innumerable Perils of a Popish School," will find an energetic second in M. Thiers and the Marseillaise. There are other snares and pitfalls from which the volume does not secure us; for instance, that of young girls thinking uncertainty of their personal salvation awful and appalling, and triumphant assurance an ordinary privilege.

"The Duty of the Members of the Church of England to adhere to Her Doctrine and Discipline," by Rev. F. R. Nixon (Wix), is a Visitation Sermon, written with much earnest feeling and sound principle. He mentions, as from an influential member of the Wesleyan body, that "the Oxford Tracts were getting into circulation amongst the Methodist preachers, and that many of them were 'decided Oxford tract men,' (his own expression,) and held the doctrine of the 'power of the keys' as fully as any Romish priest could do."—p. 47.

Mr. Beaven's "Calm Exposure," in answer to the Fifth Part of "Ancient Christianity" (Riv-

ingtons), is, like his former pamphlets, written in a style remarkably temperate, sensible, and persuasive. It gives the authors of the "Tracts for the Times" their due, but distinctly draws the line at which they ought to have stopped in the development of their opinions,—what they should have said,—and what they should not. We anticipate that in no long time he will carry with him the bulk of English Churchmen. Our solitary misgiving about the view to which we allude is, lest it should turn out like the cry of the pieman, "Banbury cakes, all jam and no crust."

The learning and excellent principles of Rev. W. Blunt's "Dissenters' Baptism and Church Burials" (Rivingtons) made us feel that it is wrong to despair of the Church, in spite of the captivity to which decisions such as Sir John Nicholl's, and her own conduct before and after it, have reduced her.

The "Letter to the Clergy on the Bishop of Norwich's Speech" (Rivingtons) is on so painful a subject, that, excellent as the letter is, we had rather the Church should speak before us.

"The Life of the late Bishop Burgess," by J. S. Harford, Esq. (Longman and Co.) is written in the clear, simple, unaffected style which becomes biography, and is interesting at once from its subject and from the various letters and anecdotes it contains of his literary and ecclesiastical contemporaries.

Dr. James's "Proper Lessons, with a short Commentary" (Rivingtons), is intended "to aid the worshipper to understand their application to his own condition." It will be found useful for that purpose:—the tone of doctrine is not so boldly and distinctly Catholic as we could desire, though it is more than enough so to offend ordinary Protestants.

The grave, wise, and learned Bishop Sanderson's "Sermons, two volumes," (Arnold) are preceded by an Introductory Essay, by the Rev. R. Montgomery, who accordingly "acknowledges in all honest truth that the renovating doctrines of the cross, the riches of that everlasting covenant of love where the heart of the Trinity is revealed as interested with the miracles of salvation, and the profound mystery of sanctification, as effected by the energizing work of the Spirit, occupy by no means that position in these Sermons which might be desired."—p. xiv.

Rainbow's "Sermon on the Death of the Countess of Pembroke" (Nichols) is a fair specimen of the mode of composition usual in the seventeenth century.

Mr. Harness's "Four Sermons on Christian Education" (Rivingtons) are impressive and practical discourses introduced with a graceful dedication.

We are obliged to Mr. Bennett for his second volume of Sermons, (Cleaver) which we feel sure will do good wherever it is known.

Mr. Slade's "Plain Parochial Sermons," vol. iv. (Rivingtons) are not only so, but sound, affectionate, and instructive.

Mr. Merewether's "Strictures on Mr. Benson's Sermons" (Rivingtons) are written in the amiable temper and with the clearness of argument, which characterize his former publications.

"Faith, Hope, and Charity," by Mr. P. Hall (Norman) is the substance of sermons preached on "three Sabbath mornings" to the united congregations of the episcopal chapels in Broad Court and Long Acre during the renovation of the former; with a long index of the texts, quoted to prove, we presume, the scriptural character of the sermons.

Harte's "Practical Sermons" (Rivingtons) are in a thoughtful and serious style, and show a strong sense of the difficulties which lie in the way of a consistent course of religion.

"The Cloud of Witnesses" is a series of eloquent discourses by Mr. James Anderson, (Rivingtons) written with the design of inviting Christians to glorify God by the commemoration and imitation of the saints of the Old Testament.

Excellent sermons have been published, on "Christian Goodness," by the Dean of Chichester, preached on a very trying occasion—the death of the much-beloved Bishop of Chichester; "The whole Counsel of God declared by the S. P. C. K.," by Rev. F. Kilvert (Riviere, Bath); "The Office of this Generation in the Church of Christ," by Rev. F. W. Faber (Rivingtons); "Christ All and in All," by Rev. B. Addison (Hamilton and Adams); "The Church the Guide to Truth and Unity," preached before the University of Cambridge by the Rev. F. W. Collison (Rivingtons); "How are the Mighty Fallen," by Rev. J. Medley (Rivingtons), with a learned and interesting Appendix; "The Edification of the Church," preached at Bishop Shuttleworth's consecration by Rev. A. Grant (Burns); "The Duty and Blessing of Church Membership," by Rev. G. Sherard (Huntingdon); "A Thanksgiving Sermon on the Queen's Escape from Assassination," by Rev. F. Stone (Burns); "The City of God," by Rev. J. F. Russell (Burns).

"Forms of Bidding Prayer, with an Introduction and Notes," (Rivingtons) is a curious and interesting little volume.

"The Order of Confirmation," by Rev. H. Hopwood, (Burns) is a collection of beautiful meditations, prayers, &c. before and after the rite, from the Fathers and standard modern divines. It is calculated to give sound views and serious thoughts to those who are candidates for it.

Mr. Keddell's "Dissertation on the Vow of Jephthah" (Painter) brings together some strong arguments for concluding that his daughter was not put to death, but makes the question of more importance than seems to us suitable.

"The Christian Gentleman's Daily Walk," by Sir A. Edmonstone, Bart. (Burns) is a beautiful composition, written much upon the model of "Herbert's Country Parson." We wish he had not repeated the exploded interpretation of the text—"Kings shall be thy nursing fathers, &c." as if it meant that they should nurse *the Church*, whereas it declares that they should be nurses, for and under her, of her *children*.

Bishop Hacket's "Christian Consolations" (Burns) are sufficiently praised by saying that Bishop Heber has attributed the book to Jeremy Taylor, and included it in his edition of his works.

"A Table of Psalms and Lessons for the Seven Services through the Week, and for Festivals, &c. from the Breviary" (Burns) will be acceptable to those who think that the influence of Romanism is best neutralized by taking from it its excellences, and leaving it the remainder.

"Texts for Meditation, before and at intervals in Divine Service and at the Holy Communion," are printed on cards, and are to be had of Mr. Burns.

"The brief Account of every Sect professing the Christian Religion" (Brittain and Reid) appears a useful little summary. Nothing can be more impartial. We have tried in vain to discover to what sect the author belongs, or whether to any.

"Sabbath Musings and Every Day Scenes," (Seeley) and "The Miracles of our Lord explained in a Correspondence between a Mother and her Daughter," (Seeley) exhibit a patchy and desultory sort of piety. The writer of the former betrays a very extensive acquaintance with Irish, English, and German watering-places. Religion "not at home" would have been a more appropriate title.

"Gospel Extracts for Young Children" (Rivingtons) are what the title signifies, simply passages from the Gospels, and will, as the preface hopes, "prove acceptable to many parents."

"An Introduction to the Evidences," for schools (Nisbet), is a condensation of much matter in a small space, carefully done, well calculated to sharpen the minds of young persons,—whether to make them religious is another matter. The following sentence seems to us to contain the essence of scepticism. "One of the greatest principles of wisdom man can arrive at in this world, is to let the degree of his belief bear *an exact proportion* to the degrees of evidence."—p. 10. *e.g.* to believe

the doctrine of the Divinity of the Holy Spirit, far less firmly, we suppose, than the Divinity of our Lord.

The "Voice of the Church, or Selections from Divines of all Ages" (Burns) has now reached a second volume. It contains extracts from S. Irenæus, St. Cyril of Alexandria, Theodoret, &c., Archbishop Cranmer, Fuller, Chillingworth, Dean Stanley, Bishop Jolly, Bishop Patrick, Dr. Comber, &c., and a life of Bishop Ridley. This assemblage of names is dear to the Anglican Churchman, and will tend to build up others on his foundation.

Of the series called "The Englishman's Library" (Burns) we have to notice "The Five Empires, an Outline of Ancient History," by Rev. R. J. Wilberforce, a work of much learning in an unpretending form; and "The Tales of the Village," by Rev. F. E. Paget, a beautiful and instructive volume.

Archdeacon Wilberforce's "Stories" make the nearest approach to John Bunyan which we have in our Church. We feel much obliged to him for his "Rocky Island, and other Parables," (Burns) which are intended for the young, and we sincerely hope he will continue his labours.

A tale of very great ability and excellent principle, though with a title which does not do it justice, has just been published, called "The Fairy Bower" (Burns). It is in form a child's tale, but is better adapted for grown people. We are sure that no one will repent having had it thus recommended to their notice. There cannot be a greater praise paid it than to say that its principal fault is a profusion of characters.

Of little books for schools and young people, we recommend Burn's "Lessons for the Days of the Week;" "Little Mary," a picture of children with a great deal of beauty and naturalness, but with no plot; "Dialogues on the Te Deum" Mr. Chamberlain's "Godfather's Gift," which is full of instructive remarks; and two, which we should praise very highly, were there not a danger of our taking sympathy as a warrant for admiration; "Conversations with Cousin Rachel;" and "Practical Exposition of the Creed;"—yet one should think they would be admired even by those who did not agree with them.

Burn's "Tracts on Christian Doctrine and Practice" will be found to answer to their title, and are much to be recommended. Of these, that on "Evangelical Truth and Apostolical Order" explains the true sense of words in themselves somewhat ambiguous. In Mr. Pridden's "Richard Morton," strange to say, Sunday is *apparently* called "the seventh day."

Among U. S. publications we notice an impressive address of Bishop Ives to the General Theological Seminary of the "Protestant Episcopal" (meaning the Catholic Apostolic) "Church in the U. S.;" a "Sermon on Isaiah's Prospects of the Church," by Bishop Doane; a "Pastoral Letter," by the same; "The Journal of the 57th Convention of the Diocese of New Jersey;" "Oxford Theology," an article from the New York Review, which must be very gratifying to the parties of whom it speaks; "The Proceedings of the Board of Missions at the first Triennial Meeting," which are very interesting, and contain valuable information about the Eastern Churches; and "A Sermon," by Dr. Jarvis, on Christian Unity, preached on that occasion, in which we are concerned to say that the excellent author defends the Nestorians and Eutychians, though of course upholding the third and fourth General Councils.

It is encouraging indeed to meet with such pamphlets as Mr. Markland's on "Sepulchral Memorials of Past and Present Times" (Rivingtons). It is dedicated to the President and Members of the Oxford Architecture Society, an institution from which we expect much.

We desire particularly to recommend "Church Music, or a selection of Chants, Sanctuses, and Responses, together with the Litany and Versicles as used in the Church Service; also Psalm Tunes adapted to the authorized Metrical Versions, (Burns) by R. Readhead, Organist at Margaret Chapel,

St. Marylebone."

There is a good deal of ability and even strength in "The Lord's Prayer contemplated as the Expression of the Primary Elements of Devotion," by Mr. Griffith (Burns), but the language is often more declamatory or discussional than suits the gravity of the subject.

"Every Day Duties, in Letters to a Young Lady," by M. A. Stodart," (Seeley and Burnside) is a little book of which the tone and spirit are much better than the creed. It is a curious instance of the gradual encroachments which the light of Catholic truth is making at this moment on doctrinal ignorance. Men are seen as trees walking.

"A Letter to T. Phillips, Esq. on the Connection between Religion and the Fine Arts," by H. Drummond, Esq. (Fraser) is a pamphlet which will repay a careful perusal.

The excellent object of Mr. Littlehales's "Letter on Education" (Stratford-on-Avon) is to promote the growing feeling of the necessity of doing something of a sound and permanent character for the education of the middle classes.

Mr. Buddicom's "Few Words for the Five Church Societies" (Rivingtons) well answers its main object of being useful for "distribution in country parishes."

We are glad to see proposals issued for collecting and printing rare or unpublished works or documents, illustrative of the "history and Antiquities of Ireland." Specimens of works still extant in manuscript, to which attention might be turned, are "The Annals of Kilronan;" "The Liber Hymnorum," supposed to belong to the Abbey of Lona; "The Registrum nigrum and Repertorium viride of Archbishop Alan;" and "The Registrum Cœnobii omnium Sanctorum juxta Dublin." Names may be sent to Messrs. Hodges and Smith, 21, College Green, Dublin.

Mr. La Trobe's "Scripture Illustrations" (Seeley) is a most splendid book, All the more remarkable places of sacred history, from Ararat to the Seven Churches, are illustrated with copious extracts from Scripture and travellers of every age, and with what is now deemed almost as indispensable, striking engravings.

"The Rhine; Legends, Traditions, History, from Cologne to Mainz," by Joseph Snow, Esq., is a very elegant, and, to those who have a taste for diablerie and such matters, a very amusing work. This peculiar sort of interest, however, is kept up at a great sacrifice of all kinds of religious feeling.

"Popular Errors explained and Illustrated," by John Timbs, parts 1 and 2, (Tilt and Bogue) is a book to take up in a leisure hour, and get information from on the "economy of man," his properties, food, and domestic arts and manufactures.

"Recollections of the Lakes," by the author of "The Moral of Flowers," (Tilt and Bogue) is an elegant volume of poems on natural and religious subjects.

Sir J. Doyle's "Miscellaneous Verses" (Saunders and Otley) are vigorous, graceful, harmonious, touching poems,—now and then extravagating beyond the bounds of reverence, and somewhat wanting in severity both of thought and composition.

"Ragg's Poems" (Longman) are interesting, as being the writing of one who has raised himself from the situation of a working mechanic to a respectable literary position. They display considerable poetical talent, developed upon not very good models; for instance, the titles of some of his former works, "Incarnation," "Deity," revive a dream of profaneness some time passed away, and uncongenial to Mr. Ragg's nice feelings and natural good taste.

"The Redeemer," by W. Howorth," (Tilt) is a poem of which our limits preclude perhaps as large a notice as it deserves. We have read considerable portions of it with a prejudice against it on account of its length, and feeling the want of that peculiar interest which an artificial plot alone can sustain. But we are forced to acknowledge that it contains much true poetry, and is full of good

versification and deep religious feeling.

The "Glossary of Provincial Words used in Herefordshire and some of the adjoining counties," (Murray) is a curious and interesting little book. It does not however discriminate enough between native old expressions, and modern corruptions and vulgarisms.

We should notice with reference to the article in our last number on "New Churches," that the late alterations in St. Mary's, Nottingham, to which we briefly alluded, are on a very excellent design, and with a decidedly primitive aim. This was of course to be expected from Archdeacon Wilkins's well-known zeal and judgment in church building. What struck us as inconsistencies were entailed by the absolute necessity of accommodating an old church to modern worship. Snenton Church appears also not so entirely destitute of a fourth, or chancel arm, as we had been given to understand. Our informant had overlooked an octagonal apsis extending eastward from the central tower. We are glad to be able to give Mr. Pugin's own account of the word "Cathedral" in the title appended to his engraving of his "Church" at Derby: "Before I left London for the continent, when I was engraving the views of the church, I left the directions for the letter-engraver on a slip of paper, and wrote 'Cath. Church, Derby,' abbreviating the word 'Catholic.' What was my astonishment and annoyance to find on my return a few weeks after, that he had engraved 'Cathedral Church' instead of 'Catholic.' I immediately had the error rectified as well as I could." It seems, too, Mr. Pugin used his best endeavours to prevent the bearings being from north to south. As for the position of the edifice, with respect to the old English church close to it, we merely meant that, however accidentally and unwillingly, ("There is a divinity that shapes our words, rough hew them how we will,") the Romanists had *in fact* stumbled upon a situation and attitude which were emblematical of their ecclesiastical position. The new Church of Holy Trinity at Blackheath has not two tiers of galleries, we are glad to learn, but an organ loft above the west end gallery. We will add, that when we spoke of "the rough work of a vestry going on just behind the altar," we were thinking of the ordinary conversation, and half-secular business, such as parish affairs, often carried on there; not to speak of the lumber, parts of the warming, lighting, or cleaning apparatus, &c., sometimes there kept or thrown aside. We have just received notice that the tower of Lee Church, which is in course of building by Mr. Brown, has been erected according to a plan different from that which was at first proposed and to which we alluded, and, as the architect informs us, avoiding the errors which we pointed out.

Notices of Books

[*British Critic*, April 1841.]

Dr. Mill has published his "Christian Advocate's" publication for 1840 (Rivingtons), for which we have been some time looking with great interest. It is the first part of a profound reply to the Pantheistic Principles of Strauss.

To Dr. Wall's very interesting volume (2nd) on "The Ancient Orthography of the Jews," (Whittaker), we cannot do more in so brief a notice as this than direct the reader's attention. As his former volume was intended to establish the miraculous origin of alphabetic writing, so this illustrates the value of the gift by showing the low state in which learning must have remained, had mankind been confined to the use of such means of writing as they have invented for themselves. A third volume is to follow, principally on the subject of China.

The subject alone is sufficient to make "Egyptian history deduced from Monuments still in existence," (Fraser), deeply interesting. The first part, which is all that we have seen, extends from Menes to Osirtesen. We are glad to see that it observes that reverence for Scripture history which is

often wanting in such investigations.

Mr. Girdlestone's "Commentary on the Old Testament," Part V., on Job and the Psalms, (Rivingtons), is written with a careful attention to the details of moral duty, which is particularly seasonable in this day, and which, we may trust, cannot fail of a beneficial result.

"The Book of Illustrations," by the Rev. H. Salter, (Hatchards) is condemned by its very length, which runs to 532 closely printed octavo pages. Illustrations should be written in a terse and pithy style; so large a book therefore must either have a great many indeed, or they must be spun out. Again, it is condemned by its being original and selected, for illustrations are not likely to be expressed vigorously unless thrown off by the author. Mr. S. seems too to belong to a bad school in religion; yet we cannot help feeling kindly towards him for his advocating the *principle*, which is most philosophical and true, that teaching should proceed by means of visible things, or that religion is mystical.

Dr. D'Oyly has, in his second edition of "Sancroft's Life" (J. W. Parker), added some extracts from the Archbishop's letters, the three sermons which he published himself, and the celebrated treatise called "Modern Policies," attributed to him.

Mr. Pope, in his "Roman Misquotation," (Holdsworth), shows that the Roman work called "The Faith of Catholics," used by Dr. Poynter, the Bishop of Strasburgh, &c. is not at all to be depended on in certain of its extracts and translations of the early Fathers.

We observe that "Geraldine" has got to the third edition, and really do not know how to be sorry for it. It contains incomparably more truth than error, and is far more powerful against the Protestantism of the day than in behalf of Rome. Some few converts it may make to its own creed; but *on the whole* we doubt not its circulation will work beneficially for our Church; and even as regards its converts, we have always to inquire *what* they were before conversion. The chance is that they will be found in the judgment of the sober Anglican to have gained by it. We are no palliators of superstition, but England is not in so orthodox a state, that Romanism is the worst of heresies.

Two new Tracts have appeared in the series called the Tracts for the Times, No. 89, "On the Mysticism attributed to the early Fathers of the Church;" and No. 90, "Remarks on certain Passages in the Thirty-nine Articles." The latter is creating a great sensation.

Mr. Bickersteth "*completes* a series of theological works begun in 1815," with "a Treatise on *Baptism*" (Seeley). This looks like "*labor actus in orbem*," and perhaps indicates the beginning of a new and improved cycle. The spirit which dictated the following words is progressive: "Let us be led by these considerations to a more full and entire confidence in the Lord, and a more diligent, believing, and practical observance of every direction of our God, though at the time we may little discern its full meaning and importance."

"The Case stated," with reference to the late meeting of the subscribers to the Curates' Fund at Leeds, is a little tract, published at Leeds, in defence of the vicar of that parish, who it seems had been attacked by Mr. William Sinclair and another clergyman of the Parish of Leeds, and Mr. Atkinson, a solicitor, for some observations he had made on the Pastoral Aid Society. It is noticed here for two reasons, to express our satisfaction at finding that church principles "*have progressed*" in Leeds, and that with the progress of church principles, there has been a progress of church *temper*. The assailants of the vicar of Leeds seem to have displayed some asperity of temper, and to have indulged not in hard arguments, but in hard words, from which the writer of this pamphlet has carefully abstained. As to Dr. Hook's speech itself, if we may judge from the report of it given in the Leeds Intelligencer for Feb. 6, a more impressive and beautiful one never was delivered at any

meeting.

We are glad to find that Dr. Biber disclaims the views which we gathered in our last number from his late work, "The Standard of Catholicity." We understand that some remarks will be appended by the author to our present, by way of explanation.

Mr. Clay's "Explanatory Notes on the Prayer Book Version of the Psalms" (Parker, London) are carefully done, but prolix. It has however often occurred to us, that an edition of the Psalms on this plan, but with no more than two or three lines of argument and explanation to each Psalm, is a desideratum.

Mr. Painter is carrying on the very seasonable reprints called "Tracts of the Anglican Fathers," which had come to an end, with a new editor and against the wishes of the old.

"Twelve Sermons on the Faith and Practice of a Christian," by C. Gregory, B.A. (Rivingtons), will be found earnest exhortations to general obedience and holiness.

The Dean of Chichester has published a sermon on "the Decoration of Churches" (Parker). Mr. Alexander Watson, a farewell sermon, preached at St. Andrew's, Ancoats (Burns). Mr. Stafford, a sermon on "The Offertory," a subject to which we are glad to observe a growing attention (Rivingtons). Mr. Frere, a sermon on the "Ember Weeks," preceded by a discourse upon "Fasting" (Rivingtons). We had intended before this to have called attention to an excellent Sermon of Mr. Nelson's, lately published.

We recommend Mr. Dodsworth's three excellent "Discourses on the Holy Communion" (Burns).

Mr. Fryer's Sermons (Cadell) is a volume of excellent principles, somewhat wanting in definiteness.

"Sermons by the Rev. W. H. Tucker," (Fellowes), contains a good deal of thought not always adequately enucleated.

We are glad to observe that "Fuller's Characters," taken out of the "Holy State," have been published (Burns) in a small volume.

Bishop Jeremy Taylor's "Practical Works," (Ball and Arnold), comprise all his Sermons and the "Holy Living and Holy Dying" in one volume and in a very clear type.

We are not particularly fond of Bishop Burnet, but his "Pastoral Care," (Washbourne), has always been reckoned useful, and Mr. Dale has put an excellent preface to it, which it will do most people good to read.

"Felix de Lisle," (Seeley and Burnside), is the history of the conversion of an Englishman, bred-up abroad without baptism, from heathenism to Christianity. He grows up, his mind expands; his father, who is an unbeliever, dies with sudden assurance of salvation; he finds Deists all ignorance, Roman Catholics all form and mystery, Jews all cheating, and high Churchmen all morality. He studies the Bible and Prayer-Book; thinks no sect conducts worship so admirably as the Church of England, yet baptizes himself, from not being clear what communion it is best to enter. Then he falls into a consumption, receives a more regular baptism from the clergyman of the parish, and dies with an assurance which he felt before receiving it.

Dr. Molesworth has published an excellent Letter to the Bishop of Chester, on the "Pastoral Aid Society" (Rivingtons).

Mr. Burns has published a series of books for children, with woodcuts, which will be found very suitable for school prizes.

Mr. Soames's edition of "Dr. Murdock's Translation of Mosheim's Ecclesiastical History," 4 vols. (Longman), must any how be a great improvement on a translation like Maclaine's.

"Baptismal Regeneration" (Burns) is a tract on that subject, written in a very serious and practical spirit, and adapted to help persons in their difficulties.

We would not pronounce anything magisterially in so sacred a matter as grief, and we know how wonderfully all things are transmuted to good by the recipient mind; but we will only say with respect to "The Christian Mourner," (Seeley and Burnside), that if a volume of [number illegible] closely printed pages [be found to?] assuage sorrow, it is the first time that such a host of words did anything else for the unfortunates upon whom they fell but inflict a desperate headache.

"Aids to Devotion," (Dalton), is a selection of texts and hymns arranged under heads; the plan is simple and good; the selection somewhat objectionable.

"Tendrils Cherished, or Home Sketches," (Houlston), 'is a tale for the young, drawn, apparently, after life. It has considerable merit, and will be useful, in spite of its title being somewhat sentimental, and of the little girls who are its subjects inventing and writing down "Aphorisms," p. 37, at the end of every day.

"The Temperance Emigrants, a Drama, by John Dunlop, Esq." (Houlston and Stoneman), is a vulgar, outrageous story conveyed in vigorous and striking dialogue.

"Ecclesia" is a volume of poems by the Rev. R. S. Hawker (Rivingtons), marked by good feeling, elegance and grace, with some want of severity and awe, considering the subject treated of.

"Sketches of Country Life and Country Matters," by One of the Old School, (Rivingtons), is a little work of excellent principles written in a pleasing style.

The Baron Geramb's "Journey from La Trappe to Rome," (Dolman), is a lively, interesting, and (making allowances for his creed) instructive narrative.

We think it right, in justice to Dr. Burney, and for the satisfaction of our musical readers, to correct an error in the article on Chanting, in a late Number. It was there stated that Dr. Burney could trace no difference between the Ambrosian and Gregorian chants. This is correct; but in the errata at the end of the second volume he corrects his error, and says that Padre Martini informed him it was "in the finals." "The principal difference (he says) which I can discover in these finals, from those of the Gregorian chant, is the frequent use of the favourite Greek interval, the fourth, with which, descending from the octave of the key of C or D to the fifth, almost every close is made."

At a general meeting of the Board of the Society for Promoting Christian Knowledge on the 9th of February the following Report from the Foreign Translation Committee was laid before the Meeting:—

"The Foreign Translation Committee beg to state to the Board that they have had a report made to them by the Secretary, the Rev. G. Tomlinson, of the journey which he made to the Levant, in the autumn of last year, at their request.

"In the Report which the Committee made to the Board in July last, they stated that they had received some communications respecting the Translation both of the Holy Scriptures and of Books and Tracts for use in the Levant; but that they had found it difficult to obtain such information upon these subjects as might enable them to come to a satisfactory conclusion respecting the course which ought to be pursued. They agreed, therefore, with the approbation of his Grace the President, and with the concurrence of the Standing Committee, to request the Secretary to go out to the Levant to make inquiries personally in the different localities, and to ascertain, as far as possible, the opinions and views of the authorities of the Oriental Churches and communities respecting these matters.

"The Committee had afterwards the satisfaction to learn that his Grace the President, and the Lord Bishop of London, had been pleased to give the Secretary commendatory letters to the Bishops of the Oriental Church.

"The Secretary has now reported to the Committee, that in accordance with their wishes he visited Malta, Athens, Constantinople, and other intermediate places, but was prevented from extending his visit to Syria, Palestine, and Egypt, on account of the war which broke out whilst he was in the Levant. He has stated that he met with a friendly reception from the heads of the Oriental Church generally; and in particular, that he was kindly and cordially received by the bishops and principal clergy of the kingdom of Greece, who are willing and desirous to receive such assistance as the Society may be able consistently to give towards the Christian instruction and improvement of the members of the Greek Church. In the conferences which he held with some of the Greek clergy, it was suggested by them that the Society would render much service to the Greek Church and to the cause of pure religion generally in the East, if it would print an edition of the Holy Scriptures in ancient Greek, and also of some portions of the works of the ancient Greek Fathers, so that they might be distributed, either gratuitously or at a very small price, particularly to the clergy. These are represented as being the works of which they at present stand most in need; and a supply of them would be most gratefully received by the bishops and clergy in Greece.

"The Committee have therefore agreed, with the approbation of his Grace the President, to print an edition of the Septuagint Version of the Old Testament and an edition of the New Testament in ancient Greek, with the marginal references and the sections of Eusebius, according to the edition of Bishop Lloyd, for distribution in Greece and the Levant.

"The Committee also consider it advisable that the Society should print, for the same purpose, the Apostolic Fathers, the Ecclesiastical History of Eusebius, and the Homilies of St. Chrysostom; and they request that they may be empowered, with the approbation of his Grace the President, to print editions of these works for circulation among the clergy and other members of the Greek Church.

"The Committee are happy to learn that the authorities of the Greek Church will be glad to avail themselves of the offer made to them by the Secretary, of translating and printing any of the Society's publications, which they can consistently approve of, for circulation in Greece. But as the Standing Committee already possess the power of ordering such translations to be made, it will not be necessary to make any application to the Board for that purpose.

"It having been moved that the Report be adopted, and some discussion having taken place, it was moved by way of amendment by the Dean of Chichester,

""That the consideration of this Report be deferred till the next meeting."

"The Rev. R. Monro seconded this.

"The amendment was lost.

"The Rev. J. Endell Tyler then moved, as an amendment to the original motion,

""That the Report be adopted, with the omission of the words "the Apostolic Fathers.""

"This amendment was seconded by the Rev. Dr. D'Oyly, and carried."

In explanation of these proceedings it may be stated, that certain members present objected that the term "Apostolic Fathers" was too indefinite, and begged to be informed what writers were intended to be included under it. The Secretary replied that those Fathers were contemplated who were so termed by Archbishop Wake; whereupon a discussion arose on the question of what writers were entitled to the name, and on the comparative merits of those recognized by Archbishop Wake. Some members strongly protested against this discussion as contrary to the rules of the Society,

which prohibit all debate on any theological subject. The objection however was overruled, and the Board proceeded at considerable length to entertain the questions. As might have been anticipated, no decision was arrived at. And hence, partly to evade the difficulty, and partly, it may be feared, from a wish to get rid of the "Apostolic Fathers," it was proposed to leave them out from the Report. This proposal, it will be seen, was carried, notwithstanding a strenuous opposition on the part of a few members present.

These facts are painfully illustrative of the character of this Society's proceedings, and of its very faulty constitution. The simple facts are these:—The Primate of the English Church entered into communication with the heads of the Greek Church; and after diligent inquiry into the wants of that Church by the Secretary of the Society during a personal visit, it is proposed to print certain books for circulation amongst the Greek clergy. This proposal is maturely weighed by the Foreign Translation Committee, who, under the sanction and approbation of the Archbishop of Canterbury, draw up a Report recommending the adoption of the plan as above detailed. This plan is brought forward at a public meeting. *By chance* there happens to be present a majority unfavourable to a very important part of it. And on the spur of the moment, in an assembly as little deserving the name of *deliberative*, as can well be imagined, the proposal of the Committee, who, it must be supposed, had maturely considered it, and the sanction and approbation of the Archbishop are set at naught.

It cannot be said that this was merely a slight upon the Committee; because their recommendation was understood to have the approbation of the Archbishop. Besides, all they asked was, "to be empowered, *with the approbation of his Grace the President*, to print editions" of the proposed works for circulation in the Greek Church.

As the Report appears above, a stigma seems to be thrown on the Apostolic Fathers. Let the clergy of the Church of England observe the terms of the amendment which was carried; "That the Report be adopted, *with the omission of the words 'Apostolic Fathers.'*" Is this resolution in harmony with the general sentiments of the clergy? We confidently answer, no.

Notices of Books

[*British Critic*, July 1841.]

Archdeacon Thorp, of Bristol, has published two Charges delivered in 1839 and 1840. They embrace the subjects of Cathedral Chapters, Rural Chapters, Church Discipline, Church independence, the Tithe Commutation Act, and Church Rates; and contain an excellent suggestion on the union of the Five Church Societies into a Church Union Society.

Dr. Pusey has published a Sermon, preached in Bristol, (Rivingtons,) under the title of "Christ the Source and Rule of Christian Love."

The learned Dr. Todd has published a literary curiosity (Dublin Univ. Press), "The Last Age of the Church," by John Wycliffe, the morning star of the Reformation.

Mr. Collison, of St. John's, Cambridge, has published (Rivingtons) a temperate and successful "Vindication of the Anglican Reformers" from the well-meant calumnies of Professor Scholefield.

Mr. Beaufort's Norrisian Essay on "Scripture sufficient without Tradition" (J. W. Parker), is a careful, learned, temperate, and well-reasoned essay on the important subject which it undertakes. It is singular that the same general subject has been proposed for one of the Oxford Theological prizes of the year, which has been gained by the Rev. M. Pattison, Fellow of Lincoln College. These prizes are not ordinarily published, but the character of Mr. Pattison's mind, as seen in a work which we have reviewed above, is sufficient to assure us of the clearness and critical acumen with

which he would treat an argument.

"A letter to the Warden of Wadham on the Oxford System of Education," (Vincent, Oxford,) is the work of a person who has evidently thought a good deal on the subject, and does not write at random.

The Bishop of Nova Scotia has published a Sermon in behalf of the Society for the Propagation of the Gospel. Mr. Hussey, Censor of Christ Church, a University Sermon on "The Great Contest," preached on Easterday; and Mr. Sibthorp, a University Sermon on St. Mark's, under the title of "The Claims of the Catholic Church;"—both excellent; the latter especially interesting from its subject;—Mr. C. Marriott, another University Sermon on St. Barnabas, on "The Church's Instruments for the Work of the Holy Spirit;" Archdeacon Thorp, an impressive University Sermon, called "The Student's Walk;" Mr. Ram, a Visitation Sermon at Towcaster; Mr. Tarbutt, a Sermon on the Observance of Lent; Mr. Scott, a Sermon on Christian Quietness, by way of warning against so-called Revivals of Religion.

It is with melancholy satisfaction that we have received, in a collected form, the late Mr. Davison's "Occasional Publications" (Rivingtons); satisfaction, that so many papers can be traced to him on theological and other subjects; deep regret, that his pastoral labours hindered the gifted author from leaving us further memorials of his faith and wisdom.

"Principles of Natural Education, by Rev. H. Hopwood," (Burns,) is an examination of the views of "the state-educationists," with the main object of pointing out what is good in them, and developing it into something more definite and real than they present. The idea is philosophical and valuable, and it is well brought out.

"Hints to Teachers in National Schools," by the same author, (Burns), is a useful little selection of remarks and hints from some authors of name on the subject of education. There is much in it that is highly interesting; for on no subject has there been more ingenuity elicited than on education. The writer notices, with respect to some of these authors, their sad want of "definite Christian principles." If it had been possible, (which perhaps it was not), the book would have been made much more valuable by being compiled more from sources not thus objectionable.

"The history of a Pocket Prayer Book, written by itself," (Philadelphia), collects under that fictitious form a great number of facts and true narratives; and shows how wide and how deep church principles are taking root in the United States.

"The careless Christian reminded of his Privileges, warned of his Danger, and urged to repent without delay," by the Rev. G. W. Woodhouse, (Rivingtons), is written in a serious practical style, and more sound and faithful in its doctrine than many publications on the subject.

Mr. Cyril Hutchinson's "Plain Sermons on the Church Ministry and Sacraments," (Cleaver), are clear and plain spoken discourses, designed to prove the danger of slighting these means of grace.

Mr. Woodward writes on "The Amusements of the World" (Duncan and Malcolm) in a style almost amusing enough to be a fair substitute for them. Far be it from us to tolerate anything so utterly out of the control of the Church as the theatre in its present state, but we cannot agree with Mr. Woodward when he says, that if he had an acquaintance, a most exalted character, as near Christian perfection as a man can be, he would mentally pass a lighter judgment on him if he heard that he had "committed some desperate act of flagrant open sin," than if he heard that "a character of the same high stamp" had "with all sobriety and decorum, presented himself at the theatre." However he does not always speak in this tone.

"Your Life, by an Ex-Dissenter," (Fraser), is in substance a comparative history of the Church of England, and Dissent, for the last century, leading to the condemnation of the latter. It is a mixed

and rambling production, running too much on statistics to be always interesting; but contains many good observations.

Mr. Fulford has published a very interesting Essay on "The Progress of the Reformation in England," (Rivingtons), likely to do great service by exposing some popular errors on that subject.

The Bishop of Chester has published a Charge, in which, amongst other topics, he urges on Dissenters "the Church, which authority has accredited, antiquity bequeathed, and the judgment of succeeding ages sanctioned."

A volume of Sermons by the Rev. T. T. Smith (Hatchard) appears both sound and practical.

Mr. Tate's "Continuous History of St. Paul" (Longman) is drawn up on the basis of Paley's "Horæ Paulinæ," and is intended to exhibit clearly the series and succession of St. Paul's labours and writings.

The excellent Bishop Mant has finished his elaborate work on "The History of the Church of Ireland" (Parker). The author has adopted the most useful mode of writing history, that of incorporating original documents into his text.

We do not mean to express our assent to the principles or views of Dean Waddington's "History of the Reformation on the Continent" (Duncan and Malcolm), but it is impossible to speak otherwise than respectfully of a work which has employed an able man through "seven assiduous years."

"Sephardim," or "A History of the Jews in Spain and Portugal, by James Finn," (Rivingtons,) is learned, yet in a popular and attractive form.

"The Canons of the Apostles" are, we are glad to see, published in a separate form, (Parker, Oxford,) with the translation and notes of Johnson.

Mr. Freeman's "Church Principles, as bearing on certain Statutes of the University of Cambridge," is a sound-principled pamphlet, with the motto, "Ne divagentur Scholares ad Ecclesias parochiales."

The Rev. Johnson Grant's "Sketches in Divinity" (Hatchard) are answers to three hundred questions published at Cambridge as specimens of examination for Orders. They are carefully done, and will furnish the student with much information on the subjects of which they treat, though we cannot follow the author in all he says about the Church of Rome.

Mr. Trench's "Notes on the Parables" (J. W. Parker) are, like every thing he writes, interesting, erudite, and instructive. He has "determined to use very sparingly" the materials which he "found ready to his hand, and rather to make an independent gathering of his own, however small it might prove, than to enter upon other men's labours."

Mr. Parker (Oxford) has added to his excellent series of publications, Hammond's "Parænesis;" Jones's (of Nayland) "Letters from a Tutor to his Pupils," edited by "E. C." and dated "Eton;" Sherlock's "Practical Christian," a devotional work especially to be recommended; and Spelman's "Churches not to be violated." Also, an instructive "Inquiry into the Mode of distributing the Holy Communion in the Church of England and Ireland," by Rev. J. C. Crosthwaite; and "A Book of Family or Private Prayer," by Rev. H. K. Cornish, which will be acceptable to many persons.

We had intended before this to announce the commencement of the publications forming the "Anglo-Catholic Library" (Parker, Oxford). It has begun with three volumes of Bishop Andrews's Sermons, edited with great care and accuracy by Mr. Wilson of Magdalen College. We understand Bramhall's Works, a translation of Bull's Harmonia, and Courrayer's Defence of English Ordinations, are in course of preparation.

Among reprints of old divinity are two excellent Tracts by Thorndike; one "Of the Government of Churches," edited by Rev. D. Lewis, (Stewart); the other on "The Right of the Church in a

Christian State" (Cleaver), by the Rev. J. Brewer. Also of Bishop Ken's "Pastoral Letter and Sermon on Daniel" (Wertheim); and of Mede's "Three Discourses on the Church and Offertory" (Burns). There have also come out Bishop Patrick on "The Work of the Ministry," edited by the Rev. W. B. Hawkins, (Rivingtons); and Bishop Montague's "Articles of Inquiry," (Rivingtons), with an interesting memoir, and notes.

We are glad to see a reprint also of Lawrence's "Lay Baptism invalid" (Burns), edited by Mr. Scott, of Hoxton.

Of the Englishman's Library (Burns) has appeared, Mr. Paget's instructive and excellent "Tales of the Village," Parts I. and II.; Dean Howard's "Scripture History of the New Testament;" and "Charles Lever," another of Mr. Gresley's clever productions. The 18th No. of this collection is a reprint of "The Art of Contentment," a series of meditations for those who are suffering or feeling disappointment, by Lady Pakington, the reputed author of *The Whole Duty of Man*; edited by the Rev. W. Pridden.

A considerable portion of Mr. Bosanquet's "Rights of the Poor" (Burns) has already appeared in this Review. Those who perused so much of it will need no recommendation of it in its new and enlarged form.

"Home Discipline by a Mother" (Burns) is a thoughtful little work, and will suggest thoughts to others, for which they will thank the authoress. The subjects of which it treats will best be seen by the headings of some of the chapters; such as, "the Government of Servants, and other Dependents;" "General Arrangement of a Family;" and "Home Duties as taking Precedence of Public."

Mr. Parkinson on "The Present Condition of the Labouring Poor in Manchester" (Simpkin and Marshall), is the pamphlet of a person who writes from what he sees and knows, and who combines knowledge with good principle.

We cannot give the reader a clearer notion of "Anti-Popery, a new edition altered and amended by John Rogers," (Simpkin and Marshall,) than by stating his opinion, that certain divines are "endeavouring to bring a dark papal cloud athwart our clear and bright Protestant firmament, by circulating the Oxford Tracts, or rather Oxford Trash."—p. 37. Also, he writes "*suprematy* and *primaty* for supremacy and primacy, as more musical and more etymological."—p. 61. Nor "could he well avoid coining the word *secundaty*," which "comes regularly from *secundus*, as primaty from *primus*."—p. 309.

We are glad to find from the Pastoral Letter of Mr. Boyd, of St. John's, Philadelphia, with the authorities he brings from bishops of his Church, that our American brethren are beginning a movement against the system of pew rent.

"The Festivals and Fasts of the Church of England" (Burns), conveys instruction upon the subjects which it treats in an attractive, because in a devotional and affectionate tone. "The Mother of St. Augustine" is another of the little works which Mr. Burns has so seasonably furnished for young people.

An excellent Essay upon the "True Character of the Scripture Work of Mercy" has been published by "A Clergyman of the Archdeaconry of Dorset," under the title of "A hospital is a Religious Institution."

"One Tract more, or the System illustrated by the Tracts for the Times externally regarded, by a Layman," (Rivingtons,) will repay an attentive perusal.

Of Mr. H. E. Head's "Sermons on the First Principles of the Oracles of God," (Palmer and Son), it may be enough to observe, that he denies not only the Eternal Sonship of the Word, but even that the Word is Son in any real sense whatever.

Mr. W. Harness, the author of *Four Sermons* preached before the University of Cambridge, on the subject, "The Image of God in the Soul of Man," (Rivingtons), appears to us to treat of that *first* creation of man, the divine attribute of love, and the human instinct of benevolence, too exclusively of other parts both of the revealed word, and of human nature. In *Five Sermons*, on the parable of the "Rich Man and Lazarus," preached before the University of Cambridge, by the Rev. J. Hildyard, (Rivingtons), the author has introduced under that awful subject a great deal that is sound and useful, written in a serious style.

"Pastoral Addresses," by the late Bishop of Chichester, (J. W. Parker), is a valuable collection of Charges, Letters, and Sermons of that lamented prelate.

"Sermons on the Seven Churches of Asia, and other subjects," by the late Mr. Carr, of Southborough, (Dalton), is a publication much to be regretted. There are many things, both in the matter and in the style, which one can hardly suppose the writer would deliberately print and publish, and which it is painful to think were ever even spoken. Some of the worst peculiarities of the Jacob Abbot school, and worse even than they, are here to be found. For example, "Our blessed Lord himself does not appear to have been a man of strong nerve;"—"If this were the day of visions, and one of you saw Christ, in a vision, *making at you* with a sharp sword, &c.;" soon after, "Christ is well pleased, *I am assured*, with our creeds and articles of religion;"—"that it is his last effort, is evident from what he (Christ) says about *supper-time*;"—"even Christ himself said, Why call ye me good? Can they then be blameless who deify and canonize men into such objects of veneration as to make them almost worshipped;"—"as if he (Christ) said, 'I am glad you respect the name of a Christian, *that is something*,' &c.;"—"after an interval *which gave Jesus an opportunity* of showing much love to them all," &c.

The 4th No. of the Publications of the Cambridge Antiquarian Society is an essay on the application of Heraldry to the illustration of various University and Collegiate Antiquities, by H. A. Woodham, Esq., A.B.

In the May Number of the *Christian Miscellany* our readers will find three most interesting lectures by the Rev. John Jebb on the Cathedral Service,—its history, and rationale; with suggestions for its proper performance.

"The Lyra, or Sacred Songs, the words taken chiefly from the *Lyra Apostolica*," (Bates), is a collection of airs, some original, and some adapted from German and other composers. Several of the originals are very sweet and suitable. The Morning and Evening may be singled out as most likely to be generally pleasing. The others have considerable merit, but are more difficult. The airs taken from foreign composers are melodious and well adapted; though perhaps we should say that some of them do not quite come up to the serious tone of the words.

The Rev. Samuel Rickards has published, with an especial view to a rural congregation, "*Selections from the Prayer-Book Versions of the Psalms*," (Rivingtons), adapted to the services of the Church, and the different seasons of the Christian year. The Psalms are selected, and the tunes from our old English Psalmody appropriated to them, with carefulness and skill. With a view to the object of the work it is cheap, and easy of use.

Mr. Ogle's "*Mariamne, an Historical Novel of Palestine*," (Fraser,) has prefixed to it a flattering recommendation from Sir Walter Scott.

Mr. Alison's meritorious object, in his "*Principles of Population*," (Cadell,) is to "illustrate the intentions of God in the moral works of nature," and to deduce from statistical, geographical, and economical considerations, "the principles of supreme wisdom, human corruption, spiritual regeneration, and Christian charity."

Dr. Silver's "Second Letter to Sir R. H. Inglis on the Origin and Importance of the Church Rate" (Rivingtons), is one of the most learned pamphlets we have met with a long while.

Le Keux's "Memorials of Cambridge" continue. The new Numbers, from the tenth to the fifteenth, contain views and antiquities of C. C. College, Trinity Hall, and Sidney Sussex College; and of Great St. Mary's, with several other parishes.

We do not profess to agree with all the sentiments entertained by the author of "Pastoral Annals" (Seeley and Burnside), but they are written by a person of independent mind, though not of the most fastidious taste.

Mr. Gillmour's "Unity of the Church" (Rivingtons) is an impressive and forcible essay on a subject which will, we trust, attract more and more the anxious attention of all Christian denominations, and, not the least, members of the Church itself.

We have received a number of excellent Tracts from the New York Protestant Episcopal Tract Society. By-the-bye, we are glad to have the great authority of Dr. Mac Vickar's opinion against some of the words which go to make up this composite title. "For the legal style and designation of the Church in America," he says, "we are indebted, partly to the necessity of discriminating among the endless divisions of Christians in this country, as well w perhaps to some want of true Churchmanship in those who first adopted it."

We have to notice a useful series of "Questions and Answers on the Church Catechism," by Mr. Sandford, (Rivingtons). And another of the same character, under the title of "A Manual of Christian Doctrine," (Burns,) by the Rev. John James.

Two very graphic and effective exposures have appeared of the mode in which Church-Building and Repairs are at present conducted (Burns); one by Mr. Paget, under the title of "St. Antholin's;" the other is anonymous, and is called "The Church Committee, or an Incident in the Life of Mr. John Wilful."

"Difficulties of Elementary Geometry, especially those which concern the straight Line, the Plane, and the Theory of Parallels, by F. W. Newman, formerly Fellow of Balliol College," (Ball and Co.) is an ingenious attempt to suggest a basis for geometrical proof, more axiomatic than that adopted in Euclid's Elements. With this view the author, whose high mathematical talent is well known to his contemporaries at the University, does not scruple to introduce the idea of *motion* and the doctrine of *limits* into his definitions, though aware of the objections to which, at first sight, such a method is exposed.

"Sacred Poems," by the Rev. J. Gorle, (Rivingtons), are the production of a cultivated mind, and contain much finished versification.

The known history of the Nestorians appears to us fully to account for their present condition, without having recourse to Dr. Asahel Grant's hypothesis that they are the Lost Tribes. Possibly this writer's prepossessions may have helped him to this conclusion. "They have," he says, "broad common ground with Protestant Christians, so that not inappropriately they have been called the Protestants of Asia."

A layman has published what he calls "The Bishop. A Series of Letters to a newly-created Prelate," (How and Parsons). Being advice to a bishop, the cover is adorned with a splendid mitre; and being written by *one* man, the motto in the title-page is, "The opinion of the *many* possesses great value." The writer also suggests that as bishops are appointed by laymen, therefore laymen are their proper advisers, on the principle that it is not a jury of cooks, but the guests, who pronounce whether a dinner has been well dressed. The writer gives "his friend" much the same advice that all the world has been favouring bishops with for the last fifty years and longer,—that

they must not make their sons tuft-hunters, &c.; and then says that converting the maxim "*præcipere laudando*," he has offered a tribute of applause in the guise of precept. As the letters were entirely private and confidential in the first instance, they were written in sentences of the length of a page, with abundance of illustration and oratorical ornament. Having been so written, of course they were published, contrary, however, to a rule the writer himself lays down that "*a concio ad clerum* must not become a *concio ad populum*."

A Winter in the Azores," by J. Bullar, M.D. and H. Bullar, of Lincoln's Inn, (Van Voorst), is written in a light amusing style, with numerous pretty sketches, both by pencil and pen. It gives a pleasant account of the people, and describes their religious customs with as much sympathy as one expects from a good-natured traveller of the liberal school.

"A History of British Star-Fishes," by Edward Forbes, Esq. (Van Voorst), discloses a world of wonders round our shores. The illustrations, in which fancy is made to lighten science, are very beautiful.

"Letters from Italy to a Younger Sister," by Catharine Taylor, (Murray), a mere traveller's note-book, not much illumined by sentiment. Speaking of the splendid decorations of the tomb of Borromeo, she makes the following singular remark: "These riches seem indeed ill to accord with the memory of one whose life was devoted to acts of mercy and benevolence, and whose days were spent in self-denial and humiliation." Has this lady ever read the Beatitudes?

"One Hundred Sonnets," translated from Petrarch, with the original and notes, by Susan Wollaston, (Bull), are at once elegant as compositions, and useful for Italian students; but we cannot prevail on ourselves to be patient with a poet whose genius is dedicated to the praises of another man's wife, whom, by-the-bye, suitably enough, he fell in love with in church on Good Friday.

"Poems by Lady Flora Hastings" (Blackwood) is really a beautiful volume, and speaks as pleasingly for the religious feeling as for the talent of the lamented writer.

Sir A. Croke's "Progress of Idolatry, and other Poems," (Rivingtons,) are written at once with learning and classical taste. However, we like the poetry better than the theology.

"The Selwood Wreath" (Burns) is a collection of poems from one neighbourhood, forming an agreeable memento of the parties concerned in it. They are written with much religious and amiable feeling, and are not ambitious of any extended celebrity.

An elegant edition of Bishop Heber's Poems (Murray) has been published in one volume.

"Athanasion, an Ode by A. C. Coxe," (Hertford, America,) is a poem of much merit, and more promise.

Mr. Hankinson's "Ministry of Angels, a Seatonian Poem," (J. W. Parker), evidences abundant power of versification and elegance of thought; but one marvels how any one should treat the very sacred subjects which are introduced with so little sobriety and reverence as is here shown, e.g.

"There be Four, standing by the Throne,
Nearest of living things;
Within the rim of the rainbow zone,
They catch its emerald tints upon
The snow of their folded wings."

Is St. John's heaven a romance or fairy tale, to be celebrated in ballad-metre?

The Camden Society at Cambridge, amongst other valuable services to the cause of sacred architecture, has published some useful Directions to Church-wardens, which should be circulated

to every parish in the kingdom. We have, however, two objections to make. The first is a matter of taste. We do not think that stone is beyond doubt the best paving for churches. For our part we like coloured tiles, which are getting cheaper every day, quite as well. The other is a more important affair. It is most dangerous to attempt the cure of damp by clearing away the earth from the foundations of churches. In half-a-dozen instances, recently, within our knowledge, this proceeding has been followed by the spreading of the walls, the earth having, as it afterwards appeared, done the duty of a buttress. Our churches were built in days when people did not care for damp, and built their own houses half underground. From inspection we are able to say that it was common to build village churches thus: an excavation was made the size of the church, one or *two* or *three* feet deep; the foundations were laid not much below the inner surface, and *against* the side of the excavation. In such cases, instead of the earth having accumulated against the wall, it will be found that the outer face of the wall to that height never was above ground, and accordingly was not finished. At least let not the earth be removed without the advice and assistance of an experienced architect.

The following has been sent to us as an illustration of our remarks in the last Number on Religious Advertisements. It is without parallel.

"NEWLY INVENTED WAFERS, neatly coloured, containing fifty various Scripture Texts, Maxims, Admonitions, and Appeals.

"The publisher has spared neither time, trouble, nor expense, in preparing these Wafers, and trusts that by a general circulation, they will tend greatly to encourage the Christian, impart a word of consolation to the afflicted, admonish the careless professor, and warn the impenitent sinner.

"They possess many advantages beyond any article in present use; require only to be moistened on one side, and gently pressed, are considerably cheaper than sealing-wax, and the mottoes being short, and impressive, are more liable to be read and remembered than a tract.

"Sold by —, Paternoster-row, and all booksellers, at the low rate of 3d. per 100; and sent, post-free, at 4d. per 100; or 300 for 10d., if the cash is enclosed to —, Essex.

"All true Christians should immediately forward their orders, and use these wafers, without delay, and thus assist in disseminating gospel truths and religious precepts throughout the world.

"'As ye have opportunity do good unto all men.'—Gal. v. 10."